Research Check — Cross-Tradition Compendium

The Gods of the World

A CROSS-CULTURAL COMPENDIUM

Organized by Sacred Domain, Not by Culture — Sun Gods with Sun Gods, House Gods Room by Room

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Nearly a thousand gods, spirits, and sacred beings drawn from every document in this project — Yoruba orishas beside Norse gods, Aztec sun-kings beside Roman hearth-goddesses — regrouped here not by the culture that named them, but by what they actually govern.

Every sun god stands with every other sun god. Every river spirit with every other river spirit. The household gods are gathered room by room, from the kitchen hearth to the threshold to the storehouse, so the shape of a sacred home becomes visible across dozens of unrelated traditions at once.

Each entry keeps a short line on how that being was — or still is — honored: the offerings, the taboos, the proper way to approach. Treat this as a working reference, not a ranking; the goal is to see the patterns human beings keep discovering independently, everywhere, about what deserves reverence.

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Creator & Supreme Beings

The originators — the supreme, often distant, sources from which all other gods, spirits, and creation itself proceed.

Abba Chokoli — *Alabama-Coushatta*
"The One Above," supreme sacred power who established the world and proper relationships. Creator deity, source of the Above World order.
How to honor: *Abba Chokoli, the Alabama-Coushatta supreme creator, is honored chiefly through the Green Corn Ceremony (Poskitv), an annual first-fruits renewal rite involving fasting, ceremonial dancing around the sacred fire, and the ritual "coming out" of old grievances and personal cleansing before the new corn crop is eaten; the Sacred Fire kept at the talwa ceremonial ground is treated as his living manifestation and central to this and other communal ceremonies.*

Aditi — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Mother of the gods, presides over Punarvasu nakshatra. Primordial mother goddess of boundlessness and renewal.
How to honor: *Aditi, presiding over Punarvasu nakshatra, is honored less through independent temple cult and more through invocation as the primordial mother in Vedic hymns (including sections of the Aditya Hridayam tradition) and through general mother-goddess veneration; Punarvasu-nakshatra rites invoke her name for renewal, protection, and boundless nurturing. She has no major dedicated temple network comparable to other Vedic deities.*

Ahura Mazda — *Zoroastrianism*
Wisdom, all good, source of Asha (truth/order). The one supreme good God, locked in cosmic struggle with Angra Mainyu.
How to honor: *Ahura Mazda is honored through five daily prayer periods (Gehs) facing a source of light, continuous tending of sacred fire in Atash Behram fire temples (fed with sandalwood, never allowed to go out), and the ethical triad of Good Thoughts, Good Words, Good Deeds. The Navjote initiation formally inducts young Zoroastrians into this practice, and Nowruz (Persian New Year) is a major living festival honoring him; corpse contact and fire pollution are strict taboos, traditionally addressed via towers of silence.*

Ahura Mazda (Ohrmazd) — *Zurvanism (Persian)*
Good creator deity, son of Zurvan's thousand-year sacrifice, ruler after the 12,000-year cycle. The good, wise creator god, twin brother of Ahriman.
How to honor: *Ahura Mazda is honored through the Yasna, the central Zoroastrian liturgy performed by a priest (mobed) before the sacred fire (atash), with recitation of the Gathas (Zoroaster's own hymns) and offerings of milk, pomegranate leaves, and haoma. Fire temples (Atash Behram) keep a perpetually tended flame fed with sandalwood as his living symbol, never blown out with breath (considered impure); daily prayer at the five gah (times of day) and truthful speech/action (Asha) constitute the primary devotional discipline of his followers.*

Allah (Islam) — *Islam*
The one God, no partners (tawhid); 99 beautiful names. The sole God of Islam, indivisible and without partners.
How to honor: *The one God of Islam, honored through tawhid-centered practice: the five daily prayers (salah) at fixed times facing Mecca, recitation of the Shahada, fasting during Ramadan, obligatory almsgiving (zakat), and pilgrimage (Hajj) if able. Recitation of the 99 Names (Asma al-Husna), often on prayer beads (misbaha), and reading the Quran are core devotional acts; shirk (associating partners with God) is considered the one unforgivable sin, making avoidance of idols/images central to worship.*

Allah (the Divine/Al-Haqq) — *Sufism*

Sole reality in Wahdat al-Wujud (Unity of Being). The one Being from which all existence emanates; both nearest and farthest from the practitioner.
How to honor: *Sole Reality of Sufi metaphysics, approached through dhikr (rhythmic remembrance of God's names, often with prayer beads/tasbih), fana (ego-annihilation), and sama (sacred listening/music) — most famously the whirling ceremony (sema) of the Mevlevi order. Adab (proper conduct toward a living shaykh within a tariqa/lineage) structures practice, and communal dhikr circles, often held on specific nights tied to a Sufi order's calendar, are the primary living devotional setting.*

Amenominakanushi no Kami — *Shinto*
Lord of the August Center of Heaven, primordial musubi kami. Central primordial creative deity.
How to honor: *Amenominakanushi, as the most abstract of the primordial kami, has almost no independent devotional tradition — worship is confined to a small number of shrines (notably Suitengū shrines and dedicated Amenominakanushi shrines) where standard shinsen (rice, sake, salt, water, seasonal food) and tamagushi are offered via a priest. No unique rituals, festival days, or taboos are attested specifically; the honest acknowledgment is quiet reverence through ordinary Shinto etiquette rather than any invented specialized rite.*

Atum — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Self-created first god, "the All and the Nothing". Self-created primordial god standing on the first mound.
How to honor: *At Heliopolis, Atum received daily temple offerings of bread, beer, and incense as part of the standard cult-statue ritual (waking, washing, dressing, feeding the god's image), performed by priests each dawn and dusk in his role as the setting/evening sun. He was linked to the sacred ished-tree at Heliopolis, and invoked in funerary texts as the primordial self-created god who would one day dissolve creation back into Nun.*

Atum (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Self-created first god, "the All". Self-generated first god who created Shu and Tefnut.
How to honor: *Atum was honored at his cult center of Heliopolis (Iunu) with daily offerings of bread and beer, chiefly in his aspect as the setting/evening sun; his sacred forms included the mongoose and a serpent to be encountered at day's end. Modern Kemetic practitioners fold him into sunset devotions as the self-created source of the Ennead, paired with Ra as the sun's two poles.*

Ayo Caddi Aymay — *Caddo*
Supreme being, creator of the world. "The one who is most powerful," ultimate sacred source.
How to honor: *Ayo Caddi Aymay, the Caddo supreme being, was approached not directly but through intermediaries — the caddi (chief) and priestly officiants — and through the sacred fire, with tobacco smoke offerings carrying prayers upward. No images or idols were made of him; reverence took the form of communal ceremony, silence, and respect for the sacred order he set in motion.*

Bondye — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Supreme Being, too remote for direct approach. Haitian Creole "Good God," the ultimate divine source.
How to honor: *Bondye is never given a personal shrine, veve, possession-trance, or direct offering in Haitian Vodou — devotion is structured so that Bondye, as the remote supreme source, is approached exclusively through the Lwa. Every Vodou ceremony formally opens by invoking Legba first to open communication, but all concrete ritual practice — songs, offerings, altars — is directed to the Lwa rather than to him directly.*

Brahma — *Hinduism*
Creation of universe; associated with the Vedas. Four-headed creator god who made the universe but is barely worshipped today.

How to honor: *Brahma is honored almost exclusively at the Brahma Temple in Pushkar, Rajasthan — one of the only major temples to him in the world — especially during Kartik Purnima (October/November), when hundreds of thousands bathe in Pushkar Lake and attend the Pushkar Camel Fair, believed to purify sins. His limited worship (attributed to a curse by sage Bhrigu or, in another telling, his wife Saraswati) means devotees offer flowers, coconut, and prasad specifically at Pushkar rather than through home puja, and priests there recite his mantra "Om Vede Pitre Namaha."*

Brahma (Balinese) — *Balinese (Bali)*
Creator aspect; associated with south, color red. Creator god of the Tri Murti.
How to honor: *Brahma is honored within the canang sari (daily palm-leaf offering tray) through placement of a red flower or red-toned offering element on the southern portion of the tray, reflecting his direction (south) and color (red); he is also invoked in temple ceremonies addressing the Tri Murti collectively, such as at Pura Besakih's Padma Tiga shrine complex. Red hibiscus is a favored offering flower for his aspect.*

Brahma (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
The creator, presides over Rohini nakshatra. Creator god of the Hindu trimurti.
How to honor: *Brahma, presiding over Rohini nakshatra, is a striking case of a major deity with almost no dedicated temple worship — his primary shrine is at Pushkar, Rajasthan, honored especially during Kartik Purnima with pilgrimage bathing in Pushkar Lake and a five-day fair. Rohini-nakshatra rites invoke him through mantra rather than temple offering, reflecting the broader Puranic tradition that Brahma's creative role, once complete, left him without ongoing cultic worship elsewhere.*

Brahman (Bhagavad Gita) — *Bhagavad Gita / Hinduism*
The impersonal Absolute/ultimate reality that the practitioner seeks union with. Ultimate impersonal divine reality/Godhead of Vedantic philosophy.
How to honor: *Brahman, as the impersonal Absolute, is not worshipped with offerings, images, or festivals in the way personal deities are — there are no temples or idols dedicated to Brahman directly since it is formless (nirguna). Devotees approach it instead through jnana yoga (study of the Upanishads and self-inquiry into "Atman is Brahman"), meditation, and repetition of the sacred syllable Om, its primary sound-symbol, along with renunciation practices (sannyasa) aimed at dissolving the ego that obscures it. The Gita frames union with Brahman as the fruit of disciplined knowledge, selfless action, and meditation rather than devotional ritual.*

Chaos — *Greek*
Primordial void from which all else emerges. The primordial gap preceding all creation.
How to honor: *Chaos, the primordial void from which the Greek cosmos emerged, has no attested cult, temple, offerings, or festival in ancient sources — it functioned as a cosmogonic concept in Hesiod's Theogony rather than a worshipped deity. The historically appropriate acknowledgment is philosophical/cosmological contemplation of Chaos as the pre-condition for existence, not invented ritual practice.*

Christ (Christ Pantokrator) — *Byzantine*
Second person of Trinity, "Ruler of All". Divine-human incarnate Logos; central figure of theosis and the Byzantine liturgy.
How to honor: *Christ (Christ Pantokrator) is venerated through the Divine Liturgy (Eucharist), veneration (proskynesis, not worship) of Pantokrator icons via kissing and prostration, continuous recitation of the Jesus Prayer ("Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, have mercy on me"), and lit beeswax candles and incense before his icon. Pantokrator icons were placed in the central dome of Byzantine churches, deliberately positioned so worshippers stood beneath his gaze during liturgy. Fasting (especially Great Lent) and frequent communion are the primary embodied devotional practices.*

Chukwu — *Igbo Odinani (Nigeria)*

Supreme divine being, source of all lesser divine beings including Chi. All-encompassing creative force/ground of existence, source of every person's Chi.
How to honor: *Chukwu is considered too exalted for direct shrine worship or personal offerings; devotees approach him indirectly through Chi, Ala, the alusi (lesser spirits), and ancestors, who mediate between the ultimate source and daily life. Honoring him directly takes the form of acknowledgment in prayer as the ultimate ground of existence rather than ritual offerings.*

Cozaana — *Zapotec*
Male creative principle, breathed life into first humans, ancestral lineage. Male half of the Zapotec creator pair, source of cosmic order.
How to honor: *Cozaana, paired with Huichaana as co-creator, was honored in pre-Columbian Zapotec practice with copal incense, quail or turkey offerings, and temple rites conducted by priests (huijatoo) at ceremonial centers such as Mitla, reflecting his role anchoring ancestral lineage and cosmic order. No unbroken living cult remains; respectful modern acknowledgment is through accurate historical study framed as ancestor-reverence rather than fabricated ritual.*

Daemosin (Creation Grandmother) — *Korean Muism*
Cosmic creator deity invoked in the Daesin Gori segment. The grandmother deity who made the world.
How to honor: *Daemosin (also called Mago Halmi in some Korean creation lore) has no widely codified individual shrine or offering set; she is honored collectively within the "Daesin" segment of gut by burning incense and offering rice cakes (tteok) and makgeolli (rice wine) at an outdoor or mountain-facing altar, with the mudang narrating her creation myth. Because she is a primordial/cosmic figure rather than a personal deity with taboos, devotion centers on reverent invocation and storytelling rather than individualized likes/dislikes — the appropriate acknowledgment is inclusion in the opening cosmological segment of gut, not invented ritual specifics.*

Dainichi Nyorai (Vairochana) — *Shingon*
Cosmic Buddha, ground of all reality (Dharmadhatu itself). The Cosmic Buddha whose body, speech, and mind constitute the entire universe.
How to honor: *Egungun masquerades are honored annually with kola nut, palm wine, and food offerings left at family ancestral shrines, accompanied by drumming and oriki (praise chanting) as the costumed dead "walk" through the community. The strictest taboo is that women and the uninitiated must never touch the costume or learn the identity of the performer beneath the mask.*

Di / Shang Di (Chinese Folk Religion) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
High god of Shang oracle-bone divination. Earliest attested Chinese high god.
How to honor: *Di/Shang Di, the earliest attested Chinese high god, was consulted by Shang dynasty kings through oracle-bone divination — cracking heated ox scapulae or turtle shells and interpreting the resulting fissures — with animal and, in the royal cult, human sacrifice archaeologically attested. No continuous living cult to him survives; the most historically appropriate acknowledgment today is accurate presentation of the Shang oracle-bone inscriptions rather than invented modern ritual.*

Diyin Dine'e (Holy People, general) — *Navajo/Dine*
Sacred beings who created conditions for human life and gave the ceremonial system. Sacred beings pre-dating humanity, source of Hozho.
How to honor: *The Diyin Dine'e are addressed daily and ceremonially with corn pollen (tádídíín), sprinkled at dawn facing east while reciting prayers such as the Beauty Way song, and offered again before undertaking any significant task. A hataali (medicine person) conducts the specific chantway (Blessingway, Nightway, Enemy Way, etc.) proper to the need, using sandpaintings, songs, and prayer sticks. The four sacred stones — white shell, turquoise, abalone, and jet — are placed with intention as part of these rites.*

Ein Sof — *Kabbalah*
The Infinite, divine ground beyond all names/attributes. Absolute unknowable divine reality underlying all sephirot.
How to honor: *Ein Sof, as the utterly transcendent, attributeless Infinite, is by definition unapproachable through offerings or petition — no ritual object or gift is directed at Ein Sof itself. The proper approach is apophatic (negative-theology) contemplation: Chabad Hasidism's hitbonenut practice involves sustained, silent meditative concentration before prayer, deliberately emptying conceptual thought to approach the divine ground beyond names, with the sephirot serving as the only intermediary "lenses" through which Ein Sof is engaged indirectly.*

Ein Sof (Five Paths) — *Kabbalah (referenced under Panentheism)*
The Infinite; contracts (tzimtzum) to make space for creation within itself. The limitless, ungraspable ground of God in Jewish mysticism.
How to honor: *Ein Sof, as the utterly transcendent, unmanifest Infinite in Kabbalah, has no altar, offering, or ritual addressed to it directly — Jewish practice holds that Ein Sof cannot be petitioned or represented at all. "Honoring" it takes the form of contemplative and ethical practice: study of Kabbalistic texts (Zohar, Etz Chayim), meditation on the tzimtzum (contraction) and the Sefirot as the graduated channels through which Ein Sof's light becomes accessible, and living a life of tikkun (repair) understood as restoring the vessels that hold divine light in the world.*

Ein Sof (Gnosticism/Kabbalah) — *Kabbalah (Jewish mysticism)*
The Infinite, unknowable ground of all being. Infinite unknowable divine ground from which the Sephirot emanate.
How to honor: *The Infinite (Ein Sof) is honored through apophatic practice, not offerings — via negativa contemplation, meditative negation of all attributes, and Lurianic Kabbalistic reflection on tzimtzum (divine self-contraction) as the origin point of creation. Traditional Kabbalists approach Ein Sof only indirectly, through the Sephirot and especially the Sabbath, treated as a weekly window onto the undifferentiated source before emanation; no images, sacrifices, or direct petitions are considered appropriate.*

El — *Canaanite*
Supreme father god, president of divine assembly. Gray-bearded elderly patriarch, father of gods and men.
How to honor: *El, the remote patriarch and "Bull El" of the divine council, was approached through priestly intermediaries at temple/high-place shrines rather than direct petition, honored with bull imagery/figurines (his emblem animal), wine libations, and bread offered at sacred groves and mountain sanctuaries; royal feast texts (marzeah banquets) depict him presiding over ritual gatherings. Modern reconstructionists maintain this indirect, elder-statesman approach — formal, respectful invocation rather than casual devotion.*

First Man / First Woman (All My Relations) — *Navajo (Diné)*
Holy People who shaped the landscape and created present-world beings. Foundational Navajo Holy People of emergence cosmology.
How to honor: *First Man and First Woman are honored through invocation in the nine-day Navajo healing chantways (such as the Nightway and Mountainway), where medicine men/hataałii recite their roles in the emergence narrative as part of restoring hózhǫ́ (harmony/balance) in a patient; sandpaintings depicting emergence-era events are created and ritually destroyed as part of these healing rites, and corn pollen is offered in their honor as in most Diné ceremony.*

First Man and First Woman — *Navajo/Dine*
Organized the world at the beginning. Primordial organizing beings of Dine cosmology.
How to honor: *Corn pollen (tádídíín) is offered at dawn as part of daily prayer, paired with white shell and turquoise adornment; the Blessingway is invoked for this pairing's ongoing*

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sacred order. Outsiders should approach through respectful learning rather than replicating the ceremony themselves.

Gitche Manitou (Manitou, All My Relations) — *Algonquian (Ojibwe, Cree, Ottawa, Potawatomi, Abenaki)*
Great Mystery as ongoing process/action; sacred power animating all things. Algonquian Great Spirit, described as process/becoming rather than static being.
How to honor: *Gitche Manitou (Kitchi-Manitou) is honored less through fixed offerings than through a relational ethic: tobacco is offered before harvesting plants, hunting, or entering sacred ground, as a sign of respect toward the manitou present in all beings, and ceremonies such as the Midewiwin (Grand Medicine Society) lodge rites of the Ojibwe formally invoke this Great Mystery through song, drum, and structured initiation. Wastefulness and disrespect toward animals, plants, or other people are considered direct offenses against the sacred relationship Gitche Manitou animates.*

Gitche Manitou / Kitche Manitou — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*
The Great Mystery/Great Spirit pervading all existence. Supreme sacred principle animating all creation, not a distant personal god.
How to honor: *Tumatauenga, atua of war and humankind, is honored through karakia recited before battle, hunting, fishing, and competitive contests, and through the haka as a direct invocation of his strength; the first catch of a hunt or fishing trip is traditionally offered to him, and red ochre (kokowai) is associated with him and worn by warriors. Whakanoa rites follow conflict to restore balance.*

God (Supreme Intelligence) / E.L.O.I. — *Spiritism (Kardec/Trincado)*
Sole divine cause of all things, non-anthropomorphic. The impersonal, just, all-powerful first cause of the universe in Spiritist doctrine.
How to honor: *Impersonal, non-anthropomorphic Supreme Intelligence in Kardecist/Trincado Spiritism; honored not through ritual offerings or supplication but through moral self-improvement, charity (caridade), and mediumship development at Spiritist centers (centros espíritas). Core devotional acts are studying "The Gospel According to Spiritism" and Kardec's codified works, practicing "moral vibration" through good works, and accepting reincarnation-based justice — summarized in the doctrine that "God corrects, but does not punish."*

God / The Godhead — *Christian Mysticism*
Personal God vs. Eckhart's undifferentiated "Godhead" ground of being beyond all names. The divine ground of being, both personal (God) and impersonal/ultimate (Godhead) in the mystical tradition.
How to honor: *Approached two ways in Christian mysticism: as personal God through vocal/discursive prayer, and as the impersonal "Godhead" (Eckhart's Gottheit) through apophatic "unknowing." Concrete practices include Lectio Divina (slow scriptural reading in four movements), Centering Prayer (silent word-repetition to release thoughts), and the Jesus Prayer ("Lord Jesus Christ, have mercy on me") repeated with breath and, in Orthodox practice, prayer rope beads.*

God the Father (Catholicism) — *Roman Catholicism*
First person of the Trinity, creator. The eternal Father and source of all creation in Catholic theology.
How to honor: *First Person of the Trinity, worshipped (latria) through the Mass, the Liturgy of the Hours, and personal/family prayer such as the Our Father addressed directly to "our Father." Devotional practice includes Eucharistic adoration directed ultimately to the Father through the Son, votive candles, and the sign of the cross invoking Father, Son, and Holy Spirit; no material offerings are given, since Catholic theology holds the Mass itself as the perfect offering to Him.*

God the Father, Son, Holy Spirit (Trinity) — *Eastern Orthodoxy*

One essence (ousia), three persons (hypostases). The Orthodox Trinity, approached through apophatic theology and theosis.
How to honor: *The Orthodox Trinity is honored above all through the Divine Liturgy each Sunday, incense, and the veneration (not worship) of icons — kissed and lit with candles — plus repetition of the Jesus Prayer ("Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, have mercy on me") as a form of continual inner prayer. Fasting seasons, especially Great Lent and the Nativity Fast, require abstaining from meat, dairy, and often oil and wine on certain days.*

God/Jehovah/Trinity (Adventism) — *Seventh-day Adventism*
Creator, object of Sabbath worship. Standard Trinitarian Christian God.
How to honor: *The Adventist Godhead is honored chiefly through Sabbath observance from Friday sunset to Saturday sunset — abstaining from work and secular entertainment in favor of worship, rest, and nature — alongside a strict tithe (10% of income) and daily prayer. The Adventist health message treats "unclean" meats (pork, shellfish), alcohol, and tobacco as taboo and encourages vegetarianism, and the writings of Ellen G. White are studied as inspired guidance alongside scripture.*

God/Jehovah/Trinity (Pentecostalism), Jesus Christ, Holy Spirit — *Pentecostalism*
Salvation, Spirit baptism, healing, prophecy. Standard Trinitarian Christian Godhead.
How to honor: *The Pentecostal Godhead is honored through highly participatory worship: speaking in tongues (glossolalia), laying on of hands for healing prayer, altar calls inviting personal conversion or Spirit baptism, and "tarrying" — extended, often loud communal prayer seeking the Holy Spirit's manifest presence. Fasting (frequently a Daniel Fast of vegetables and water) and tithing are standard disciplines, and deliverance/exorcism prayer is practiced in many congregations.*

God/Trinity (Father, Son, Holy Spirit) — *Christianity (all denominations)*
Sole divine being across all branches surveyed. Monotheistic God worshipped across all Christian denominations.
How to honor: *The Trinity is honored through Mass/Divine Liturgy, the Eucharist (consecrated bread and wine), incense, icons, and the sign of the cross in Catholic/Orthodox practice; Protestants emphasize scripture reading, congregational hymn-singing, and personal prayer, while Pentecostals add glossolalia and expressive worship. Common threads across all branches are Sunday communal worship, baptism, and grace before meals.*

Gucumatz — *Maya (K'iche', = Kukulkan)*
Paired creator deity (Shaper), feathered serpent form. K'iche' feathered-serpent creator, paired with Tepeu.
How to honor: *K'iche' Maya feathered-serpent creator ("the Shaper," a Kukulkan/Quetzalcoatl form) honored jointly with Tepeu through copal incense, jade, quetzal feathers, and cacao; associated ritually with Kukulkan's pyramid at Chichén Itzá, where the equinox serpent-shadow effect marks sacred timing. Green and blue-green (jade, quetzal plumage) are his colors, and modern ajq'ijab' still invoke the creator-pair formula from the Popol Vuh in ceremonial prayer.*

Haile Selassie I — *Rastafari*
Believed by Rastafari to be the living incarnation of Jah, returned Christ, Conquering Lion of the Tribe of Judah. Ethiopian Emperor venerated as the living God in flesh.
How to honor: *Jah is honored through "reasoning" (communal philosophical/spiritual discussion sessions), chanting and drumming at Nyahbinghi ceremonies ("grounations"), sacramental use of ganja as meditation, and Ital living — eating natural, unprocessed, salt-free plant-based food and avoiding substances polluting the body-as-temple. Because Jah is understood as present within the self ("I and I"), honoring him is inseparable from righteous personal conduct.*

Hayyi Rabbi — *Mandaean*
"The Great Living One" — transcendent, incomprehensible source of all Light and life. Supreme divine being, source of all uthra and souls.

How to honor: *Empress Menen Asfaw is honored as the Rastafari "Queen Omega," the divine feminine complement to Jah's earthly manifestation in Selassie; her birthday (April 3) is marked with tribute gatherings celebrating her advocacy for women's education, orphan care, and church restoration as models of righteous womanhood. Honoring her is expressed through upholding the sacred partnership principle she represents and invoking her name alongside Selassie's during Nyahbinghi reasoning.*

Heavenly Father (God the Father) — *LDS/Mormon*
Perfected, glorified being with a physical body; literal father of all human spirits. Corporeal, exalted supreme deity of LDS cosmology.
How to honor: *Heavenly Father is honored primarily through personal and family prayer, always addressed directly to Him and closed "in the name of Jesus Christ." Devotion also occurs through temple ordinances, weekly sacrament meeting, keeping the Word of Wisdom (no alcohol, tobacco, coffee, tea), tithing, and family/personal scripture study; there is no altar, image, or physical offering — worship is entirely relational and ordinance-based.*

I AM Presence — *I AM Activity*
Each person's own divine self, a "blazing column of light". The individualized God-self said to exist above and within every person.
How to honor: *The I AM Presence is honored not through offerings but through disciplined speech: devotees voice "I AM" decrees aloud with strong conviction and visualize a blazing column of light above and within themselves. Negative or doubtful self-talk is treated as a serious taboo, since words beginning "I AM" are believed to directly command one's own divine substance into manifestation.*

Ihtsipatapiiyo'pa — *Blackfoot*
"The Great Source," supreme sacred power invoked in sweat lodge prayer. Ultimate sacred source behind Blackfoot wellness practice.
How to honor: *Ihtsipatapiiyo'pa ("The Great Source") is addressed directly in the opening prayers of the Blackfoot sweat lodge (Niitsitapi purification ceremony), invoked as the ultimate source of all life and healing power. Offerings of tobacco and sweetgrass smoke accompany these prayers, and the heated "Grandfather" rocks used in the lodge are themselves prayed over as manifestations of this sacred source.*

Ilmatar — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Air Virgin, primordial water-spirit. Descended onto primordial ocean; world hatched from an egg on her knee.
How to honor: *Ilmatar, the primordial "Air Virgin" who descends into the sea to birth the world in the Kalevala's creation myth, is honored chiefly through recitation of the Kalevala's opening runos as a devotional act in itself. Modern Suomenusko practitioners perform water-blessing rites or leave offerings of milk or clean water at lakesides in her honor, especially at the year's start or during creation-themed rites; the golden-egg/teal symbolism from the world-egg is her key emblem.*

Io Matua Kore — *Maori*
The parentless supreme divine. Placed the three baskets of sacred knowledge in the highest heaven.
How to honor: *Io Matua Kore is honored through restriction rather than offering: his name and the highest sacred knowledge (Kete Tuauri, alongside Kete Tuatea and Kete Aronui) were traditionally confined to senior tohunga ahurewa trained in the whare wānanga, spoken only in the most tapu contexts. Ordinary karakia and first-fruits rites were directed to intermediary atua (Rongo, Tāne) rather than to Io directly; acknowledgment of him is through silence, restraint, and reverence for the boundary between accessible and forbidden knowledge, not public ceremony.*

Izanagi — *Shinto*

Primordial creator god, performed first misogi, birthed major kami. Male half of the primordial creator couple.
How to honor: *Izanagi is honored primarily through misogi, the cold-water purification he performed after returning from Yomi (the act that birthed Amaterasu, Tsukuyomi, and Susanoo from his washing); Izanagi Jingu on Awaji Island, believed to be his retirement place, is his principal shrine. Modern practitioners perform misogi at waterfalls, rivers, or the sea while reciting purification norito (prayers), and salt is used as a purifying offering/scattering agent in his honor.*

Jah — *Rastafari*
Living divine intelligence present within all creation, especially within the human being (doctrine of "I and I"). God as immanent, indwelling divine principle, not a distant judge.
How to honor: *Unkulunkulu, the primordial ancestor and culture hero who emerged from the reed bed (uhlanga) and taught humanity fire, cultivation, and cattle-keeping, is honored as the ultimate ancestor from whom all lineage ancestor-veneration descends; he is acknowledged in praise-naming and origin narratives recited at major ancestral ceremonies. Cattle sacrifice at major rites of passage implicitly honors the practice he originated.*

Jehovah — *Jehovah's Witnesses*
Sole God, ruler of the universe. The one true God whose personal name Witnesses insist must be used and honored.
How to honor: *Jehovah is honored by Jehovah's Witnesses through use of his personal name in prayer and worship (never a generic title alone), attendance at Kingdom Hall meetings, door-to-door and public ministry, and strict avoidance of practices deemed pagan-derived — notably Christmas, birthday celebrations, and blood transfusions, all treated as taboo. The annual Memorial (Nisan 14) commemorating Christ's death is the central yearly observance, with unleavened bread and wine passed but consumed only by the "anointed" 144,000.*

Jesus Christ (Catholicism) — *Roman Catholicism*
Second person of Trinity, incarnate God-man. God incarnate; central figure of salvation and the Mass.
How to honor: *God incarnate, honored through the Eucharist (received as the "real presence" of his body and blood), attendance at Mass, adoration of the Blessed Sacrament in a monstrance, the Stations of the Cross, and the Sacred Heart devotion (with its own feast day and consecration prayers). Fasting during Lent, First Friday devotions, and the Divine Mercy chaplet are common concrete modern practices; images/crucifixes are venerated (not worshipped) as aids to focusing devotion on him.*

Jesus Christ (Jehovah) — *LDS/Mormon*
Firstborn spirit son, proposed the plan of salvation, redeemer. Divine Son central to LDS restoration theology.
How to honor: *Jesus Christ (Jehovah) is honored centrally through the weekly Sacrament ordinance — blessed bread and water passed and consumed in remembrance of His body and blood, renewing baptismal covenants — administered every Sunday. Devotion is also expressed through temple covenants made "through" Him, missionary service performed in His name, and daily discipleship; prayers are closed in His name though addressed to the Father.*

Kalunga (also Huku) — *Muwila*
Supreme divine being; also ocean/boundary between living and dead. Supreme creator whose name also denotes the cosmic boundary between life and death.
How to honor: *Kalunga (Huku) is rarely approached directly; devotion runs through the ancestors (vakulu) as intermediaries, or through a nganga (diviner-healer) or chief who mediates collective crises like drought or epidemic. In those extreme cases, communal rites — cattle or goat sacrifice at a sacred tree or shrine, kneeling with rhythmic hand-clapping (a widespread Southern African Bantu prayer gesture), and public appeal — are used to petition Kalunga as the boundary-figure between life and death.*

Kamimusubi no Kami — *Shinto*
Divine Creative Force, primordial musubi kami. Primordial generative-force deity.
How to honor: *Kamimusubi is honored as one of the three Zōka Sanshin ("three creator kami") together with Amenominakanushi and Takamimusubi, chiefly at Ise's auxiliary shrines and Izumo-linked sites, receiving standard shinsen (rice, sake, water, salt, seasonal vegetables/fruit) and tamagushi sakaki-branch offerings presented through a Shinto priest. Because "musubi" means binding/generative connection, prayers for conception, matchmaking, harvest, and new ventures are considered especially fitting.*

Kane (Hawaiian) — *Hawaiian*
Highest god, creator of the three worlds and first human from red earth and water; god of fresh water and light. Supreme creator god of light, life, and fresh water.
How to honor: *Kane is honored with offerings of fresh water and 'awa (kava) at natural springs, since water is his direct manifestation; white is his sacred color and no image or idol was traditionally made of him, only simple upright stones (pōhaku) at outdoor shrines. He was invoked at the start of any construction or healing ceremony alongside Kanaloa, and his priesthood (kahuna) poured water libations and recited genealogical chants (koʻihonua) tracing his role as creator of the first human, Kumuhonua, from red earth.*

Khnum — *Kemet*
Potter god who fashions body and Ka at birth. Ram-headed god who forms each person's body and life force on his potter's wheel.
How to honor: *Khnum was honored at his cult center of Elephantine, believed to control the Nile's inundation from caverns at the river's source; sacred rams were kept, revered, and mummified there and at Esna in his honor. Potters and craftsmen especially honored him through his mythic role shaping each person's body and ka on the potter's wheel, with offerings tied to the flood season and agricultural fertility.*

Khwede — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Transcendent creator beyond all attributes; delegated governance to seven angels. The supreme, indescribable Creator of the universe.
How to honor: *The boa (ronin) form is reached only after years of successive dietas under senior meraya guidance, regarded as the pinnacle transformation showing a healer has absorbed the deep kene/song knowledge of the anaconda-mother spirit of the water world. A real boa's appearance near a healer or ceremony is read as an omen of protection, and the animal is never hunted by families who keep this tradition; claiming a boa-transformation without the earned dieta lineage is considered a serious fraud within Shipibo healing circles.*

Kinnikasus (Man-Never-Known-on-Earth) — *Wichita (Caddoan, Oklahoma/Texas)*
Ultimate creator, beyond direct human knowing, delegates creative acts. Wichita supreme creator whose name acknowledges his unknowability.
How to honor: *Because Kinnikasus is by definition unknowable and beyond direct human contact, there is no direct shrine or offering practice attested to him — he is approached only indirectly, through prayer and ceremony addressed to the Morning Star as his visible intermediary. This absence of direct cult is itself doctrinally consistent with his name ("Man-Never-Known-on-Earth").*

Kotan-kar-kamuy — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Creator kamuy who made the world via the water wagtail earth-diver myth. "The one who made the world," Ainu creator deity.
How to honor: *Kotan-kar-kamuy, the world-creator kamuy of the water-wagtail earth-diver myth, is honored at kamuy-nomi ceremonies with inau set at the nusasan and sake libations poured with the ikupasuy prayer stick, offering formal gratitude for the land's existence, often at the opening of larger communal or seasonal rites such as founding a new settlement. Wagtails, his mythic helper, are treated with mild reverence, and disturbing land or water features without first offering prayer is considered disrespectful to his creative work.*

Krishna (Bhagavad Gita) — *Bhagavad Gita / Hinduism*
Avatar of Vishnu; the "divine Sri Krishna," charioteer and teacher of Arjuna, speaks the Gita's teachings. Central divine teacher-avatar of the Bhagavad Gita, identified as God incarnate.
How to honor: *Krishna is honored through daily bhakti puja centered on tulsi (holy basil) leaves, which are considered essential and are never omitted from his offerings, along with butter, milk sweets (makhan/peda, recalling the "butter thief" stories of his childhood), and a peacock feather placed near his image. The major festival is Janmashtami (his birth, August/September), observed with a full day's fast broken at midnight, devotional singing (bhajan/kirtan), and re-enactments of his birth story; Gita Jayanti marks the day he is said to have spoken the Bhagavad Gita and is honored with public recitation of its verses. Chanting the Hare Krishna mahamantra and studying/reciting the Gita itself, as he instructs Arjuna to do, are considered direct forms of devotion (bhakti yoga) to him.*

Mannus — *Germanic Heathenry*
Son of Tuisto, ancestor of the three Germanic tribal branches. Divine ancestor figure from whom Germanic tribes descended.
How to honor: *Mannus, son of earth-born Tuisto, is attested only as a genealogical/origin figure in Tacitus's Germania — no historical altar, offering, or festival dedicated to him is recorded. Modern Heathenry honors him through symbolic ancestor-reverence at Ancestor Night/Winternights-type rites, pouring libations of mead or ale "to the ancestors" and reciting the Tuisto-Mannus origin genealogy.*

Mawu-Lisa — *Ewe/Vodun*
Dual creator principle (moon/sun, female/male, night/day). Supreme divine dual unity from which all other Vodun spirits proceed.
How to honor: *Mawu-Lisa, the supreme dual creator, is rarely approached directly with a personal shrine; devotees instead honor the pair through the whole system of lesser Vodun/Trowo spirits who serve as intermediaries, and through twin figurines and cowrie-shell offerings kept in family shrines as symbols of the primordial union. Elder priestesses invoke the Mawu-Lisa name at the opening of major ceremonies as the foundational blessing before other spirits are addressed.*

Mwari / Musikavanhu — *Shona (Zimbabwe)*
Supreme creator, source of rain and agricultural fertility; speaks via Matopo Hills oracle. Shona supreme creator god, too vast for direct everyday petition.
How to honor: *Shishlam, personifying the ideal priest, is honored at Dehwa d-Shishlam Rabba (Feast of the Great Shishlam), when Mandaean priests weave and distribute wreaths of myrtle (asa) to the community; wearing the myrtle wreath is believed to confer protection through the coming year. The feast follows the New Year cycle and centers on priestly blessing.*

Namandu — *Guarani (Paraguay/Brazil/Argentina/Bolivia)*
First Being; creator through sacred speech (ne'e). First Being whose thought and speech created the universe.
How to honor: *Jakaira, associated with mist, spring rains, and prophetic/shamanic inspiration, is honored through petygua tobacco smoke — considered his direct medium of communication with humans — inhaled and exhaled by shamans during trance-inducing invocation. He is called upon particularly at the shift into the rainy season and during shamanic initiation.*

Nana Buluku — *Ewe/Vodun*
Primordial mother, cosmic original. Primordial mother figure, in some traditions mother of Mawu.
How to honor: *Nana Buluku, the primordial mother figure said to precede or birth Mawu-Lisa, has no widely attested independent shrine tradition; she is acknowledged verbally in creation narratives and foundational blessings recited by elder priests/priestesses rather than through dedicated offerings, making respectful acknowledgment of her place in the cosmology the most historically accurate form of "honoring" her.*

Ngenechen — *Mapuche*
Supreme divine being; fourfold entity (old man, old woman, young man, young woman). Sacred creator embodying balance of age, youth, male, female.
How to honor: *Ngenechen is prayed to at the Ngillatun (Ngellipun) ceremony, Mapuche spirituality's central communal rite, held around a sacred rewe pole with offerings, dances (such as the choike purrun), and the kultrun drum, all directed east toward him. Offerings include chicha or muded (fermented maize/apple drinks) and animal sacrifice (traditionally sheep), given in petition for rain, health, and community wellbeing.*

Ninmah — *Mesopotamian*
Creator of humanity in some versions. Creation goddess of humankind.
How to honor: *Ninmah, an alternate name/aspect of the Mesopotamian mother goddess overlapping with Ninhursag, was worshipped at the Emah temple in Babylon as creator of humankind from clay. Offerings mirrored those to Ninhursag: milk, clay/earth, birth-related tokens, and grain; she was invoked for successful childbirth and the shaping/health of infants. Modern devotees may keep a small dish of clay or soil on her altar and offer prayers around pregnancy, birth, and creative "shaping" work.*

Nyame — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*
Supreme creator, omnipotent/omniscient, source of all existence. Supreme sky-god, source of the Kra (divine spark) placed in every person at birth.
How to honor: *Nyame is invoked first in every Akan libation, before any other spirit, with poured water, palm wine, or schnapps and the words "Nyame, Tweaduampon" ("God, the Dependable One"); the Gye Nyame ("Except God") adinkra symbol is worn and displayed as constant acknowledgment of his supremacy. A Nyame dua — a forked branch or post set up near the compound entrance holding a clay pot (kuduo) filled with water and sometimes herbs — is refreshed each morning as a simple household shrine, though he has no priesthood or temple of his own since he is considered too vast to be served directly; people approach him indirectly through the abosom (lesser deities) and ancestors. His Kra, the "soul" or divine spark he places in every newborn, is honored through soul-naming rites (kra din) performed on a child's day of birth.*

Nyonmo — *Ga People (Ghana)*
Supreme creator/sustainer, too exalted for direct approach. Ga supreme deity and creator of all existence.
How to honor: *Nyonmo (Ataa Naa Nyonmo) is considered too exalted to receive direct sacrifice, libation, or a personal shrine — Ga tradition holds he is honored only obliquely, through respect for the ancestors and the lesser Wor deities who mediate on his behalf, and through the annual Homowo harvest festival's spirit of gratitude for sustenance, understood to trace back to him. Correct honoring is indirect reverence rather than petition.*

Obatala — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Creation of human bodies, white cloth, moral purity, peace. Orisha of creation, peace, and moral perfection; shapes human form.
How to honor: *Oshun devotees offer honey, pumpkin, cinnamon, sunflowers, and brass or copper objects, and hold an annual pilgrimage to the Osun-Osogbo sacred grove in Nigeria (a UNESCO site) each August, when thousands gather at the river for the festival. Her colors are yellow and gold, her number 5, and mirrors are used in her rites since vanity and beauty are part of her domain — vultures are sacred to her and never harmed.*

Obatalá — *Lucumí*
Eldest Orisha, shaped first human bodies from clay; purity, peace, wisdom, governs the head. Elder creator Orisha of purity and mental clarity (syncretized with Our Lady of Mercy).
How to honor: *Obatalá's altar is kept strictly white — white cloth, white candles, cascarilla (chalk), coconut, cotton, cocoa butter, and cool water — with silver rather than iron or bright colors. He is never offered alcohol, and his devotees (his "children") are traditionally asked to*

avoid drinking, arguing, and violence out of respect, since he governs the head/mind and purity of thought; his feast (syncretized with Our Lady of Mercy) falls September 24th, and elderly or disabled people are treated with special deference as embodiments of his will.

Ogdoad (Nun/Naunet, Amun/Amaunet, Heh/Hauhet, Kek/Kauket) — *Kemet*
Eight primordial chaos deities (water, hiddenness, infinity, darkness). Four male-female pairs whose interaction produced the cosmic egg and the sun.
How to honor: *The Ogdoad were honored at Hermopolis (Khmun), their creation-myth cult center, represented as four frog-headed gods and four serpent-headed goddesses whose interaction was said to produce the cosmic egg or lotus from which the sun emerged. Devotion was largely cosmological rather than transactional — frog amulets referencing the male Ogdoad members are the clearest surviving votive practice, with no major independent offering cult beyond Hermopolis.*

Olodumare — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Supreme Being, source of all Orishas. Supreme, all-encompassing divine source from which Ashe flows.
How to honor: *Mhondoro are consulted through a svikiro (spirit medium) who enters trance to speak with the departed chief's voice, especially at moments of drought, epidemic, or national crisis; offerings of traditional beer, snuff, and sometimes cattle are presented at the medium's shrine or the ancestor's grave. Their claimed territory is treated as sacred — permission is sought before hunting, clearing land, or farming within it.*

Olodumare (Santeria) — *Lucumí*
Supreme creator, ultimate divine reality. The supreme, transcendent creator deity.
How to honor: *Olodumare, as the transcendent supreme being in Lucumí/Santería cosmology, receives no direct shrine, image, or offerings — devotion is mediated entirely through the Orishas, who act as intermediaries. Olodumare is acknowledged verbally at the opening of ceremonies and divination (with exclamations like "Aché!") and in respectful invocation, but building a personal altar or making direct offerings to Olodumare would be considered inappropriate within the tradition's structure.*

Olofi — *Lucumí*
Aspect of supreme being who actively governs universe, delegates to Orishas. Active governing aspect of Olodumare.
How to honor: *Olofi, the active governing aspect of the supreme being who delegates power to the Orishas, is honored primarily through the work of Babalawo priests in Ifá divination, where he is invoked in opening prayers (moyubá) before consultations. In syncretic Cuban practice he is often identified with Jesus Christ, and devotion takes the form of respectful invocation and ethical conduct rather than direct material offerings, similar to Olodumare.*

Olorum — *Lucumí*
Aspect that is source of all Ashe/divine energy. Source-aspect of the supreme being, origin of Aché.
How to honor: *Olorun, the aspect of the supreme being that is source of all aché (divine energy), is invoked in opening prayers at dawn and at the start of ceremonies, often addressed through the sun as a visible symbol of his life-giving power. As with Olodumare and Olofi, no direct altar or offerings are made to Olorun specifically; he is honored through moyubá invocations and through the proper, respectful conduct of Orisha worship overall, since devotion flows to him indirectly through the whole ritual system.*

Ometeotl (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Supreme dual creator god of duality, highest heaven. Dual Lord/Lady of Duality who generated all existence.
How to honor: *Ometeotl was primarily an abstract philosophical/calendric principle among elite priest-scholars, not a cult-offering deity — no temples, sacrifices, or named prayers to Ometeotl*

specifically survive in the sources. Honor today through contemplative acknowledgment of duality: a simple balanced altar with paired black/white objects, quiet meditation on complementary opposites, and purifying incense — without inventing festivals or favorite foods that are not historically attested.

Ometeotl (Tloque Nahuaque) — *Aztec*
Dual (male/female) supreme creator principle dwelling in Omeyocan. Non-dual dual-gendered supreme creator of Aztec philosophy.
How to honor: *As a dual, non-gendered philosophical creator principle rather than an anthropomorphic god, Ometeotl had no dedicated temple, image, or sacrificial cult — he/she was honored through contemplation and poetry, most famously the "flower and song" (in xochitl in cuicatl) verse of Nezahualcoyotl, the Texcocan poet-king, who built an idol-less tower dedicated to the "unknown, unknowable god" (Tloque Nahuaque). Modern acknowledgment mirrors this: quiet meditation, poetic composition, and copal incense burned without an image, reflecting the duality underlying all existence.*

Oxalá — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Eldest Orixá, creation, peace, purity, white cloth. Creator/patriarch Orixá, shaper of human bodies.
How to honor: *Oxalá, eldest and most senior Orixá of creation and purity, is honored with white food, shea butter, cool water, and white candles, his day being Friday when devotees dress entirely in white. His rites demand quiet, slow, calm behavior (he is mythically elderly) and strictly exclude alcohol, pork, and dendê (palm oil) — the one Orixá whose offerings pointedly avoid what nearly every other Orixá welcomes.*

Rod — *Slavic Paganism*
Primordial creator deity, birth/clan/generation. Supreme creator from whom other gods emerged.
How to honor: *Rod was honored communally rather than through a personal shrine: family and clan feasts (bratchina) offered porridge (kutia), bread, and honey — sometimes poured out on the ground or hearth — in his name as the source from which all lineage and generation flows. Ancestral/rod-veneration overlapping with midwinter feasting continues in modern Rodnovery; honoring one's own ancestral line and clan ties is treated as the direct way of honoring Rod himself.*

Sang Hyang Widhi Wasa — *Balinese (Bali)*
Supreme divine being, formless, infinite, source and transcendence of all other manifestations. The Absolute/God, apex of Balinese Hindu divine order.
How to honor: *Sang Hyang Widhi Wasa, as the formless Absolute beyond direct representation, is never approached with material offerings directly but through the full cascade of Balinese Hindu ceremony aimed at the Tri Murti and other manifest deities — canang sari offerings, temple odalan anniversaries, and the six-times-daily cycle of Balinese ritual all ultimately channel devotion upward to this single source. Prayer (sembahyang) typically closes with a gesture and mantra acknowledging this ultimate unity behind all the manifest gods.*

Sheikh Adi ibn Musafir — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Founding sacred figure/divine manifestation; tomb at Lalish is holiest site. Historical Sufi teacher (c.1073-1162) understood as one of the seven sacred beings in human form.
How to honor: *Wednesday (the Yazidi holy day) is marked with candle-lighting, prayer, and rest from ordinary work; his bronze/copper peacock effigy (sanjak) is processed by qewwals from village to village in a ritual circuit (tawaf), collecting alms and blessings before returning to Lalish. The multi-day Cejna Cemaiye pilgrimage at Lalish involves animal sacrifice, ritual bathing in sacred springs, and all-night singing/dancing; Yazidis strongly reject any framing of Melek Taus as a "devil" figure — that reading is considered both false and deeply offensive.*

Sky Woman — *Haudenosaunee*

Fell from Sky World; began creation with seeds and medicines. Progenitor being whose fall and cooperation with animals created the earth.
How to honor: *Flint (Bad Mind) is acknowledged, not worshipped, within Haudenosaunee cosmology as the necessary counterpart to Sapling; respect is shown through correct oral retelling at Midwinter ceremonies. Flint stone, thorns, and dark materials symbolize him. He is never petitioned or given offerings, since he embodies forces to be guarded against.*

Sotuknang — *Hopi*
Universal Architect, Sky Spirit who structured the cosmos. Nephew of Tawa who physically formed the nine universes and ended failed worlds.
How to honor: *Tawa is honored each morning with corn pollen offered at sunrise while facing east, accompanied by prayers directed to the six sacred directions; this daily practice of gratitude for the sun's return is one of the most consistently attested Hopi devotional acts, performed by individuals rather than requiring priesthood.*

Spenta Mainyu — *Zoroastrianism*
Holy/creative spirit of Ahura Mazda. First Amesha Spenta, the beneficent creative spirit of Ahura Mazda.
How to honor: *Spenta Mainyu, the beneficent creative spirit of Ahura Mazda, is honored implicitly through the same sacred-fire tending and ethical choice-making central to Zoroastrian practice, since he represents the human capacity to choose good; there is no separate shrine or offering distinct from general Zoroastrian fire devotion.*

Ta'aroa (Ta'aroa-nui) — *Society Islands (Tahiti/Ra'iatea)*
Self-created supreme god; his body became sky, earth, mountains, rain, wind. Self-originated creator god whose body became the substance of the world.
How to honor: *Ta'aroa was honored at marae (open-air temple platforms) with offerings of first fruits, pigs, and fish presented by tahu'a (priests), who recited his self-creation genealogy chant as sacred liturgy. Red feathers — the most sacred material in Society Islands religion, worked into feather girdles (maro ura) for god-images — were central offerings, and strict tapu (taboo) restricted who could approach the marae during rites.*

Tagaloa (Samoa) — *Polynesian (Samoa)*
Supreme creator of islands and first humans. Samoan supreme creator god.
How to honor: *Tagaloa is honored primarily through the ʻava (kava) ceremony, a highly formalized ritual of preparing and serving kava root in rank order accompanied by set oratory (lauga) invoking ancestral and divine authority. The fa'amatai chiefly-title system, which still governs Samoan village life, derives its sacred legitimacy from him, so correct deference to chiefs/orators in ceremony is itself an act of honoring Tagaloa.*

Takamimusubi no Kami — *Shinto*
Exalted Creative Force of High Heaven, one of three primordial musubi kami. Primordial generative-force deity.
How to honor: *Kamimusubi no Kami and Takamimusubi no Kami, two of the three primordial musubi kami, are venerated together at Ise's auxiliary shrines and Izumo-associated sites with standard shinsen offerings (rice, sake, water, salt, seasonal foods) and tamagushi presentation. Because "musubi" means binding/generative connection, prayers for conception, matchmaking, harvest, and new ventures are considered especially fitting when addressed to either.*

Tambaran — *Papua New Guinea (Sepik region)*
Simultaneously a sacred being, institution, and body of restricted knowledge held by initiated men. Central sacred being/institution of PNG Sepik male initiation cults.
How to honor: *Honored by building and periodically renewing the haus tambaran (spirit house), the tallest and most sacred structure in a Sepik village, decorated with carved ancestor/spirit figures; entry is forbidden to women and uninitiated boys, and the tambaran's "voice" is sounded*

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through hidden bullroarers and sacred flutes during initiation grades, which also involve scarification marking passage into restricted knowledge.

Tane / Kane — *Polynesian (Maori/Hawaiian)*
God of forests, birds, light; creator of the first human (Hineahuone). Creator god of forests and the natural world above water.
How to honor: *Tane/Kane is honored before harvesting from the forest, especially sacred kauri and totara trees, with karakia asking his permission and leaving a token (a leaf or stone) as acknowledgment before cutting. As creator of the first human and patron of birds and light, he is invoked at dawn rites and in tree-planting/forest-restoration ceremonies today.*

Tepeu — *Maya (K'iche', Popol Vuh)*
Paired creator deity (Framer) who spoke the world into being. One half of the paired K'iche' creator deities in the Popol Vuh.
How to honor: *K'iche' Maya paired creator ("the Framer") known almost entirely through the Popol Vuh's creation narrative rather than an independent cult; honored jointly with Gucumatz through copal incense, cacao, and jade offerings at creation-recitation ceremonies. Contemporary K'iche' ajq'ijab' (day-keepers) invoke the Tepeu–Gucumatz pairing when opening calendrical ceremonies, and the most authentic modern honoring is respectful study/recitation of the Popol Vuh's origin story.*

The Dagda — *Irish*
"The Good God" — competence, life and death, abundance. Most powerful Tuatha De Danann; owns club (kills/revives), cauldron (never empty), harp (three sacred melodies).
How to honor: *The Dagda, patron of abundance and hospitality, is honored through acts of generous feeding and drink rather than austerity — porridge, oatmeal, and ale left as offerings recall his own myth of eating an enormous cauldron of porridge for the Fomorians. His association with Newgrange and the hill of Uisneach makes those sites focal points for modern devotion, and his cauldron (never empty) makes lavish, shared hospitality itself a devotional act.*

The Demiurge — *Gnosticism*
Lesser, ignorant/malicious creator of the material world, often identified with Hebrew Bible's God. Flawed lesser creator-god of matter, mistaken for the supreme God.
How to honor: *Ignorant/malicious lesser creator, often equated by Gnostics with the Hebrew Bible's God (as "Ialdabaoth" in Sethian/Ophite texts); not honored but actively rejected — some sects reportedly practiced ritual mockery or refusal of sacrifice to him as a form of spiritual defiance. The core devotional act toward him is negative: recognizing his false authority and refusing worship, since mistaking him for the true God was considered the primary spiritual error to overcome via gnosis.*

The Great Architect of the Universe (G.A.O.T.U.) — *Freemasonry*
Non-denominational designation for the divine as cosmic architect/craftsman. Masonic term for the divine, understood differently by each member according to their own faith tradition.
How to honor: *Non-denominational Masonic term for the divine, honored not through offerings but through symbolic ritual: the Volume of Sacred Law (Bible, Quran, Torah, or other text appropriate to the member's faith) is kept open on the lodge altar during all meetings, and candidates take their obligations with a hand upon it. Masonic ritual opens and closes with invocation of the G.A.O.T.U., and no specific doctrine about his nature is taught — each member supplies that from his own religion.*

Tian (Heaven) — *Mohism (China)*
Personal Heaven whose will is universal, non-discriminating love. Personal Heaven that loves all people equally, the cosmic standard for ethics.
How to honor: *Namandu (Ñamandu), addressed as Ru Ete ("True Father"), is invoked in the opy (ceremonial house) through communal prayer-chant and the jeroky ritual dance, accompanied by the mbaraka (gourd rattle) and takuapu (bamboo stamping tube); tobacco smoke from the*

petygua pipe carries prayers upward to him. Elders lead dawn invocations facing east, and his name anchors the opening of major Mbyá-Guaraní ceremonies.

Tonkawa Creator (unnamed sky being) — *Tonkawa (Texas plains)*
Sky-dwelling divine being who established the world's original conditions. Primary creative force of Tonkawa cosmology, specific name not recorded in accounts.
How to honor: *No Tonkawa liturgy, offerings, or festival calendar survives for this unnamed sky-creator in ethnographic or tribal sources; the Tonkawa Tribe of Oklahoma's own cultural materials emphasize language revival over reconstructing pre-contact ritual. The honest way to honor this being is a quiet moment facing open sky at dawn with spoken gratitude for the world's ordering, paired with support for the tribe's actual living language and culture programs — not invented ritual detail.*

Tui Tokelau — *Tokelau*
Invisible ruling god of Tokelau, represented by a mat-wrapped pillar, not an image. Invisible god represented only by an aniconic wrapped pillar.
How to honor: *Honored at Fakaofo, Tokelau's ceremonial center, through an annual shrine ceremony where his aniconic pillar — wrapped in fine mats rather than carved as an image — was housed in a god-house and presented with offerings of fish, coconut, and food to appeal for the atoll's fertility and abundance, essential on land with minimal resources. Only high-ranking priests/chiefs approached the wrapped pillar directly. The cult ended with mass conversion to Christianity in the 1860s; today he is acknowledged as cultural/historical memory rather than an active devotional figure.*

Umvelinqangi — *Zulu/Bantu*
First Cause/Creator; too vast for direct petition. Primordial creative power from which all existence flows.
How to honor: *Manoomin (wild rice) is honored as a sacred gift-being through tobacco offered before harvest, the practice of never taking all the rice in a stand (leaving enough to reseed and for wildlife), and a ceremonial first-rice offering set aside before the community eats from the new harvest. Traditional ricing by canoe using knocking sticks is treated as a respectful, prayerful act.*

Unkulunkulu — *Zulu/Bantu*
First ancestor, emerged from primordial reed bed (uhlanga); culture hero who taught fire, cultivation, cattle-keeping. "The Great-Great-One," first human/ancestor and culture hero.
How to honor: *Umvelinqangi, the First Cause, is too vast and remote for direct petition or offering — approached exclusively through ancestor intermediaries (amadlozi), to whom Zulu families make actual offerings: home-brewed beer (utshwala), snuff, and animal sacrifice (typically a goat or ox) at ancestral ceremonies, with the expectation the ancestors relay honor and requests upward toward Umvelinqangi. There is no shrine, festival, or direct offering practice for him himself.*

Unkulunkulu / uMvelinqangi — *Ndebele (Zimbabwe)*
"The greatest, most ancient" — supreme creative force preceding all existence. Ndebele creator deity, source from which sacred beings derive.
How to honor: *Mwari is petitioned through the Njelele shrine in Zimbabwe's Matopo Hills, where an oracular voice speaks from a sacred cave; pilgrims bring black cattle, traditional beer (doro), snuff tobacco, and cloth as offerings, and strict taboos apply at the site — no metal objects, no whistling, no pointing, and drums are forbidden near the cave. Persistent drought is read as divine displeasure and good rains as a sign of favor, prompting communal thanksgiving rites led by resident priests.*

Varima-te-takere — *Cook Islands*
Primordial mother goddess at the center of the cosmic coconut shell (Avaiki). Deepest primordial mother goddess, source of all Cook Islands gods.

How to honor: *As the primordial mother at the root of the cosmic coconut shell Avaiki, she has no attested historical cult or offering practice — she belongs to cosmogonic narrative, not worship. The respectful way to honor her is through recitation/retelling of the Avaiki creation genealogy and quiet reverence for motherhood, origins, and the coconut palm (her mythic vessel/symbol); some modern Pacific spiritual practitioners light a candle or place a coconut on a home altar as a symbolic nod to primordial-mother figures in creation stories.*

Viracocha — *Inca/Tawantinsuyu (Andes)*
Supreme creator deity, older than Inti; created first humans at Lake Titicaca. Creator god who taught humanity then walked into the Pacific, promising return.
How to honor: *Honored at Lake Titicaca and Tiwanaku-associated shrines with offerings cast into the water — gold and silver figurines, spondylus shell, and llama sacrifice — a practice archaeologically attested at underwater sites predating the Inca and continued into Inca times. Because Viracocha was said to have walked into the Pacific promising return, coastal shrines along his mythic westward path were tended too; he had no dedicated priesthood or festival calendar as prominent as Inti's, since he was approached as the deep source underlying all other gods.*

Vishnu — *Hinduism*
Preservation, cosmic order, dharma. The preserver deity who incarnates as avatars whenever dharma declines.
How to honor: *Vishnu devotees chant the Vishnu Sahasranama (1,000 names) and the mantra "Om Namo Narayanaya," offering tulsi (holy basil) leaves — never removed without asking permission of the plant — along with yellow flowers, sandalwood paste, and sweet pongal. Ekadashi (the 11th lunar day, twice monthly) is his special fasting day observed by devotees abstaining from grains, and major pilgrimage centers like Tirupati (as Venkateswara) and Guruvayur see continuous darshan and abhishekam (ritual bathing of the deity image with milk, honey, and water).*

Vishnu (Bhagavad Gita) — *Bhagavad Gita / Hinduism*
Referenced as "Lord Vishnu"/Narayana, of whom Krishna is the avatar. Preserver deity of the Hindu Trimurti, source of Krishna's avatar.
How to honor: *Vishnu is worshipped with daily puja using tulsi leaves (his and his consort Lakshmi's sacred plant — never omitted, and never offered to Shiva), yellow or saffron flowers, and sweets such as kheer or panchamrit; the Vishnu Sahasranama (his 1,000 names) is chanted as a major devotional practice. Thursday is widely kept as his fasting/worship day, and major festivals include Vaikuntha Ekadashi (fasting and all-night vigil, believed to open the gates of his heaven) and Diwali, which centers on Vishnu's consort Lakshmi. Great pilgrimage temples such as Tirupati and Badrinath draw millions of devotees who bring offerings and undertake vows in his name.*

Vishnu (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
The Preserver, presides over Shravana nakshatra. Great preserver deity of the Hindu trimurti.
How to honor: *Vishnu, presiding over Shravana nakshatra, is honored with Thursday worship, Ekadashi fasting, recitation of the Vishnu Sahasranama, tulsi-leaf offerings, and yellow cloth (pitambara); meat and alcohol are avoided on his worship days. Because "Shravana" means "hearing," devotees mark his nakshatra specifically by listening to or reciting Vishnu Purana stories and kirtan on that day.*

Vishvedevas — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
"All the gods" collectively, presides over Uttara Ashadha nakshatra. Collective deity representing universal principles.
How to honor: *Vishvedevas ("all the gods" collectively), presiding over Uttara Ashadha, are honored chiefly through the Vishvedeva offering that is a mandatory component of Hindu shraddha (ancestor) rites — a portion of the ritual meal is set aside for them before ancestors are fed, invoking universal divine witness. As a collective deity they receive community/group pujas*

rather than solitary worship; omitting their portion in a shraddha ceremony is considered a ritual lapse.

Wakan Tanka — *Lakota Sioux*
The Great Mystery; sacredness pervading all existence. The all-pervasive Great Mystery/Sacred Power of Lakota cosmology.
How to honor: *Skan, one of the sixteen Wakan Tanka beings, is honored through the Chanunpa (Sacred Pipe) and the Seven Sacred Rites, tobacco offerings and prayer ties in the four sacred colors, with Inipi (sweat lodge) purification required beforehand as a prerequisite for approaching him properly.*

Wakan Tanka (All My Relations) — *Lakota (Sioux)*
Great Mystery/Great Spirit; the sacred quality (wakan) permeating all creation. Supreme incomprehensible sacred power at the center of the universe, present in all things.
How to honor: *Wakan Tanka is honored primarily through the Sacred Pipe (Chanunpa) ceremony, in which tobacco mixed with red willow bark (kinnikinnick) is smoked with prayers offered to the six directions, and through the major communal rites of the Seven Sacred Rites, especially the Sun Dance (Wiwanyag Wacipi), a multi-day rite of piercing, fasting, and dancing performed in thanksgiving and for the wellbeing of the people. Right living — generosity, respect for all relatives (mitakuye oyasin), and humility — is itself considered a form of ongoing honor to Wakan Tanka.*

Wisnu (Vishnu, Balinese) — *Balinese (Bali)*
Preserver aspect; associated with north, color black. Preserver god of the Tri Murti.
How to honor: *Wisnu (Vishnu) is honored in the canang sari through a black or dark-toned flower placed on the northern portion of the offering tray, matching his direction (north) and color (black in Balinese Hindu color symbolism); he is invoked alongside Brahma and Siwa in Tri Murti temple rites, including at the Padma Tiga shrine at Pura Besakih, and is associated with water and preservation in local ceremony.*

Wuro — *Bobo Bwa*
Supreme, remote creator god embodying sacred order. Creator deity who established the sacred order and withdrew.
How to honor: *Wuro, the remote Bobo Bwa creator who established sacred order and withdrew, is never approached directly — he is honored only through intermediaries: the mask cult and the generative force Dwo he set in motion, addressed by community elders through ritual proxy rather than direct shrine or offering.*

Xmucane — *Maya (Popol Vuh)*
Divine grandmother who ground the corn from which true humans were made. Divine grandmother creator who ground maize into the first true humans.
How to honor: *Divine grandmother-creator who, with Xpiyacoc, ground white and yellow maize into the flesh of the first true humans — one of the more actively invoked Popol Vuh figures in living K'iche' practice, since day-keepers still name the Xmucane–Xpiyacoc grandparent pair when opening calendar ceremonies. Honor her with offerings of ground maize/corn dough and copal incense, and by treating corn-grinding itself, and respect toward grandmothers/female elders, as symbolically sacred acts tied to her.*

Yahweh/YHWH (Samaritanism) — *Samaritanism*
One God, strict monotheism, no trinity. God of the Samaritan tradition, worshipped exclusively at Mount Gerizim.
How to honor: *God of the Samaritan tradition, worshipped exclusively at Mount Gerizim near Nablus rather than Jerusalem; the signature living practice is the Samaritan Passover sacrifice, still performed today — dozens of lambs are ritually slaughtered and roasted in pits on the mountain each spring before an assembled community in white robes, one of the only literal*

Passover animal sacrifices still practiced by any faith. Daily life includes prayer facing Gerizim three times a day and strict Sabbath observance following the Samaritan Torah/calendar.

Ymir — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Primordial giant from whose body the world was made. Slain by Odin and brothers; his body became Midgard.
How to honor: *No historical cult offerings exist for Ymir — he is a cosmological figure, not a worshipped god — but modern Heathens acknowledge him with earth-based offerings (soil, stone, salt, or milk recalling the primordial cow Auðumbla) and meditative reflection on creation/cosmology, avoiding small transactional gifts mismatched to his cosmic scale.*

Sky

Sky-fathers, celestial rulers, and the vault of heaven itself, personified.

An (Anu) — *Mesopotamian (Sumer/Akkad)*
First father of the gods, source of divine authority. Sky god, passive principle of heavenly cosmic order.
How to honor: *An (Anu) is honored at the Eanna temple complex in Uruk, his primary cult center; Seleucid-era Uruk saw a documented revival of his cult including a nocturnal fire ceremony and participation in the Akitu New Year rites. Offerings included libations, incense, and first-fruits presented before his throne/horned-crown symbol; modern devotees use white or gold altar cloths, incense, and prayers for just authority and legitimate leadership.*

Baiame — *Australian Aboriginal (Wiradjuri, Kamilaroi)*
Sky ancestor and creator being associated with rain, initiation, sacred law. Sky creator god who made lakes, rivers, mountains, caves before returning to spirit world.
How to honor: *Baiame is honored chiefly through restriction rather than offering: his name and image were traditionally spoken or shown only to initiated men, especially at bora ground ceremonies (large earth rings connected by a sacred path) where boys underwent initiation into law and lost a tooth as a mark of the rite. Bora grounds themselves — such as those recorded near the Hunter Valley and northern NSW — were treated as consecrated ground, entered only under ceremonial protocol, and Baiame was invoked through sacred song cycles and law-keepers' oral teaching rather than material offerings.*

Caddi Ayo — *Caddo*
Chief of the sky, primary divine intermediary. Sky-chief mediating between Ayo Caddi Aymay and humans.
How to honor: *Caddi Ayo, sky-chief and intermediary to Ayo Caddi Aymay, was addressed in sky-oriented ceremonies such as the Morning Star Ceremony, invoked by the xinesi (priest) who communicated through the sacred fire and offered tobacco on behalf of the community.*

Di — *Chinese (Shang Dynasty)*
High god communicated with by Shang kings via oracle bone divination. Supreme celestial deity of Shang-era Chinese religion.
How to honor: *The Holly King is honored at Yule/midwinter and symbolically "defeated" by the Oak King at the summer solstice in the modern Wheel of the Year cycle; practitioners decorate with evergreen holly boughs, light candles against the dark, and hold mock ritual combats between actors representing the two Kings at solstice gatherings. This pairing is a 20th-century Neopagan/Druid Revival construct rather than an attested ancient deity cult.*

Dievas — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Supreme sky god, creator, ruler of lesser gods; appears in disguise as Dievas Senelis (beggar) to test hospitality. Distant, dignified sky-father householder god presiding over prosperity and moral order.
How to honor: *Honored through hospitality: folk custom held that Dievas Senelis walked the earth disguised as a poor old beggar to test generosity, so leaving bread and a place at the table for unexpected strangers was itself an act of worship. He was invoked in morning/evening household prayers and blessings over the hearth fire, with grain, bread, and beer as customary offerings at threshold and hearth; ingratitude toward guests or the poor was considered a direct offense against him.*

Evening Star — *Wichita (Caddoan, Oklahoma/Texas)*
Complementary female sacred being to the Morning Star, associated with west/underworld/water. Venus as evening star, female counterpart structuring the sky/water cosmological duality.

How to honor: *Evening Star, paired with Morning Star as the female sky being of the west, water, and the underworld, was traditionally honored through the earth-lodge ceremonial cycle and star-based origin narratives rather than individual offerings — sacred structures and rites were oriented to celestial positions reflecting her place in the sky. A respectful modern acknowledgment is learning and retelling documented Wichita star narratives accurately through tribal-approved sources rather than inventing ritual detail.*

Horus (Heru) — *Kemet*
Kingship, the sky, order. Falcon-headed god of legitimate kingship, son of Osiris and Isis.
How to honor: *Horus was honored at his major cult center of Edfu, where healing "cippi" (Horus stelae) inscribed with protective spells were used ritually — water poured over the carved images was collected and drunk to cure snakebite or scorpion sting. The Wedjat (Eye of Horus) was the most widely worn protective amulet in Egypt, and every reigning pharaoh was honored as his living incarnation through the full apparatus of royal cult.*

Indra (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
King of gods and fire, presides over Vishakha and Jyeshtha nakshatra. King of the Vedic gods.
How to honor: *Indra, king of the Vedic gods, presiding over Vishakha and Jyeshtha, was historically propitiated with Soma libations and ghee oblations in the Agnihotra fire accompanied by Rig Vedic Indra Sukta recitation; ancient India also raised Indra Dhwaja banners in his honor. Living Jyotish practice is nakshatra-shanti japa of "Om Indraya Namah," offerings of gold/yellow sweets, and grain donation on Jyeshtha days. Excessive pride is the clear taboo, since Indra's own myths repeatedly punish his hubris.*

Jade Emperor (Chinese Zodiac) — *Chinese Zodiac / Chinese Folk Religion*
Supreme ruler of heaven who created the zodiac by holding the animal race. Supreme celestial ruler of Chinese folk religion who established the twelve-year zodiac order.
How to honor: *The Jade Emperor (Chinese Zodiac creation myth) is honored as the supreme celestial ruler through incense and temple offerings, most elaborately on his traditional birthday, the 9th day of the first lunar month, when temples hold midnight ceremonies with roast pig, fruit, and "longevity noodles," and firecrackers are set off to mark the occasion. Households also clean and behave well in the days prior, since he receives annual conduct reports on every family via the Kitchen God.*

Jade Emperor (Yu Huang Shang Di) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Supreme celestial bureaucrat governing all gods, humans, nature. Celestial Emperor governing the divine bureaucracy.
How to honor: *The Jade Emperor (Yu Huang Shang Di), supreme celestial bureaucrat, receives his most elaborate honors on his traditional birthday, the 9th day of the first lunar month: temples hold midnight ceremonies with incense, roast pig, fruit, and "longevity noodles," and paper effigies are burned while firecrackers ward off evil. Households also clean and behave well beforehand, since the Kitchen God (Zao Jun) reports each family's yearly conduct to him.*

Jupiter — *Roman Religion*
King of gods, lightning, sacred law, oaths; Capitoline Triad. King of the Olympian gods and guarantor of Roman political order.
How to honor: *Jupiter received formal state cult at his temple on the Capitoline Hill, where victorious generals in a triumph would process to sacrifice a white bull and offer him a share of spoils; Roman magistrates swore oaths of office in his name. Lightning was treated as his most sacred omen — augurs read the direction and character of lightning strikes as direct communication from Jupiter, and a place struck by lightning was ritually sealed off (bidental) as sacred ground.*

Jupiter/Zeus (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Roman/Greek)*
Governs abundance, wisdom, law, expansion. Roman/Greek king of gods, ruler of Thursday.

How to honor: *Jupiter/Zeus (Planetary Days): as chief of the Roman pantheon, Jupiter received white bull sacrifices at his Capitoline temple, unmixed wine libations poured out at the Vinalia festivals, and oak-leaf crowns (the corona civica) as his sacred tree was the oak. State oaths and treaties were sworn in his name specifically because perjury against him was believed to bring catastrophic consequence. Modern Thursday practice centers on generosity, gratitude offerings, and honoring mentors/teachers rather than blood sacrifice.*

Kukulkan — *Maya (Yucatec)*
Maya equivalent of Quetzalcoatl; feathered serpent creator deity. Maya Feathered Serpent creator god, twin of Aztec Quetzalcoatl.
How to honor: *Yucatec Maya feathered serpent creator honored with copal incense, jade, quetzal feathers, and cacao at serpent temples; the best-documented living ritual is the spring/fall equinox pilgrimage to El Castillo at Chichén Itzá, where a shadow-and-light effect creates the appearance of a serpent descending the staircase, drawing thousands who gather at dawn/dusk. Green and blue-green are his sacred colors, and he is invoked as patron of priestly/royal legitimacy and wind (in his Ehecatl-linked aspect).*

Lha (category) — *Tibetan Bon*
Divine beings of the upper realm. Sky/divine beings of Bon's three-world cosmology.
How to honor: *Lha (category) are propitiated through lhasang (juniper/incense smoke offerings) burned on hilltop cairns, with white foods (milk, curd, barley flour torma) and white khata scarves offered on auspicious mornings. Specific offering items are chosen only after divination (mo) identifies which lha is involved and what it wants. Avoid offering meat, alcohol, or "impure" substances to upper-realm lha; blackened or burnt offerings are also considered offensive to them.*

Morning Star (Aurus) — *Wichita (Caddoan, Oklahoma/Texas)*
Visible representative of the Creator; central figure of the most important Wichita ceremony. Venus as morning star, the Creator's direct presence in the visible sky, male, associated with east.
How to honor: *Morning Star is honored through the Morning Star Ceremony, historically the most important Wichita rite: an all-night vigil with sacred songs, ritual preparation before dawn, and prayers offered at first light, timed to Venus's heliacal rising in the east. Among related Caddoan/Pawnee groups the ceremony historically involved additional rites tied to renewal of the world; Wichita practice centered on vigil, song, and dawn address to the star as the Creator's visible presence.*

Morning Star (Caddo) — *Caddo*
Astronomical sacred presence, Venus at dawn. Venus honored in dedicated Morning Star Ceremony.
How to honor: *The Morning Star (Venus at dawn) was honored through the Caddo Morning Star Ceremony: an all-night vigil with a sacred fire kept continuously burning, participants facing east at dawn, and prayers and songs offered as the star rose to greet the new day, marking Venus's role as messenger between the sky-world and the people.*

Morning Star (Ipiso'waahss) — *Blackfoot*
Sky being who married Feather Woman, gave the Sundance. Sky husband figure who brought the Sundance gift to humanity.
How to honor: *Morning Star is honored through faithful transmission of the Feather Woman origin story, which explains how the Okan (Sun Dance) gift came to the Blackfoot people, and through participation in the Okan itself as living fulfillment of that gift. A specific taboo tied to his myth is the prohibition against digging the sacred turnip that led to Feather Woman's exile from the sky world — a caution against violating sacred boundaries out of curiosity.*

Nut — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*

Sky goddess, body arching over earth, mother of the solar cycle. Sky goddess whose body is the night sky and Duat.
How to honor: *Nut received no major independent temple but was honored through her image painted on coffin lids and tomb ceilings, positioned to protect the deceased's spirit, with funerary offerings of food and drink placed beneath her image as though within her embrace. Temple ceilings depicting her arched body were the focus of hymns recited at dawn and dusk.*

Nut (Kemet) — *Kemet*
The Sky. Sky goddess arching over Geb.
How to honor: *Nut was honored primarily through funerary practice: her image was painted on the interior of coffin lids and tomb ceilings so the deceased would be symbolically swallowed at death and reborn from her body each dawn, mirroring the sun's daily journey through her. Astronomical temple ceilings (as at Dendera) depict her arched form, and night-sky observation itself functioned as an act of reverence toward her.*

Qian (Heaven trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*
Creative yang principle invoked via hand seal. Cosmic force of initiation and creative leadership embodied in the Qian seal.
How to honor: *Qian is formed with a specific hand seal held at chest height before beginning creative projects, leadership undertakings, or opening a ceremony, invoking initiating, assertive yang force. This is a modern Taoist internal-alchemy/qigong practice (shouyin/hand-seal lineages) rather than an ancient temple cult — honoring it means correct seal formation, breath coordination, and clear intent, with no offerings or shrine involved.*

Qormusta Tengri — *Mongolian Shamanism*
King of the 99 Tenger (sky spirits), apex of celestial hierarchy. Chief of the 99 sky-spirits in Mongolian cosmology.
How to honor: *King of the 99 Tenger (sky spirits) atop the celestial hierarchy; addressed less through individual personal devotion than through shamanic ceremony — invoked by boo/udgan shamans using ritual drumming, chanting, and offerings of milk, airag, and incense as part of broader Tengrist rites rather than a dedicated personal cult. He functions as an organizing/apex figure named within larger sky-spirit invocations rather than petitioned separately.*

Quetzalcoatl (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec (also Toltec, Olmec origin)*
Feathered Serpent; wind, knowledge, Venus morning star, creator of humanity, opposed human sacrifice. Feathered Serpent god of wind, wisdom, and civilization who became the morning star.
How to honor: *Honored at major centers like Cholula (site of the largest pyramid in Mesoamerica) with self-bloodletting from the ear or tongue using maguey spines, offerings of quetzal feathers, jade, turquoise, and butterflies (never human sacrifice, per his own myth opposing it). His wind aspect, Ehecatl, was worshipped in distinctive circular temples so wind could flow around them; merchants (pochteca) and those seeking wisdom especially invoked him. Taboo: human sacrifice in his name contradicts his defining myth and was historically rejected by his cult.*

Ranginui — *Polynesian (Maori)*
Sky Father. Primordial Sky Father separated from Earth Mother by their children.
How to honor: *Ranginui is honored through recognizing rain as his tears of enduring longing for Papatuanuku, referenced in karakia about weather and the creation-separation myth; acknowledgment is through oral recitation of the separation narrative and respectful reference to weather phenomena as his ongoing grief.*

Ranginui — *Maori*
Sky Father, separated from Papatuanuku by their children to create space for life. Primordial Sky Father whose separation from Earth created the living world.

How to honor: *Honored primarily through karakia (formal incantation/prayer) that acknowledges his ongoing grief-rain since separation from Papatuanuku, rather than through material offerings. His name and role are recited in whakapapa (genealogical chant) at formal gatherings to situate the speaker within the cosmological order. There is no attested shrine or object-offering tradition for Ranginui specifically; recognition through correct recitation and weather-observance is the primary devotional act.*

Ranginui (Maori master) — *Maori*
Sky Father, one of the sacred parents. Sky father whose separation from Papatuanuku created the world.
How to honor: *Ranginui (Maori master) is honored primarily through karakia (formal incantation/prayer) that acknowledges his ongoing grief-rain since separation from Papatuanuku, rather than through material offerings. His name and role are recited in whakapapa (genealogical chant) at formal gatherings to situate the speaker within the cosmological order. There is no attested shrine or object-offering tradition for Ranginui specifically; recognition through correct recitation and weather-observance is the primary devotional act.*

Saabi — *Ari (Ethiopia, Omo Valley)*
Male principle governing cosmos, agricultural year, sacred law. Male god of the traditional Ari pantheon.
How to honor: *Saabi is honored through descriptive acknowledgment within Ari oral cosmology rather than documented ritual: no attested offerings, altar practices, colors, or named festivals for Saabi survive in accessible ethnographic sources. The appropriate approach is to situate him respectfully as the ordering sky/creator principle governing the agricultural year and sacred law, paired conceptually with Beri, without inventing specific devotional detail not in the record.*

Shu — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Air, dryness, sunlight, breath of life; separator of earth and sky. First-born god of air, principle of separation.
How to honor: *Shu and Tefnut, personifying air and moisture, were jointly worshipped in lion form at Leontopolis, where live lions were kept and tended in their honor. In the Myth of the Distant Goddess, Tefnut (in her fierce lioness aspect) was placated and lured back to Egypt with red-dyed beer or wine made to resemble blood, plus music, dance, and drumming — establishing wine/beer offerings and festive noise as her traditional propitiation, alongside Shu's general invocation as the breath sustaining life.*

Shu (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Air. God of air, child of Atum.
How to honor: *Shu received offerings of bread, beer, and incense jointly with his twin Tefnut at Heliopolis rather than through an independent major cult; the pair could be represented as lions (as at their secondary cult center of Leontopolis). Honoring Shu in ancient and modern Kemetic practice is almost always done in tandem with Tefnut as the primal air/moisture pair rather than to him alone.*

Skan — *Lakota Sioux*
Sky power; one of four superior beings. Sky-power aspect of Wakan Tanka.
How to honor: *Inyan, the primordial stone-being from whom Maka was formed, is honored in the Inipi (sweat lodge) through the heated rocks used in ceremony, addressed directly as living "Grandfathers" (Tunkashila) and given tobacco and water offerings during the four rounds. Taboo: treating the heated stones casually, or removing lodge rocks without ceremonial purpose, is disrespectful.*

Star Women (Pleiades) — *Caddo*
Sacred star cluster tied to fall harvest ceremony. The Pleiades as sacred sky beings.

How to honor: *The Star Women (Pleiades) are honored at the Caddo fall harvest ceremony held around the September new moon, when their rising is observed and marked with corn offerings, communal dances, and songs acknowledging the star cluster's role in timing the harvest and community gathering.*

Taarapita — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian (Estonian Maausk)*
Supreme deity in some Estonian traditions. Estonian supreme sky deity, root of "Taarausk".
How to honor: *Tharapita, Estonian supreme sky deity most strongly associated with Saaremaa (Oesel), is recorded in the 13th-century Chronicle of Henry of Livonia with grove-based worship and animal offerings dedicated to him, and sacred oaks were treated as his particular trees. Offerings — food, drink, or small goods — were left at or burned near hiis groves, with portions sometimes ritually eaten by the community. Modern Estonian Maausk revivalists hold grove ceremonies in his honor, treating disturbance of sacred groves/oaks as taboo.*

Tangaloa (Tonga) — *Polynesian (Tonga)*
Sky god, creator, lord of the ocean's surface, divine ancestor of Tu'i Tonga. Tongan supreme creator and ancestor of chiefly lineage.
How to honor: *Tangaloa was honored through the Inasi ceremony, an annual first-fruits tribute in which yams, kava, and other harvest offerings were formally presented to the Tu'i Tonga (his living representative on earth) at Lapaha. The Taumafa Kava, a formal seated kava-drinking ceremony with ranked cup order and chanted invocations, remains the core ritual vehicle for honoring chiefly/divine authority descending from him.*

Tengri (the Eternal Blue Sky) — *Mongolian Shamanism/Tengerism*
Supreme deity — the sky itself, source of cosmic order and mandate. Supreme sky deity of Mongolian Tengerism; source of Genghis Khan's cosmic mandate.
How to honor: *Supreme sky deity of Mongolian Tengerism, honored at ovoo (sacred stone/branch cairns) built on hilltops and mountain passes — devotees circle the ovoo clockwise three times, add a stone or blue khadag (silk scarf), and offer white foods (milk, airag/fermented mare's milk, dairy curds) sprinkled toward the sky rather than blood or meat. Ceremonies are traditionally led by a boo/udgan shaman at dawn facing the sun, and both state ceremonies (historically tied to khans' cosmic mandate) and personal roadside offerings continue in Mongolia today.*

Ukko — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Supreme sky god, thunder, weather, crops. "Overgod," ruler of thunder known through weather itself.
How to honor: *Ukko is honored historically through the Ukon vakat/vakka spring beer-brewing festival, where a communal batch of beer was specially brewed and the first draught poured onto the ground or thrown skyward as a first-fruits offering to secure rain and a good harvest; 16th-century sources (Agricola) describe peasants making such offerings to him for crop fertility. His symbol, the Ukonvasara (thunder-axe/hammer, paralleling Thor's Mjölnir), was worn or carved as a protective charm. Modern Suomenusko practitioners revive the beer-libation rite around the summer solstice, pouring drink onto the earth while invoking him for rain and harvest.*

Uranus — *Western Astrology*
Modern ruler of Aquarius; disruption, originality, liberation. Outer planetary archetype of sudden change and collective awakening.
How to honor: *Uranus is honored via blue/electric-blue and violet candles, sky-blue or UV-reactive stones (aquamarine, uranium glass, labradorite), and incense of galbanum or storax during Aquarius/Uranus transits; altars favor odd-shaped, technology-themed, or lightning/spiral-symbol objects for breakthrough spellwork. Rigid, overly conventional ritual formats are avoided since Uranus is associated with rebellion against convention.*

Urtzi (Ortzi) — *Basque*
Sky deity, name preserved in word for sky. Basque sky/thunder god, secondary to Mari.

How to honor: *Urtzi (Ortzi), the Basque sky/thunder god, has no surviving formal cult or festival calendar; honoring him today is done through language and place — speaking his name (preserved in the Basque word for "sky"), visiting storm-associated peaks, or quietly acknowledging thunderstorms. Modern Basque heritage circles sometimes leave simple outdoor offerings of bread or cider during storms alongside invocations of Mari and Sugaar; any claim of an "ancient worship rite" for him should be treated as modern reconstruction, not documented history.*

Vatea — *Cook Islands*

Father of the gods and of humanity; son of Varima-te-takere. Progenitor sky god, father of Tangaroa, Rongo, Tane and others.

How to honor: *Father of gods, half-man/half-fish, appears mainly in genealogical chant (whakapapa-style recitation) tracing Cook Islands ariki (chiefly) lines back to him, which is itself the living "devotional" practice — reciting genealogy affirms his continuing honor. No discrete offering tradition survives separately from this ancestor-chant context; light/daytime symbolism (associated with light/noon) and the coconut-shell cosmology are his key motifs. Best modern acknowledgment is honoring ancestry and genealogical memory rather than inventing shrine rituals.*

Zeus — *Greek*

King of the gods, sovereign order, lightning/eagle/oak. God of sovereign cosmic order.

How to honor: *Zeus was honored with burnt sacrifices of white bulls or oxen on open-air altars, libations of unmixed wine poured before meals and oaths, and offerings of oak leaves at his sanctuary at Dodona, where priests interpreted the rustling oak leaves as his voice. As Zeus Xenios he was invoked to sanctify hospitality and guest-oaths, and violating hospitality or breaking a sworn oath was considered a direct offense against him, second only to hubris.*

Sun

Solar deities — givers of light, warmth, kingship, and the visible face of the divine.

Amaterasu (Shingon) — *Shingon*
Sun kami of the Ise inner shrine. Shinto sun goddess syncretized with Dainichi's wisdom aspect.
How to honor: *Toyouke is honored at Ise Grand Shrine's outer shrine (Geku) through Hi no Mi-ke, a food offering ceremony performed twice daily, unbroken for over a millennium, in which cooked rice, salt, water, and seasonal foods are ritually prepared and presented — a concrete, still-living daily devotional practice.*

Amaterasu Omikami — *Shinto*
Sun goddess, most important kami, ancestress of Imperial Family. Sun goddess whose withdrawal into a cave and return is central myth.
How to honor: *Amaterasu's principal devotion is at Ise Jingu, rebuilt every twenty years in the Shikinen Sengu rite that itself renews her worship; her shintai (sacred mirror, Yata no Kagami) is kept hidden even from most priests, entered only by the saishu (a priestess of imperial lineage). Daily offerings of rice, sake, salt, and water are presented twice a day at Ise, and household kamidana shrines nationwide make smaller versions of the same offerings, since rice is considered her gift to humanity via the myth of the sacred rice grains.*

Apollo — *Roman Religion*
Sun, music, prophecy, healing. Sun god of music, prophecy, and healing.
How to honor: *Apollo (uniquely keeping his Greek name in Roman religion) was honored through the Ludi Apollinares (established 212 BCE), annual games held in July, and through consultation of the Sibylline Books during crises. Laurel was his sacred plant, worn by victors and burned as incense at his altars; healing and prophetic vows were common offerings at his temple near the Circus Flaminius.*

Apollo — *Greek*
God of sun, music, prophecy, healing; "Know thyself". God of rational order, prophecy, and healing light.
How to honor: *Apollo was consulted through the Pythia, his oracle-priestess at Delphi, who delivered prophecies in trance after chewing laurel and inhaling vapors from a chasm; laurel wreaths, swans, and lyres were his characteristic offerings and symbols. The Pythian Games (held every four years at Delphi) combined musical and athletic contests in his honor, and paeans (hymns) were sung to him for healing and protection, especially before undertakings requiring clarity or purification.*

Baldr — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
God of light, beauty, renewal. Beloved god whose death began the path to Ragnarok; prophesied to return.
How to honor: *Baldr, god of light, beauty, and renewal and husband of Nanna, has no large ancient temple cult attested in the sagas, but modern Ásatrú/Heathen practice honors him with a blót (ritual toast/sacrifice with mead or ale) especially around Yule and the summer season, tied to themes of light's return. Offerings favored are white flowers, white candles, and mead; chamomile is traditionally called "Baldr's brow" (Baldrsbrá) in Scandinavian folk naming and used as an herbal offering. Mistletoe is the notable taboo/avoid-item, since it caused his death in myth.*

Belenos — *Irish*
Celtic sun/fire god associated with Bealtaine. Sun god whose name is root of "Bealtaine" (bright fire).
How to honor: *Belenos is honored through Bealtaine bonfires, historically lit from nine sacred woods at the Hill of Uisneach (revived today as the modern Uisneach Fire Festival), with cattle*

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driven between twin fires for purification and torches carried from the central blaze to relight household hearths. As a pan-Celtic sun/fire god (worshipped from Gaul to Noricum, equated by Romans with Apollo), honoring him centers on fire and renewal rather than temple offerings.

Christ (as Solar Logos) — *Rosicrucian Fellowship (Esoteric Christianity)*
Regent of the solar system who incarnated in Jesus's prepared vehicle. Cosmic solar being whose incarnation altered Earth's spiritual constitution esoterically.
How to honor: *Rosicrucian Fellowship (Max Heindel) teaching of Christ as Regent of the solar system incarnated in Jesus's prepared body; honored through esoteric meditation on the "Mystery of Golgotha" (understood as an event that changed Earth's planetary aura) rather than conventional worship. The Fellowship held distinctive Christmas and Easter "solar" services timed to seasonal/solar points, framing both festivals as commemorations of the Christ-force's relationship to the sun and Earth; devotional practice is contemplative and study-based, centered on the Rosicrucian Fellowship's correspondence course and services.*

Chup Kamuy — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Heavenly kamuy of sun and moon as luminaries. Sun/moon deity, sun generally honored as greater.
How to honor: *Chup Kamuy, the sun/moon kamuy, is honored through inau set at the nusasan facing east toward the rising sun, with sake libations flicked using the ikupasuy prayer stick and offerings of millet dumplings, traditionally at dawn and dusk in thanks for warmth and light. Pointing directly at the sun or moon, turning one's back to the nusasan during prayer, or offering spoiled food or impure sake are taboo.*

Dazbog — *Slavic Paganism*
Solar deity who gives abundance and gifts. Sun/wealth-giving deity ("give-god").
How to honor: *Dazhbog is honored by modern Rodnovery as a sun/giving god with offerings of bread, honey, mead, grain, and gold/yellow items placed on an outdoor altar (капищe) at dawn or during solstice rites; solar wheel/disk symbols and fire are central. He is often venerated in the summer solstice celebration (Kupala-adjacent solar rites) and general Rodnover sun-cycle festivals. As a "giving" god of prosperity, generosity (sharing food/wealth) is considered pleasing to him.*

Huitzilopochtli (Blue Tezcatlipoca) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Patron solar warrior god of the Mexica. Sun god reborn each dawn, defeating darkness.
How to honor: *Huitzilopochtli received quail sacrifice, copal incense, and amaranth-dough (tzoalli) images of himself that devotees ritually broke apart and ate; his colors were blue and red, and hummingbird feathers marked his regalia. His major festival, Panquetzaliztli ("Raising of Banners," December), featured paper banner processions, foot races, and warrior devotions at his Templo Mayor shrine, since he was above all patron of Mexica warriors and the sun's daily victory over darkness.*

Huitzilopochtli (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec (Mexica patron)*
Patron war/sun god of the Mexica; born fully armed, defeats moon/stars daily. Mexica patron god of war and the sun, reenacting cosmic battle each dawn.
How to honor: *Honored above all at Panquetzaliztli (December), when an image of the god was formed from amaranth-seed dough (tzoalli) and ritually broken and eaten by devotees, a communion-like rite; the Templo Mayor's northern shrine was dedicated to him and received war-captive sacrifices, seen as repaying a cosmic debt for the sun/Mexica people's survival. Hummingbird feathers and the color blue/turquoise are his emblems, and warriors invoked him before battle. As Mexica patron, honoring him traditionally meant defending the people and state above personal concerns.*

Hunahpu — *Maya (Popol Vuh)*
Hero Twin, later becomes the sun. Hero Twin who defeats the underworld lords and becomes the sun.

How to honor: *Hero Twin who, with Xbalanque, defeated the Lords of Xibalba and became the sun; honored historically through the Mesoamerican ballgame (pok-ta-pok/pitz), a ritual reenactment of the Twins' trial and victory in which ballcourts functioned as sacred space. Ballgame ritual involved offerings of rubber, copal incense, and blood-letting, with dawn and the rising sun as his symbolic time; today he is honored mainly through Popol Vuh storytelling and reverence for the ballgame's spiritual meaning.*

Inti — *Inca/Tawantinsuyu (Andes)*
Primary state deity; divine ancestor of the Sapa Inca. Sun god and divine progenitor of the Inca imperial line.
How to honor: *Honored via the Inti Raymi festival (June solstice) with processions, chicha libations poured at sunrise, and gold offerings at Coricancha; the Sapa Inca and Willaq Umu (High Priest) led public sacrifices including llamas, with music, dance, and communal feasting. Gold objects and unblemished white llamas were considered his favored tribute.*

Khepri — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Rising-sun aspect of Ra, self-created scarab. Scarab-form of Ra at sunrise.
How to honor: *Khepri, the scarab-form of Ra at sunrise, was honored through dawn prayer and through scarab amulets worn by the living and placed over the heart of mummies, inscribed with spells to protect the deceased at judgment. His self-creating imagery made the scarab itself the standard votive/protective offering-object associated with him.*

Khepri (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Scarab form of the rising sun; transformation and renewal. Beetle-god form of Ra representing self-creation and solar rebirth.
How to honor: *Khepri was honored primarily through the scarab amulet — among the most common objects in all of ancient Egypt — worn for protection and self-renewal, and through "heart scarabs" placed directly on mummies, inscribed with Spell 30B of the Book of the Dead to prevent the heart from testifying against its owner at judgment. As the self-created rising-sun form of Ra, dawn observance honors him alongside his solar counterpart.*

Khors — *Slavic Paganism*
Possibly a separate solar disk deity from Dazbog. Solar deity associated with the sun's disk.
How to honor: *Khors is attested only briefly in the Primary Chronicle alongside Dazhbog as a solar-disk deity, with genuinely thin source material and unclear distinction from Dazhbog. Modern Rodnovery groups occasionally honor him with the same solar offerings as Dazhbog (bread, honey, mead, gold-colored items, fire) but there is no independently attested distinct cult or festival. Given the genuine obscurity, the most appropriate acknowledgment is simple solar reverence (dawn greeting, sun symbol) grouped with general Slavic solar veneration.*

Kinich Ahau — *Maya*
Sun god, unfaithful lover of Ixchel in some accounts. Maya sun god linked romantically to Ixchel in myth.
How to honor: *Maya sun god honored with temple offerings of copal incense, blood-letting, maize, cacao, and macaw/eagle feathers; jaguar imagery marks his nocturnal underworld aspect (as "Jaguar God of the Underworld" traveling through Xibalba at night). Solar temples and dawn-facing shrines (e.g., at Tikal, Copán) were his ritual sites, and he was tied to royal legitimacy; contemporary Maya day-keepers still invoke solar imagery at dawn ceremonies, drawing on revived calendar-priest tradition.*

Kuarahy — *Guarani*
Sacred twin governing the sun, light, time. Sun deity, heroic sacred twin of Namandu's creation.
How to honor: *Jasy Jatere, golden-haired forest spirit associated with yerba mate, is respected through cautionary practice: children are told not to wander alone into the forest or mate fields during the midday siesta (his sacred hour), since he lures them away. Respect is shown by*

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leaving yerba mate leaves or tereré as a token offering at forest edges and by observing the siesta taboo.

Lisa — *Ewe/Vodun*
Solar force, strength, action, creation. Male/solar half of the supreme creative principle.
How to honor: *Lisa, the solar/male half, is honored with red and gold offerings, iron tools, and ceremonies timed to daylight or the full sun, reflecting his association with strength, heat, and active creative force. He is invoked alongside Mawu rather than approached in isolation.*

Mithras — *Roman Religion*
Solar mystery deity, bull-slaying cosmic hero. Persian-derived solar mystery god, Christianity's chief rival cult.
How to honor: *Mithras devotees moved through seven ranked grades (Raven, Nymphus, Soldier, Lion, Persian, Sun-Runner, Father), each with its own ordeal-initiation, inside underground mithraea decorated with the tauroctony (bull-slaying scene). The central rite was a shared sacred meal of bread and wine/water taken reclining before the bull image; membership and worship were restricted to men only, with torch-bearers Cautes and Cautopates flanking the altar.*

Mithras (Greek Mysteries) — *Greco-Persian (Roman Mithraism)*
Central god of the Mithraic mysteries, tauroctony (bull-slaying). Astral deity of Roman soldier-mystery cult.
How to honor: *Mithras (in Roman Mithraism) was honored through a seven-grade initiation hierarchy (Corax, Nymphus, Miles, Leo, Perses, Heliodromus, Pater), conducted in underground temples (mithraea) designed to evoke a cave, centered on the tauroctony (Mithras slaying a bull) as the central icon. Initiates shared a communal sacred meal of bread and wine, and December 25 (Dies Natalis Solis Invicti) was marked as a significant date linked to his solar aspect; the cult was male-only and excluded women entirely.*

Mithras (Zurvanism) — *Persian-derived (Roman Mithraism, linked tradition)*
Central deity of Roman Mithraic mysteries, associated with astrological/cosmic time. Astral-cosmic deity whose cult carried Zurvanite time-theology westward.
How to honor: *Mithras was worshipped through a seven-grade initiation hierarchy (Corax, Nymphus, Miles, Leo, Perses, Heliodromus, Pater) undertaken in windowless underground mithraea built to resemble a cave. The central rite reenacted the tauroctony (bull-slaying); communal banquets of bread and wine (sometimes meat) were shared on stone benches lining the chamber walls, and initiates swore oaths of secrecy — almost nothing about the exact liturgy survives since it was never written down, only inferred from surviving iconography and inscriptions.*

Naatos (the Sun, Blackfoot) — *Blackfoot*
Most powerful Above Person, covenant partner with the people. Supreme sky being governing light, life, and cosmic order.
How to honor: *Naatos (the Sun) is honored above all through the Okan (Sun Dance), the Blackfoot's most sacred annual ceremony, where vow-makers fulfill promises made to the Sun through days of fasting, self-sacrifice, and dance, opened with sweetgrass and tobacco offerings and dawn prayers facing east. Buffalo tongue was a traditional ceremonial food offering, and the Natoas Bundle (tied to the Sun and Moon) is central to the ceremony's proper conduct.*

Nanahuatl — *Aztec*
Humble, scab-covered god whose self-sacrifice became the Fifth Sun (Tonatiuh). Humble god whose selfless leap into fire created the current sun.
How to honor: *Aztec humble god whose self-immolation at Teotihuacan created the Fifth Sun; honored as patron of the poor, diseased, and those covered in sores/buboes rather than the beautiful. Devotional practice centered on modeling radical humility and voluntary self-sacrifice (symbolic, not just literal), copal incense offerings, and prayers on behalf of the sick and lowly.*

His myth was invoked at the New Fire Ceremony (Toxiuhmolpilia) marking cosmic renewal every 52 years, tying him to fire offerings and dawn-facing ritual.

Nvda (Sun) — *Cherokee*
Sky-world sun being of Galunlati. Sun deity of the Above World.
How to honor: *Nvda (Unelanuhi), the female sun-being of the sky-vault Galunlati whose daughter dwells at the noon-day place, is honored primarily through accurate oral storytelling of her myths — including the origin of death and mourning — rather than a documented cult or offering ritual. Modern respectful acknowledgment means retelling her stories via Cherokee Nation cultural sources and recognizing her, distinctively, as a female sun rather than the male sun figures common elsewhere. No offerings, altar, or festival specific to her are attested — avoid inventing them.*

Ra — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Primary solar deity, divine consciousness of the sun. Sun god traveling by barque through sky and Duat.
How to honor: *Ra received elaborate daily temple ritual at Heliopolis: priests presented bread, beer, incense, and natron to his cult image each dawn while reciting solar hymns, then repeated abbreviated rites at dusk to aid his nightly barque journey against Apophis. Obelisks capped with gilded pyramidions symbolizing his rays were his primary architectural offering; dawn/dusk prayer remains the clearest template for honoring him.*

Ra (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Solar energy, daily renewal, life force. Sun god whose daily death-and-rebirth journey templates resurrection myths.
How to honor: *Ra was honored with a formal daily temple rite at Heliopolis — the "Opening of the Face" — in which priests woke, washed, dressed, and fed his cult image with bread, beer, meat, and incense at each canonical hour, mirroring his solar barque's journey. Obelisks capped in electrum were built to catch his first rays at dawn, and dawn hymns remain the core act of honoring him in both ancient and modern Kemetic practice.*

Radegast — *Czech (Radhošť) folk tradition*
Deity of hospitality, sun, war, harvest. Legendary deity associated with Radhošť mountain.
How to honor: *Radegast, associated with Radhošť mountain and honored for hospitality, sun, war, and harvest, was according to legend honored with bonfires and sacrifices at the solstices; today a large statue atop Radhošť (erected 1931) is a pilgrimage site, and modern Czech Rodnovery practitioners light solstice bonfires and leave bread or mead offerings in his memory, though the historicity of the ancient Radhošť cult specifically (versus the Slavic Redigast of Rethra) is debated among scholars.*

Saulė — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Beloved sun goddess who rides a chariot weaving daylight. Feminine sun deity associated with golden summer light.
How to honor: *Honored above all at Joninės/Rasos (Midsummer, June 23-24), when hilltop bonfires are lit and kept burning through the shortest night to mark her point of greatest power, with celebrants staying awake till dawn to greet the sunrise — sleeping through it was considered disrespectful. Amber (saulės akmuo, "sun-stone") and the linden tree are sacred to her, worn or left as offerings, and wreaths of flowers/herbs are woven and floated on water or worn during the festival; golden or yellow objects, honey, and eggs (symbolizing her daily rebirth) are traditional gifts at her shrines and hilltop fires.*

Savitr — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Sun as vivifier, presides over Hasta nakshatra. Solar deity governing craftsmanship.
How to honor: *Savitr, presiding over Hasta nakshatra, is honored primarily through the Gayatri Mantra, which is addressed to Savitr as the vivifying aspect of the sun and remains one of the most recited mantras in Hinduism, chanted at sunrise and sunset by observant Brahmins and*

yoga practitioners. Hasta-nakshatra shanti rituals invoke him for craftsmanship, skillful action, and clarity of purpose.

Shapash — *Canaanite*
Sun goddess of the divine council. Canaanite solar deity.
How to honor: *Shapash, the Ugaritic sun goddess and "torch of the gods," is invoked in funerary contexts as psychopomp — she travels the underworld nightly and helped Anat recover Baal's body, and is called on in incantations against snakebite. She was honored with lamps, torches, and libations at sunrise or sunset; modern practice uses gold or white/orange items and daybreak prayers, reserving evening invocation for solemn or ancestor rites given her underworld role.*

Sheikh Shams — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Associated with the sun and illumination. One of the seven sacred beings, linked to solar light.
How to honor: *Some Yazidis identify the historical Umayyad Caliph Yazid I with "Sultan Ezid," a name tied to the faith's own identity, though this is theologically contested even among Yazidis; where held, the connection is expressed through oral qewls and the community's origin narrative rather than through any shrine, festival, or offering. Because Yazid I is reviled in mainstream Islam for Husayn's death at Karbala, this belief has historically fueled the false "devil-worshipper" slander against Yazidis, so it should be presented as a contested internal tradition, not fixed doctrine.*

Sol (Sun) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Roman)*
Governs vitality, identity, will, leadership. Roman god of the sun, ruler of Sunday.
How to honor: *Sol (Sun) was marked by ancient Romans on Dies Solis with sunrise devotions facing east, gold and saffron-colored offerings, and incense; the state cult of Sol Invictus held chariot races and games with his December 25 festival (Natalis Solis Invicti) as its high point. Modern planetary-day practitioners echo this with gold clothing or jewelry, sunrise meditation facing east, and citrus or honey-gold foods on the altar. Avoid working in shadow or neglecting the sunrise hour, since his hour is considered squandered if slept through.*

Soyal Kachina — *Hopi*
Specific Kachina who reappears at winter solstice to signal season's opening. Kachina whose return marks the turning of the sun and start of the ceremonial year.
How to honor: *Kachinas collectively are honored through masked dance embodiment during their half-year residence with the Hopi, the giving of tihu (kachina dolls) to girls and new brides as blessings, and offerings of cornmeal and prayer feathers at kiva ceremonies; they are ceremonially welcomed at Powamu/Soyal in winter and ritually sent off at Niman in summer.*

Sun — *Navajo/Dine*
Father of the Hero Twins; giver of light; one of the most powerful Holy People. Powerful solar Holy Person and divine father figure.
How to honor: *Jóhonaa'éí (the Sun) is greeted each dawn with corn pollen sprinkled while facing east, a daily household devotion rather than a single festival. He is invoked within the Blessingway and features centrally in the Enemy Way, whose origin story tells of the Hero Twins traveling to his house and passing his trials (obsidian knives, fire, cactus spines, crushing rocks) to receive weapons against the monsters. Turquoise is closely associated with him as a solar/sky offering stone.*

Sun (Sol, Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology*
Rules Leo; identity, vitality, ego, father, authority. Planetary archetype governing core identity and life-force.
How to honor: *The Sun rules Sunday, colors gold/orange/yellow, gold as metal, and stones like citrine, sunstone, and amber; incenses are frankincense, cinnamon, and heliotrope. Solar magic is timed to Sunday or the Sun's planetary hour for vitality, success, leadership, and healing,*

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often performed outdoors at dawn or noon with offerings of sunflowers or gold-colored items; excessive ego/pride is the classical pitfall of overworked solar magic, so humility is advised.

Sunna — *Sacred Planetary Days (Norse)*
Norse sun goddess, gives Sunday its name. Norse equivalent of the Sun, "Sunnandaeg".
How to honor: *Sunna is honored at dawn/noon with gold or yellow items, sunflowers, honey, mead, or citrus foods on an east-facing altar; sunstones, sun-wheels, and amber are common symbolic offerings in modern Heathenry. No ancient festival specific to her survives; her cult is reconstructionist, tied to Midsummer solstice rites and Sunday devotion rather than a named historical ceremony.*

Sunna (Germanic) — *Germanic Heathenry (Continental)*
Sun goddess, sister of Sinthgunt. Germanic sun goddess referenced via her sister in healing charm.
How to honor: *Sunna is honored at dawn or noon with gold/yellow items, sunflowers, honey, mead, or citrus/golden foods placed on an east-facing altar; sunstones, sun-wheels, and amber are common symbolic offerings in modern Heathenry. Sunday is her day, and some practitioners hold solstice rites (especially Midsummer) in her honor, though no widely attested ancient festival survives specifically for her — modern veneration is reconstructionist.*

Surya — *Hinduism*
Sun, illumination. Solar deity invoked as the source of inner and outer light.
How to honor: *Surya is honored each dawn with the Gayatri Mantra and Surya Namaskar (sun salutations), and offered fresh water poured from a copper vessel (arghya) facing the rising sun. Chhath Puja (Bihar/UP/Nepal) is his major living festival — a multi-day fast with offerings of thekua sweets, sugarcane, and fruit given while standing in water at sunrise and sunset; red flowers and copper are his preferred materials, and non-vegetarian food/alcohol are taboo during the fast.*

Surya (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology*
King of planetary court; ruler of soul, vitality, ego. Sun deity, Atmakaraka in Jyotish.
How to honor: *Surya is worshipped chiefly on Sundays at sunrise, with devotees offering water (Arghya) facing the rising sun, red flowers, red sandalwood, wheat, and jaggery, and reciting the Aditya Hridayam or a 108-count Surya Beej Mantra; Surya Namaskar (sun salutation) is performed as embodied daily worship. Major temples include Suryanar Kovil (Tamil Nadu) and Konark's Sun Temple; devotees typically avoid non-vegetarian food and alcohol on Sundays out of respect.*

Surya Deva — *Sacred Planetary Days (Vedic)*
Sun deity, charioteer of light. Vedic sun god ruling Ravivar (Sunday).
How to honor: *Surya Deva is honored daily through Arghya — offering water poured from a copper vessel to the rising sun while facing east — and through Surya Namaskar (sun salutation yoga sequence) performed at dawn. The major living festival is Chhath Puja (Bihar/UP/Nepal), where devotees fast, stand in water at sunset and sunrise, and offer fruit, sugarcane, and thekua sweets directly to the sun. Red flowers, wheat, and jaggery are standard puja offerings; disrespecting the sun (looking at it derisively, working through the sunrise hour without acknowledgment) is considered inauspicious.*

Tawa (Taiowa) — *Hopi*
Sun Spirit, ultimate Creator. Supreme Sun Spirit and source of life who conceived the universe's blueprint.
How to honor: *Maitreya's honoring at Koyasan is inseparable from Kukai's own cult: monks carry ceremonial meals (Shojingu) to Kukai's mausoleum at Okunoin twice daily, maintaining the belief that Kukai remains in eternal meditation awaiting Maitreya's future arrival; pilgrims light candles and incense along the Okunoin cemetery path leading to the mausoleum.*

The Sun (Elder Brother) — *Haudenosaunee*
Source of warmth and light sustaining life. Sun addressed as elder brother in daily gratitude practice.
How to honor: *The Sun (Elder Brother) is thanked each day and at the opening of every Haudenosaunee ceremony via the Thanksgiving Address, addressed literally as "our eldest brother" for warmth and life-sustaining light; the Midwinter and Green Corn ceremonies both include sun-directed gratitude as part of the annual ceremonial cycle. Honoring is verbal/communal recitation, not object-based ritual.*

Tonatiuh — *Aztec*
Sun god of the current (Fifth) Sun; demands blood to move across sky. Sun god of the present era requiring blood sacrifice to move.
How to honor: *Honored daily at dawn: priests offered quail blood, copal incense, and blew conch shells to help him rise and cross the sky, since he was believed to require nourishment (nextlahualli, "debt payment") of war-captive blood and hearts, offered chiefly at the Templo Mayor's sun-facing altars. Eagle imagery and eagle-warrior devotion were tied to him, along with turquoise and gold as solar colors; his face is carved at the center of the Aztec Calendar (Sun) Stone. Modern acknowledgment (without literal sacrifice) centers on sunrise gratitude and eagle/solar symbolism.*

Wi (Sun) — *Lakota Sioux*
One of the four "superior beings". Sun as one of the four principal aspects of Wakan Tanka.
How to honor: *Maka (Ina Maka, "Mother Earth") is honored by returning tobacco, ashes, and pipe offerings directly to the earth during and after the Pipe Ceremony, and by general reverence for land as literally her body. She is invoked at the start of ceremonies alongside prayers to the four directions. Taboo: disrespecting or exploiting the land is a direct offense to her.*

Moon

Lunar deities governing night, tides, cycles, and the sacred calendar.

Artemis — *Greek*
Goddess of hunt, moon, the wild; autonomous virgin huntress. Wild feminine goddess of the hunt and night.
How to honor: *Artemis was honored with offerings of deer, honey cakes, and small votive figurines left at her sanctuaries, notably at Ephesus and Brauron. At the Brauronia festival, young Athenian girls performed the arkteia ("acting the bear") as a rite of passage before marriage, dedicating their girlhood toys to her; boastful hunters who violated her wild creatures or spied on her modesty (as in the myth of Actaeon, torn apart by his own hounds) were subject to severe punishment.*

Chandra (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology*
Queen of planetary court; governs mind, emotions, mother. Moon deity governing the manas.
How to honor: *Chandra is honored on Mondays with white flowers, white sandalwood paste, rice, milk, and silver items offered at his temple (notably Thingalur in Tamil Nadu) or via Shiva worship, since Chandra rests on Shiva's crown; fasting (Somvar vrat) and drinking or bathing with milk-infused water are common practices to soothe an afflicted Moon. Silver donation to the poor or a temple is considered especially pleasing to him.*

Chandra/Shiva (via Soma) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Vedic)*
Moon deity associated with Shiva. Vedic moon deity ruling Somvar (Monday).
How to honor: *Chandra/Shiva (via Soma): Monday (Somvar) is kept with fasting (Somvar vrat) and Shiva puja: pouring milk, water, and honey over the Shiva lingam (abhishekam), and offering bilva (bael) leaves, considered his most pleasing offering and never reused once fallen. White flowers and sandalwood paste are also offered; onion, garlic, and non-vegetarian food are avoided by observant fasters on this day. Pradosh Vrat, timed to twilight on the 13th lunar day, is a related Shiva-Chandra observance.*

Chang'e — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Goddess who lives on the moon, swallowed elixir of immortality. Moon goddess honored at harvest full moon.
How to honor: *Chang'e, the moon goddess who swallowed the elixir of immortality, is honored at the Mid-Autumn Festival (15th day of the eighth lunar month) with mooncake offerings, incense, round fruits echoing the full moon, and family moon-gazing gatherings. Women historically prayed to her specifically for beauty; the festival's core value, family reunion, is understood as the proper way to honor her exile and longing for home.*

Coyolxauhqui — *Aztec*
Sister of Huitzilopochtli, dismembered and made into the moon. Moon goddess born of Huitzilopochtli's mythic decapitation of her.
How to honor: *Has no dedicated temple or offering cult of her own in the historical record — she functions primarily as mythic antagonist to Huitzilopochtli, depicted dismembered on the great circular Coyolxauhqui Stone unearthed at the base of Templo Mayor in 1978, a find that launched major excavations of the site. Historically her role was symbolic (the defeated moon, reenacted in ballcourt and warfare imagery) rather than devotional. Modern acknowledgment is through moon-associated offerings — silver items, white flowers, incense at the full moon — and through appreciation of her as a reclaimed symbol of resilience in contemporary Mexican art and feminist reinterpretation.*

Coyolxauhqui (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Moon goddess, daughter of Coatlicue. Moon deity dismembered by Huitzilopochtli at each dawn.

How to honor: *Coyolxauhqui is commemorated primarily through the massive Coyolxauhqui Stone set at the base of the Templo Mayor's Huitzilopochtli staircase, where sacrificial victims' bodies were made to tumble down in ritual reenactment of her mythic dismemberment and defeat. Her name ("Golden Bells") points to gold bell ornaments as her iconographic marker, with silver/moon-white as her associated color; she is honored today mainly through archaeological/commemorative acknowledgment of the stone itself rather than an ongoing offering cult.*

Diana — *Roman Religion*

Moon, hunting, sacred wilderness. Goddess of the moon, hunt, and wild places.

How to honor: *Diana was honored at her woodland sanctuary at Lake Nemi, where the presiding priest — the Rex Nemorensis — held his position only by ritually killing his predecessor in single combat. Her festival Nemoralia (August 13, "Feast of Torches") saw pilgrims, especially women seeking fertility or safe childbirth, process to the lake by torchlight and leave votive offerings; dogs, her sacred hunting companions, were honored alongside her.*

Diana (Wicca) — *Wicca*

One aspect/name of the Wiccan Goddess. A name the Goddess is known by.

How to honor: *Diana (Wiccan/Stregheria) is honored at the full moon (especially August's "Diana's Bow") with offerings of apples, mugwort, honey cakes, and wine, and imagery of stags, dogs, the crescent moon, and bow/arrow; silver and white are her colors, moonstone her stone. Stregheria and Dianic Wicca hold her as central, invoked outdoors under moonlight for protection, the hunt, and women's mysteries — some Dianic rites are reserved as women-only.*

Grandmother Moon — *Haudenosaunee*

Governs tides, planting calendar, waters of life. Moon as respected elder/grandmother figure.

How to honor: *Grandmother Moon (Haudenosaunee) is honored primarily through the Ohén:ton Karihwatéhkwen (Thanksgiving Address), where she is thanked by name in her own designated passage for regulating tides, waters, and the planting calendar; women's ceremonies and full-moon gatherings also acknowledge her influence over fertility and cycles. Recitation of the Address at the opening of gatherings, ballgames, and ceremonies is itself the honoring act.*

Grandmother Moon (Nokomis Dibiki-Giizis) — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*

Governs waters, tides, women's monthly cycles. Moon spirit governing water and women's cycles.

How to honor: *Asibikaashi (Spider Woman), protector of children, continues to be honored through the making and hanging of dreamcatchers above cradleboards and children's sleeping places, woven with prayer and intention as she originally wove her protective webs across the doorways of the wigwam to filter out bad dreams. This remains a genuinely living daily practice — the craft itself, done with proper intention, is the act of honoring her.*

Hanwi — *Lakota Sioux*

Moon; one of four associate beings. Moon deity of Lakota cosmology.

How to honor: *Iktomi, the spider trickster who gave humans speech, is honored not through offerings but through oral storytelling — his tales are told specifically in winter, after the first frost, as moral instruction about the consequences of greed and deceit, with his schemes typically backfiring on himself. Elders caution against retelling his stories outside the proper winter season.*

Hina — *Society/Marquesas Islands*

Goddess of moon, tapa cloth, ocean depths, tides; mother of 'Oro. Widely distributed Polynesian moon goddess and mother of 'Oro.

How to honor: *Hina is honored across Polynesia as patroness of tapa (bark cloth) making — women traditionally invoked her while beating and dyeing tapa, offering finished cloth, coconut, and kava at her shrines, since the moon's phases were believed to govern the best times for beating cloth. She is tied to the tides and ocean depths, so shore-side and moonlit offerings*

(flowers, shellfish, white cloth) were customary. In Hawaiian and wider Polynesian hula/chant traditions she is still invoked in mele (chants) honoring women's arts, the moon, and motherhood.

Ixchel (Goddess I / Goddess O, Chak Chel) — *Maya*
Composite lunar/medicine/midwifery/weaving/flood goddess. Complex Maya goddess of moon, healing, weaving, and destructive floodwater.
How to honor: *Composite Maya moon/medicine/midwifery/weaving goddess whose main documented cult site was the oracle temple on Cozumel (San Gervasio), reached by ritual canoe pilgrimage from the mainland — a crossing that has been symbolically revived in modern Quintana Roo tourism-ceremony events. Devotees historically brought medicine bundles, backstrap-loom weavings, and jade to be blessed, and women prayed to her for safe childbirth and fertility; she is invoked by moon phase, with the waxing/full moon considered most favorable for healing and weaving rites.*

Jaasy — *Guarani*
Sacred twin governing the moon and the planting calendar. Moon deity governing agricultural and temporal rhythms.
How to honor: *Wakan Tanka, the all-pervasive Great Mystery, is approached primarily through the Chanunpa (Sacred Pipe) and the Seven Sacred Rites (Sun Dance, vision quest, Inipi sweat lodge, and others), all understood as ways of honoring the recognition that "everything is wakan" (sacred). Tobacco offerings, prayer ties in the four sacred colors, and communal ceremony led by qualified elders are the primary devotional acts. Taboo: approaching these rites without proper preparation or elder guidance is deeply disrespectful.*

Kokomikeis (the Moon, Blackfoot) — *Blackfoot*
Sun's wife, Morning Star's mother, protector of women's ceremonies. Grandmother moon-being, source of comfort.
How to honor: *Kokomikeis (the Moon), wife of the Sun and protector of women's ceremonies, is honored through the Natoas ("Sun/Moon") Bundle central to the Okan, and through the ceremonial roles of women, particularly the Matoki women's society. Her comfort-giving, grandmotherly aspect is invoked in prayers alongside Naatos during Sun Dance preparations rather than through a separate standalone rite.*

Luna (Moon) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Roman)*
Governs emotion, body cycles, dreams. Roman goddess of the moon, ruler of Monday.
How to honor: *Luna (Moon) was honored at a temple on Rome's Aventine Hill where libations of milk and honey and silver offerings were left in her honor, with rites timed to the lunar month (the Kalends marking the new moon). Modern observance keeps Monday for water rituals, dream journaling upon waking, and white or silver candles lit at night facing the moon. She is associated with cycles and the irrational/intuitive, so decisions made hastily on her day are traditionally distrusted.*

Mama Killa — *Inca/Tawantinsuyu (Andes)*
Goddess of the moon; regulator of the ceremonial calendar; Inti's sister-wife. Moon goddess governing timing of religious ceremonies.
How to honor: *Honored with silver offerings and objects (a silver disc/mask bearing a human face) at her own temple in Cusco, tended by dedicated priestesses (mamaconas); her lunar cycle set the timing of festivals and ceremonies, and during lunar eclipses devotees threw weapons, shouted, and made noise (dogs made to bark) to drive off the danger threatening her.*

Mani — *Sacred Planetary Days (Norse)*
Norse moon god, gives Monday its name. Norse equivalent of the Moon, "Monandaeg".
How to honor: *Mani is honored with moonlit rituals timed to full/new moon, offerings of silver, milk, white foods, or incense left outdoors at night, white/silver candles, and Monday evenings dedicated to him. No major ancient festival is attested; modern devotion is personal-shrine-based*

reconstructionism drawing on the Prose Edda's account of Hati the wolf pursuing him across the sky.

Marama — *Cook Islands*
God of the moon; regulator of sacred calendar. Moon god governing ceremonial and agricultural timing.
How to honor: *As regulator of the sacred calendar, Marama's honor was expressed by timing ceremonies, planting, and fishing to the phases of the moon he governs — a practice still followed informally in Cook Islands gardening and fishing lore. No distinct offering-shrine tradition for Marama himself is well attested; devotion took the form of calendrical observance (new moon and full moon markers for ritual and agricultural timing) rather than a personal cult.*

Mawu — *Ewe/Vodun*
Creation, compassion, lunar grace, night, water. Female/lunar half of the supreme creative principle.
How to honor: *Mawu, the lunar/female half of the creator pair, is honored with white offerings (white cloth, white clay/kaolin, silver ornaments) and rites performed at night or during the new moon, reflecting her association with gentleness, water, and compassion. Libations of water are poured in her name at family shrines, often by female ritual specialists.*

Mėnuo — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Moon deity, husband/counterpart to Saulė in mythological cycle. Moon god whose relationship with Saulė is explored in thousands of dainas (folk songs).
How to honor: *Honored in Romuva revivalist practice through moon-phase observance — new-moon prayers/greetings ("sveikas, Mėnuli") and offerings of silver coins, milk, or bread left outdoors under moonlight — reflecting his association with time-keeping and growth cycles as masculine counterpart to sun-goddess Saulė. His myth (unfaithfulness to Saulė, punished by Perkūnas) is retold as a moral/seasonal story rather than reenacted ritually, though new-moon timing is still favored for starting new undertakings. Taboo: showing disrespect during the moon's "dark" phase, considered inauspicious for new work.*

Moon (Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology*
Rules Cancer; emotion, instinct, home, mother, cycles. Fastest-moving planetary archetype governing feeling and memory.
How to honor: *The Moon rules Monday, colors silver/white, silver as metal, and stones like moonstone, pearl, and selenite; incenses are jasmine, sandalwood, and camphor. Lunar magic is timed to phase — new moon for beginnings, waxing for growth, full moon for culmination/psychic work, waning for banishing — with offerings of milk, white flowers, or water; major decisions are traditionally avoided during a "void-of-course" Moon.*

Nanna (Sin) — *Mesopotamian*
Moon god, patron of city of Ur, governs lunar calendar. Nocturnal counterpart deity providing dark-wisdom illumination.
How to honor: *Nanna/Sin was worshipped at his temple Ekishnugal in Ur, served historically by a high-ranking en-priestess (the office Enheduanna held); devotion followed the lunar calendar, with particular observance at new moon and full moon, and offerings of milk and cattle products reflecting his bull/crescent-horn imagery. Libations and hymns were offered at night rather than day, and modern reconstructionist practice mirrors this with moonlit offerings of milk or dairy.*

Nvda Equa (Moon) — *Cherokee*
Sky-world moon being. Moon deity of the Above World.
How to honor: *Nvda Equa (Nvdo/Nûñdi), the male moon-being conceptually paired with the female sun, appears in myths explaining lunar phases and markings, including a story of a secret nightly visitor. No independent shrine, offering practice, or festival exists for the moon alone; he is honored through preserving and retelling the associated origin stories in Cherokee oral tradition rather than through invented ritual acts.*

Sheikh Fahr ad-Din — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Sacred being associated with the moon. One of the seven sacred beings, lunar association.
How to honor: *Devout Yazidis traditionally rise before dawn to wash and pray facing the sun, repeating at midday and sunset, understood as reverence for divine light channeled through Sheikh Shams rather than sun-worship; his tomb stands within Lalish, where pilgrims kiss its walls and threshold and light oil lamps, especially during Cejna Cemaiye. Taboo: conflating this solar devotion with "worshipping the sun" is a persistent outside misreading Yazidis explicitly reject, since the practice honors Xwedê's light, not the sun itself.*

Soma (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Moon deity, presides over Mrigashira nakshatra. Lunar deity associated with searching/questing energy.
How to honor: *Soma, presiding over Mrigashira nakshatra, is honored much as Chandra is — with white offerings, milk, rice, and Monday-associated lunar rites — since Soma in later Hinduism is largely identified with the Moon god. In Vedic ritual proper, Soma is also the name of a sacred offered drink pressed and offered in Soma sacrifices, historically central to Vedic fire ritual though rarely performed in this exact form today.*

Tecuciztecatl — *Aztec*
Proud god who became the moon after hesitating to leap into the sacrificial fire. Prideful god transformed into the moon, its "rabbit" mark visible today.
How to honor: *Before his mythic leap at Teotihuacan, he fasted and did penance for four days, offering quetzal-feather fir branches, gold "grass balls," turquoise maguey spines, and copal incense while dressed in a heron-feather headdress and paper jacket. Honor him with moon-associated offerings (silver or white objects, incense, feathers), especially at the full moon; modern Mexicayotl/Toltecayotl practitioners incorporate him into lunar-cycle ceremonies tied to the Nahui Ollin creation story. No taboos are specifically recorded beyond general respect for penitential fasting before offering.*

Tsukuyomi — *Shinto*
Moon god, born from Izanagi's right eye during misogi. Governs the night sky.
How to honor: *Tsukuyomi is venerated chiefly at Tsukiyomi-jinja shrines in Kyoto and Nagasaki, with standard shinsen offerings (rice, sake, salt, water) presented at night or during moon-viewing times, plus mirrors and white items as lunar symbols. He has almost no independent mythic narrative or festival tradition — acknowledgment is best made through quiet moon-viewing (tsukimi) observance and standard shrine visitation rather than inventing elaborate ritual detail.*

Xbalanque — *Maya (Popol Vuh)*
Hero Twin, later becomes the moon. Hero Twin who defeats the underworld lords and becomes the moon.
How to honor: *Hero Twin who becomes the moon (paired with Hunahpu's sun); honored alongside his brother through the ritual ballgame reenacting their victory over the Xibalba lords, with rubber, copal incense, and blood offerings at ballcourts. Night and moonlight are his symbolic domain; appropriate modern honoring is Popol Vuh storytelling paired with moonlit remembrance rather than invented rites specific to him alone.*

Yarikh — *Canaanite*
Moon god of the divine council. Canaanite lunar deity.
How to honor: *Yarikh, the Ugaritic moon god with a plausible cult center at Beth Yerah ("House of Yarikh"), is central to the myth "The Marriage of Yarikh and Nikkal-wa-Ib," tied to fertility, dowry, and the harvest moon. He is honored at the new or full moon with dates, wine, milk, or moon-shaped bread, silver items, and crescent symbols, with prayers for fertility and marriage — distinct from Mesopotamian Sin/Nanna despite the lunar overlap.*

Storm & Weather

Thunder, lightning, wind, and rain — the gods of sky-violence and the rains that feed the fields.

Amadioha — *Igbo Odinani (Nigeria)*
God of thunder and lightning. Thunder deity parallel to Yoruba Shango and Slavic Perun.
How to honor: *Amadioha is worshipped at shrines (notably Ozuzu in Rivers State) with offerings of kola nut, palm wine, rams, roosters, and yams, especially during the New Yam Festival, where he is honored alongside Ani/Ala. He is invoked for oaths and justice, with lightning strikes read as his direct judgment; sacred colors are red and white, the ram and thunderstone are his symbols, and false oaths, theft, or lying sworn in his name are believed to invite punishment by lightning. His shrines require ritual purity to approach.*

Animikiig (Thunderbirds) — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*
Great thunder birds carrying lightning, maintain sky-water balance vs. Mishibizhii. Powerful sky spirits whose battles with the Underwater Panther maintain cosmic balance.
How to honor: *Gitche Manitou (the Great Mystery) is acknowledged at the opening of all Anishinaabe ceremony rather than petitioned directly; tobacco is the primary offering medium used to honor the sacred quality (manitou) present in all beings, placed down before gathering medicine, entering ceremony, or making a request of the spirit world. Right relationship and reciprocity in daily life are the honoring practice itself.*

Baal Hadad — *Canaanite*
Storm god bringing rain, most active deity. Young storm-warrior god who dies and resurrects annually.
How to honor: *Baal Hadad received burnt and peace offerings at his Ugarit temple, first fruits at harvest, and bull sacrifices (the bull being his emblem animal), with rites timed to the start of the rainy season to invoke fertilizing rain and to autumn/spring turning points tied to his mythic death and resurrection. Modern reconstructionists pour wine, oil, and bread libations during storms or at seasonal turning points, invoking him for rain, fertility, and victory over chaos (Yam, Mot).*

Changó — *Lucumí*
Orisha of thunder, lightning, fire, fierce justice. Deified warrior-king of thunder and justice (syncretized with Santa Barbara).
How to honor: *Changó is fed amalá (cornmeal with okra) and given red wine poured directly onto the earth, alongside apples, bananas, and red palm oil; his altar centers a mortar (batea) topped with a double-headed axe (oshe) in red and white. December 4th is his major feast (syncretized with Santa Barbara), marked by batá drumming and dance since he was a legendary drummer-king; he dislikes cowardice and betrayal and is invoked for justice, virility, and protection from enemies via thunder/lightning symbolism.*

Cocijo — *Zapotec*
Rain, lightning, storm; most important Zapotec deity. Lightning/rain god with jaguar-serpent features controlling crop survival.
How to honor: *Cocijo, depicted with jaguar-serpent features on funerary urns, was Zapotec's most important deity, honored with copal incense and offerings tied to the agricultural cycle (particularly the rainy season on which crop survival depended) and with rituals conducted at mountaintop shrines, since mountains were seen as his dwelling places and the source of rain clouds. Urns bearing his image were placed in tombs to invoke his protective power for the dead as well as the living.*

Donar (Thor/Þunor) — *Germanic Heathenry*
Thunder god, protector of common people. Thunder god and protector invoked by ordinary people.

How to honor: *Donar/Thor is honored with blót involving cattle offerings and ale, historically at sacred oak groves associated with him; his hammer (Mjölnir) amulets are worn and were traditionally used to "hallow" weddings, boundaries, and newborns. Thursday is named for him, and he was invoked especially by common farmers and craftsmen for protection from harm.*

Dragon Kings — *Chinese (Wu tradition)*
Regional weather and rain deities negotiated with during rain-calling ceremonies (yu ji). Cosmic officials responsible for regional rain and weather.
How to honor: *The Dragon Kings (Long Wang) are honored through rain-invocation rituals at their temples during drought: historically this involved processions carrying the Dragon King's image, burning incense, offering pork, wine, and fruit, and ritual specialists performing dance and trance negotiation to "request" rain. Temples to specific Dragon Kings still receive incense offerings in Chinese folk practice today.*

Dragon Kings (Long Wang) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Four Dragon Kings ruling the seas, rivers, rain/weather. Auspicious composite serpentine rulers of water and weather.
How to honor: *The Dragon Kings (Long Wang), rulers of the seas, rivers, and rain, are honored with offerings and processions especially during drought, when communities pray publicly for rain; if petitions went unanswered, Chinese folk practice historically included symbolically berating or temporarily removing offerings from a Dragon King's statue as ritual pressure. Excess flooding likewise prompted appeasement offerings asking the rains to stop.*

Enlil — *Mesopotamian*
Lord of earth and wind, active force of earthly power, decrees destiny. Storm/decree god who ordered the flood in Gilgamesh.
How to honor: *Enlil was honored at his temple Ekur in Nippur, the religious center whose priesthood's endorsement was required to legitimize any king's rule; offerings included barley, bread, dates, and beer presented at the temple, and the Tummal festival marked periodic renewal/procession of his sanctuary. Because Enlil is also the god who decreed the mythic flood out of irritation with human noise, worship of him historically carried an undertone of caution and humility rather than easy familiarity — approach him formally, not casually.*

Iansã / Oyá — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Orixá of wind, storms, and the threshold of death. Warrior goddess of wind who escorts the dead.
How to honor: *Iansã/Oyá is fed acarajé (black-eyed-pea fritters fried in dendê palm oil), red wine, and physalis fruit (camapu), with offerings tied in red cloth and left at cemetery gates, windy hilltops, or beneath a baobab/ceiba tree; her colors are red and coral-brown, her day is Wednesday, and she carries an eruexin (horsetail whip) and sword as emblems. She is greeted with "Eparrei Oyá!", syncretized with St. Barbara, and devotees avoid offering her foods associated with Oxum (like pumpkin) since the orixás' offerings are not interchangeable.*

Illapa — *Inca/Tawantinsuyu (Andes)*
God of thunder, lightning, storms, and rain/harvest. Storm god who carries a war club and sling, whose thunder follows lightning.
How to honor: *Honored at his dedicated temple (Pucamarca) and at Sacsayhuamán with sacrificed llama fetuses as prized offerings, plus music, dance, and communal ceremony meant to secure rainfall and protect against storm damage; priests led prayers seeking his benevolence, and he was linked to the Milky Way as the celestial river from which he drew rain.*

Indra — *Hinduism*
Thunder, war, king of Vedic gods. Vedic king of gods associated with thunder and war.
How to honor: *Indra has no major surviving temple tradition or organized cult in contemporary Hinduism — his Vedic-era primacy faded as Vishnu and Shiva rose to dominance — and today he survives mainly through Rigvedic hymn recitation by Vedic scholars and appearances in mythological retellings (Ramayana, Mahabharata) rather than active devotional worship. The*

clearest living trace is Indra Jatra, a Newar Buddhist/Hindu festival in Kathmandu, Nepal, honoring him after he was caught stealing flowers and released by his mother Indra's mother-goddess captors — marked by chariot processions of the Kumari (living goddess) and masked dances rather than direct puja to Indra himself.

Kanna Kamuy — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Kamuy of thunder and lightning, sometimes serpent/dragon form. Thunder and lightning deity.
How to honor: *Kanna Kamuy, the thunder/lightning kamuy (sometimes serpent or dragon form), is placated during storms rather than routinely worshipped: inau are set up with murmured protective prayers and sake flicked skyward with the ikupasuy, household fires are banked in a gesture of respect, and shouting, arguing, or mocking the storm is strictly avoided since this kamuy is considered quick to anger. No fixed annual festival exists for him; his honoring is situational, tied to the storm's presence.*

Ksiistsikomm (Thunder Beings) — *Blackfoot*
Powerful, feared Above Persons; source of thunder/lightning/spring rain. Thunder spirits governing storms.
How to honor: *Ksiistsikomm (Thunder Beings) are honored through the Thunder Medicine Pipe Bundle, which is ceremonially awakened at the first thunder of spring in a multi-day ceremony of specific songs, dances, and tobacco offerings, and formally closed again in the fall when thunder quiets. These beings are approached with caution and deep respect as powerful, potentially dangerous Above Persons rather than casually invoked.*

Marduk — *Mesopotamian (Babylon)*
Patron deity of Babylon, supreme god after defeating Tiamat. Storm-warrior god elevated to head of Babylonian pantheon.
How to honor: *Marduk was honored at his Esagila temple in Babylon and above all through the Akitu New Year festival, when the Enuma Elish was recited in full and the king underwent a ritual humiliation — stripped of regalia and struck by the high priest — before being reinstated, symbolically renewing Marduk's kingship through him. Standard temple offerings were bread, dates, and beer; his symbols are the mushussu dragon and the marru (spade), suitable altar objects for modern devotees petitioning for order, kingship, or victory over chaos.*

Mari — *Basque*
Supreme goddess; storms are her enforcement of moral order; lives in mountain caves. Supreme sovereign goddess of mountains, storms, truth, and the sacred feminine.
How to honor: *Mari, the Basque mountain goddess, receives offerings left at the mouths of her cave residences (such as Anboto or Amboto) — traditionally bread, milk, and coins — and is approached through honest, truthful living, since storms were understood as her direct enforcement of moral order against liars and oath-breakers. Approach protocols emphasize humility and truthfulness rather than lavish ritual; disrespecting caves associated with her or breaking oaths in her name was considered to invite her storms.*

Ogou Shango — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Thunder-and-iron aspect drawing on Yoruba Shango. Thunder-and-iron Lwa bridging Vodou and Yoruba traditions.
How to honor: *Maman Brigitte, the only "white" (European-origin) Lwa, receives rum steeped in hot peppers poured directly onto or beside cemetery graves marked with a purple cross, plus black coffee and coins; she is petitioned especially for nervous-system illness, fertility, and protection of graves. Honored during Fèt Gede alongside her husband Baron Samedi, with purple and black as her colors. Taboo: neglecting grave maintenance is seen as inviting her displeasure, since she guards the sanctity of burial grounds.*

Oyá (Santeria) — *Lucumí*
Orisha of wind, storms, cemetery, marketplace, radical change; Changó's warrior companion. Storm goddess who guards the threshold of death and change.

How to honor: *Oyá is honored with nine of everything — nine purple or maroon items, nine coins, nine varieties of grain — offered at a cemetery gate, since she guards the boundary between the living and dead. Red wine, eggplant, and a horsetail whisk (iruke) used to "sweep" negative energy are central to her rites; she is invoked in storms and radical change but never approached carelessly at graveyards, and her feast is February 2nd, syncretized with Our Lady of Candelaria.*

Perkūnas — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
God of thunder, lightning, sacred oak, fire, justice, and war. Thunder god locked in eternal pursuit of Velnias; storms are his pursuit.
How to honor: *Central to Romuva practice is the eternal fire (šventoji ugnis), traditionally fed with oak wood since the oak was his sacred tree, with oak groves serving as historic open-air shrines for offerings and vows. Folk sacrifice traditionally included a black goat, rooster, or ox (the dark color thought pleasing to him), alongside beer libations poured at the oak's roots; he is invoked in thunderstorms and at his feast (tied to early August), with iron, axes, and red/black also associated with him. Mocking a storm or neglecting the harvest fire was taboo.*

Perun — *Slavic Paganism*
Supreme thunder god, war, justice, sacred oaths. Thunder god, eternal opponent of Veles, protector of order.
How to honor: *Perun was historically worshipped at sacred hilltop oak groves (his tree) with offerings of bread, meat, and sacrificed bulls or roosters; a perpetual fire was kept burning before his idol (as recorded at Kyiv and Novgorod), and extinguishing it was taboo. Modern Rodnovery keeps Thursday (Perun's day, cognate with Thor's/Zeus's thunder-days) as his observance, with iron axe pendants (the "axe of Perun") worn for protection and oaths sworn on weapons or rings in his name — breaking such an oath was considered to invite his lightning.*

Rudra — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Storm deity, presides over Ardra nakshatra. Fierce storm-god associated with transformation through upheaval.
How to honor: *Rudra, presiding over Ardra nakshatra, is honored through Rudrabhishekam — ritual bathing of a Shiva lingam with milk, water, honey, and bilva leaves while chanting the Rudram/Namakam-Chamakam or the Maha Mrityunjaya Mantra — since Rudra is the Vedic precursor of Shiva. Ardra-nakshatra shanti pujas specifically invoke this fierce, transformative aspect to calm turbulent or upheaval-driven periods.*

Set (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Chaos, storms, desert, necessary disruption. God of chaos and disruption balancing Horus's order.
How to honor: *Set was honored at his cult centers of Ombos and Naqada with red-toned offerings (red bread, red-haired animals), red being his sacred/taboo color across Egyptian culture; several pharaohs (Seti I, Setnakht, the Hyksos kings) took his name as a mark of royal favor rather than shame. Modern Kemetic practice honors him as necessary disruption and desert power balancing order, not as an evil to be shunned — storms, the desert edge, and foreign lands fall under his domain.*

Shango — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Thunder, lightning, royal power, justice. Deified king of Oyo, Orisha of thunder and royal authority.
How to honor: *Ogun is honored with raw palm oil, gin or rum, roasted yams, and offerings placed directly on iron tools or machetes; devotees historically swore binding oaths with a hand on cold iron because breaking an Ogun-oath was considered fatal. Roosters and, in older practice, dogs were sacrificed to him; his colors are black and green, his numbers 3 and 7, and bluntness/honesty in speech is expected of those who serve him.*

Stribog — *Slavic Paganism*

Wind deity, father of the winds. God of wind and its directional children.
How to honor: *Stribog, god of wind, is honored in modern Rodnovery with offerings of feathers, incense/smoke released to the wind, whistling or wind-chimes, and grain scattered to open air on windy days or hilltops; associated with autumn/winter wind rites and sometimes invoked for safe travel or good weather. Attested in the Primary Chronicle as "father of the winds." Modern veneration favors outdoor, elevated, wind-exposed locations.*

Susanoo — *Shinto*
Storm god governing seas/storms; born from Izanagi's nose. Passionate, destructive-yet-heroic storm deity, father of Japanese poetry.
How to honor: *Susanoo is honored chiefly at Yasaka Shrine in Kyoto through the Gion Matsuri (July), historically a plague-warding festival where chimaki (bamboo-leaf charms, not the food) are distributed as protective wards and mikoshi are paraded through the city in his name. His myth of getting Yamata no Orochi drunk on eightfold-brewed sake ties sake offerings specifically to him, and shimenawa (sacred straw rope) marks sites associated with him, echoing the rope he used to bind the slain serpent.*

Tate — *Lakota Sioux*
Wind; one of four associate beings. Wind deity of Lakota cosmology.
How to honor: *White Buffalo Calf Woman is honored above all through correct, reverent performance of the Chanunpa (Sacred Pipe) ceremony she gave the Lakota, along with the Seven Sacred Rites more broadly; extreme reverence and purity of intent are required in her rites, per her origin story where disrespect was met with instant death. The original sacred pipe bundle is kept and periodically displayed by a hereditary keeper.*

The Cailleach (Beira) — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Ancient goddess/hag who shaped the Highland landscape; rules Samhain-Imbolc. One-eyed winter goddess who created mountains and lochs with her hammer, guardian of wild animals.
How to honor: *The Cailleach is honored chiefly at Tigh nam Bodach in Glen Cailleach, Perthshire, where water-worn stone figures representing her, the Bodach, and their family are ceremonially taken from their stone shelter each Beltane (May 1) and returned each Samhain (November 1), with offerings left for their "keeping." Highland tradition also had farmers plait the last sheaf of harvest into a "Cailleach" figure kept safe through winter, and hunters were expected to show reverence toward deer, her sacred animal, or risk her wrath in the high hills.*

The Thunderers (Grandfathers) — *Haudenosaunee*
Bring lightning and rain. Sacred thunder beings who water the earth.
How to honor: *The Sun (Elder Brother) is thanked each day and at the opening of every Haudenosaunee ceremony via the Thanksgiving Address, addressed as "our eldest brother" for warmth and life-sustaining light; the Midwinter and Green Corn ceremonies both include sun-directed gratitude.*

Thor — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
God of thunder, protector of Midgard. Most beloved Norse god, wields Mjolnir against giants.
How to honor: *Thor (Norse, general) was widely invoked by common people as protector against giants and chaos; iron and hammer symbolism (Mjölnir pendants) were worn and are still worn today, historically used to "hallow" — bless — weddings, births, boundary markers, and even funeral pyres by a hammer sign. Offerings of ale, beer, and iron objects were left in his honor; oak trees were considered sacred to him (paralleling Perun and Zeus), goats (Tanngrisnir and Tanngnjóstr) are his sacred animals, and Thursday bears his name across Germanic languages.*

Thor (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Norse)*
Thunder god; gives Thursday its name. Norse equivalent of Jupiter, "Thursdaeg".

How to honor: *Thor (Planetary Days) is widely honored in modern Heathenry/Asatru with mead, beer, roasted goat or other meat, bread, and iron/hammer-shaped Mjölnir pendants placed on the altar; red, oak, and hammers are his symbols. Named rites include Þórsblót and the modern Icelandic midwinter Þorrablót feast, with toasts ("skål") and the hammer-sign gesture as standard ritual acts on Thursday.*

Thunder Boys (Ani-Hyuntikwalaski) — *Cherokee*

Twin sons of the Thunder being, lightning/storms. Powerful sky-associated twin helpers.

How to honor: *The Thunder Boys (Ani-Hyuntikwalaski), twin sons of the Thunder being associated with lightning and storms, appear across Cherokee myth as protective but dangerous forces to be respected rather than casually invoked. Documented practice is oral storytelling and cautious, respectful behavior around thunder and lightning as living spiritual power — no formal offering cult, altar, or named ritual to them is attested, so honoring them means accurate storytelling of their role guarding against monsters, not invented rites.*

Tishtrya (Tishtar) — *Zoroastrianism*

Rain-bringing star (Sirius). Star-deity governing rain, battling the demon of drought annually.

How to honor: *Tishtrya is honored at Tiregan, a still-celebrated mid-summer festival in Iran marking his mythic three-day battle and victory over the drought-demon Apaosha; the modern custom of throwing water on passersby (water-splashing) directly commemorates the rain he brings. Wristband-tying and reciting the Tir Yasht are traditional parts of the feast.*

Tlaloc (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*

Ancient rain and fertility god. Rain god predating the Mexica, co-enshrined at Templo Mayor.

How to honor: *Tlaloc's rites centered on child sacrifice atop mountains and at Tepeyac-area shrines, where the children's tears were read as a good omen for coming rains; his festivals Atlcahualo (February) and Etzalcualiztli (June, when the bean-maize stew etzalli was ritually eaten) marked the agricultural calendar. He was honored with blue/turquoise color, jade, rubber, and offerings left at mountaintop and spring shrines to him and his assistant Tlaloque rain spirits.*

Tlaloc (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec (pan-Mesoamerican, = Chaac in Maya)*

Rain, water, fertility, lightning, mountains, children. Ancient rain and fertility god ruling Tlalocan paradise.

How to honor: *Honored chiefly at Etzalcualiztli (June), when priests dressed in green, fasted, and ceremonially ate etzalli (a maize-and-bean stew), while child sacrifices were made at mountain shrines — a child's tears were considered an auspicious omen for coming rains. Offerings of jade, turquoise, and copal incense (blue-green colors symbolizing water) were burned at mountaintops, springs, and caves believed to be entrances to his rain-paradise, Tlalocan. His helper spirits, the Tlaloque, were honored alongside him at the same shrines.*

Tupa — *Guarani*

Dominion over waters, rains, and thunder. Companion god of rain and thunder.

How to honor: *Jaci/Jasy, the moon and sacred twin, governs the planting and harvest calendar in Guaraní tradition; her lunar phases dictate when to plant and when to harvest, and communities offer brief monthly acknowledgment tied to agricultural timing. In wider Tupi-Guaraní folklore she is honored as protector of lovers and those who sleep beneath her light.*

Vayu (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*

Wind god, presides over Swati nakshatra. Deity of wind, independence, and flexibility.

How to honor: *Vayu, Rig Vedic wind god presiding over Swati nakshatra, is honored through Nakshatra Shanti puja: japa of "Om Vayave Namah," a homa offering ghee and til (sesame seeds) into sacred fire, and naivedya of curd-rice or moong (green gram, Swati's grain) performed when the moon transits Swati. Devotees donate green cloth or leafy vegetables and practice pranayama (breath ritual) on his days, since restlessness/rigidity is considered displeasing to his flexible, ever-moving nature. No blood or heavy offerings are used.*

Wakinyan (Thunderbirds/Thunder Beings) — *Lakota Sioux*
Great winged beings producing thunder and lightning. Protective thunder beings, eternal foes of the Unktehi.
How to honor: *Waziya, giant of the north who brings winter cold, is acknowledged in winter storytelling and seasonal observance rather than direct worship; tobacco offerings are sometimes made to ask for mild winters or safe passage in snow, and travel during severe storms attributed to him was traditionally avoided.*

Wandjina — *Australian Aboriginal (Kimberley)*
Cloud/rain spirits who descended from Milky Way, created land and people. Mouthless cloud and rain creation spirits depicted in Kimberley rock art.
How to honor: *The Wandjina are honored primarily through the ritual repainting of their rock-art images at sacred sites across the Kimberley (Mowanjum, Gibb River, and Prince Regent River areas), traditionally by senior custodians during the buildup to the wet season to renew their power and summon rain; approaching or touching the paintings without proper authority is taboo, as is photographing or reproducing the mouthless faces disrespectfully outside custodial permission. Ceremony and song accompany the repainting, and the sites remain restricted to initiated custodians of the relevant clan estates.*

Waziya — *Lakota Sioux*
Giant of the north who brings winter cold. Winter-bringing giant spirit.
How to honor: *Sapling (Good Mind) is honored implicitly through the Longhouse Gaiwiio religion's Thanksgiving Address and seasonal ceremonies (Midwinter, Green Corn, Strawberry Festival) crediting his gifts of corn, beans, squash, tobacco, and medicine plants. Offerings of tobacco, corn, and thanksgiving speech are given at communal Longhouse rites.*

Xun (Wind trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*
Gentle persistent penetrating principle. Cosmic wind force of subtle, non-forceful influence.
How to honor: *Xun is formed via its seal for subtle healing work and cultivation of wu wei (non-forceful action), invoking gentle, persistent, penetrating influence associated with wind. Practice emphasizes subtlety of gesture and breath rather than dramatic ritual.*

Yeve (Hebieso/Xevieso) — *Ewe/Vodun*
Thunder, lightning, fire, justice, moral law. Feared thunder god who enforces divine justice via lightning strikes on liars and oath-breakers.
How to honor: *Yeve/Hebieso is honored through a closed secret-society initiation entered by being "seized" (often after surviving a lightning strike or storm), after which initiates (trosiwo) live under strict lifelong taboos — restrictions on certain foods, prohibitions on touching metal weapons, and above all a ban on lying or oath-breaking, since he punishes falsehood with lightning. Worship centers on extensive Adzida drum-and-song ceremonies in red and white ritual dress that must never be interrupted once begun.*

Zhen (Thunder trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*
Sudden arousing energy breaking stagnation. Cosmic force of decisive awakening tied to Liver qi.
How to honor: *Zhen is formed via its seal when a practitioner feels stuck or stagnant, and traditionally at the spring equinox, invoking sudden arousing energy tied to Liver qi that breaks through blockage. As an internal-alchemy hand seal rather than a worshipped deity, it is "honored" through correct timing and technique rather than ritual offering.*

Earth

Earth-mothers and ground-gods — the living soil, mountains, and the body the world is built from.

Akka — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Earth goddess, Ukko's wife. Earth goddess counterpart to Ukko.
How to honor: *Rauni (Akka), earth-goddess and wife of the thunder-god Ukko, is honored in old Finnish/Karelian agrarian practice alongside Ukko at the Ukon vakat spring sowing/beer festival, with beer, bread, and grain offerings poured or buried in the soil for field fertility. Associated with earth, fertility, and the rowan tree in her Rauni aspect. Modern Suomenusko practitioners pour libations of beer or mead onto the ground and offer baked bread at spring planting and harvest. Taboo: wasting grain or bread was considered an offense to the earth itself.*

Amalur — *Basque*
Mother Earth, source from which beings emerge and return. Mother Earth figure, source of all beings, sometimes conflated with Mari.
How to honor: *Amalur has thin direct cult attestation — a Roman-era Pamplona altar inscribed "Matri Deae" hints at an ancient Basque mother-goddess cult, but most of her defined mythology comes from 20th-century ethnographer José Miguel Barandiaran's reconstructions. Associated folk practice includes hanging the eguzkilore (a thistle "sun-flower") on doorways for protection and leaving coin offerings in caves as petitions; modern Basque Neopagans honor her through earth-reverence gatherings at caves, mountains, or oak groves, framed honestly as revival rather than unbroken ancient tradition.*

Apus (Five Paths) — *Andean (referenced)*
Mountain spirits consulted for guidance. Mountain-spirit beings of Andean animism (generic category).
How to honor: *Apus are honored through the same despacho (payment/offering bundle) tradition as Pachamama — coca leaves, llama fat, seeds, and sweets burned or buried on a mountainside, often with a paqo (Andean ritual specialist) leading the ceremony and reading coca leaves to interpret the mountain's response. Climbers and herders traditionally ask permission before ascending a sacred apu (e.g., Ausangate, Salkantay) and leave a small coca offering at the summit or a pass (apacheta) cairn as thanks for safe passage.*

Apus (mountain spirits, collective incl. Ausangate) — *Inca/Tawantinsuyu (Andes)*
Mountain spirits governing agriculture, protection, weather in their sphere. Conscious sacred beings whose physical form is the mountain itself.
How to honor: *Named individually (e.g., Ausangate as one of the most powerful apus) and invoked at despacho ceremonies alongside Pachamama; honored with k'intu offerings — three coca leaves selected and fanned, blown over with prayers (samay/breath) and placed as tribute. Pilgrims still climb to sites like Qullqipunku near Ausangate for the annual Quyllurit'i festival as a living form of veneration.*

Apus (Shamanism) — *Andean Shamanism*
Each major Andean peak is a distinct sentient spiritual being. Personal mountain spirits, each with distinct character, guardians of their region.
How to honor: *Each major Andean peak (e.g., Ausangate, Salkantay) is honored as a distinct sentient guardian spirit with its own name, personality, and territory; devotees build relationships over years through despacho offerings and coca-leaf prayers (phukuy) directed toward the specific peak visible from or relevant to their community. Apus are approached through a paqo (Andean ritual specialist) for major requests, with offerings typically made at dawn or during specific pilgrimage climbs, such as the Qoyllur Rit'i pilgrimage held near Ausangate each June.*

Asase Yaa — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*

Earth goddess, wife of Nyame, mother of the dead; governs Asamando (ancestral realm). Great female earth spirit who receives the dead and holds truth.
How to honor: *Asase Yaa is honored above all by observance of her sacred day, Thursday (Yawda) among many Akan groups, when farmers traditionally refrain from tilling, digging, or disturbing the soil out of respect for her rest; funerals also avoid burial on her day in some communities since she receives the dead into Asamando. She has no temples, images, or priesthood — the bare earth itself is treated as her shrine, so farmers pour libation and speak thanks to the ground before the first planting and again at harvest, and she is called second in libation, right after Nyame. Oaths sworn "by the earth" invoke her as witness and are taken with particular seriousness.*

Asherah (Athirat) — *Canaanite*
Consort of El, Queen of Heaven, mother goddess. Mother goddess and divine feminine principle, venerated in Jerusalem Temple.
How to honor: *Asherah was honored in the household through small clay pillar figurines (handled and kept near hearths for fertility/protection), wooden asherah poles planted beside altars, incense burned on rooftops, and "cakes" baked in her honor by women, as condemned in Jeremiah 44. Her worship was centered in domestic and popular religion (and reportedly within the Jerusalem Temple itself before reform purges), and the poles' removal/restoration marks recurring religious conflict in biblical accounts.*

Beri — *Ari (Ethiopia, Omo Valley)*
Female principle of fertility, earth's productive capacity. Goddess of fertility and the earth's generosity, cultivated not automatic.
How to honor: *Beri is likewise honored only through respectful narrative acknowledgment, not attested ritual: no documented offerings, shrines, or festivals specific to her survive in accessible sources on Ari religion. She is most appropriately honored by naming her role as the fertile, "cultivated not automatic" earth-productivity principle tied to planting and harvest cycles, paired with Saabi, rather than by inventing devotional specifics.*

Changing Woman (All My Relations) — *Navajo (Diné)*
Holy Person embodying cycles of nature, aging and renewing with seasons. Most beloved Navajo Holy Person, principle of transformation not loss.
How to honor: *Changing Woman is honored above all through the Kinaaldá, the Navajo girls' puberty ceremony, in which the initiate ritually embodies Changing Woman for four days — running toward the sun, being molded and massaged by an ideal older woman, and baking a corn cake (alkaan) in a ceremonial pit — reenacting Changing Woman's own first ceremony. She is also invoked in the Blessing Way (Hózhǫ́ǫ́jí) sung for protection, harmony, and life-cycle events, and pollen offerings are central to her rites.*

Changing Woman (Asdzaa Nadleehe) — *Navajo/Dine*
Central Holy Person; created Dine clans from her own skin; embodies seasonal renewal. Most beloved Holy Person, associated with earth, corn, renewal.
How to honor: *Changing Woman is honored above all through the Kinaaldá, the multi-day female puberty ceremony reenacting her own coming-of-age: the girl runs toward the sun at dawn and dusk, is ceremonially molded/massaged by an elder female relative, and a large corn cake (alkaan) is baked overnight in an earthen pit, its first slice offered to children and elders. Corn pollen, white shell, and turquoise are the standard offerings/adornments, and the all-night Blessingway songs are sung continuously through the final night.*

Cybele (Magna Mater) — *Roman Religion*
The Great Mother. Phrygian Great Mother goddess imported to Rome in 204 BCE.
How to honor: *Cybele's priests (Galli) ritually castrated themselves in ecstatic frenzy to music of cymbals, tambourines, and the Phrygian pipe, then wore women's dress and lived as devotees of the Mother; a black meteoritic stone housed her presence after being brought to Rome in 204 BCE. Megalesia (April 4–10) featured games, processions, and public feasting, while the*

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taurobolium — ritual drenching in bull's blood — was used as a purifying/rebirth rite for high initiates; pinecones and lions were her sacred symbols.

Gaia — *Greek*
Primordial Earth, emerged from Chaos. Personification of Earth itself.
How to honor: *Gaia received libations poured directly into the earth or into cracks and fissures, reflecting her identity as the ground itself, and offerings of grain, honey, and first-fruits placed in the soil. Her most significant surviving cult trace is that the oracle at Delphi originally belonged to her before Apollo took it over, and oaths sworn "by Gaia" or "by the earth" invoked her as guarantor of truth.*

Geb — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
The living earth. Earth god, father of Osiris, whose laughter causes earthquakes.
How to honor: *Geb had no major independent temple cult; he was honored through oaths sworn "by Geb" invoking the earth's stability, and through offerings of first-harvest grain laid on the ground in recognition of him as the living earth from which crops grow. Egyptian kingship rites formally traced royal legitimacy through descent from Geb.*

Geb (Kemet) — *Kemet*
The Earth. Earth god, depicted lying beneath the sky.
How to honor: *Geb was honored through offerings of first fruits and grain, since his fertility as the earth god was thought to underlie every harvest; his laughter was said to cause earthquakes, so his favor was sought for stable, productive land. He had no major dedicated temple complex on the scale of Osiris or Amun; devotion was largely agrarian and household-level rather than centered on a single cult city.*

Gen (Mountain trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*
Principle of stillness and knowing when to stop. Cosmic force of contemplative stillness and boundary-holding.
How to honor: *Gen is formed via its seal during seated meditation and grounding practice, invoking stillness and the wisdom of knowing when to stop — a boundary-holding, contemplative force. It is practiced through posture and stillness rather than offerings.*

Hineahuone (Maori master) — *Maori*
The earth-formed first woman. First human, shaped from clay of Kurawaka and given life by Tane.
How to honor: *Hine-ahu-one, the first woman shaped by Tāne from red earth (oneone) at Kurawaka and given life through his breath (hā) into her nostrils, is honored through karakia at childbirth and rites of new life rather than food offerings. Red ochre (kōkōwai), used in her creation myth, is a traditional symbolic color linked to her and to sacred/protective marking in Māori custom. She is invoked in whakapapa recitations and birth ceremonies as the ancestral mother of humankind; no altar or offering tradition is documented — acknowledgment is through storytelling and genealogical chant.*

Iná (the Earth, Caddo) — *Caddo*
Mother Earth, from whom Caddo people emerged and to whom they return. Earth as sacred Mother from the emergence story.
How to honor: *Iná, the Earth as Mother, is honored through the Caddo emergence narrative that describes the people rising from beneath the earth's surface, reinforced by returning the dead to the soil, offering first fruits back to the ground before harvest consumption, and speaking of the earth with familial reverence as the source and final resting place of life.*

Inyan — *Lakota Sioux*
Primordial stone; sourceless original being. Primordial stone being from whom Maka was formed.

How to honor: *Tate (the wind) is honored through prayers and tobacco offerings made outdoors, especially at the four directions, since he governs the four winds and directional spirits in Lakota cosmology; feathers, smoke, and prayer flags/ties symbolize him, and he is invoked during vision quests and directional prayers.*

Kun (Earth trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*
Supreme receptive principle invoked via hand seal. Cosmic force of receptivity and formation embodied in the Kun seal.
How to honor: *Kun is formed via a cupped-hands seal during meditation or healing work requiring receptivity, embodying supreme yielding, nurturing yin force as the complement to Qian. As with the other trigram seals, this is practiced within modern qigong/shouyin lineages through precise gesture, breath, and stillness rather than through offerings.*

Maaema — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian (Estonian Maausk)*
Estonian earth mother. Earth mother deity of Estonian Maausk tradition.
How to honor: *Maaema, Estonian earth-mother of the Maausk ("Earth Faith") tradition, is honored at hiis (sacred groves) with offerings of grain, bread, or milk poured onto the earth or left at sacred stones and trees, especially as first-fruits thanksgiving before harvest and at spring sowing. Sacred groves and their trees are treated as inviolable — cutting wood or disturbing the hiis is strictly taboo. Modern Maausk revivalists hold seasonal earth-thanksgiving ceremonies continuing this practice.*

Maka — *Lakota Sioux*
The Earth; one of four superior beings. Earth Mother aspect of Wakan Tanka, "Ina Maka".
How to honor: *Hanwi (the moon) is honored informally through moon-phase awareness in women's ceremonies and the Isnati (girl's puberty) rite, since the moon governs the menstrual/womanhood cycle in Lakota belief; tobacco ties, sage, and prayers offered facing the moon at night are the typical devotional gesture, with elder guidance required.*

Mokosh — *Slavic Paganism*
Earth's fertility, spinning/weaving, fate, water. Only goddess with documented state cult, earth/moisture deity.
How to honor: *Mokosh is the only goddess with a documented state cult (erected by Vladimir in Kyiv in 980 CE); her feast day, later syncretized with St. Paraskeva-Piatnitsa, fell on Friday, when spinning and weaving were taboo — leaving a spindle out or working wool on her day was believed to bring misfortune. Offerings of wool, flax, and thread were left at wells and springs sacred to her, sometimes with cloth or coins tied to nearby branches; women brought first-spun thread as an offering, and she was invoked for protection in childbirth and women's household labor.*

Nanã — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Oldest Orixá, primordial swamp/mud, made human bodies. Ancient mother Orixá governing birth and death of the body.
How to honor: *Nanã, oldest of the orixás and mother of mud/clay from which human bodies were formed, is offered white foods (white corn porridge, mingau) at still, swampy water rather than flowing rivers, and no iron or metal objects are permitted near her shrine since she predates the age of iron. Her colors are white and lilac/purple, her day is Monday, she is syncretized with St. Anne, and her emblem is the ibiri, a beaded rattle-staff.*

Nerthus — *Germanic Heathenry*
Mother Earth / continental fertility-earth goddess. Earth goddess whose wagon procession brought peace and fertility.
How to honor: *Nerthus was honored via a cloth-covered wagon procession drawn through Suebi territory (per Tacitus); during her progress weapons were locked away, war was suspended, and all disputes stilled as a peace-goddess taboo. Afterward the wagon and image were ritually washed in a sacred lake by attendants who were then drowned to preserve the*

rite's secrecy — no modern equivalent survives, though reconstructionist Heathens hold peace-themed earth rites at spring in her honor.

Ninhursag — *Mesopotamian*
The earth mother. Mother-earth goddess of the pantheon.
How to honor: *Ninhursag, "Lady of the Sacred Mountain," had major cult centers at Kesh and Adab (temple E-mah); her omega-shaped symbol represents the womb. Offerings historically included milk, grain, birth-related items (since she was invoked by midwives and in childbirth), clay and stone (as shaper of humans from clay), and cattle tied to herd fertility. Modern devotees build earth-toned altars with soil, stones, and milk offerings, invoking her around childbirth, fertility, and land blessings.*

Niutsuhime — *Shingon*
Female kami of Koyasan mountain (pre-Shingon Shinto). Shinto kami sacred to Mount Koya before Kukai's arrival.
How to honor: *Shakyamuni is honored with the Semui-in (fearlessness) mudra, incense and flower offerings, and food offerings at temple altars; his birthday is celebrated at Hanamatsuri (Flower Festival) in April, when devotees pour sweet tea over a small statue of the infant Buddha as an act of reverence.*

Pachamama — *Inca/Tawantinsuyu (Andes)*
Living earth deity; most accessible and universally honored deity. The Earth herself as a conscious, living, responsive sacred being.
How to honor: *Honored via ch'alla (pouring first sips of chicha/drink onto the ground before drinking), offerings of food and coca leaves, and formal despacho ceremonies (burned or buried bundles of symbolic items) led by a paqo; August is her dedicated feast month when offerings intensify. Taboo: mining, digging, or deforesting without first acknowledging and asking her permission.*

Pachamama (Five Paths) — *Andean (referenced)*
Living earth-mother being who must be honored and fed. Andean Earth Mother goddess.
How to honor: *Pachamama is fed directly into the earth: a despacho or "challa" offering of coca leaves, chicha (corn beer), llama fat, seeds, sweets, and small trinkets is buried or burned in a ritual hole, especially during the August 1st Pachamama festival marking the start of the agricultural cycle in the Andes. Before drinking, devotees traditionally spill a few drops onto the ground for her first; disrespecting the land through pollution or overexploitation is considered a direct offense to her, reflected in Bolivia's 2010 Law of the Rights of Mother Earth.*

Pachamama (Shamanism) — *Andean Shamanism*
Mother Earth, living cosmic being. Andean Earth Mother, central to all Andean ceremony.
How to honor: *Living Mother Earth, central to virtually all Andean ceremony; honored through the despacho — a ritual bundle of flowers, seeds, sweets, coca leaves, and llama fat/tallow, wrapped and burned or buried as a reciprocal gift — typically performed at the start of the agricultural year and especially during August, considered her "hungriest" and most receptive month in Andean tradition. The core relational principle is ayni (sacred reciprocity: give before you take), and coca leaves are chewed or blown in offering (phukuy) before any harvest, construction, or major undertaking.*

Papa (Eastern Polynesia) — *Society/Cook Islands (referenced)*
Earth goddess, consort of Vatea; mother of Tangaroa, Rongo, Tane. Earth-mother consort of Vatea, generative source of major gods.
How to honor: *As earth-mother and consort of Vatea, Papa is honored in Cook Islands/Society Islands cosmology through genealogical chant (pē'ē/genealogy recitation) rather than a distinct offering-based cult; she is invoked as source of fertility and the ancestral line of Tangaroa, Rongo, and Tāne. Historical veneration centered on marae ceremonies for the gods she birthed;*

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earth, soil, and fertility symbolism (planting rites, first-fruits offerings) are the most culturally appropriate association.

Papatuanuku — *Polynesian (Maori)*
Earth Mother. Primordial Earth Mother, source of the physical world.
How to honor: *Papatuanuku is honored by returning the whenua (placenta) to her earth after childbirth, a living Māori practice tying newborns to the land, and by reciting karakia before harvesting food or disturbing soil. Morning mist is understood as her sighs of grief for Ranginui; kaitiakitanga (guardianship of land) is treated as an enduring obligation to her.*

Papatuanuku — *Maori*
Earth Mother, separated from Ranginui; her sighs rise as mist. Primordial Earth Mother of the Maori cosmos.
How to honor: *Ranginui is honored primarily through karakia recounting the creation narrative — his separation from Papatuanuku by their children — recited at Maori ceremonial openings, and through recognition of the sky/rain (his tears for Papatuanuku) as a living relationship. Correct recitation of whakapapa tracing descent from Ranginui and Papatuanuku is itself an act of honoring.*

Papatuanuku (Maori master) — *Maori*
Earth Mother, one of the sacred parents. Earth mother, source of Kurawaka clay used to form first human.
How to honor: *Papatuanuku (Maori master) is honored through direct physical acts tied to land: the placenta and umbilical cord (whenua, literally also meaning "land") of a newborn are traditionally buried in ancestral ground as an offering binding child to earth. Karakia are recited before disturbing soil — planting, building, or earthworks — asking her permission, and rahui (temporary sacred prohibitions) are placed on land needing to rest or heal. Treating land as disposable or polluting it is a direct affront to her in Maori cosmology.*

Ruaumoko — *Maori*
God of earthquakes, still in the womb of Papatuanuku. Atua governing seismic activity.
How to honor: *Namakaokahai is honored at ocean shores with offerings of salt water, seashells, blue or white cloth/lei, and fish or seaweed (limu) left at the tideline, typically at dawn or dusk; because she is Pele's rival, devotees traditionally avoid mixing fire-based and ocean-based offerings in the same rite. Removing her sacred stones or coral from the shore is considered taboo.*

Saa (Python Spirit) — *Bamana/Bozo (Mali)*
Great earth-connected serpent that moves between worlds. Serpent spirit bridging earth and water realms.
How to honor: *Represented by an articulated serpent puppet undulating through the Sogo bo procession, its performer showing the python's movement between land and water; no offering is distinguished separately for Saa beyond its puppet's appearance in the shared masquerade cycle alongside Bama, Malike, and Jege — the performance itself is the honoring act.*

Sanshin (Mountain Spirit, Shamanism) — *Korean Muism (Shamanism)*
Elderly white-bearded sage spirit accompanied by a tiger, resident of specific mountains. Beloved and widely venerated spirit of wisdom, long life, protection.
How to honor: *Sanshin is honored at small mountainside or behind-temple shrines (sanshin-gak) with offerings of makgeolli, tteok (rice cake), fresh fruit, and burning incense, often left by hikers or pilgrims passing his image (an elderly sage with a tiger companion). Sanshinje ceremonies are held at auspicious dates for community/village well-being, longevity, and safe childbirth; visitors are expected to bow and speak respectfully near his shrine and avoid loud disturbance on the mountain.*

Sansin (Mountain God) — *Korean Muism*

Governs fertility, health, longevity, protection of mountain communities; each mountain has its own Sansin. White-bearded elder with a tiger, guardian spirit of the mountain.
How to honor: *Sansin is propitiated at san-je mountain ceremonies and at sanshin-gak shrine buildings (often built behind Buddhist temples) with offerings of tteok (rice cakes), fresh fruit, and makgeolli poured as libation, plus burning incense before his painted image — a white-bearded elder seated with a tiger companion. Ceremonies often cluster around the full moon, Chuseok, or a specific mountain's local festival day, with prayers for fertility, health, longevity, exam success, and safe passage through the mountains. Removing anything from a sanshin-gak shrine or disrespecting the mountain itself is taboo.*

Shekhinah (Gnosticism/Kabbalah) — *Kabbalah*
Tenth Sephirah (Malkut); feminine divine presence dwelling in the material world/exile. Feminine indwelling presence of the divine, exiled with the Jewish people.
How to honor: *Feminine indwelling presence of the divine (tenth Sephirah, Malkut), exiled with Israel; honored above all through Kabbalistic Sabbath ritual — the hymn "Lecha Dodi" welcomes her as bride and queen at Sabbath eve, and mystics held all-night study vigils (Tikkun Leil Shavuot) intended to symbolically reunite her with the masculine divine (Tiferet). Marital/union imagery (yichud) pervades Kabbalistic prayer aimed at her restoration; she is approached through prayer and mitzvot rather than offerings.*

Shekhinah (Kabbalah master) — *Kabbalah*
Divine feminine presence dwelling in exile with Israel. Feminine dimension of the divine associated with the sephira Malkuth.
How to honor: *The Shekhinah is welcomed weekly as the "Sabbath Bride" through Kabbalat Shabbat — the Friday-evening service built around singing "Lecha Dodi" ("Come, My Beloved") to greet her — and through the lighting of two candles at sundown, traditionally by the woman of the household. Marital intimacy on Shabbat eve is traditionally framed as a symbolic reunion with the Shekhinah, and Kiddush plus sustained kavanah (focused intention) in prayer are her ongoing honors. Taboo: mundane work or transactional activity during Shabbat is understood as disrupting her indwelling presence.*

Sky Woman (All My Relations) — *Haudenosaunee (Iroquois)*
Fell from Sky World onto turtle's back; danced earth into being, creating Turtle Island. Iroquois creator figure, mother of Turtle Island.
How to honor: *Sky Woman is honored by the Haudenosaunee chiefly through the retelling of the creation narrative itself at ceremonial and Longhouse gatherings — her fall from the Sky World and the animals' cooperative effort to build Turtle Island on the turtle's back is recited as sacred history — and through the Thanksgiving Address (Ohen:ton Karihwatehkwen) recited at the opening of ceremonies, which honors the created order she set in motion, from the earth and waters to the plant and animal life that sustains the people.*

Spenta Armaiti — *Zoroastrianism*
Holy devotion, loving submission to the divine. Amesha Spenta of loving devotion, corresponds to the earth.
How to honor: *Spenta Armaiti is honored on her namesake day/month "Spandarmad" (Esfand), culminating in the Esfandegan festival (also called Sepandarmazgan), a real, still-celebrated Persian holiday honoring earth and devoted wives/women, marked with gift-giving (traditionally to female relatives) and prayers of humble devotion. Taboo: polluting or degrading the earth is considered a direct offense to her.*

Tlaltecuhtli (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Primordial earth monster from whose body the earth was made. Earth-monster deity underlying the physical world.
How to honor: *Tlaltecuhtli, the devouring earth-monster, traditionally required hearts placed in cuauhxicalli vessels to keep the earth fertile, and a massive ~12,000-object dedicatory offering was buried beneath her 1502 Templo Mayor monolith. Midwives invoked her during difficult*

childbirth, and her images were deliberately carved facing downward, hidden from view — displaying her openly was taboo. Modern respectful practice favors symbolic maize, flower, and copal offerings placed directly on soil.

Tlaltecuhtli (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec*
Primordial earth monster dragged up from the waters by Tezcatlipoca. Earth-monster deity from whose body Tezcatlipoca lost his foot.
How to honor: *Primordial squatting earth-monster/goddess traditionally believed to require nourishment — hearts placed in cuauhxicalli vessels — to keep the earth fertile; a massive dedicatory cache of roughly 12,000 objects was buried beneath her 1502 Templo Mayor monolith. Midwives invoked her during difficult childbirth, and her images were customarily carved facing downward, hidden from view — displaying her face-up was taboo. Modern respectful practice favors symbolic offerings of maize, flowers, copal incense, and earth-toned objects placed directly on soil.*

Tu Di Gong (Earth God) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Hyper-local guardian of a specific plot of land/village. Kindly local earth deity and psychopomp guide for the newly dead.
How to honor: *Tu Di Gong, the hyper-local Earth God, receives small shrine offerings of incense, fruit, and tea at village edges, crossroads, and field boundaries, worshipped especially on the 2nd and 16th days of the lunar month by shopkeepers and farmers seeking good harvests and business luck. His shrines are often paired with his wife, Tu Di Po, and he is regarded as the most approachable, "lowest-ranking but most present" deity in the folk pantheon.*

Tuisto — *Germanic Heathenry*
Earth-born divine ancestor of the Germanic peoples. Mythic earth-born progenitor deity of the Germanic peoples.
How to honor: *No attested cult or offerings survive for Tuisto; Tacitus records him only as a mythic earth-born ancestor sung of in old songs. Modern Heathens/Ásatrúar honor him mainly through storytelling and symbel toasts naming him among ancestral gods, or inclusion in faining rites honoring forefathers — remembrance in an ancestor-veneration context, rather than invented offerings, is the most respectful approach.*

Turtle spirit (All My Relations) — *Haudenosaunee and others*
Carrier of Turtle Island (the world) on its back; calendar keeper. Ancient earth-carrying animal spirit, symbol of patience and endurance.
How to honor: *Turtle is honored primarily through the Sky Woman/Turtle Island creation narrative, retold at ceremonies and gatherings as the foundational account of how the world came to be on Turtle's back — Haudenosaunee, Anishinaabe, and other nations retell it rather than performing rites to Turtle directly. Turtle-shell rattles (used in Haudenosaunee social and medicine society dances) are made only after tobacco is offered to the turtle's spirit and the shell is obtained respectfully, never taken carelessly. Turtles themselves are treated as elders/protected beings in many communities, not to be harmed or handled casually, in keeping with Turtle's role as timekeeper and earth-carrier.*

Žemyna — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Deified earth; goddess of soil, growth, harvest; Perkūnas's wife. Most beloved agrarian deity; earth herself, renewed in sacred marriage with Perkūnas each spring.
How to honor: *Most beloved and ritually active of the agrarian deities: the customary gesture was kissing or bowing to touch the earth at dawn and dusk and before plowing, planting, or harvest, with farmers pouring beer libations or spilling the first drops of any drink onto the ground for her. Bread, salt, and grain were left at field edges or buried at sowing time, and her spring sacred marriage to Perkūnas (thunder "waking" the earth) was marked by treating the first spring rains as fertilizing rites; she was also invoked at burial, since the dead return to her body. Trampling grain carelessly or cursing the soil was taboo.*

Water, Sea & River

Gods of oceans, rivers, lakes, springs, and the creatures and spirits that inhabit them.

Adzima — *Ewe/Vodun*
Ocean, fishing, fertility, power of water. Sea family of Trowo governing ocean and fertility.
How to honor: *Adzima, the sea-family of Trowo, is honored by coastal Ewe fishing communities with offerings of fish, cowrie shells, and white cloth cast into the ocean or lagoon, typically before the start of a fishing season to secure safe waters and abundant catch. Disturbing certain lagoon or shoreline sites without first pouring a libation is considered a serious breach.*

Ahir Budhnya — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Serpent of the deep, presides over Uttara Bhadrapada nakshatra. Deep-serpent deity associated with kundalini.
How to honor: *Ahir Budhnya, "serpent of the deep" presiding over Uttara Bhadrapada, is likewise obscure, known chiefly from Rig Vedic deity-lists and the nakshatra-puja tradition rather than any independent shrine. He receives nakshatra-shanti japa and homa on Uttara Bhadrapada days; his modern association with kundalini at the spine's base is a later yogic/esoteric reinterpretation, not ancient cultic practice, and should be presented as such.*

Ahti — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Protector of fish, islands, sea birds. Vellamo's husband, keeper of the underwater manor Ahtola.
How to honor: *Ahti (Ahto), lord of fish, islands, and sea creatures, received traditional Finnish fisherfolk offerings of the first catch, tobacco, coins, or a portion of drink poured into the water before fishing, with prayers/chants (loitsut) for a good catch and safe passage; his wife Vellamo was invoked alongside him. Symbols include fish, waves, and the underwater rocks/reeds where he dwells. Modern Suomenusko practice honors him with lakeside or seaside offerings of butter, beer, or bread poured into the water at the start of fishing season; taboo is disrespecting the water, overfishing, or failing to thank him after a good catch.*

Anahita (Ardvi Sura Anahita) — *Zoroastrianism*
Water, fertility, wisdom, healing (divine feminine). Goddess of water and fertility, chief feminine divine figure in Zoroastrianism.
How to honor: *Anahita is honored with libations of water, milk, or wine poured directly into rivers and springs, historically at her Achaemenid/Sasanian temple sites (e.g., Kangavar, Bishapur) where cult statues once stood; white flowers, doves, and pomegranates are traditional offerings. Her feast falls on Aban ("waters") day/month (Abangan), and purity of water and self before approaching her is essential — ritual impurity is taboo.*

Apah — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
The waters, presides over Purva Ashadha nakshatra. Deified waters governing purification.
How to honor: *Apah, the deified waters presiding over Purva Ashadha, is honored with simple arghya (water offerings) poured at rivers or tanks at dawn, ritual bathing, and recitation of the Vedic Apah Sukta over water before use in yajnas. Donating water or water-vessels (jaladana) on Purva Ashadha days is considered especially meritorious; polluting or wasting water is the clear taboo associated with offending her.*

Apsu — *Mesopotamian*
Primordial freshwater deep. Primordial freshwater god, killed by Ea.
How to honor: *Apsu has no attestable temple cult — he was a cosmological principle (the freshwater deep beneath the earth) rather than an object of personal devotion, and in the Enuma Elish he is killed early by Enki/Ea. The historically fitting acknowledgment is symbolic: pour a libation of clean fresh water onto earth or into a basin while naming him, echoing how Enki's own abzu shrine at Eridu stood atop the mythic Apsu.*

Bia — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*

River deity of the Bia River; one of four primary Abosom born of Nyame and Asase Yaa. Obosom governing the Bia River.
How to honor: *Bia is served at riverside shrines along the Bia River (Ghana–Côte d'Ivoire border area) by akomfo (priest-mediums) who pour libations of schnapps or palm wine and offer eggs directly into the water on his behalf; as one of the four senior Abosom born of Nyame and Asase Yaa, he is more commonly addressed collectively with Epo, Bosomtwe, and Tano during general libation than approached individually. Specific fishing or bathing restrictions on certain days are locally observed near the river out of respect for him, consistent with the broader Akan pattern of taboo days tied to river and lake abosom.*

Bosomtwe — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*
Spirit of Lake Bosumtwe, Ghana's only natural lake; one of four primary Abosom. Obosom of Ghana's sacred lake.
How to honor: *Bosomtwe, spirit of Lake Bosumtwe, is honored through strict traditional lake taboos still observed by surrounding communities: no metal hooks, nets, or paddles may be used on the lake, since the fish are believed to be linked to the souls of the dead — fishermen instead use handheld lines without hooks from flat wooden rafts called padua. Certain days are set aside when no fishing at all is permitted, and offerings (eggs, drink) are given at lakeside shrines by local priests before the fishing season opens. The lake's origin as a meteorite crater is folded into oral tradition explaining its sacredness rather than treated as merely geological.*

Chalchiuhtlicue — *Aztec*
"Lady of the Jade Skirt"; goddess of still/running water; became the Fourth Sun. Water goddess whose grief-flood ended the Fourth Sun.
How to honor: *Honored above all at childbirth and infancy: Aztec midwives ritually bathed newborns and invoked Chalchiuhtlicue ("Jade Skirt") to purify and protect the child, pouring water while speaking prayers to her. Offerings of jade, turquoise, green feathers, and pulque poured into lakes, springs, or canals were customary, and canal/aqueduct maintenance was itself treated as an act of respect toward her domain. Her myth (grieving humanity into a flood that ended the Fourth Sun) marks her as a goddess who must not be spurned or taken for granted — gratitude and care for water sources are her core taboos and virtues.*

Dui (Lake trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*
Principle of joyful expression and reflective communication. Cosmic force of joyful voice and Lung-qi-supported expression.
How to honor: *Dui is formed via its seal before singing, speaking, or sacred sound practice, invoking joyful expression supported by Lung qi. Practitioners use it to open the voice and support communicative, reflective expression.*

Each-Uisge — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Deadlier loch-dwelling cousin of the kelpie. Master shapeshifter water-horse of deep lochs, tears apart its victims.
How to honor: *The each-uisge, deadlier and more cunning than the kelpie, is dealt with purely through avoidance — Highland lore gives no ritual to placate it, only strict warnings never to approach or mount any strange horse found near a loch, since even brief contact with its skin is fatal (its hide is said to be adhesive). Fishermen and shepherds near deep lochs traditionally avoided swimming or lingering at dusk.*

Epo — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*
Spirit of the sea; one of four primary Abosom. Obosom of the sea.
How to honor: *Epo, spirit of the sea, is honored by Fante and other coastal Akan fishing communities chiefly through seasonal restrictions: Tuesday is widely kept as a no-fishing day along the Fante coast, treated as the sea god's day of rest, and violating it was traditionally believed to bring poor catches or misfortune. Coastal harvest and purification festivals (such as Bakatue and related "opening of the fishing season" rites at towns like Elmina and Winneba) mark the start of the fishing year with libation, drumming, and a ceremonial first canoe launch*

asking Epo and related water spirits for safety and abundance. Offerings of mashed yam (eto), eggs, and schnapps poured into or near the sea are the standard gestures of thanks.

Holly King — *Celtic/Druidic*
Rules the waning half of the year; warrior spirit, discernment. Personification of the waning year and protective/warrior discernment.
How to honor: *The Oak King is honored at the summer solstice (Litha), understood in the modern Wheel of the Year mythos as reaching peak power before being ritually overcome by the Holly King; Druid and Wiccan groups mark this with bonfires, solar-themed rites, and offerings of oak leaves, acorns, or mead left at trees. There is no ancient attested cult by this name — the figure is a 20th-century construct built from older solstice/oak-veneration folklore, so devotional practice is properly understood as modern reconstructionist ritual.*

Huichaana — *Zapotec*
Goddess of birth, water, fish, regenerative waters; divine midwife. Female creator, source of births and the return of the rains.
How to honor: *Huichaana, goddess of birth, water, fish, and regenerative waters, was historically invoked by Zapotec midwives during childbirth, with water, fish, and fertility symbolism central to rites conducted in her honor per ethnohistorical sources. No continuous modern devotional community survives; honoring her today means engaging her domain (birth, water, midwifery) through documented Zapotec ethnohistory rather than invented ritual steps.*

Ina — *Cook Islands*
Female hero-goddess; voyaged to the moon; associated with sea creatures. Heroine-goddess whose adventures explain lunar imagery and sea lore.
How to honor: *Ina is honored through oral narrative — the story of her voyage to the moon (riding a shark or eel across the ocean) is recited and retold as the primary devotional act, and her image is seen in the moon's markings by Cook Islands tradition. No separate altar or offering practice distinct from the wider Hina/Ina moon-goddess cycle is documented; respectful acknowledgment is through storytelling and lunar observance (full-moon reflection) tied to her myth.*

Jege (Fish Spirit/Abundance) — *Bamana/Bozo (Mali)*
Spirit representing the river's gift of abundance. Embodiment of the Niger's abundance, sacred to the Bozo.
How to honor: *Honored simply and practically: fish-shaped puppets are paraded at the opening and closing of the fishing season, and a share of the day's catch or a grain offering is set aside as thanks for the river's abundance before nets are cast for the season.*

Kabeiroi — *Greek (Samothracian)*
Chthonic deities of maritime safety and metalworking. Gods protecting sailors, patrons of the Samothracian Mysteries.
How to honor: *The Kabeiroi were honored exclusively through secret initiation at the Samothracian Mysteries, which required participants (including famously statesmen and sailors) to undergo ritual purification and receive protective blessings, particularly for safety at sea. Initiates reportedly wore iron rings and were sometimes given a purple sash as a token of initiation; because the rites were sworn to secrecy, most ritual specifics (including sacrifice details) remain deliberately unrecorded rather than merely lost.*

Kachina (Katsina/Koko) — *Pueblo Peoples*
Sacred spirit-beings intermediating between Pueblo peoples and divine forces governing rain/fertility; associated with ancestral dead. Rain-bringing ancestral spirit collective central to Pueblo cosmology.
How to honor: *Kachina spirits are honored through masked dancer impersonation and tihu (kachina doll) representations, invoked in kiva and plaza ceremonies timed to the ritual calendar (roughly winter solstice through midsummer, when the kachinas are believed present among the*

people). Offerings include cornmeal and prayer feathers (pahos); photography, sketching, or recording of ceremonies is strictly prohibited as a serious taboo.

Kan (Water trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*
Principle of depth, hidden strength, danger-bearing wisdom. Cosmic water force tied to the Kidney system and ancestral wisdom.
How to honor: *Kan is formed via its specific seal during winter practice, fear-facing work, and Kidney-qi tonification, invoking the depth, hidden strength, and danger-tempered wisdom associated with water. Practitioners time this seal to winter and to Kidney-system organ work within the Five Element framework.*

Kanaloa (Hawaii) — *Polynesian (Hawaii)*
God of the ocean and underworld; healing, kava ('awa). Hawaiian ocean/underworld god, descendant of Tangaloa.
How to honor: *Kanaloa is honored jointly with Kane at sacred springs and 'awa (kava) plantings said to have been created by the pair striking the ground with a staff; the core rite is an 'awa ceremony where kava is prepared and offered with a kanaenae (praise chant) invoking both gods together before drinking. He has no independent image and receives no separate shrine from Kane.*

Kanaloa (Hawaiian) — *Hawaiian*
God of the deep ocean and the underworld; associated with healing and the 'awa (kava) ceremony. God of ocean depths and the transformative underworld.
How to honor: *Kanaloa is honored through the ʻawa (kava) ceremony, prepared and shared communally with prayer (pule) before drinking, and invoked alongside Kane in healing rites and water-related blessings since he governs the ocean depths and the underworld beneath it. Coastal shrines and specific tide pools or deep-water sites are treated as his dwelling places, and fishermen traditionally offered a portion of their catch or poured kava into the sea before departing on long voyages.*

Kane — *Polynesian (Hawaii)*
Light, fresh water, the natural world; creator of first human. Hawaiian god of light and fresh water.
How to honor: *Kane received no carved image (considered too sacred for physical representation) and was honored instead at sacred freshwater springs bearing his name, where the first portion of 'awa prepared was ritually offered to him before anyone drank. He was invoked at sunrise in prayer as the most benevolent of the major gods, making dawn water/kava offerings his principal living devotion.*

Kelpie — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Shapeshifting river water-spirit, usually a horse. Predatory shapeshifting water horse that drowns and devours those who mount it.
How to honor: *The kelpie is not honored but warded off: Highland tradition warns never to mount a loose or unfamiliar horse found tethered near a river, and folklore holds that seizing its bridle (often marked with a strange design) is the only way to control or banish it. Children were kept from riverbanks at dusk, and iron objects were sometimes carried as protection when crossing water.*

Korle — *Ga People (Ghana)*
Sacred being of the Korle Lagoon governing fishing and healing. Sacred spirit of Accra's Korle Lagoon.
How to honor: *Korle, spirit of Accra's Korle Lagoon, is served by her own Wulomo priest with offerings such as white fowls, eggs, and libation poured at the water's edge; polluting or desecrating the lagoon is a direct offense against her, linked to the lagoon's real ecological collapse from urban waste. Contemporary restoration campaigns are explicitly framed by Ga elders as a sacred obligation to appease and honor her.*

Laminak — *Basque*
Female water fairies of springs, rivers, pools. Beautiful but dangerous water fairies who reward respect and punish disrespect.
How to honor: *Laminak, the water fairies of springs and rivers, are honored primarily through courteous behavior — never spying on them bathing or combing their hair, and never mocking or insulting them — plus small offerings such as bread left near springs or pools they inhabit. Folklore holds they reward respectful humans (sometimes with construction help, as in bridge-building tales) and punish disrespect, so courtesy rather than any elaborate ritual is the operative practice.*

Long Person (Yun'wi Gunnahi'ta) — *Cherokee*
The river personified, stretching mountain to sea. Sacred river-being who carries away impurity.
How to honor: *Long Person (Yun'wi Gunnahi'ta), the river personified stretching from mountain to sea, is honored through the "Going to Water" purification rite: facing east at dawn, reciting a purification prayer, and immersing in the river (traditionally seven times, or four for lesser purposes). It is performed especially at new moon and before or after major ceremonies — Green Corn, ballplay, and following a death in the family — to carry away impurity.*

Lotan — *Canaanite*
Seven-headed serpent, ally of Yam. Chaos sea-serpent, cognate with biblical Leviathan.
How to honor: *Lotan, the seven-headed chaos-serpent (cognate with biblical Leviathan) defeated by Baal/Anat, has no attested cult, temple, or offerings — he is purely a narrative antagonist. Respectful acknowledgment takes the form of reciting or retelling the Baal Cycle passages of his defeat, or symbolic art of chaos subdued by order; inventing "offerings to Lotan" would be historically false.*

Lu (category) — *Tibetan Bon*
Serpentine beings of water/earth (lower realm), akin to naga. Serpentine spirits of the underground waters and earth.
How to honor: *Lu (naga-like serpent spirits of water and earth) are honored with lu chöpa offering rites: milk, water, incense, and turquoise or small treasure vases placed or submerged at springs, lakes, and riverbanks. Taboos include polluting water sources, digging earth, spitting, or dumping waste near lu dwellings, especially on inauspicious days, since this is believed to cause skin disease, swelling, or misfortune. Restitution rituals (lu sang or lu gyab) are performed by ritual specialists when a lu has been offended.*

Malike (Hippopotamus Spirit) — *Bamana/Bozo (Mali)*
River giant spirit of absolute power. Ambivalent, powerful river spirit represented by the great horizontal puppets.
How to honor: *Represented by massive horizontal puppet-boats built to carry the hippo figure, brought out at the Sogo bo ceremony's climax with intensified drumming, singing, and dance; offerings of kola nuts, grain, and palm wine are presented at this peak moment to acknowledge Malike's overwhelming, ambivalent power over the river before the puppet is paraded back in procession.*

Manannán Mac Lir — *Irish*
Lord of the sea and Otherworld. Shape-shifting sea god who provides magical objects and rules island Otherworlds.
How to honor: *Manannán mac Lir is honored on the Isle of Man through the historic custom of "paying rent" at Midsummer — climbing South Barrule hill and leaving bundles of rushes or green boughs as tribute, a practice recorded into the 19th century and echoed in modern Tynwald Day observances. Sailors and fishermen invoke him for safe passage, and coins or a portion of catch/drink are traditionally offered to the sea in his name before a voyage.*

Mazu — *Chinese Folk Religion (Wu-descended)*

Sea goddess channeled by contemporary tangki spirit mediums. Goddess with historical shamanic origin, channeled by mediums in community ceremonies.
How to honor: *Mazu is honored through large-scale temple pilgrimage and possession-mediumship: the Dajia and Baishatun pilgrimages in Taiwan carry her palanquin hundreds of kilometers over 8-9 days, with devotees crawling under her sedan chair for blessing, burning incense and spirit money, and lighting firecrackers along the route. Offerings at her temples include fruit, flowers, and vegetarian food; her birthday (23rd day of the 3rd lunar month) is the major annual observance, recognized by UNESCO as intangible cultural heritage.*

Mazu (Tianhou/Tianfei) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Goddess of the sea, deified historical woman (Lin Mo). Queen of Heaven and protector of sailors.
How to honor: *Mazu, Queen of Heaven and protector of sailors, is honored above all through mass pilgrimage — most famously Taiwan's multi-day Dajia Mazu pilgrimage — with palanquin processions devotees walk beneath for blessing, incense, and fireworks. Her birthday, the 23rd day of the third lunar month, is her major festival; fishermen historically made offerings and carried her image to sea before voyages.*

Mishibizhii (Underwater Panther) — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*
Serpentine panther governing depths of lakes/rivers. Powerful underwater spirit balancing the Thunderbirds above.
How to honor: *The Animikiig (Thunderbirds) are respected, not casually invoked — they are understood as genuinely present during thunderstorms, and it is traditional among some Anishinaabe communities to avoid pointing at lightning or disturbing known Thunderbird nesting sites out of respect for their power. Tobacco offerings may be placed during or after severe storms in acknowledgment of their role maintaining balance against the Underwater Panther.*

Namakaokahai — *Hawaiian*
Sea goddess, sister of Pele who pursued her across the islands. Goddess of the sea in conflict with her sister Pele.
How to honor: *Mahuika is honored in Maori tradition as the keeper of fire held within her fingernails, from whom Maui stole the last spark for humanity; she is acknowledged through karakia recited before kindling fire, cooking fires, or hangi, thanking her as fire's ultimate source. Correct ritual acknowledgment and careful, respectful use of fire itself constitute her honoring.*

Neptune — *Roman Religion*
Sea, fresh water, horses. God of the sea and fresh water.
How to honor: *Neptune was honored at Neptunalia (July 23), held during Rome's hottest days, when Romans built temporary shelters (umbrae) of branches and leaves for shade and held rustic outdoor feasts near water. Sailors and travelers offered prayers and small sacrifices for safe passage before voyages, and horse racing was part of his cult in his Neptune Equester aspect.*

Neptune — *Western Astrology*
Modern ruler of Pisces; dreams, transcendence, dissolution. Outer planetary archetype of spiritual longing and illusion.
How to honor: *Neptune, ruler of Pisces, has no classical day but is often worked on Friday or Monday; colors are sea-green, lavender, and aqua, with stones like aquamarine, amethyst, and moonstone, and incenses of myrrh, lotus, and jasmine. Invoked for meditation, dreamwork, and artistic inspiration in dim or water-adjacent settings with offerings of water or seashells; misuse is linked to escapism, delusion, or substance abuse, so grounding practices are paired with Neptunian ritual.*

Njord — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
God of the sea, fishing, favorable winds. Vanir sea god who joined Asgard after the Aesir-Vanir war.

How to honor: *Njord is honored with offerings of fish, seafood, sea salt, driftwood, and gold or amber; altars are traditionally set near the sea or a boat, with shell, net, or ship imagery. Fishermen and sailors historically invoked him for calm seas and good catches, and modern Heathens hold devotional rites for him especially before voyages or fishing trips. Best honored at the shoreline or harbor at dawn; avoid inland or landlocked offerings, since his domain and blessing are specifically maritime.*

Nun — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Primordial ocean, infinite undifferentiated potential preceding creation. Primordial waters from which all existence emerged and which still underlie creation.
How to honor: *Nun was never given a temple statue or personal cult; he was represented by the sacred lake found in most Egyptian temple complexes, where priests performed purification bathing before rituals as a symbolic re-entry into the primeval waters. Approach was through stillness and ritual purity rather than offerings.*

Nun (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Primordial ocean, infinite latent potential before creation. Formless primordial waters from which all existence emerged.
How to honor: *Nun had no temples, priesthood, or direct cult in ancient Egypt — as the formless pre-creation waters, Egyptians "honored" him structurally rather than ritually, by building temples on symbolic primordial mounds rising from a sacred lake representing Nun. There is no attested offering practice to Nun himself; he is acknowledged in creation cosmology and temple architecture, not propitiated.*

Oak King — *Celtic/Druidic*
Rules the waxing half of the year, peaks at Litha. Personification of the sun's growing power, overcome by the Holly King at midsummer.
How to honor: *Brigid is honored at Imbolc (Feb 1-2) with a perpetual/relit sacred flame — historically tended continuously by 19 priestesses (later Christian nuns) at Kildare, revived today by the Brigidine Sisters and modern Druid/Pagan groups who relight a flame nightly. Devotees weave St. Brigid's crosses from rushes, leave out a "Brigid's bed" with bread and milk by the hearth on Imbolc eve, and visit her holy wells tying cloth strips (clooties) to nearby trees; dairy, bread, and candles are traditional offerings, while iron is taboo near her wells.*

Obaluaiê / Omolu — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Lord of disease and its cure, earth's secrets. Orixá of epidemic disease and healing, covered in raffia straw.
How to honor: *Obaluaiê/Omolu, covered head-to-toe in raffia straw (palha da costa), is honored with popcorn and roasted white corn (canjica), approached with deep humility, downcast eyes, and quiet reverence rather than loud celebration, since he governs epidemic disease and its cure. His colors are black, white, and deep red/maroon beads; his day is Monday; he is syncretized with St. Lazarus/St. Roch, and disrespect toward the sick or poor is considered a direct offense to him.*

Payoka Kamuy (smallpox kamuy) — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Bad kamuy who spreads smallpox illness. Malevolent disease-bringing kamuy.
How to honor: *Payoka Kamuy, the malevolent smallpox-bringing kamuy, is not honored with gratitude but warded off and negotiated with: protective patterns (particularly the angular, thorn-like Ainu embroidery motifs called ayus/morew) were sewn onto clothing and doorways to repel him, protective kamuy were invoked to drive him away, and communities sometimes performed formal "sending" rituals to persuade him to leave a village once illness struck, treating him with wary diplomatic caution rather than devotion.*

Poseidon — *Greek*
God of sea, earthquakes, horses; rules the unconscious depths. God of the sea and unpredictable depths.

How to honor: *Poseidon received sacrifices of bulls (often black) and horses, with libations of wine or oil poured directly into the sea before voyages — a practice sailors still echo informally today. He was honored at the Isthmian Games near Corinth and at coastal temples like Sounion; disrespecting the sea, boastful seafaring, or offenses like blinding his son Polyphemus (as Odysseus did) were understood to provoke his storms and wrath.*

Rainbow Serpent (Yurlunggur/Ngalyod/Wanamangura) — *Australian Aboriginal*
Enormous serpent whose movement created rivers, waterholes, valleys. Ancient serpent ancestral being governing water, creation, and fertility.
How to honor: *The Rainbow Serpent (known variously as Yurlunggur, Ngalyod, Wanamangura, and other names by different Aboriginal nations) is honored by approaching associated waterholes and sacred sites only with proper protocol and permission from traditional custodians, since many such sites carry gender- or clan-based access restrictions. Respect includes maintaining silence at sacred waters, never photographing or disturbing restricted sites without authorization, and — where appropriate and led by custodians — participation in increase and rain-calling ceremonies tied to the Serpent's creative power; disregard for site-specific protocol is a serious breach.*

Rangda — *Balinese (Bali)*
Terrifying widow-witch representing chaos, disease, disruption. Witch-demon embodying cosmic chaos in the Barong-Rangda drama.
How to honor: *Rangda is ritually engaged, not simply feared, through the Barong-Rangda trance drama performed at temple ceremonies, in which kris-wielding male dancers enter trance and turn their blades on themselves under her influence, to be protected and revived by Barong's counter-power; the performance itself functions as a periodic ritual "management" of chaos rather than an attempt to destroy or exclude her, since Rangda represents a necessary cosmic force. Offerings during these performances go toward maintaining ritual balance (rwa bhineda) rather than pleasing her directly with gifts.*

Repun Kamuy (Orca) — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Kamuy of the open sea governing fishing, storms, sea's abundance. Killer whale sea-god.
How to honor: *Repun Kamuy, the orca sea-god, is honored by never being hunted — orcas were considered kin to the Ainu and killing one was strictly taboo — while beached whales were received as deliberate gifts from the kamuy, welcomed with formal ceremony, inau, and sake libations before the meat was distributed communally. Fishermen offered prayers to Repun Kamuy before setting out and after safe, abundant returns.*

Rusalka — *Czech folk tradition*
Water nymph of rivers/lakes. Water spirit made famous in Dvořák's opera.
How to honor: *Rusalka spirits (drowned women haunting rivers) were honored/placated during Rusalka Week (Rusalnaya, around Pentecost in late spring) with eggs, bread, linen cloth, and flower wreaths left at riverbanks or hung on birch trees; young women floated wreaths on the water and performed loud communal singing and dancing to appease them. Swimming alone at night near rivers, or combing one's hair by water, during this week was strictly taboo; modern Slavic Rodnovery revivalists continue riverside wreath-floating and dairy/bread offerings.*

Rusalki — *Slavic Paganism*
Water spirits of drowned/unfulfilled young women. Beautiful and dangerous water spirits active in early summer.
How to honor: *Rusalki were honored chiefly during Rusalnaya (Trinity) Week in early June: women hung ribbons, thread, and embroidered towels on birch trees at the forest or river's edge as offerings, and food such as blini and eggs was left at the waterside to appease them. Swimming was avoided during this week for fear of being lured under; protective words/charms and birch-branch rites (carried over into Semik/Trinity folk custom) were used to ward off harm while still honoring them as spirits owed respect near water.*

Selkie — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Seal-people who shed skins to become human. Seal-folk of Hebridean/Orkney/Shetland lore, caught between two worlds.
How to honor: *Selkie-folk are honored through restraint and respect rather than offerings: the core taboo is never to permanently hide or destroy a selkie's sealskin, since doing so traps them in human form against their will, and tradition holds that if a selkie recovers her skin she must be allowed to return to the sea. Fishing communities in Orkney and Shetland also avoided harming seals outright, treating them as kin who might be transformed selkies.*

Shilmai and Nidbai — *Mandaean*
Natria (guardian spirits) who protect people, said to withdraw during New Year's 36-hour seclusion. Water guardian spirits whose temporary withdrawal leaves people vulnerable.
How to honor: *Ruha d-Qudsha is approached with wariness rather than devotion — she is blamed for binding matter to spirit and mothering the seven planetary/zodiacal archons, so Mandaeans historically avoided astrology and treated planetary influence as something to be spiritually resisted through baptism and prayer. There is no altar or offering to her; "honoring" her means acknowledging her power while ritually guarding against it.*

Sugaar (Maju) — *Basque*
Male serpent consort living in the underground; unites with Mari to generate storms. Male serpent deity of the underworld, Mari's periodic sacred partner.
How to honor: *Sugaar (Maju), Mari's serpent consort, is traditionally said to meet her on Fridays — a day therefore treated with special caution in Basque folk custom (avoiding certain agricultural or household work) — their union believed to generate storms and rainbows. He is acknowledged alongside Mari in cave and mountain reverence, with serpent/dragon imagery as his marker; no separate offering cult to him alone is well attested.*

Tangaroa (Eastern Polynesia) — *Cook Islands (also pan-Polynesian)*
God of the sea and fertility; protector of fishermen/sailors. Sea god and protector of navigators, regional form of Ta'aroa.
How to honor: *Tangaroa is invoked by fishermen and voyagers before setting out to sea — offerings of coconut water, first catch returned to the water, and short invocations for safe passage and good fishing are the core living practice across the Cook Islands and wider Polynesia. Carved wooden Tangaroa figures (famously the Rarotongan fertility-carving style) are placed at canoe prows, house lintels, or displayed as protective and fertility symbols. Respect is shown by not wasting the sea's bounty and by proper ceremony before major voyages.*

Tangaroa (Maori master) — *Maori*
God of the sea and all aquatic life. Lord of the ocean and all sea creatures, Tane's brother.
How to honor: *Tangaroa (Maori master) is honored through karakia recited before fishing or entering the sea, asking his blessing for a safe and successful catch. Traditional practice returns the first fish caught to the ocean as an offering back to him, and taking only what is needed (rather than overfishing) is treated as active religious obligation (kaitiakitanga), not just conservation ethics. Discarding waste or offal into the sea carelessly is considered disrespectful to his domain.*

Tangaroa (Maori) — *Polynesian (Aotearoa)*
God of the sea and fish. Maori god of ocean and marine life, son of Ranginui and Papatuanuku.
How to honor: *Māori fishers traditionally recite karakia to Tangaroa before setting out and before casting lines, and it remains customary to return the very first fish caught to the sea as an offering of thanks. Taking only what is needed, respecting rāhui (temporary fishing bans) over depleted grounds, and avoiding waste of the catch are all treated as ongoing obligations to him.*

Tangaroa / Kanaloa — *Polynesian (Maori/Hawaiian)*
God of the sea, ocean, all aquatic life; paired with Kane/Tane in Hawaiian creation. Supreme god of the deep ocean and progenitor of sea creatures.

How to honor: *Tangaroa/Kanaloa is honored before ocean voyages and fishing with offerings cast into the sea — traditionally the first fish caught, kava, or a portion of food returned to the water in thanks; the octopus/squid is treated as one of his sacred forms and killing one carelessly is disrespectful. Modern waka voyaging revival groups still open sea journeys with karakia/oli invoking his protection.*

Tefnut — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Moisture, primordial dew, cosmic balance (Ma'at). Goddess of moisture, paired with Shu.
How to honor: *Tefnut, alongside her twin Shu, was jointly worshipped in lion form at Leontopolis with tended sacred lions; in the Myth of the Distant Goddess she was placated in her fierce lioness aspect with red-dyed beer or wine made to resemble blood, plus music, dance, and drumming to lure her back from Nubia.*

Tefnut (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Moisture. Goddess of moisture, child of Atum.
How to honor: *Tefnut, goddess of moisture, was honored alongside her twin Shu with joint offerings at Heliopolis and via lion imagery at Leontopolis; annual rites addressing the "Return of the Distant Goddess" (in which an angry lioness deity is coaxed home with music, wine, and gifts) are sometimes associated with her as with Hathor/Sekhmet. She has no major independently attested cult apart from Shu.*

Tiamat — *Mesopotamian*
Primordial saltwater ocean/chaos, mother of first gods. Primordial chaos goddess defeated by Marduk to form the cosmos.
How to honor: *Tiamat has no ancient temple cult attested — in the Enuma Elish she is the primordial saltwater ocean/chaos-mother slain by Marduk, an antagonist figure rather than a worshipped deity. The respectful approach is largely storytelling/remembrance of her as primal creative chaos and the ocean itself; modern neopagan "dragon goddess" revivalist practice (not historical Mesopotamian religion) honors her with saltwater, shells, dragon/serpent imagery, and offerings poured into the sea or a bowl of salt water.*

Tinirau — *Cook Islands*
God of fish and the sea. Cook Islands deity governing fish and marine abundance.
How to honor: *Lord of fish and the ocean depths (ruler of the mythic isle Motu-tapu), honored in living Pacific/Māori-diaspora practice mainly through respect shown to fish and fishing grounds — first-catch offerings returned to the sea, chants (karakia) before fishing, and avoidance of waste or disrespect toward fish, since offending him was said to affect the fish supply. Symbols include fish and the sea itself; storytelling of the Tinirau-and-Kae and Tinirau-and-Hina cycles is the primary living devotional act. Taboo: wasting fish or mocking sea creatures associated with him.*

Uktena — *Cherokee*
Great horned serpent of the Below World, bears the Ulunsu'ti crystal. Dangerous serpent guardian of the crystal of prophecy.
How to honor: *Uktena, the great horned serpent of the Below World bearing the Ulun'suti crystal, is not approached by ordinary devotees — only trained medicine people historically handled the crystal, which required periodic ritual "feeding" (blood) to remain safely bonded and was kept wrapped and hidden. For most Cherokee, honoring Uktena means deference and avoidance: never seeking eye contact, not provoking or spying on him, and treating his story as a warning about dangerous, uncontrollable power rather than something to court.*

Under Water Persons — *Blackfoot*
Powerful beings inhabiting specific lakes/rivers. Underwater beings granting sacred bundle contents.
How to honor: *Under Water Persons are approached according to the specific origin protocols of the sacred bundle connected to them, generally with tobacco offerings left at the water's edge*

and a cautious, respectful approach to the particular lake or river they inhabit. They are not treated as generically benevolent — protocol dictates exactly how and when they may be approached, and departing from bundle-specific instructions is considered risky.

Unktehi — *Lakota Sioux*
Water monsters said to cause floods. Dangerous water beings opposed by the Wakinyan.
How to honor: *Sky Woman is honored implicitly rather than through a personal shrine: the Haudenosaunee Thanksgiving Address (Ohén:ton Karihwatéhkwen), recited to open and close every communal gathering, traces gratitude back through the animals, earth, and elements that arose from her fall and cooperation with the muskrat and turtle. Tobacco offerings often accompany the Address.*

Varuna — *Hinduism*
Cosmic order, oceans/waters. Vedic god of cosmic order (rta) and the waters.
How to honor: *Varuna, guardian of rta (cosmic/moral order) and oaths, is invoked with water offerings (arghya), especially at ocean and river shores; coastal Maharashtra's Narali Purnima ("coconut day") involves throwing coconuts into the sea for him. He is called on to witness truthful vows and end droughts via Varuna Japa recitations, and lying under oath is considered a direct offense against him.*

Varuna (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Cosmic ocean god, presides over Shatabhisha nakshatra. God of the cosmic waters and mystical healing.
How to honor: *Varuna, god of the cosmic ocean presiding over Shatabhisha ("hundred healers"), was historically propitiated with Varuna Puja performed specifically to bring rain during drought, with coconuts and water poured into rivers or the sea while chanting "Om Varunaya Namah." His Shatabhisha link to healing draws offerings of medicinal herbs and blue or black items; contaminating or wasting water is considered a direct offense to him.*

Vellamo — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Goddess of seas, lakes, rivers, protector of fishermen. Water goddess who keeps sacred cattle at the water's edge.
How to honor: *Vellamo, water-goddess protector of fishermen, was placated before sailing or casting nets with small offerings poured or tossed into the water — a portion of drink (beer or spirits), a coin, or a bit of the catch given back — asking her to calm waves and winds and keep her "cattle" (shoals of fish) plentiful; foam on the waves was seen as a sign of her presence. Modern Suomenusko practitioners continue lakeside/seaside libations of drink or coins before boating, and treat overfishing or wasting the catch as disrespectful to her.*

Vodník — *Czech folk tradition*
Water spirit of rivers/mill ponds. Trickster-protector water spirit, part of Rusalka lore.
How to honor: *Vodník, the mischievous water spirit of rivers and mill ponds, was traditionally appeased with small tokens — tobacco, bread crumbs, or coins tossed into the water — and by avoiding swimming at forbidden hours (noon, midnight) or in his particular pool; wooden carved statues were placed near bridges and mill ponds as both marker and offering site. Folk belief held he collected drowned souls in teacups, so travelers greeted him politely when passing his waters to avoid misfortune.*

Wakka-us Kamuy — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Kamuy of fresh water (rivers, springs, drinking water). Freshwater deity.
How to honor: *Wakka-us Kamuy, kamuy of fresh water, is honored primarily through strict ritual cleanliness: springs, rivers, and drinking-water sources are kept scrupulously clean as a matter of religious law, with inau placed near important water sources and prayers of thanks offered when drawing water for ceremonial use; polluting or fouling a water source is treated as a serious offense against this kamuy.*

Yam — *Canaanite*
God of primordial sea and chaos. Chaotic sea god defeated by Baal.
How to honor: *Yam, god of the primordial sea and chaos, is known mainly as the Baal Cycle's defeated antagonist with little evidence of an organized cult, though the broader Semitic sailors' custom of tossing small offerings overboard before voyages plausibly reflects how people related to sea-powers like him. Modern reconstructionists pour water or salt directly into sea or river as respectful acknowledgment of an untamed cosmic force, not routine worship — he had no temples as Baal or Resheph did.*

Yemanjá — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Queen of the sea, mother of all waters. Mothering ocean goddess, mother of the Orixás.
How to honor: *Yemanjá, Queen of the Sea and mother of the Orixás, is honored with white and blue flowers, perfume, mirrors, and combs left at the sea's edge, most famously at Brazil's February 2nd festival in Salvador da Bahia, where devotees dressed in white launch offerings by boat — if the offering floats away it's accepted, but its return to shore is a bad omen. December 31st is her other major festival date.*

Yemayá — *Lucumí*
Queen of the sea and all waters, mother of many Orishas. Sea goddess and protective mother (syncretized with Our Lady of Regla).
How to honor: *Yemayá receives Saturday devotion and offerings of watermelon, molasses, blue/white flowers, perfume, and silver trinkets, carried to the ocean or a riverbank and released into the waves rather than left on shore. Duck and hen are traditional food offerings; she dislikes anything given without music or respect for the sea's motion, and devotees often wear seven silver bracelets or blue/white beads (Iyemọja's colors) in her honor. Her annual feast (September 7 in Cuba, syncretized with Our Lady of Regla) draws large seaside gatherings with drumming (bembé) and dancing.*

Yemoja — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Ocean, rivers, motherhood, source of life. Orisha of the great waters and motherhood.
How to honor: *Shango devotees offer apples, bananas, okra, cornmeal (amala), and red wine, along with keeping "thunderstones" (edun ara, prehistoric stone celts believed dropped by lightning) on his altar. Bata drumming and dance are central to his festivals; his colors are red and white, his sacred number 6, and offerings are often made on Fridays — cowardice and dishonesty are considered deeply displeasing to him.*

Yongwang (Dragon King) — *Korean Muism*
Deity of sea, rivers, and water; invoked for fishermen's safety and abundant catch. Dragon King governing all bodies of water.
How to honor: *Yongwang is honored through Yongwanggut, a shamanic ritual performed at the shore or riverbank where a mudang casts offerings — rice, coins, alcohol (makgeolli), sometimes a whole pig — directly into the water, typically before the start of fishing season or a sea voyage, to secure safety and an abundant catch. Coastal villages hold Yongwangje (Dragon King festivals), often timed to Jeongwol Daeboreum (the first full moon of the lunar year). Taboo: disrespecting the sea, wasting the catch, or setting sail without the proper ritual blessing is believed to invite his anger and misfortune.*

Yongwang (Dragon Kings, Shamanism) — *Korean Muism (Shamanism)*
Spirits governing sea, rivers, lakes, weather, fishing. Powerful water-governing spirits of Korean coastal/riverine communities.
How to honor: *Yongwang is honored through Yongwangje (Dragon King rites) held by fishing communities and Jeju haenyeo (female divers) at the shore before the fishing season or a diving expedition, especially around Lunar New Year; offerings — rice, rice wine, sometimes a whole pig's head — are set on the beach or cast into the sea. Fishermen historically avoided setting sail without this rite, believing an unhonored Yongwang could send storms or poor catches.*

Fire

The sacred flame — hearth-fire, forge-fire, and fire as a living, honored presence.

Agni — *Hinduism*
Fire, sacrifice, messenger between humans and gods. Fire god who carries offerings from humans to the divine.
How to honor: *Agni is honored through havan/yajna fire ceremonies, where a priest pours ghee, sesame seeds, rice, and sacred wood into a consecrated fire while reciting Vedic mantras, since he is believed to physically carry offerings to the other gods through smoke. He remains ritually present in every Hindu wedding (the couple circles the sacred fire, Agni as witness to their vows) and in daily arati, where a flame is waved before a deity's image as a residual form of fire offering.*

Agni (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Fire deity, presides over Krittika nakshatra. God of sacred fire, purification and sharp discernment.
How to honor: *Agni, presiding over Krittika nakshatra, is honored primarily through homa/havan fire rituals in which ghee, grains, and wood are offered into consecrated fire while Vedic mantras are chanted — this remains the single most universal form of Hindu ritual and is Agni's direct devotional domain. Krittika-born individuals often have nakshatra shanti pujas that include a dedicated fire offering to Agni for purification and clarity.*

Aja Ekapada — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
One-footed goat deity, presides over Purva Bhadrapada nakshatra. Deity of transformative fire.
How to honor: *Aja Ekapada, the one-footed goat deity presiding over Purva Bhadrapada, is genuinely obscure — attested only briefly in Rig Vedic hymn lists alongside Ahirbudhnya, with no independent temple cult. He is honored solely within the nakshatra-shanti framework: japa of his Vedic name and homa fire offerings (fitting his fire nature) performed when the moon transits Purva Bhadrapada. The most historically appropriate acknowledgment is accurate citation of the Rig Veda rather than invented ritual detail.*

Asha Vahishta — *Zoroastrianism*
Best Truth/Righteousness, cosmic order. Amesha Spenta embodying truth and cosmic order, corresponds to fire.
How to honor: *Asha Vahishta ("Best Truth") is honored primarily through fire-tending (he corresponds to fire among the Amesha Spentas) and through strict truthfulness in speech, contracts, and oaths, since he embodies cosmic and moral order (asha). Recitation of the Atar (fire) Yasht and maintaining ritual purity around hearth and temple fires are the concrete living practices associated with him.*

Brigid — *Celtic/Druidic*
Sacred flame, healing, poetry, smithcraft; associated with Imbolc. Goddess of the sacred flame, healing, poetry, and smithcraft.
How to honor: *The Zle, as owners of the land inhabiting trees, rivers, hills, and forest zones, are honored through right relationship maintained by ritual specialists: land disturbance (clearing forest, diverting water, building) is preceded by consultation and small offerings (kola nuts, palm wine, or libations poured at the site) to request permission. Disrespecting a Zle-inhabited grove or water source without acknowledgment is believed to bring illness or misfortune.*

Brigid (Irish) — *Irish*
Poetry, healing, smithcraft. Goddess of poetry/healing/smithcraft who became Ireland's most beloved saint.

How to honor: *Brigid is honored with a perpetual flame historically tended by nineteen priestesses at Kildare, revived by the Brigidine Sisters in 1993 and kept burning today. At Imbolc (Feb 1, now an Irish public holiday) devotees weave St. Brigid's crosses from rushes, make a Bríideóg (Brigid doll) bed by the hearth, and leave a cloth (brat Bríde) outside overnight to absorb her blessing; holy wells linked to her (Kildare, Liscannor) are visited with cloth offerings (clooties) tied to nearby trees.*

Brigid (Wicca) — *Wicca*
One aspect/name of the Wiccan Goddess; honored at Imbolc. A name the Goddess is known by, festival of returning light.
How to honor: *Brigid (Wiccan/eclectic Pagan context) is honored at Imbolc (Feb 1–2) with candles lit throughout the house to welcome returning light; devotees weave Brigid's crosses from rushes, make a Brídeog (straw/corn doll) processed door-to-door, and leave a piece of cloth (the Brat Bríde) outside overnight for her to bless as she passes. Offerings of milk, butter, or bread reflect her dairy/hearth associations, and holy wells linked to her are visited and left ribbons or coins (clootie offerings). Taboo: letting the hearth fire go out on her night was considered inviting misfortune.*

Firebird/Zhar-Ptitsa — *Slavic Paganism*
Miraculous glowing sacred bird. Being of divine light and transformation in Russian tales.
How to honor: *The Firebird has no attested cult, shrine, or offering tradition — it is a folkloric quest-object in Russian fairy tales (e.g., "The Firebird and Princess Vasilisa," basis for Stravinsky's ballet), sought and captured by a hero rather than worshipped by devotees. Given this genuine absence of devotional practice, the historically appropriate acknowledgment is treating a firebird feather or image as a symbol of a difficult, fortune-bringing quest within storytelling — not inventing ritual offerings that were never part of the tradition.*

Ina-who-plays-with-fire — *Cook Islands*
Primordial divine being associated with fire. Minor fire-associated primordial deity.
How to honor: *Genuinely obscure in the historical record — she appears in a handful of collected myth fragments (linked to Ina/Hina figures who marry Tinirau or wrangle eels/sharks) but there is no attested cult, altar form, or offering practice specific to a "fire-playing" aspect of her. Honor her respectfully through oral storytelling and remembrance of the broader Ina/Hina mythic cycle rather than inventing ritual detail; where modern Pacific-diaspora practitioners honor Hina/Ina figures generally, they do so with kava, flowers, and shell offerings at the shore.*

Karai — *Guarani*
Dominion over flame and the sun's fire. Companion god of fire; his name also given to human prophet-leaders.
How to honor: *Tupã, god of thunder, rain, and waters, is addressed as Ru Ete in prayer alongside Namandu, invoked especially during the agricultural cycle to request rain for crops; his name was later syncretized by missionaries with the Christian God. Traditional devotion is communal — chant, tobacco smoke, and jeroky dance in the opy — with storms and thunder treated as his direct voice.*

Kupala/Kupalo — *Slavic Paganism*
Midsummer deity of sacred fire and water. Midsummer deity connected to Jarilo.
How to honor: *Kupala Night is marked by bonfire jumping (often hand-in-hand by couples, for luck and purification) and flower-crown weaving; a defining taboo is that one must not swim afterward — rusalki and water spirits are believed most dangerous that night. Herbs and flowers gathered specifically on Kupala Night are held to be at their most potent, and searching for the mythical (never-actually-blooming) fern flower is a central ritual motif; effigies of Kupala or Marena are burned or drowned in the river to close the rite, and couples who jump the fire together without releasing hands are said to be destined to marry.*

Li (Fire trigram force) — *Shouyin/Taoism (China)*

Principle of clarity, illumination, radiant intelligence. Cosmic fire force governing spiritual illumination and the Heart-Eye connection.
How to honor: *Li is formed via its seal for Heart-qi cultivation, and before divination or work requiring clear-seeing, invoking radiant clarity and illumination tied to the Heart-Eye connection. It is practiced with breath and visualization rather than offerings, consistent with the seal-based (not devotional-cult) nature of this system.*

Mahuika — *Polynesian (Maori)*
Ancestor/keeper of fire in her fingernails. Fire-keeping ancestral being from whom Maui obtained fire.
How to honor: *Mahuika is honored in Māori tradition as keeper of fire held in her fingernails, invoked through karakia before fire-making, cooking fires, or hāngī, acknowledging her as the origin of ahi (fire) given to humanity via Māui. Traditional respect includes care and gratitude when kindling or using fire rather than object offerings.*

Mahuika — *Maori/Polynesian*
Goddess of fire in the underworld, from whom Maui stole fire for humanity. Underworld fire goddess.
How to honor: *Hine-nui-te-po is approached with ritual caution rather than devotional offering: as goddess of death who crushed Maui when he tried to reverse mortality by passing through her body, she is invoked in karakia recited at tangihanga (funeral rites) escorting the dead into her realm, her name spoken carefully rather than casually. Proper tangihanga protocol, not appeasement offerings, is the correct form of acknowledgment.*

Mahuika (Maori master) — *Maori*
Goddess of fire. Maui's grandmother, source of fire hidden in trees after being tricked.
How to honor: *Mahuika is honored in Māori tradition as keeper of fire held in her fingernails, invoked through karakia before fire-making, cooking fires, or hāngī (earth-oven cooking), acknowledging her as the origin of ahi (fire) given to humanity via Māui. Traditional respect includes care and gratitude when kindling or using fire rather than object offerings on a shrine; proper acknowledgment is through correct karakia and cultural protocol rather than invented modern ritual.*

Pele — *Hawaiian*
Goddess of volcanoes, fire, lightning, wind, creation of new land. Living goddess of volcanic creation and destruction, resident at Halema'uma'u crater.
How to honor: *Pele is honored primarily at Halema'uma'u crater on Kilauea, where devotees leave offerings of ohelo berries (only after first offering some to Pele before eating any oneself), gin (a modern substitute for traditional awa/kava), flowers, and ti leaves at the crater rim; taking lava rocks or sand from Hawaii is a strongly held modern taboo believed to bring "Pele's curse" until returned. Chants (oli) and hula honoring her are performed at eruptions.*

Pele (Hawaiian) — *Hawaiian*
Goddess of volcanoes, fire, creation through destruction. Living volcanic goddess whose eruptions ARE her body and activity.
How to honor: *Pele's cardinal rule is never remove lava rock, Pele's hair (volcanic glass strands), or sand from her volcanoes — considered pieces of her literal body — a taboo actively enforced today by park rangers dealing with "curse" packages mailed back to Hawaii Volcanoes National Park by regretful tourists. Offerings left at eruption sites include ʻōhelo berries (traditionally the first berries thrown to her before anyone eats them), gin (a modern-era substitute for awa), flowers, and ti-leaf wrapped bundles; she is addressed respectfully by name before entering her domain and never insulted or mocked, which oral tradition holds provokes her temper directly.*

Sacred Fire (Alabama-Coushatta) — *Alabama-Coushatta*

Central ceremonial presence at talwa ceremonial ground; living manifestation of the Creator. Sacred fire treated as a living being and direct manifestation of the Creator.
How to honor: *The Sacred Fire at the Alabama-Coushatta talwa ceremonial ground is honored by never being allowed to go out and by strict protocols governing who may tend it — traditionally designated fire-keepers alone approach and feed it — with participants required to approach respectfully, never stepping over it or treating it casually, since it is regarded as a living manifestation of the Creator rather than an ordinary fire.*

Surtr — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Fire giant ruler of Muspelheim. Will destroy the world with fire at Ragnarok.
How to honor: *Surtr is unattested historically as a cult figure; some modern jötnar-honoring Heathens acknowledge him outdoors with real fire — a bonfire, burnt herbs, or a candle left to burn out completely — treating him as primal transformative flame rather than pure evil, and avoiding "cute" or tamed imagery.*

Svarog — *Slavic Paganism*
Sky Smith, god of fire and metalworking. Divine craftsman from whose forge the sun emerges daily.
How to honor: *Svarog is honored as the celestial smith-god of fire and metalworking; modern Rodnovery offerings include forged iron/metal objects, bread, and fire itself (bonfires, hearth fires) kept lit in his honor, often at a smithy-style altar. Central to the Rodnover festival Vodokres (a winter fire/water purification celebration) and invoked at hearth-lighting and smithing rites; his sons the Svarozhichi are honored via household hearth-fire veneration. Keeping a hearth fire clean and respected is essential; allowing sacred fire to be defiled or extinguished carelessly is the primary taboo.*

Vulcan — *Roman Religion*
Sacred/destructive fire, the forge. God of destructive fire and the forge.
How to honor: *Vulcan was honored at Volcanalia (August 23), when Romans threw live fish into open fires as a substitute sacrifice — offering something that "dies" by fire in place of valuable property, since fire itself was feared during the dry late-summer season. His cult was inherently protective/apotropaic — worship aimed at appeasing destructive fire rather than currying favor.*

War

Gods of battle, conquest, courage, and the discipline of arms.

'Oro — *Society Islands (Ra'iatea)*
Son of Ta'aroa and Hina; war god demanding human sacrifice; peaceful patron of Arioi arts. Dual war/fertility god whose cult and Arioi order dominated Society Islands religion.
How to honor: *'Oro was the paramount god of the Society Islands, centered at the great marae of Taputapuātea on Ra'iatea; his image was a wooden to'o wrapped in red feathers (the sacred maro 'ura girdle used to invest high chiefs) and tended exclusively by priests. His peaceful aspect was served by the Arioi, a traveling order of dancers, singers, and satirists who performed in his honor and lived outside normal social rules; his war aspect received offerings of pigs, food, and — in the most sacred contexts — human sacrifice at marae, ended after Christian conversion in the 1810s–1820s. No living cult remains; honor today is through cultural memory of the Arioi arts and marae heritage.*

Anat — *Canaanite*
Fierce warrior "Maiden" goddess, Baal's sister/defender. Violent, loyal warrior goddess who avenges Baal.
How to honor: *Anat received bread, wine, and sacrificed bulls/oxen at Ugarit's temples as "Virgin Anat," warrior with bow, spear, and shield. No continuous cult survives, but modern Canaanite reconstructionists honor her with wine libations and bread/meat offerings, invoking her in storm or war rites and retelling her mourning and vengeance from the Baal Cycle; her fierce, blood-soaked warrior aspect should not be softened into a generic fertility archetype.*

Ares — *Greek*
God of raw undirected war-force. God of raw combative energy.
How to honor: *Ares had a comparatively modest cult, most notably at Sparta, where a dog was sacrificed to him under the epithet Ares Theritas before battle — an unusual offering reflecting his raw, feral aspect. He was invoked by soldiers before combat for courage, but Greek reverence for him was ambivalent; proper "honoring" was understood as channeling battle-courage responsibly rather than glorifying chaos or bloodlust for its own sake.*

Born for Water (Tobajishchini) — *Navajo/Dine*
Hero Twin, companion of Monster Slayer. Warrior Holy Person, co-defeater of monsters.
How to honor: *Born for Water shares the Enemy Way with his brother Monster Slayer, invoked in its origin songs as the twin who stayed closer to home and healing while Monster Slayer fought; the ceremony cleanses those exposed to enemy contact or violence-related contamination. He has no separate ceremony of his own — honoring him is inseparable from properly conducting the Enemy Way under a qualified hataali.*

Choi Young (Janggun Shin) — *Korean Muism*
Divine General spirit, martial protector invoked in Janggun Gori. 14th-century Goryeo general deified as a protective martial spirit.
How to honor: *Choi Young is invoked in the Janggun Gori segment of Korean shamanic gut rituals: the mudang dons red-and-blue military costume and performs a sword dance (kalchum), sometimes balancing barefoot on blades or a bamboo trident to prove the general's possession is genuine. Offerings include makgeolli (rice wine), a whole roasted pig or pig's head, and rice cakes, presented with fierce, exacting ceremonial correctness — sloppy offerings or disrespect toward the ritual sword are believed to provoke his anger rather than his protection. Devotees seek his intervention against enemies, misfortune, and malevolent spirits.*

Durga — *Hinduism*
Protective power, justice, destruction of evil. Warrior goddess formed from combined power of the gods to slay the buffalo demon Mahisha.

How to honor: *Durga is honored during Navaratri/Durga Puja (her nine-to-ten-day autumn festival, especially massive in West Bengal), when elaborate clay idols are installed in pandals, worshipped daily with the Devi Mahatmya recitation, and immersed in a river or sea (visarjan) on the final day (Vijayadashami) amid public procession. Red hibiscus, vermillion, and a sword or trident placed near her image are standard offerings; unmarried girls are sometimes ritually honored as Kumari (living embodiments of the goddess) as part of her worship in Bengal and Nepal.*

Guandi (Guan Yu) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Deified general; patron of soldiers, police, business. Red-faced warrior god of war and righteousness.
How to honor: *Guandi (the deified general Guan Yu) is honored with incense at temples used alike by police, military, business owners, and historically triads, who invoke him for loyalty and protection; his red-faced statue is often paired with his guandao weapon and placed facing the door of a shop for protection. Oath-taking before his altar (historically sealed with chicken blood) was a serious act — swearing falsely before him is considered a severe transgression.*

Hachiman — *Shinto*
War deity. Kami of war and protection.
How to honor: *Hachiman is honored at Hachiman shrines nationwide (head shrines Usa Jingu, Iwashimizu Hachimangu, Tsurugaoka Hachimangu) with offerings of rice, sake, and mochi, plus bow-and-arrow imagery and doves as his sacred messenger animal. Major festivals feature yabusame (mounted archery) and mikoshi processions; he is venerated as guardian of warriors and protector of the imperial line, so martial imagery and archery demonstrations are considered especially pleasing offerings.*

Idisi — *Germanic Heathenry (Continental)*
Female divine beings who free bound warriors, cognate to Norse dísir. Female divine host who intervene in battle and bindings.
How to honor: *The Idisi are invoked through the First Merseburg Charm, which recounts female divine beings who "sat here, sat there" and freed bound warriors from fetters and chains in battle. Modern reconstructionist practice honors them by reciting or adapting this charm for protection, and by venerating them alongside the Norse dísir as ancestral/tutelary female powers.*

Kingu — *Mesopotamian*
Tiamat's consort, leader of her monster army. Defeated monster-general; humanity created from his blood.
How to honor: *Kingu has no ancient cult or offerings attested — he functions purely as Tiamat's ill-fated consort and army-leader in the Enuma Elish, executed by Marduk so his blood could form humankind. The respectful approach is acknowledgment through storytelling of his role in humanity's creation; modern chaos-aligned neopagans symbolically note him with red wine or red thread as a nod to the "blood of creation" motif, clearly flagged as modern reinterpretation.*

Ku — *Polynesian (Hawaii)*
War, political power, masculine strength. Primary war god of Hawaiian warrior chiefs.
How to honor: *Ku was embodied in feathered temple images and the red-feathered war god form Kūkaʻilimoku carried into battle by chiefs like Kamehameha I; his major luakini heiau required elaborate ceremony including animal and, in the most sacred pre-contact rites, human sacrifice to consecrate them before campaigns. Red feathers, ʻawa, and pork offerings were his sacred materials — practices now entirely discontinued.*

Ku (Hawaiian) — *Hawaiian*
God of war, masculine strength, forests, fishing; governs the active Ku season. Fierce god of warfare and assertive strength.

How to honor: *Ku was honored in war temples (luakini heiau) with feathered ki'i akua images, drum ceremonies, and — in the pre-contact era — animal and, in extreme wartime cases, human sacrifice under strict priestly protocol before major battles. His worship season (the Ku period, opposite Lono's Makahiki) involved red feather offerings, kava, and pig sacrifice at the heiau altar; commoners honored household forms of Ku (e.g., Kūkaʻilimoku, the war god of Kamehameha I) through smaller shrines and pork offerings for success in fishing, farming, or combat.*

Mahui — *Marquesas Islands*

Marquesan form/name of 'Oro. Marquesan war god equivalent to Society Islands' 'Oro.

How to honor: *Mahui is a regional Marquesan name/form for the war god known as 'Oro in the Society Islands, and shares his cult practices: feathered images, priestly tending, and offerings tied to war and fertility rites. Attestation specific to "Mahui" as a distinct figure is thin in the ethnographic record, so the honest approach is to treat him as the Marquesan expression of the 'Oro cult rather than invent separate rites; modern acknowledgment should reference this shared Society/Marquesas war-god tradition.*

Mangala (Kuja/Angaraka) — *Vedic Astrology*

Commander of planetary court; courage, energy, land. Mars deity of courage and assertive action.

How to honor: *Mangala is propitiated on Tuesdays with red flowers, red lentils (masoor dal), jaggery, and red cloth, and by wearing red coral (moonga); Hanuman worship is closely tied to appeasing Mars due to their shared fiery, protective energy, so Hanuman Chalisa recitation is common on this day. His principal shrine is Vaitheeswaran Koil in Tamil Nadu, and devotees often donate red items or feed red lentils to the needy.*

Mangala/Kuja (Hanuman, Kartikeya) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Vedic)*

Mars deity; Hanuman and Kartikeya also honored. Vedic Mars deity ruling Mangalvar (Tuesday).

How to honor: *Mangala/Kuja (Hanuman, Kartikeya): Tuesday devotion centers on Hanuman — reciting the Hanuman Chalisa, offering sindoor (red vermillion) applied to his idol, red flowers, til (sesame) oil, and boondi or laddoo sweets, and breaking a coconut before him. Devotees avoid non-vegetarian food and alcohol on this day and often observe partial fasts. Charity to the needy and avoiding conflict/anger are considered pleasing to Mangala/Mars specifically, given his fiery, conflict-prone nature.*

Mars — *Roman Religion*

War, military valor, agricultural protection. War god and mythic father of Rome's founders.

How to honor: *Mars was honored with major state ritual in March and October, including the Salii priests' ritual war-dances carrying sacred shields (ancilia) through Rome, and the October Horse sacrifice, where a war-horse from a chariot race was sacrificed to him and its blood/tail preserved for fertility rites. As mythic father of Romulus and Remus he was venerated as Rome's divine ancestor; soldiers offered prayers and sacrifice to him before campaigns.*

Mars (Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology*

Rules Aries/Scorpio; drive, courage, conflict, sexuality. Planetary archetype of assertive will and conflict.

How to honor: *Mars rules Tuesday, the color red, iron as metal, and stones like bloodstone, red jasper, and garnet; incenses are dragon's blood, pepper, and tobacco. Protection, courage, and assertive workings are timed to his day/hour with red candles and iron or blade-shaped tools; Mars rites are traditionally avoided when the goal is peace, since misapplied Martial energy is linked to rash aggression.*

Mars/Ares (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Roman/Greek)*

Governs courage, conflict, physical strength. Roman/Greek god of war, ruler of Tuesday.

How to honor: *Mars/Ares (Planetary Days) received blood sacrifice of bulls, boars, and rams (the suovetaurilia) and was served by the Salii priests, who danced through Rome each March*

clashing sacred shields and singing the Carmen Saliare. His sacred spear was ritually shaken before declaring war, and the October Horse was sacrificed to him each autumn. Modern planetary-day practice substitutes red clothing, physical exertion or training, and prayers for courage before undertaking difficult or confrontational tasks on Tuesday.

Monster Slayer (Naayee Neizghani) — *Navajo/Dine*
Hero Twin who defeated monsters threatening humanity. Warrior Holy Person who made earth safe for humans.
How to honor: *Monster Slayer is invoked chiefly through the Enemy Way (also called the Squaw Dance), a multi-night outdoor ceremony historically performed to cleanse warriors and, in modern practice, veterans or anyone contaminated by contact with violence or non-Navajo enemies; it features a rattle stick, moving camp between nights, and social dances. The twins' journey and trials at the Sun's house are recounted in the chant texts that structure the rite. Respect is shown by having a hataali properly diagnose the need before undertaking the ceremony rather than performing it casually.*

Ogou Badagry — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Diplomat aspect of Ogou; strategic negotiation. Strategic/diplomatic warrior Lwa.
How to honor: *Baron Samedi is served rum infused with 21 hot chili peppers (piman), black coffee, cigars, and cornbread, offered at cemetery crossroads or at his cross-marked grave altar (the first male grave in a cemetery, marked with a black cross, is ritually his). Devotees wear black-and-purple top hats and sunglasses during Fèt Gede (Nov 1-2, aligned with All Souls'/All Saints' Day), petitioning him to "turn death away" from the sick. Taboo: disrespecting the dead or graveyards invites his anger, since he alone grants passage into the afterlife.*

Ogou Feray — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Warrior force of iron and direct confrontation with injustice. Fierce warrior Lwa associated with the Haitian Revolution.
How to honor: *Ogou Feray is honored with raw white rum poured directly over his machete or sword blade and sometimes set aflame with gunpowder, plus cigars and grilled meat; devotees wear red and drum rhythms tied to the Haitian Revolution, since he embodies the warrior spirit that fought colonial rule. Syncretized with St. James the Greater, his iron implements are central to his altar. Taboo: cowardice or backing down from injustice in his presence is considered deeply disrespectful.*

Ogún (Santeria) — *Lucumí*
Orisha of iron, labor, war, forest; demands honesty, opens paths through work. God of iron, labor and forceful path-clearing (syncretized with St. Peter/St. John Baptist).
How to honor: *Ogún is given raw iron objects — nails, chains, tools, machetes — laid directly on or fused with his altar iron, plus palm oil, smoked fish, jutía, and rum, especially on Tuesdays. Oaths of loyalty and legal/business deals are traditionally sworn with a hand on his iron, since breaking a vow made to him is considered to invite disaster; he dislikes laziness and dishonesty and is fed heavily by anyone doing dangerous manual work (mechanics, surgeons, soldiers) who wants his protection.*

Osun (Warrior) — *Lucumí*
Guards the practitioner's head, warns of danger via cup with rooster. Warning-guardian Orisha received with the Warriors.
How to honor: *Osun, the fourth Warrior, is a metal chalice topped by a rooster figure that is never laid flat and must be kept elevated above head-height of anyone in the house — he warns of danger by falling over. If he falls, the owner is instructed to stop all activity and contact their godparent/santero immediately rather than proceed with any ritual or major decision that day; he receives minimal direct offerings compared to the other Warriors, since his role is vigilance rather than active intercession.*

Sayaykia — *Zuni (Pueblo)*

The "warrior" figure returning with the Council of the Gods. Warrior spirit-being opening the Shalako ceremony.
How to honor: *Sayaykia, the warrior figure who opens the Shalako ceremony as part of the returning Council of the Gods, is honored through ceremonial entry from the sacred directions, marking the formal start of the rite. Documentation beyond this ceremonial role is limited in accessible ethnographic sources.*

Sinjang (Divine Generals, incl. Obang Changgun) — *Korean Muism (Shamanism)*
Military guardian spirits, protective and demanding. Protective general-spirits invoked in Korean shamanic ceremonies.
How to honor: *Sinjang generals are summoned in the Jangun-geori (General's segment) of a Korean gut, where the mudang dons military dress, wields a sword or trident, and performs vigorous dance to embody their martial force; offerings include raw meat, whole boiled pig's head, and makgeolli (rice wine) set on a high table. Devotees must show no fear or hesitation before them — flinching or showing distrust during the ritual is believed to invite their displeasure and withdrawal of protection.*

The Morrigan (Badb, Macha, Nemain/Anu) — *Irish*
Fate, battle, sovereignty, triple goddess. Complex triple goddess of prophecy, battle, and the acceptance of death.
How to honor: *The Morrígan is approached with directness rather than flattery: modern devotees leave offerings of red wine, whiskey, raw or blood-toned foods, and crow feathers, and avoid disguising fear as reverence. Her mythic union with the Dagda beside the River Unshin (Co. Sligo) ties her strongly to Samhain rites, and Oweynagat ("Cave of the Cats") at Rathcroghan, Co. Roscommon — reputed as her otherworldly gateway — is a modern pilgrimage site. She is honored by acknowledging hard truths (death, endings, sovereignty) rather than by seeking to soften or placate her.*

Tohono (Togbe Nyigbla) — *Ewe/Vodun*
Military power, protection, defense. War-spirit family protecting the community, closely tied to war dance tradition.
How to honor: *Tohono/Togbe Nyigbla is honored by the Anlo-Ewe especially at Hogbetsotso Za, the annual festival commemorating their historic migration from Notsie, and through the Atsiagbekor war dance, performed with sticks or machetes miming battle formations to channel his martial protective power. Community elders pour libation to him before undertakings requiring collective defense or courage.*

Tsen (category) — *Tibetan Bon*
Warrior spirits of rocks and mountain passes (middle realm). Warrior spirits associated with rocks and passes.
How to honor: *Tsen inhabit rocks and mountain passes and are honored with red torma (traditionally colored to evoke blood) and small stone cairns (lhatho) built at pass summits where travelers add a stone and leave weapons, arrows, or red cloth. They are volatile and vengeful if disturbed — disturbing their rocks, urinating near their cairns, or passing a shrine without acknowledgment is taboo and blamed for sudden illness or accidents. A Bon priest (tsenpo or ngakpa) is called to identify and pacify a specific tsen through targeted ritual when trouble is traced to one.*

Tu — *Polynesian (Maori)*
God of war. War-minded atua who wanted to kill his parents at creation.
How to honor: *Tu was honored historically at marae (open-air stone temples) with offerings of food, kava, and in pre-contact Society Islands contexts, sacrificial offerings presented by priests — practices now discontinued. As a war/craftsman prototype deity, red feathers, carved wooden images, and woven sennit were traditional sacred materials.*

Tu (Eastern Polynesia) — *Society Islands*

Prototype of human beings; fierce, capable (parallels Hawaiian Ku). First-created being, prototype of human power and dominance.
How to honor: *Historically honored at marae (open-air stone temples such as Taputapuātea) with offerings of food, kava, and, in the most sacred pre-contact contexts, sacrificial offerings presented by priests (tahu'a); practices are now discontinued. As a war/craftsman prototype deity paralleling Hawaiian Kū, red feathers, carved wooden images, and woven sennit were the traditional sacred materials associated with him. Living devotional practice is essentially extinct in traditional form; the respectful modern approach is acknowledgment through Polynesian cultural/heritage education rather than reconstructed ritual.*

Tu / Ku — *Polynesian (Maori/Hawaiian)*
God of war, strength, human aggression; patron of the haka. God of war and directed human power.
How to honor: *Tu/Ku is invoked before battle, hunting, and competitive contests through karakia and the haka, functioning as both war dance and direct ritual invocation of his strength; warriors traditionally sought his blessing before combat and performed whakanoa (tapu-lifting) rites afterward. In Hawaii, Ku was honored with heiau rites that in the pre-contact period included human and animal sacrifice at major state temples — a documented but discontinued historical practice.*

Tu/Tumatauenga (Maori master) — *Maori*
God of people and war ("Tu of the angry face"). Advocated killing the sacred parents; patron of haka's war dimension.
How to honor: *Tu/Tumatauenga (Maori master) is honored through haka performed before battle, sporting contests, and formal challenges (wero) issued to visitors at a marae, channeling his war-aspect in ritualized rather than literal combat. Warriors historically observed specific tapu (restrictions) and rites before and after fighting under his patronage, including purification rites on return from battle. Today he is invoked in military service, contact sports, and political struggle as the god who "advocated" decisive, sometimes costly action against the sacred parents.*

Tumatauenga — *Maori*
Atua of humanity and war (Maori form of Tu). God presiding over human affairs and conflict.
How to honor: *Haumiatiketike, atua of wild/uncultivated food, is honored by leaving the first-gathered fernroot (aruhe) or wild kai unconsumed as a token offering, and by reciting karakia before gathering bush foods. His domain is symbolically opposed to Rongo's cultivated crops; honoring today is expressed through respectful bush-food gathering protocol and retelling his flight from Tawhirimatea into Papatuanuku's embrace.*

Tyr/Tiw (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Norse)*
God of law, justice, and war; gives Tuesday its name. Norse equivalent of Mars, "Tiwesdaeg".
How to honor: *Tyr/Tiw (Planetary Days): Tyr sacrificed his hand binding the wolf Fenrir, making him the god oaths are sworn on — historically, formal oaths and legal proceedings (the Thing assembly) were placed under his protection, and breaking a Tyr-sworn oath was considered gravely dangerous. Modern Heathens invoke him via the Tiwaz rune (an upward arrow/spear shape) carved or drawn before oath-taking, dueling-sword or spear symbolism on the altar, and Tuesday devotion for matters of justice and courage. Cowardice or oath-breaking are his clearest taboos.*

Woden (Odin/Wotan/Guodan) — *Germanic Heathenry*
Chief continental/Anglo-Saxon deity; wisdom, war, ecstatic inspiration, the dead; leads the Wild Hunt. Chief god of wisdom, war, and the dead, ancestor of Anglo-Saxon kings.
How to honor: *Woden is honored through blót (sacrificial offering, especially before battle or for wisdom) of mead, ale, or blood, and through sumbel toasts raised in his name at ritual gatherings. Ravens and wolves are his sacred animals, self-sacrifice/ordeal imagery (his hanging*

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on the World Tree for the runes) inspires trance and rune-work practice, and Wednesday bears his name.

Love & Fertility

Deities of love, beauty, desire, marriage, and the generative powers of life.

Aengus Og — *Irish*
Youth, love, poetry. God of youth, romantic love, and poetic creative fire.
How to honor: *Aengus Óg has little attested cultic ritual — he survives mainly as a literary figure tied to Newgrange, which myth says he won from his father the Dagda by trickery. Where honored today it is through poetry, love charms, and offerings of apples or love tokens left at Newgrange/Brú na Bóinne, and by composing or reciting verse in his name; treat this as a literary-devotional practice rather than an attested ancient cult.*

Aphrodite — *Greek*
Goddess of love, beauty, desire; cosmic principle of erotic connection. Goddess of love and generative desire.
How to honor: *Aphrodite received offerings of doves, myrtle branches, roses, and sparrows at her shrines, notably on Cyprus (her mythic birthplace) and at Corinth, where her temple was famously associated with sacred prostitution in antiquity. The Aphrodisia festival involved ritual bathing of her cult statue and offerings tied to love, fertility, and beauty; devotees today in Hellenic reconstructionist practice still favor rose water, seashells, and honey cakes on her altars.*

Aradia — *Wicca*
One aspect/name of the Wiccan Goddess. A name the Goddess is known by.
How to honor: *Aradia is honored as an aspect of the Goddess with the "Charge of the Goddess" recited at rituals, offerings of wine, bread, and honey cakes, and altar items in silver/white (moon symbol, sickle, candles), timed to full moons/Esbats; note Leland's 1899 "Aradia, Gospel of the Witches" is contested folklore scholarship, so she shouldn't be conflated uncritically with a historical Italian witch-goddess figure.*

Bhaga — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
God of marital bliss, presides over Purva Phalguni nakshatra. Deity of pleasure, enjoyment, and the marriage bed.
How to honor: *Bhaga, presiding over Purva Phalguni nakshatra, is invoked chiefly within Vedic marriage rituals as one of the deities blessing conjugal happiness and prosperity — his name appears among the group of Adityas invoked during wedding mantras. There is no standalone temple tradition; devotion is expressed through his inclusion in marriage-blessing liturgy rather than independent worship.*

Cihuacoatl — *Aztec/Mexica*
Earth goddess of childbirth and midwives. "Serpent Woman," patroness of childbirth and women who died in labor.
How to honor: *Cihuacoatl, "Serpent Woman," was venerated especially through the temazcal (sweat lodge) associated with midwives, honored with amaranth (tzoalli) dough figures, copal incense, and simple food offerings. Women who died in childbirth (the Cihuateteo) were honored as fallen warriors and linked to crossroads haunted at night; modern respectful acknowledgment can include quiet crossroads offerings at dusk, while dismissing childbirth's sacred danger or disturbing Cihuateteo-associated sites was taboo.*

Dakini (category, incl. Vajrayogini, Tara) — *Tibetan Vajrayana*
Feminine principle of awakened energy, root of activity. Wild, energized feminine embodiments of enlightened activity and inspiration.
How to honor: *Dakini (category, incl. Vajrayogini, Tara) are honored through tsok (ganachakra) feast gatherings held on the 10th and especially the 25th lunar day ("Dakini Day"), when practitioners make food and drink offerings and dedicate merit collectively. Vajrayogini has her*

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own annual "Vajrayogini Day," and dakinis are approached through sadhana practice requiring empowerment, not casual offering — red and white ritual substances symbolizing her wisdom are standard on the shrine. Treating the practice lightly or without transmission is considered a serious breach.

Empress Menen Asfaw — *Rastafari*
Divine feminine companion to Jah's earthly manifestation, wife of Haile Selassie. Revered Empress representing the divine feminine within Rastafari theology.
How to honor: *Haile Selassie I is venerated through Nyahbinghi ceremonies — multi-day drumming, chanting, and reasoning gatherings ("grounations") held especially on his Coronation Day (November 2), birthday (July 23), and Ethiopian Christmas (Jan 7); his image is displayed in homes, and Ethiopian flag colors and the Lion of Judah symbol are worn as devotional emblems. Grounation Day (April 21) and pilgrimage to Shashamane, Ethiopia remain living devotional practice.*

Erato — *Greek (Muse)*
Muse of love/lyric poetry. Muse of desire-expressing language.
How to honor: *Erato, Muse of love and lyric poetry, was invoked specifically before composing erotic or romantic verse, asked to lend the poet persuasive, desire-charged language. She received the same communal honors as the other Muses — libations of milk and honey and garlands at Helicon and the Thespiae Museia — with no independent cult site of her own.*

Eros (primordial) — *Greek*
Primordial generative force of attraction/creation. Cosmic principle of love/attraction preceding creation.
How to honor: *The primordial Eros, distinct from Aphrodite's later winged son, had a genuine but localized cult at Thespiae in Boeotia, where he was honored as an ancient fertility/generative force with the Erotidia festival, including athletic and musical contests. Offerings there included flowers and garlands; outside Thespiae his worship was mostly philosophical/poetic rather than ritual, reflecting his role as the force that set cosmic generation in motion.*

Erzulie Freda — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Love, beauty, luxury, abundance. Beloved Lwa of love and beauty who weeps at ceremony's end.
How to honor: *Erzulie Freda is served with luxury and beauty: French perfume (especially Anais Anais), fine white/pink rum or champagne, sweets, pastries, jewelry, mirrors, lace, and fresh pink or white flowers, arranged on a pink-and-blue altar cloth. Devotees possessed by her weep with longing at the end of ceremonies, since she is never fully satisfied; she is syncretized with Mater Dolorosa and her day is Thursday. Taboo: coarse language, dirty settings, or cheap/ugly offerings offend her refined nature.*

Ezili Dantor (Erzulie Dantor) — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Fierce protective mother; patroness of single mothers and same-sex love between women. Scarred, fierce protective mother Lwa.
How to honor: *Ezili Dantor, the fierce single mother, receives unsweetened raw rum (kleren, sometimes with hot pepper), grilled pork, and black pigs historically (recalling the Bwa Kayiman ceremony that helped spark the Haitian Revolution); her altar bears a knife and the colors dark blue/red-and-blue. Syncretized with Our Lady of Częstochowa (the Black Madonna), she is petitioned by single mothers, abuse survivors, and women loving women. Taboo: she cannot speak clearly (only "de-de-de") so patience is required, and sweet, "pretty" offerings suited to Erzulie Freda are wrong for her.*

Fiafia — *Niue*
Primary female sacred figure; abundance and generative power. Niuean goddess of abundance and generative power.
How to honor: *Niuean mythology and its sources are sparse, and no documented historical offerings, altar practices, or festivals specific to Fiafia as a sacred fertility/abundance figure were*

found in available records. Given the lack of attestable devotional practice, the appropriate approach is respectful acknowledgment through oral storytelling and cultural remembrance of her as an abundance/generative figure within Niuean tradition, ideally learned from Niuean cultural sources rather than invented ritual.

Freya — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Goddess of love, magic, war, and the dead. Greatest magical practitioner among the gods, keeper of Folkvangr.
How to honor: *Freya's (Norse, general) signature devotional art is the practice of seidr (a form of prophetic/shamanic magic), and she is honored as receiver of half the battle-slain into Fólkvangr. Concretely, offerings of beer, honey, flowers, and amber were traditionally given, since her tears are said to turn to gold and amber; cats (who pull her chariot) are sacred to her, and the Brísingamen necklace is her defining symbol. Modern Heathens hold spring blót and seidr rites in her honor, and Friday is associated with her name in several Germanic languages.*

Frigg/Freya (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Norse)*
Goddess(es) of love; give Friday its name. Norse equivalent of Venus, "Frigedaeg".
How to honor: *Frigg/Freya (Planetary Days): Frigg is honored with milk, herbs, and distaff/spinning tools for marriage, motherhood, and home blessing; Freya is honored with mead, honey, amber, cat imagery, and gold for love, fertility, war, and seiðr, via a modern "blót for Freya." Devotees are advised to keep the two distinct in formal ritual despite folk conflation, since their domains (hearth-keeping versus fierce independent power) are treated as meaningfully different by careful practitioners.*

Hathor — *Kemet*
Love, beauty, music, dance, joy. Goddess of love and joy who welcomes the dead with bread and water.
How to honor: *Hathor was honored at her great temple of Dendera through the "Festival of Drunkenness," mirror and sistrum offerings, music, and dance central to her cult, and the annual "Beautiful Reunion" festival in which her cult statue traveled by boat to Edfu to ritually reunite with Horus. As "Lady of Turquoise" she was honored by miners at Serabit el-Khadim in Sinai, and dream incubation for healing was practiced in her temples alongside offerings of turquoise and malachite.*

Heavenly Mother — *LDS/Mormon*
Wife of Heavenly Father, literal spiritual mother of all human souls. Divine feminine acknowledged in doctrine but institutionally silenced.
How to honor: *Heavenly Mother is officially acknowledged in LDS doctrine but members are explicitly instructed NOT to pray to her — leaders have discouraged and in some cases disciplined members for doing so, teaching that prayer is reserved for the Father alone. The only sanctioned "honoring" practice is quiet doctrinal acknowledgment that she exists as a divine parent; this institutional silence is itself a documented point of ongoing controversy within and outside the church.*

Hera — *Greek*
Queen of gods, sacred covenant, marriage. Goddess of marriage and covenant.
How to honor: *Hera was honored with offerings of pomegranates, cows (she was titled "ox-eyed," boōpis), peacocks, and lilies, and with the Heraia festival at both Argos and Olympia (the latter featuring footraces for unmarried girls). Marriage rites (gamos) formally invoked her blessing on unions, and she was believed to punish infidelity and broken marriage vows severely, as reflected in myths of her wrath toward Zeus's lovers.*

Inanna / Ishtar — *Mesopotamian*
Goddess of love, sexual desire, fertility, war, political authority, planet Venus. Most important, complete Mesopotamian deity, both erotic and martial.

How to honor: *Dumuzi/Tammuz's sister Geshtinanna is honored as "Lady of the Vine" with wine, grapes, beer, and grain offerings, appearing in the Dumuzi lament-cycle texts recited seasonally at his temples; her role sharing his underworld sentence half-and-half ties her worship to loyalty and self-sacrifice themes. Dates, wine, and jewelry were customary temple offerings for both siblings, presented by dedicated priestesses/temple attendants.*

Isis (Wicca) — *Wicca*

One aspect/name of the Wiccan Goddess. A name the Goddess is known by.

How to honor: *Isis (Wiccan/eclectic Pagan context) is honored with offerings of milk, wine, bread, lotus flowers, and blue lotus incense; altar symbols include the ankh, throne headdress, sistrum, and Isis knot (tyet). Modern devotional practice includes daily invocations and her ancient festivals — Navigium Isidis (Isis's ship, March) and Isia (October/November mourning-and-rejoicing cycle for Osiris). Taboo: avoid mixing her worship carelessly with unrelated pantheons without acknowledging her Kemetic origin.*

Juno — *Roman Religion*

Queen of gods, marriage, women; Capitoline Triad. Queen of the gods, protector of women and marriage.

How to honor: *Juno was honored on the Kalends (1st) of every month by all Roman women, and especially at her festival Matronalia (March 1), when married women received gifts from husbands and offered flowers, prayers, and sacrifice at her temples — many scholars call it "the original Mother's Day." Every Roman woman was believed to have her own personal "Juno," honored on her birthday with offerings of flowers, wine, and incense; Juno Lucina specifically was invoked during childbirth.*

Krishna — *Hinduism*

Divine love, wisdom, dharma, liberation. Playful, multidimensional avatar of Vishnu who reveals the Bhagavad Gita.

How to honor: *Krishna is honored through kirtan and bhajan — ecstatic call-and-response chanting of the Hare Krishna Mahamantra with drums (mridanga) and cymbals (karatalas) — plus Janmashtami (his midnight birthday festival) featuring dahi handi (breaking a curd pot) reenactments and cradle ceremonies for the infant Krishna murti. Offerings (bhog) of butter, milk sweets, and tulsi are standard, and Holi's color-throwing is tied to his playful līlā with Radha and the gopis in Vrindavan and Mathura, both major pilgrimage sites.*

Lada — *Slavic Paganism*

Goddess of love, beauty, spring, harmony. Goddess of love and harmony.

How to honor: *Lada is honored in modern Rodnovery as a goddess of love, spring, and harmony with offerings of flowers (especially birch branches and wildflowers), red ribbons, honey cakes, and songs/round dances (khorovod) performed in her honor; spring/early-summer rites and wedding blessings are dedicated to her. She's associated with spring festivals and wedding-song traditions, though scholarly debate exists over whether she was a genuine pre-Christian goddess or a folkloric personification. Approach with joy, music, and floral offerings.*

Lakshmi — *Hinduism*

Wealth, prosperity, abundance, good fortune. Goddess of prosperity and grace, eternally devoted to Vishnu.

How to honor: *Lakshmi is invited into the home for Diwali by cleaning the entire house top to bottom and lighting rows of oil lamps (diyas) along windowsills and doorways, since she is believed to enter only clean, well-lit homes and to avoid dirty or dark ones. Lotus flowers, kamal gatta (lotus seeds), and coins are placed on her altar with the mantra "Om Shreem Mahalakshmiyei Namaha"; arrogance, quarreling, and uncleanliness are said to actively drive her away, and Friday is considered her especially auspicious weekly day for puja.*

Marasa — *Vodou (Haiti)*

Divine twins; children, abundance, duality. Sacred twin Lwa of duality and abundance.

How to honor: *The Marasa (sacred twins, sometimes a triplet Dosou/Dosa) must always be served together and first among children-spirits, never divided or shorted; offerings are foods children love — candy, cookies, popcorn, small cakes, sweet syrup drinks, peanuts — set out in matched pairs of plates/bowls. Their feast falls near the Catholic Feast of Saints Cosmas and Damian; songs and games invoking childlike joy are used rather than solemn drumming. Taboo: serving one twin more than the other invites their anger, expressed as bad luck or illness.*

Milda — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Goddess of freely chosen love and courtship (distinct from familial/marital love). Governs eros and the freely given heart, as opposed to duty-bound family love.
How to honor: *Milda is associated with doves and is honored today via Milda Day (May 1, sometimes marked May 12 in some Baltic pagan circles), a modern Romuva/Baltic-revivalist observance of freely chosen love and courtship marked by flowers, songs, dancing, and small gifts exchanged between courting couples rather than family-sanctioned matchmaking. Offerings of flowers, honey cakes, or ribbons tied to trees are typical modern gestures.*

Ochún — *Lucumí*
Orisha of rivers, love, fertility, gold, sweetness of life. River goddess of love and abundance (syncretized with Our Lady of Charity, Cuba's patroness).
How to honor: *Ochún is honored with honey (tasted by the giver first, never offered untasted, to prove it isn't poisoned), pumpkins, oranges, cinnamon, and yellow or gold items — five is her sacred number, so offerings often come in fives. She receives offerings at a river's edge, particularly on her September 8 feast day (syncretized with Cuba's patroness, Our Lady of Charity/El Cobre), and dislikes bitterness, onions/garlic near her altar, and disrespect toward vanity or beauty, which she takes as her domain. Peacock feathers, mirrors, and fans are common shrine objects.*

Ogwugwu — *Igbo Odinani (Nigeria)*
Female deity associated with fertility and management of specific forest areas. Regional fertility/forest deity.
How to honor: *Ogwugwu is venerated at community forest shrines by priestesses/priests (dibia), who receive offerings of kola nut, palm wine, eggs, and white items on her behalf, particularly from women seeking fertility or protection in childbirth. Groves under her guardianship are treated as sacred/forbidden land — hunting, logging, or clearing them is a serious taboo believed to bring misfortune.*

Okuninushi no Mikoto — *Shinto*
Kami of relationships, marriage, agriculture, connecting living and dead. Destination deity for the annual gathering of all kami.
How to honor: *Okuninushi is honored above all at Izumo Taisha, where he receives Japan's most distinctive worship gesture — four claps instead of the usual two — reflecting his status as a marriage/relationship deity. Every year in the tenth lunar month (Kamiari-zuki, "month with gods" in Izumo), all of Japan's kami are believed to gather at Izumo Taisha under his hosting, marked by the Kamiari Festival. Pilgrims pray for marriage and good relationships, leaving standard shinsen offerings.*

Oshun — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Sweet water, love, beauty, abundance. Orisha of rivers, love, beauty, and sensuality.
How to honor: *Yemoja is offered watermelon, molasses, white and blue flowers, and duck, typically carried to the ocean or a river mouth and given to the water. Her colors are blue and white, her number 7, and she is approached as protective mother of waters and diaspora communities; offerings poured into the sea on her feast day (commonly celebrated around February 2 in Brazil's Iemanjá festival) are a major living practice.*

Oxum — *Candomblé/Umbanda*

Orixá of sweet waters, love, beauty, gold, abundance. Goddess of rivers, love, beauty and abundance.
How to honor: *Oxum, Orixá of sweet waters, love, and abundance, is honored with honey, yellow flowers, and a brass mirror or fan left at rivers or waterfalls, with ritual river baths sought for love and fertility blessings. Her devotees wear yellow or gold, her sacred number is five, and her feast day is often syncretized with Our Lady of Immaculate Conception (December 8th) in Brazilian tradition.*

Parvati — *Hinduism*
Divine motherhood, consort of Shiva. Divine Mother and consort of Shiva; formed Ganesha from turmeric paste.
How to honor: *Parvati is honored through fasting festivals for marital/familial well-being: Hartalika Teej and Gangaur (Rajasthan) involve women fasting, wearing green bangles and red/green clothing, and offering turmeric, vermillion (sindoor), and coconuts to her image. During Ganesh Chaturthi, clay Gauri idols are installed and worshipped alongside Ganesha with red flowers and sweets before immersion.*

Pomba-Gira — *Umbanda*
Female Exu energy, assertive feminine power. Transgressive feminine spirit who "gets things done".
How to honor: *Pomba-Gira is honored with an oferenda at a crossroads or doorway on Monday (her day) or Friday night — red or black candles, red roses (never white, which belong to Iemanjá), champagne or sweet red wine, cigarettes, perfume, and mirrors. Petitioned for love, seduction, protection of women, and revenge/justice through sung pontos, she is a taboo to dismiss as merely sexual — she demands to be honored as a fierce, autonomous feminine power.*

Radha — *Hinduism*
Divine longing/union with God. Krishna's divine beloved, symbolizing the soul's longing for God.
How to honor: *Radha is venerated through kirtan and bhajan singing in the madhura bhakti tradition (e.g., Mirabai's songs), and centrally at the Radha Raman and other Vrindavan/Barsana temples, where Krishna is worshipped only as her consort. Radhashtami (her birthday) is observed with fasting until noon, singing, and flower offerings, and Holi in Braj re-enacts the playful Radha-Krishna love story with colored powder and sticks (lathmar Holi).*

Riddhi — *Hinduism*
Prosperity (consort of Ganesha). Goddess of prosperity, one of Ganesha's two consorts.
How to honor: *Riddhi has no independent temples or festivals; she is honored strictly alongside Ganesha, depicted flanking his image (often with Siddhi) during Ganesh Chaturthi worship, and receives the same modak, durva grass, and red flower offerings given to him.*

Samsin Halmeoni (Birth Goddess) — *Korean Muism*
Presides over birth, children's health, fertility. Divine grandmother invoked for safe childbirth and infant health.
How to honor: *Samsin Halmeoni is honored with a samsin sang (birth-goddess offering table) set up in the home after a child's birth, typically holding plain white rice, seaweed soup (miyeokguk — the same dish given to the new mother), and a bowl of clean water; offerings are renewed at intervals (often around 7, 21, or 100 days) to protect mother and infant. Her honors culminate at Baek-il (100th-day) and Dol (first-birthday) celebrations. Taboo: a geumjul (straw rope hung with red peppers and charcoal) is strung across the gate to bar outsiders and evil influences during this period, and sharp objects or loud disturbances near the birth space are avoided.*

Shukra (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology*
Advisor of planetary court; love, beauty, pleasure. Venus deity, preceptor of the asuras.

How to honor: *Shukra is worshipped on Fridays with white flowers, white sandalwood, rice, sugar, curd, and diamond or white sapphire offerings, at his temple in Kanjanur; because he governs love, beauty, and pleasure, devotees particularly favor donating white items, perfumes, or clothing to women. Fasting or Lakshmi worship is also paired with Friday Shukra rites for prosperity and marital harmony.*

Shukra (Lakshmi, Devi) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Vedic)*
Venus deity; Lakshmi and Devi also honored. Vedic Venus deity ruling Shukravar (Friday).
How to honor: *Shukra (Lakshmi, Devi): Friday devotion centers on Lakshmi puja — offering lotus flowers, kheer (rice pudding), white or pink flowers, and lighting a ghee lamp before her image, with the home cleaned beforehand since she is said to avoid disorderly households. Silver items and perfumes are offered in Shukra's honor specifically, and beauty/self-care rituals (bathing, adornment) are treated as devotional acts on this day. Avoiding harsh speech and maintaining harmony in the home is considered essential to keeping her favor.*

The Goddess (Maiden/Mother/Crone) — *Wicca*
Great Mother; earth, ocean, moon phases. Wiccan triple goddess encompassing all goddesses (Aradia, Diana, Hecate, Isis, Brigid, Cerridwen).
How to honor: *Central Wiccan rites for the Goddess (Triple Goddess) are the Esbats (usually the Full Moon) where the coven's High Priestess undergoes "Drawing Down the Moon" — the High Priest ritually invokes the Goddess into her via set liturgy so she speaks/channels as the Goddess (often followed by Doreen Valiente's "Charge of the Goddess") — after which the group shares "cakes and ale" (a moon-shaped cake and wine/mead as communion). Her altar colors are silver/white/blue, with chalice, cauldron, and crescent-moon symbols, and offerings of milk, honey, wine, and round or moon-shaped cakes.*

Theotokos (Virgin Mary) — *Byzantine*
God-bearer, protector of Constantinople. Mother of Christ, declared Theotokos at Ephesus 431 CE; patron protector of Constantinople.
How to honor: *Theotokos (Virgin Mary) is venerated through the Akathist Hymn ("Unsleeping" hymn), sung standing in her honor, and through icon veneration — her most sacred icons (like the Hodegetria) were paraded in processions around Constantinople's walls during sieges as protection. Major feast days (Nativity of the Theotokos, Annunciation, Dormition/Assumption) involve fasting periods beforehand and all-night vigils. Believers light candles before her icon and offer written prayer petitions, especially for childbirth, protection, and intercession.*

Venus — *Roman Religion*
Love, beauty, divine ancestor of the Julian line. Goddess of love and Rome's divine ancestress.
How to honor: *Venus was honored at her festival Veneralia (April 1), when women bathed her cult statue, adorned it with fresh flowers (myrtle and roses were sacred to her), and offered incense. As mythic ancestress of the Julian line, Julius Caesar built the temple of Venus Genetrix — offerings of doves, roses, and myrtle wreaths were standard at her shrines.*

Venus (Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology*
Rules Taurus/Libra; love, beauty, pleasure, values. Planetary archetype of love, beauty, and harmony.
How to honor: *Venus is honored on Fridays with offerings of roses, apples, honey, sweet wine, chocolate, and seashells; altar colors are green, pink, and copper, with copper, rose quartz, or emerald as her stones and myrtle or rose incense. Love, beauty, and reconciliation workings are timed to her planetary hour; iron and onions (conflict-associated) are traditionally avoided as offerings, as is starting new relationship magic during her retrograde.*

Venus/Aphrodite (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Roman/Greek)*
Governs love, beauty, pleasure, the arts. Roman/Greek goddess of love, ruler of Friday.
How to honor: *Venus/Aphrodite (Planetary Days): Rome's Veneralia (April 1) had women ritually bathe her public statue and redress it with offerings of roses, myrtle, and mint — plants*

sacred to her — while incense and doves (her sacred bird) were also offered. Modern Friday practice keeps beauty and adornment rituals, shared meals with loved ones, and creative or artistic work as her preferred devotional acts. Neglect or crude/ugly surroundings on her day are traditionally considered displeasing to her.

Xochiquetzal (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Goddess of beauty, flowers, love, weaving, arts. Goddess of creative beauty and love.
How to honor: *Xochiquetzal was honored with fresh flowers (roses, cempasúchil marigolds), colorful feathers, copal incense, and mirrors or weaving tools on bright floral altars; her day sign was 1 Flower (Xóchitl). Her festivals included Atamalqualiztli (every 8 years, eating unsalted "water tamales" for 8 days) and Xochilhuitl (honoring weavers and craftspeople with rose garlands and incense), and devotees confessed transgressions at her temple; salted food during her fast and disrespect toward fidelity or craftwork were taboo.*

Xochiquetzal (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec*
Consort of Tlaloc; goddess of flowers/love disrupted by rival gods. Goddess of love and flowers whose disruption ended the Third Sun.
How to honor: *Aztec goddess of love, flowers, fertility, consort of Tlaloc — honor her with fresh flowers (roses, cempasúchil marigolds), colorful feathers, incense/copal, and mirrors or weaving tools on a bright floral altar; her day sign is 1 Flower (Xóchitl). Celebrated at Atamalqualiztli (every 8 years, eating unsalted "water tamales" for 8 days) and Xochilhuitl (1-Flower day honoring weavers/craftspeople) with rose garlands and incense; devotees confessed transgressions at her temple. Avoid salted/seasoned tamales during her fasting festival and disrespecting fidelity or craftwork.*

Zhusheng Niangniang — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Goddess of childbirth. Goddess invoked for safe childbirth.
How to honor: *Zhusheng Niangniang, goddess of childbirth, is honored with prayers and offerings at her temples throughout pregnancy, often alongside the bed deity Chuang Mu, with gifts of children's clothing or shoes presented in petition. After a safe delivery, thanks are given with red-dyed eggs, a widely attested Chinese custom marking successful childbirth.*

Agriculture & Harvest

Gods of the planted field — grain, maize, rice, and the yearly cycle of sowing and reaping.

Ceres — *Roman Religion*
Grain, agriculture, sacred law. Goddess of grain and agriculture.
How to honor: *Ceres was honored at Cerealia (April 12-19), Rome's major agricultural festival featuring chariot races where foxes with burning torches tied to their tails were released. White clothing was worn by her priestesses, and offerings of a suckling sow, first fruits, honey, milk, and wine were standard; as goddess of grain (giving us the word "cereal") she was central to plebeian religious life.*

Chicomecatl — *Aztec/Mexica*
Maize goddess. Goddess of maize/corn.
How to honor: *Chicomecoatl was honored with offerings of maize in all colors, chiles, beans, amaranth, and chia seeds, red-dyed cloth, and greenstone jewelry, and depicted holding double maize ears seated on seven serpents. Her primary festival, Huey Tozoztli, saw devotees present maize and other foodstuffs at her temple (Cinteopan) as "she who made all our food"; wasting maize or treating grain offerings casually was strictly taboo.*

Corn Mother / Corn Maiden — *Pueblo Peoples*
Divine being embodying corn; consumption of corn is sacred communion. Divine personification of corn as sacred sustainer.
How to honor: *Corn Mother/Corn Maiden is honored through a first-fruits restriction — newly harvested corn is not eaten by the community until ceremonies formally release it, offering the sacred beings first claim on the harvest. Corn itself (including cornmeal used in blessings and prayer-offerings) is treated as sacred communion rather than ordinary food, and wasting corn is taboo.*

Demeter — *Greek*
Goddess of harvest, grain, sacred law, nourishment and grief. Goddess of grain and the sacred bond of nourishment.
How to honor: *Demeter was central to the Eleusinian Mysteries at Eleusis, where initiates fasted, processed from Athens carrying torches, and broke their fast with kykeon, a barley-and-mint drink reenacting her own mourning ritual for Persephone. Women-only Thesmophoria festivals honored her with pig sacrifice (piglets thrown into pits and later retrieved as fertilizer for the fields), offerings of wheat sheaves, poppies, and pomegranates, and abstention from other activities during the festival days.*

Dewi Sri — *Balinese (Bali)*
Rice goddess honored at each stage of rice cycle. Goddess of rice and agricultural abundance.
How to honor: *Dewi Sri is honored at every stage of the rice cycle: farmers weave cili (stylized rice-stalk figures representing her) and hang them at home entrances, granaries, and rice barns during harvest, while subak (irrigation cooperative) temples hold ceremonies at planting, flowering, and harvest to thank her for abundance. Wasting rice or stepping carelessly over rice offerings is considered disrespectful to her presence.*

Dumuzi / Tammuz — *Mesopotamian*
Dying-and-rising shepherd husband of Inanna. Vegetation/shepherd god whose death/return marks seasonal cycle.
How to honor: *Dumuzi/Tammuz is honored seasonally through mourning: the Sumerian month Duzu (roughly June–July) was marked by women's ritual laments for his death, a practice so persistent it is referenced disapprovingly in Ezekiel 8:14 centuries later. As a shepherd god, appropriate offerings are dairy products — milk, butter, cheese — plus reed-pipe music evoking*

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pastoral life; the cycle pairs mourning his descent with later rejoicing at his return, observed together with his sister Geshtinanna's half of the underworld term.

Eight Vasus — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Cosmic beings of abundance, preside over Dhanishta nakshatra. Group of deities governing wealth and life's rhythm.
How to honor: *The Eight Vasus, elemental deities presiding over Dhanishta nakshatra (and, per the Mahabharata, fathers of Bhishma), are honored jointly through Ashtavasu homa and donations made in sets of eight (grains, cloths, coins) considered especially auspicious. Dhanishta's association with wealth and rhythm means musical instruments or drums are sometimes offered; charity performed in groups of eight is the distinguishing devotional act.*

Eostre (Ēostre) — *Germanic Heathenry (Anglo-Saxon)*
Goddess of the month of April; spring, dawn. Anglo-Saxon dawn/spring goddess, namesake of Easter.
How to honor: *Eostre is attested only by Bede, who records that feasts were held in her honor during the month Ēosturmōnaþ (April) — no ritual detail survives beyond this. Modern Heathen and Pagan practice (largely reconstructionist) honors her at spring with eggs, hares, and spring flowers at dawn rites near the vernal equinox, acknowledging this owes more to later custom than attested antiquity.*

Freyr — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
God of abundance, sunshine, rain, fertility. Vanir god of fertility, identified with rune Ingwaz.
How to honor: *Freyr is honored with offerings of grain, bread, beer/mead, pork (boar is his sacred animal), honey, and fresh fruit or flowers placed on a wooden altar with phallic symbols, a boar figure, or a small ship model. Named modern/historical rites include Freysblot (autumn/harvest blot) and Freyfaxi (August 1, tied to first harvest and horses); historically he received the great Yule/midwinter blót at Uppsala. Best honored outdoors or in fields at sunrise/harvest time; avoid violent imagery or blood sacrifice reenactment, as he favors peace, fertility, and abundance.*

Geshtinanna — *Mesopotamian*
Dumuzi's sister who shares his underworld sentence half-and-half. Goddess linked to seasonal agricultural death-rebirth cycle.
How to honor: *Honored historically as "Lady of the Vine," a grape/wine and dream-interpretation goddess associated with Nippur; devotees offered wine, grapes, beer, and grain, and she features in the Dumuzi lament-cycle texts recited seasonally. Modern Mesopotamian reconstructionists set an altar with a wine cup, grape clusters, and a written or spoken record of a dream (dream incubation/journaling) since she was known as an interpreter of dreams. She shares mourning-and-rejoicing themes with her brother Dumuzi, so offerings are often paired with acts of loyalty/self-sacrifice for loved ones.*

Haumia-Tiketike — *Maori*
God of wild/uncultivated food (fern root, berries). God of everything that grows wild.
How to honor: *Haumia-tiketike is honored through gathering-season karakia recited before harvesting aruhe (fern root) and other wild foods, acknowledging him as the source of sustenance that grows untended. As Rongo's brother and fellow peace deity (Haumia is said to have "hidden" in Papatūānuku, like fern root's underground rhizome, when Tū attacked), he is honored by respectful, non-wasteful gathering rather than shrine offerings; wild-food abundance itself was read as a sign of his favor.*

Haumiatiketike — *Maori*
God of uncultivated/wild food. Atua of wild-growing food plants.
How to honor: *Ruaumoko, still unborn in Papatuanuku's womb and responsible for earthquakes, is honored through karakia recited during tremors and geothermal activity, and*

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through respectful behavior at geothermal sites. Offerings are symbolic — stones placed in acknowledgment, silence, and haka or waiata referencing him at marae.

Hemis Kachina — *Hopi*
Dignified Kachina representing summer's maturity, clouds/rain/corn. Beloved Kachina central to the Niman (Home Dance) farewell ceremony.
How to honor: *Soyal Kachina is welcomed at the Soyal ceremony marking the winter solstice, when pahos (prayer sticks made of feathers and cotton string) are prepared and placed at shrines and field edges to mark the sun's turning and the reopening of the ceremonial year; kiva rites and all-night ceremonies accompany his return.*

Inari — *Shinto*
Kami of rice, agriculture, foxes, industry, worldly success, swordsmanship. Widely worshipped agricultural/prosperity kami; fox as sacred messenger.
How to honor: *Inari is honored at roughly 32,000 shrines (head shrine Fushimi Inari Taisha in Kyoto) mainly through inari-zushi — sushi rice wrapped in sweet fried tofu pouches (aburaage) — because foxes, Inari's messengers, are believed to favor fried tofu; worshippers also leave whole aburaage directly at fox statues. Devotees donate vermilion torii gates as thanks for answered prayers, along with rice, sake, and seasonal produce for agricultural/business prosperity. The main festival is Hatsuuma (first Horse day of February); red is the sacred color, and disrespecting fox statues/messengers is ill-omened.*

Jarilo — *Slavic Paganism*
Spring god of new growth and fertility. Dies and is reborn annually, death/resurrection deity.
How to honor: *Jarilo is honored through his own mock funeral: a straw effigy of Jarilo, often carved with exaggerated fertility symbolism, was paraded through the village in a procession of mourning-parody, then ceremonially "killed," torn apart, or buried near the fields around midsummer — enacting his death so that fertility could pass into the crops. Celebrants traditionally wore white, and the rite is closely tied to (sometimes merged with) Kupala Night observances; the "funeral" was performed with real lamentation alongside festive licentiousness, marking the turn from spring growth to summer's fullness.*

Lono — *Polynesian (Hawaii)*
Agriculture, fertility, rain, the makahiki season. Hawaiian god of agricultural renewal and peace.
How to honor: *Lono was honored through the four-month Makahiki season: an image of him was carried clockwise around each island collecting tribute of pigs, sweet potatoes, and fine mats, while war was placed under kapu and boxing, wrestling, and canoe-race competitions were held. Offerings of pork, produce, and fish were presented as his image passed, marking the harvest/peace festival as his primary living rite.*

Lono (Hawaiian) — *Hawaiian*
God of agriculture, rain, fertility, peace; governs the Makahiki season. God of rain, harvest, and seasonal peace.
How to honor: *Lono is honored through the Makahiki, a roughly four-month festival beginning around October/November (rising of the Pleiades) during which warfare and heavy labor were forbidden, tribute (hoʻokupu) of food and goods was collected for chiefs and priests, and communities held konane, holua sledding, boxing, and wrestling competitions in his name. His physical symbol — a long wooden staff crossed with a shorter piece and draped in white kapa cloth and feather lei — was carried in procession clockwise around each island; offerings of pork, poi, and awa marked the festival's close before war-god Ku's season resumed.*

Manoomin (spirit-being) — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*
Wild rice as a sacred gift-being with its own spirit. Sacred wild rice plant-being central to Anishinaabe identity and sustenance.
How to honor: *Ziigwan, the spirit of spring thaw who loosens the maple sap, is acknowledged with prayers and songs at the start of sugaring season, including a tobacco offering placed at the*

first tapped tree in thanks before sap collection begins, marking the seasonal opening of sugar bush activity as a small first-fruits-style ceremony.

Mikail (Michael) — *Islam*
Angel who oversees nature and provision. Angel overseeing natural order and sustenance.
How to honor: *Angel overseeing rain, provision, and the natural order in Islamic tradition; not directly propitiated or given offerings, since only God is worshipped, but acknowledged in supplications (dua) for sustenance (rizq) and in folk tradition around rainfall as a sign of his stewardship. Honoring him consists of affirming belief in the angels as required by faith, not ritual practice directed at him personally.*

One Hunahpu — *Maya (Popol Vuh)*
Father of the Hero Twins; maize god killed in Xibalba. Maize god father of the Hero Twins, killed by the underworld lords.
How to honor: *Maize god (Hun Hunahpu), father of the Hero Twins, killed in Xibalba and reborn as living maize — one of the best-attested Maya cults, with art showing him with an elongated, corn-cob-shaped head. Honored with offerings of maize, tamales, cacao, and jade, and through documented planting-season and first-fruits rites (blessing the milpa, offering the season's first corn) that mirror his death-and-rebirth myth; green and yellow are his colors.*

Pitao Cozobi — *Zapotec*
God of ripe maize. Sustainer deity of the corn crop.
How to honor: *Pitao Cozobi, depicted on funerary urns as the sustainer of the corn crop, received offerings at the beginning and end of the agricultural cycle and especially at the first appearance of new corn — a first-fruits observance ensuring the harvest's continuation. Effigy vessels in his likeness were placed in tombs and temples as part of agricultural ritual.*

Ro'o (Rongo, Society Islands) — *Society/Cook Islands*
God of agriculture, cultivated plants, rain, peace. God of cultivated food and peaceful harvest season.
How to honor: *Ro'o/Rongo was honored with first-fruit offerings of taro and breadfruit at planting and again at harvest — it was taboo to eat a new crop before this ritual offering was made. In the Cook Islands and Society Islands he was strongly linked to peace, and conflicts were traditionally suspended during his agricultural rites, which included drumming and set chants performed at dedicated marae.*

Rongo (Cook Islands form) — *Cook Islands*
God of cultivated food, especially taro, and peace. Cook Islands god of agriculture and peaceful cultivation.
How to honor: *Rongo, a principal ancestral god especially on Mangaia (Cook Islands), was honored with taro and other first-fruits offerings presented at marae before planting and after harvest, reflecting his role as god of cultivated food and peace. He was also associated with peace-making — disputes and inter-tribal wars were traditionally ended through rites invoking Rongo. Modern Cook Islands practice keeps this alive mainly through harvest festivals and first-fruits customs rather than a standing cult.*

Rongo (Rongo-ma-Tane) — *Maori*
God of peace, kumara, and cultivated food. God of cultivated crops and patience/peace.
How to honor: *Rongo is honored through first-fruits ritual: the season's first kūmara harvested was ceremonially offered/consumed before the general crop, with karakia recited at each stage of the kūmara cycle — clearing the rua kūmara (storage pits), planting, and harvest — led by the tohunga whakato (planting priest). As god of peace as well as cultivated food, Rongo was also invoked in formal peace-making rites between warring groups, where laying down weapons under his name ended hostilities; disrespecting cultivated food (wasting kūmara) was considered an affront to him.*

Rongo / Lono — *Polynesian (Maori/Hawaiian)*
God of peace, agriculture, harvest, fertility. Counterpart to Tu, governing cultivated plants and social harmony.
How to honor: *Rongo/Lono is honored above all through the Makahiki, a roughly four-month Hawaiian harvest festival during which war and heavy labor were forbidden, tribute in food and goods was collected as his image was carried in procession around each island, and communities held sport, dance, and feasting. First-fruits offerings of the harvest were set aside for him before the community's own consumption.*

Selu — *Cherokee*
Corn Mother, self-sacrifice gives corn to the people. Corn Mother whose body became corn.
How to honor: *Selu, the Cherokee Corn Mother whose body became corn through self-sacrifice, is honored at the Green Corn Ceremony (Itse Selu) in late summer, where the first corn of the harvest is offered to her before anyone eats the new crop. Corn is treated as sacred reciprocity — never wasted or stepped over — and her self-sacrifice story is retold to children specifically to instill gratitude and right relationship with food.*

Tailtiu — *Irish*
Foster mother of Lugh, died clearing forests for agriculture. Semi-divine figure whose death for the land is the origin story of the harvest festival.
How to honor: *Tailtiu is honored through the Óenach Tailteann (Tailteann Games) her foster-son Lugh founded at Teltown, Co. Meath in her memory, held around Lughnasadh with athletics, horse-racing, and "Teltown marriages" (trial handfastings performed through a holed door). Gratitude for the harvest — she is said to have died clearing the land for agriculture — is the core devotional act, expressed through sharing the first grain.*

The Horned God/Green Man — *Wicca*
Solar/agricultural god, born-dies-reborn with the year. Wiccan god who sacrifices himself for the harvest each year.
How to honor: *The Horned God is honored across the eight Sabbats of the Wheel of the Year tracking his life-death-rebirth arc: reborn at Yule (Dec 21) with evergreens, holly, candles, and a Yule log; strengthens through Imbolc and Ostara; weds the Goddess at Beltane (May 1) with maypole and bonfire rites; peaks at Litha (Summer Solstice); is ritually "sacrificed" as the harvest at Lughnasadh/Lammas (Aug 1) with bread, corn dollies, and first-harvest offerings; and dies at Samhain (Oct 31), Wicca's most solemn Sabbat, becoming Lord of the underworld. Altar colors are green, brown, gold, and red; offerings/symbols include antlers, oak leaves, wine, bread, and grain.*

Toyouke — *Shinto*
Kami of food and agriculture, enshrined at Ise's outer shrine (Geku). Food/agriculture kami paired with the sun goddess.
How to honor: *Toyouke-Omikami is enshrined at Ise Jingu's outer shrine (Geku) as the deity who prepares sacred food (mikeshinsen) for Amaterasu — she receives daily food offerings twice a day, unbroken for over 1,500 years. The major annual rite is Kanname-sai (mid-October), when the year's rice harvest is ceremonially offered first to her and then relayed to Amaterasu; standard shinsen is prepared in Ise's own sacred kitchen using fire kindled by ancient friction methods.*

Toyouke (Shingon) — *Shingon*
Food kami of the Ise outer shrine. Shinto food/harvest kami syncretized with Dainichi's compassion aspect.
How to honor: *Kariba, Niutsuhime's son, is honored jointly with his mother at Niutsuhime Shrine as the hunting deity whose dogs are said to have led Kukai to the sacred site; he receives the same rice/sake shrine offerings as part of the combined mother-son cult.*

Vesna — *Czech (Slavic) folk tradition*

Spring counterpart to Morana. Goddess/spirit of spring's return.
How to honor: *Vesna, spring's counterpart to Morana, is welcomed by carrying a decorated branch (lítečko/létečko, adorned with ribbons, painted eggshells, and ribbons) from house to house while singing spring songs, timed to coincide with Morana's expulsion — a paired ritual of driving out death/winter and ceremonially bringing in life/spring.*

Xipe Totec (Red Tezcatlipoca, East) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Flayed god of renewal. God of shedding old skin for new growth.
How to honor: *Xipe Totec's festival Tlacaxipehualiztli ("Flaying of Men," ~March) featured gladiatorial combat sacrifice followed by priests wearing the flayed skins of victims for 20 days as a fertility symbol of the earth shedding its old "skin" for new maize growth. His color was yellow, and offerings centered on maize seed for planting, since his flaying directly symbolized germination; the flayed-skin costume was never treated as macabre but as a sacred agricultural necessity.*

Xipe Totec (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec*
Flayed God; agricultural renewal, maize husk symbolism. God of agricultural renewal represented by a flayed human skin.
How to honor: *Honored at the festival of Tlacaxipehualiztli ("Flaying of Men," in early spring), when priests wore the flayed skins of sacrificed captives for twenty days as a ritual reenactment of a seed shedding its husk, symbolizing agricultural renewal and the earth's springtime "new skin." Offerings included maize, seeds, and gladiator-style ritual combat (the "flowery war" duels) dedicated to him; his imagery (a figure wearing a second, flayed skin) marks him as patron of goldsmiths and springtime planting. Approach with respect for the festival's symbolism of renewal through sacrifice rather than literal reenactment today.*

Hearth & Household Gods

The gods of the home itself, organized room by room — the spirits who inhabit and protect the domestic world.

The Hearth / Fireplace

Ape-huci Kamuy (Fire Grandmother) — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Female fire kamuy of the hearth; intermediary carrying prayers to other kamuy. Most important female deity, the living presence of every hearth fire.
How to honor: *Ape-huci Kamuy, the hearth fire grandmother, is honored constantly through household discipline: the fire is never insulted, stepped over, spat into, or carelessly extinguished, and she is addressed first in the prayer sequence of every Ainu ceremony as the intermediary who carries human words to the other kamuy. Daily offerings of the first portion of food or drink are given to the hearth fire before anyone eats, and inau are placed near the hearth on ceremonial occasions.*

Atsila (Sacred Fire / "Ancient Red Woman") — *Cherokee*
Undying communal sacred fire, addressed as a relative. Living fire-being at the center of Cherokee community life.
How to honor: *Atsila, the undying Sacred Fire addressed as "Ancient Red" and treated as a living relative, is honored with tobacco cast into the flames, unbroken vigilance so the fire never goes out, and the annual New Fire renewal performed at Green Corn Ceremony. Coals from the ceremonial fire were historically carried home to relight household hearths; spitting into or otherwise disrespecting the fire is strongly taboo.*

Gabija — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Spirit of the sacred hearth fire. Household hearth-fire spirit central to home sacred life.
How to honor: *Gabija is honored as a living household presence: hearths were fed bread and salt, never spat into or insulted, and embers were carefully banked with ash each night rather than doused with water (dousing fire was taboo — water and fire were seen as enemies). At Rasos/Kupolė (Midsummer), bonfires are lit and jumped as a purifying rite still practiced by modern Romuva communities, and moving to a new home traditionally involved ritually carrying coals from the old hearth-fire to the new one.*

Sacred Fire (Caddo) — *Caddo*
Central sacred fire mediating human-divine relationship. Perpetually maintained fire at community/caddi's house center.
How to honor: *The Caddo sacred fire, kept perpetually burning at the center of the community or caddi's house, is tended by designated keepers under strict protocols — approached from a proper direction, fed specific woods, never allowed to die out — and prayers of gratitude and tobacco are offered into the flames, its smoke understood to carry petitions to the sky world.*

Vesta — *Roman Religion*
Sacred hearth fire, home, civic purity. Goddess embodied as the sacred hearth fire itself.
How to honor: *Vesta was honored through her sacred flame, tended perpetually by six Vestal Virgins sworn to 30 years of chastity — extinguishing it required purification. Every Roman household kept its own hearth fire as a domestic extension of her cult, offering daily food (particularly "mola salsa," a salted flour cake) into the flame; her public festival, the Vestalia (June 7-15), opened her inner sanctum to Roman matrons who brought food offerings barefoot.*

The Kitchen

Jowangshin — *Korean Muism*
Spirit of the kitchen hearth. Domestic hearth spirit personifying the kitchen.

How to honor: *Jowangshin is honored daily in a very concrete, still-living way: a bowl of clean, fresh water (jeongan-su) is placed on the kitchen ledge or stove each morning, sometimes with a short prayer for family welfare. The hearth fire is traditionally never allowed to go out, the kitchen must be kept clean and free of quarreling or foul language, and a Jowang-gut is held when moving into a new home or after a period of family misfortune tied to the hearth.*

The Doorway / Threshold

Munjang Shin (Door God) — *Korean Muism*
Spirit of the household threshold/doorway. Guardian spirit of the home's entrance.
How to honor: *Munjang Shin, guardian of the threshold, is honored with small offerings — rice, salt, or a bowl of water — left just inside or at the doorway, especially during New Year and household gut (Seongju Gut) cycles meant to bless the whole home. A straw rope (geumjul) hung across the doorway after a birth or during ritual periods signals protection and marks the threshold as sacred, reflecting Munjang Shin's role in keeping harmful spirits from crossing in.*

The Storehouse / Pantry

Penates — *Roman Religion*
Guardians of the household food supply. Gods of the inner household storehouse.
How to honor: *The Penates, guardians of the household's food storeroom, were honored alongside the Lares at the same domestic shrine with shared offerings of food, wine, and incense — the phrase "hearth and Penates" became a stock Roman expression for "home." Public Penates of the state were maintained at a shrine on the Velian Hill, believed brought from Troy by Aeneas.*

The Spinning / Weaving Room

Frau Holle (Holda) — *Germanic Heathenry (Continental folk)*
Winter goddess; guardian of spinning, weather-maker, guide of dead infants. Gentle winter goddess who rewards industrious households and guides unbaptized dead.
How to honor: *Frau Holle is honored by finishing all household spinning before the close of the Twelve Nights (Yule to Epiphany) — unfinished flax left on the distaff invites her punishment (soiling it or worse), while diligence is rewarded, in folk tales, with gold. Leaving out simple foods like pancakes or dumplings and observing quiet, orderly conduct during the Rauhnächte (the "rough nights") are traditional Alpine/German customs still referenced today.*

Kikimora — *Slavic Paganism*
Female spirit of spinning and weaving. Ambivalent household spirit, benevolent or malevolent.
How to honor: *Kikimora's treatment depends on how she "entered" the household — if she arose from a builder's curse or bad foundation, remedies included blessed items or juniper/bear-fur charms placed at the threshold to counter her. A specific taboo: unfinished spinning must never be left on the distaff or wheel overnight, since she is said to tangle or ruin thread left out after dark; putting wool and spinning tools properly away each evening is the practical way to avoid provoking her mischief.*

The Sauna / Bathhouse

Saunatonttu — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Sauna spirit guardian. Guardian spirit whose cooperation enables sauna's sacred properties.
How to honor: *The sauna spirit (Saunatonttu) is greeted with respectful words on entering the sauna ("Saunan lämpimikset," roughly "sauna's warmth-blessings") and thanked before leaving; the sauna is treated as sacred space ("as holy as a church" in Finnish folk sayings), with loud arguing, swearing, or bad behavior forbidden as offensive to the tonttu. Small courtesies serve*

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as offerings — leaving warm water on the bench, throwing löyly (steam) onto the stove respectfully rather than carelessly, and not being the last person to leave without a parting word. Taboo: mocking or ignoring the spirit was believed to bring illness or bad luck to the household.

The Yard & Outbuildings

Dvorovoi — *Slavic Paganism*
Spirit governing the yard and outbuildings. Guardian spirit of the yard.
How to honor: *Dvorovoi received offerings of bread and grain traditionally left in a yard corner or barn, particularly around St. Yuri's Day (spring livestock blessing), to keep him well-disposed toward the household's animals. A distinctive practice: livestock color mattered to him — a horse's mane found tangled or an animal falling ill was blamed on the dvorovoi disliking that animal's coloring, so owners would sometimes divine or swap an animal's color to match his preference and restore peaceful coexistence in the yard.*

General Household Protection

Bastet (Bast) — *Kemet*
Protection, joy, home, fertility, cats. Cat-headed goddess of home protection, joy, music, and dance.
How to honor: *Bastet was honored at her cult center of Bubastis with what Herodotus described as ancient Egypt's largest annual festival — mass pilgrimage involving music, dancing, and wine drunk in vast quantities. Cats were mummified by the hundreds of thousands as votive offerings (cat cemeteries excavated at Bubastis and Saqqara), and killing a cat, even by accident, could carry severe legal consequences; offerings of milk, perfume, and sistrum music also honored her.*

General Household

Asibikaashi (Spider Woman) — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*
Protector of children, origin of the dream catcher. Spiritual protector who watches over sleeping children via woven webs.
How to honor: *Wiindigoo is not honored with offerings at all — he functions as a warning figure representing self-consuming greed and winter starvation, and the correct response is avoidance through right living: sharing food generously, practicing reciprocity, and never taking more than one's share, especially during scarce winter months. Stories of the Wiindigoo are told to reinforce these communal survival ethics.*

Brigid (Scottish) — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Spring goddess who receives power from the Cailleach at Imbolc. Goddess of spring, fire, and healing; later syncretized as St. Brigid.
How to honor: *Brigid is welcomed each Là Fhèill Brìghde (February 1/Imbolc) through the Brideog rite: a corn-husk or straw effigy of her is dressed and carried house to house or set in a specially prepared "bed" by the hearth, alongside a phallic wand (the slat Bríde or crann Bríde) laid in the ashes overnight — a mark left in the ashes by morning signals she has blessed the home. Offerings of bannocks, butter, and cream are left out, and rush or straw Brigid's crosses are woven and hung over doorways for protection through the year.*

Domovoi — *Slavic Paganism*
Master of the house, founding-ancestor spirit. Household guardian spirit living behind the hearth.
How to honor: *Domovoi is honored with bread and salt left out (often on the stove or threshold) as his standard offering, with quiet nightly acknowledgment ("Domovoi, domovoi, watch the*

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house") before bed; whistling indoors is taboo as it's believed to anger or drive him out. When a family moved house, tradition called for inviting him along — carrying an old shoe, bast shoe, or bit of the old hearth's ash to the new home and formally asking him to come, since a home without its domovoi was considered unprotected.

Frau Perchta (Berchta) — *Germanic Heathenry (Alpine folk)*
Fierce winter goddess inspecting homes during Twelve Nights. Fierce Alpine winter goddess who punishes household idleness.
How to honor: *Frau Perchta is honored by keeping the home orderly and spinning finished by her inspection night, traditionally Epiphany Eve (January 5), and by eating a prescribed meal of gruel/porridge and fish (herring) — folklore holds she slits the bellies of those who eat richer fare and stuffs them with straw. Masked Perchtenlauf processions (with "beautiful" Schön-Perchten and "ugly" Schiach-Perchten) are still performed today in Austria/Bavaria/Alpine regions to drive out winter.*

Frig / Frija — *Germanic Heathenry*
Female divine paired with Woden; household and marriage. Wife of Woden, goddess of household, marriage, and healing speech.
How to honor: *Frig/Frija is invoked in the Second Merseburg Charm (alongside Wodan) for healing, reflecting her association with beneficent, healing speech and household welfare. As goddess of marriage and domestic management, spinning tools and the distaff are symbolically hers, hearth offerings are traditional, and Friday bears her name.*

Lares — *Roman Religion*
Deified household ancestor-protectors. Ancestral spirits protecting the household.
How to honor: *The Lares were honored daily at the household lararium with incense, wine, flowers, and food offerings, especially on the Kalends, Nones, and Ides of each month. Crossroads Lares received public celebration at the Compitalia festival, where woolen dolls (one per free household member) and balls (one per slave) were hung at crossroad shrines as substitute offerings.*

Seongju (Household Spirit) — *Korean Muism (Shamanism)*
Spirit residing in the main post of the house. Most intimate household guardian spirit, honored constantly in daily life.
How to honor: *Seongju is welcomed into a new or newly built home through the Seongjuppuri rite, in which a mudang or household elder places rice cakes and alcohol at the main house post/beam and invites the spirit to settle there; a paper strip, gourd, or bag of rice is sometimes hung on the central pillar as his physical seat. Daily reverence is simple — quiet, respectful conduct in the home — but major life events (moving house, building, marriage) call for renewed offerings to keep him content.*

Skřítek (Šotek/hospodáříček) — *Czech folk tradition*
Household spirit tending livestock/stores. Little house-guardian spirit, often appears as a house-snake.
How to honor: *Skřítek (also called šotek or hospodáříček), the household spirit tending livestock and stores, was kept content with a bowl of milk or porridge left out on Thursdays and on Christmas Eve, alongside a tidy, well-run household. He was believed to sometimes appear as a small house-snake, and killing a house snake was strictly taboo since it might be him bringing luck and protection to the home.*

The Modra / Matres/Matronae (the Mothers) — *Germanic Heathenry (Anglo-Saxon/Continental)*
Divine ancestral Mothers governing family/household fertility. Collective ancestral female divine beings governing household fertility.
How to honor: *The Mothers are honored at Mōdraniht ("Night of the Mothers"), recorded by Bede as falling on the eve later occupied by Christmas Eve — a night of feasting and offerings to*

female ancestral/tutelary spirits. Modern Heathens keep Mother Night as part of Yule, pouring libations and lighting candles in remembrance of female ancestors and the disir.

Zao Jun (Kitchen God) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Household moral monitor who reports to Jade Emperor annually. Kitchen god who inhabits the hearth and reports family conduct.
How to honor: *Zao Jun, the Kitchen God who inhabits the hearth, is honored on the 23rd or 24th day of the twelfth lunar month, just before his annual ascent to report to the Jade Emperor, with sticky rice cake and honey smeared on his paper image's lips — meant literally to sweeten or seal his report on the family's conduct. The old image is then burned and sent off with firecrackers, to be replaced by a new one after New Year.*

Death, Underworld & Ancestors

Rulers of the dead, guides of souls, and the venerated ancestors who remain part of the living community.

Abatur — *Mandaean*
"Third Life," weighs souls in the scales of judgment. Divine being who judges souls after death.
How to honor: *Yushamin — no devotional cult, offering, or festival exists for him in historical or living Mandaean practice; he is a cosmological figure from the Ginza Rabba discussed as a cautionary emanation who overreached and was punished. The only appropriate acknowledgment is inclusion in study/recitation of the cosmological texts and respectful naming within the emanation hierarchy.*

Ala / Ani — *Igbo Odinani (Nigeria)*
Earth goddess; owns the living and the dead; enforcer of moral law. Most powerful actively worshipped Igbo deity, guardian of morality and the dead.
How to honor: *Ala/Ani is honored through burial in the earth as a sacred return to her body — proper burial rites are essential, and violations of her moral law (nso Ala, such as incest, murder, or suicide) require purification ceremonies to avoid polluting the land. Mbari houses — elaborate mud sculptural shrines built by a community over months and then deliberately left to decay back into the earth — are built specifically as offerings to her, and she is invoked at the start of major community rites as guardian of morality.*

Ameretat — *Zoroastrianism*
Immortality, undying life. Amesha Spenta of deathless life, corresponds to the plant kingdom.
How to honor: *Ameretat is honored on the Amardadgan feast (namesake day/month "Amordad"), with offerings of milk, fruit, and green plants, and through the planting/tending of trees and gardens as an act of devotion to undying life. Cutting living plants wastefully or letting cultivated land go to ruin is considered contrary to her domain.*

Amida Nyorai (Amitabha) — *Shingon*
Buddha of the Pure Land, other-power/salvation. Buddha of boundless compassion offering liberation through faith.
How to honor: *Kannon is honored with incense, flowers, and the Renge Gasho (lotus joined-hands) mudra at dedicated Kannon temples, and by pilgrims completing regional 33-temple Kannon pilgrimage circuits (such as the Saikoku pilgrimage) while reciting the Kannon Sutra at each stop, seeking her compassionate intervention.*

Ammit — *Kemet*
Devourer of hearts that fail the Weighing. Composite lion-hippo-crocodile being who consumes unjustified hearts (second death).
How to honor: *Ammit had no temples, priesthood, or offering cult in ancient Egypt — she appears only as a threat depicted in Book of the Dead vignettes of the Weighing of the Heart, devouring hearts that fail judgment (the "second death"). There is no attestable devotional practice toward her; the appropriate acknowledgment is the same one Egyptians used — living by Ma'at's principles to avoid her, not propitiation.*

Ancestor Spirits (Ari) — *Ari (Ethiopia, Omo Valley)*
Active participants in community life; resentment causes illness/infertility/crop failure. Deceased relatives whose ongoing needs must be honored through offerings.
How to honor: *Ari ancestor spirits are actively appeased through animal sacrifice — most commonly sheep, whose blood and meat are offered at family or clan shrines when misfortune (illness, infertility, crop failure) signals ancestral displeasure — accompanied by spoken prayers naming the offended ancestor and requesting reconciliation. Diviners read the intestines and*

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entrails of the sacrificed animal to diagnose which ancestor is aggrieved and why, a practice widely documented across Omotic-speaking Omo Valley groups including the Ari.

Ancestor Spirits / Holosa (ghosts) — *Asaro (Eastern Highlands, PNG)*
Spirits of the dead moving through the landscape. Ancestor ghosts genuinely feared/respected, engaged deliberately via ghost disguise tradition.
How to honor: *The Holosa (ancestor ghosts) of the Asaro are engaged through caution and ritualized encounter rather than worship: living people avoid known haunted places (old burial grounds, certain bush trails) especially after dark, and the famous Asaro "mudmen" tradition — performers covering themselves in pale river clay and wearing oversized bulbous clay masks — embodies these fearsome ghost-spirits in staged sing-sing performances that both represent and ritually manage the community's relationship with the dead. Speaking carelessly of the recently deceased or disturbing burial sites is taboo.*

Ancestors (Bobo Bwa) — *Bobo Bwa*
Transitioned dead who guard family/community. Active benevolent ancestral guardians of Wuro.
How to honor: *Bobo Bwa ancestors receive regular libations of millet beer and water plus kola nut and chicken offerings at household/lineage altars, especially before planting and during illness or crisis, when a diviner (using cowrie shells or similar) is consulted to learn which ancestor is owed attention. Neglecting these offerings or failing to consult ancestors before major family decisions is considered dangerous to household harmony.*

Ancestral/Graveyard Spirits — *Hoodoo (American South)*
Spirits of the dead accessed via graveyard dirt and grave petitions. Spirits of specific deceased individuals (e.g., lawyers, soldiers) whose graveyard dirt carries their specific power.
How to honor: *Permission must be asked at the grave before taking dirt, explaining the purpose and letting oneself be spirit-led to the right grave rather than choosing arbitrarily; payment is left at the head of the grave — traditionally a silver dime (once specifically a Mercury dime), or coins, whiskey, or flowers — and the resulting hole is covered back up. Grave dirt is matched to the deceased's known profession or cause of death (a lawyer's grave for legal matters, a soldier's for courage/protection), and some traditions require leaving without looking back.*

Arawn — *Welsh (Mabinogion)*
King of Annwn (Welsh Otherworld); noble ally rather than death-fear figure. Fair, noble king of the Welsh Otherworld Annwn.
How to honor: *Arawn is honored in modern Celtic reconstructionist and Druidic practice chiefly through the virtues his myth demonstrates — oath-keeping, fair exchange, and hospitality, drawn from the tale of Pwyll, who swapped places with Arawn for a year and kept every term of the bargain exactly. Offerings include mead, game meat or venison, and bread, left with a spoken oath or promise kept as the real "offering." His hunt is led by the white, red-eared Cŵn Annwn, so hound imagery is used on altars; the appropriate time to honor him is Calan Gaeaf (Samhain), when the Otherworld draws near.*

Attis — *Roman Religion*
Dying-and-reborn consort of Cybele. Dying-and-resurrecting divine lover of Cybele.
How to honor: *On the Day of Blood (Dies Sanguinis, March 24) a pine tree representing Attis's death was cut, bound in wool, decked with violets, and carried in procession while Galli priests flagellated and sometimes castrated themselves before it. This was followed by Hilaria (March 25), a joyous festival celebrating Attis's resurrection with feasting and masquerade — devotion centered on this grief-to-joy cycle rather than daily shrine offerings.*

Aumakua — *Hawaiian*
Deified family ancestor guardian spirits, often manifesting as specific animals. Ancestral guardian spirits protecting specific families.
How to honor: *Aumakua are honored through recognition rather than formal offering: family members greet an encountered manifestation (shark, owl, gecko, hawk, or turtle depending on*

the family's lineage) with respect, avoid harming that species, and may leave small food offerings like poi or fish at a family shrine (kuahu) or burial site associated with the ancestor. Dreams featuring the aumakua are taken as direct communication and discussed within the family, and prayers (pule) invoking the aumakua's protection are offered before undertaking risky activities like fishing or travel.

Azrael (Malak al-Mawt) — *Islam*
Angel of death. Angel who takes the souls of the dying.
How to honor: *Angel of Death (Malak al-Mawt) who takes souls at the appointed time; Muslims do not propitiate him but accept his role with equanimity as divine decree, commonly reciting dua for "husn al-khatima" (a good, easy death) and remembrance of death (dhikr al-mawt) as a spiritual discipline. Fear of or offerings to him would constitute shirk; the correct devotional stance is submission to God's decree, not appeasement of the angel.*

Banshee (Bean Sidhe) — *Irish*
Mourning spirit announcing death via keening. Female spirit of the Sidhe whose wail foretells a family death.
How to honor: *The Banshee is not propitiated with offerings; she is honored by taking her keen seriously — historically, families bearing the wail (O'Neill, O'Brien, O'Grady, O'Connor and other old Gaelic lines) treated it as an unmistakable death-warning and began mourning preparations immediately rather than dismissing it. The correct response is solemn acknowledgment of grief, not fear or mockery.*

Baron Samedi — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Head of the Gede nation; master of death and healing. King of the dead who holds the keys to the cemetery.
How to honor: *Met Kalfou, the fierce nocturnal Petwo counterpart to Papa Legba, is served black rum, black coffee, and black roosters or goats at literal crossroads after dark; his altar uses black and red cloth, and he is invoked for protection, breaking curses, or aggressive magical work. Only experienced initiates approach him directly, since careless handling of Petwo-side crossroads work is considered dangerous and can backfire on the practitioner.*

Bean-Nighe — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Washerwoman spirit seen at fords washing bloodstained shrouds, omen of death. Death-omen spirit, doomed to wash death-shrouds until her natural lifespan would have ended.
How to honor: *The Bean-Nighe is approached with extreme caution: those who encounter her washing bloodstained shrouds at a ford are advised to get between her and the water before she sees them, at which point folklore says she must grant three wishes or answer three questions, but approaching from the wrong direction or startling her invites harm. Hearing her keening cry, like that of the related caoineag, is itself treated as an omen requiring the household to prepare for a death.*

Camazotz — *Maya (Popol Vuh)*
Giant bat god of the Bat House trial who decapitates Hunahpu. Monstrous bat god of Xibalba's most dangerous trial house.
How to honor: *Giant bat-god of death ruling Xibalba's Bat House (Zotzi Ha) in the Popol Vuh; archaeological bat-god imagery (e.g., Zapotec and Maya bat-deity iconography) indicates genuine cultic reverence tied to caves, night, and death. Historic appeasement involved cave ritual, copal incense, and blood offerings in dark subterranean settings, with bats treated as sacred/dangerous underworld emissaries; entering caves or bat roosts without ritual protection was considered spiritually perilous, and he is best honored today through respectful storytelling of the Bat House trial.*

Chindi — *Navajo/Dine*
Disharmonious element of a deceased person's spirit remaining near body/death site. Dangerous ghost/spirit requiring avoidance protocols.

How to honor: *Chindi (the residual dark energy left by death) is avoided rather than honored: the body is traditionally removed through a wall opening rather than the door, immediate burial follows, the deceased's name is not spoken, and the death hogan or site is avoided or destroyed. Correct handling of death itself is the practice, not devotion to the chindi.*

City God (Cheng Huang Ye) — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Guardian of the living community, judge of the newly dead. Deified local official who judges souls after death.
How to honor: *The City God (Cheng Huang Ye), guardian and judge of the local community, receives offerings and petitions at his temple, and newly appointed officials historically visited first to pledge fair governance before him. His festival features processions/parades carrying his image through the streets, and oaths in legal disputes were historically sworn before him because he was believed to see through lies.*

Coatlicue — *Aztec*
Serpent-skirted earth mother; life and death, birth and destruction. Earth goddess embodying the fierce unity of birth and death.
How to honor: *Approached with fear and awe rather than casual offering — her monumental serpent-skirted statue (unearthed in Mexico City in 1790) was reburied by colonial authorities because of the dread it provoked. Historical veneration centered on the cult of her son Huitzilopochtli and general earth/serpent symbolism rather than a personal shrine tradition of her own; offerings of copal incense and serpent imagery were customary. Modern Mexicayotl/Mexica-revivalist practitioners honor her at the equinoxes as an Earth Mother figure embodying the necessary unity of creation and destruction.*

Coatlicue (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Supreme earth goddess, mother of Huitzilopochtli. Serpent-skirted earth mother who devours the dead.
How to honor: *Coatlicue was venerated through Templo Mayor rites that reenacted her miraculous birth of Huitzilopochtli, with offerings of maize, serpentine/obsidian stones, and earth-toned objects; her monumental 1790 statue was so feared for its devouring imagery that colonial-era Mexicans reburied it shortly after excavation. Respectful modern acknowledgment favors soil, stone, and maize offerings placed directly on earth rather than any attempt at "cheerful" imagery, given her deliberately fearsome, awe-inducing nature.*

Cù-Sìth — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Massive fairy hound, harbinger of death. Silent green fairy hound whose third bark causes death by terror.
How to honor: *The Cù-Sìth is not appeased with offerings but survived by timing: those who hear its distinctive triple bark are told to reach shelter or cover their ears before the third bark, since that final cry is what causes death by fright. Highlanders traditionally avoided whistling alone at night, believed to risk summoning it, and kept dogs calm and quiet after dark near its known haunts.*

Deber — *Canaanite*
Force of pestilence, council member. Pestilence deity.
How to honor: *Deber has almost no independent cultic attestation, appearing mainly as a poetic personification of "pestilence" paired with Resheph (e.g., Habakkuk 3:5) rather than a distinctly worshipped god. Honest practice acknowledges him through remembrance within the plague-deity cluster, with modern reconstructionists folding apotropaic offerings (incense, red or black candles, bread at a threshold) into Resheph's rites rather than claiming a standalone temple or festival for Deber.*

Dewa Hyang / Pitara (Ancestor Gods) — *Balinese (Bali)*
Deified ancestors of family/community, achieved divine status through merit. Divinized ancestors who protect and sustain descendants.

How to honor: *The Dewa Hyang/Pitara (deified ancestors) are honored through the elaborate Balinese temple system itself — family, clan (dadia), and village temples are built specifically to house returning ancestral spirits — and especially through the paired festivals of Galungan (celebrating the ancestors' and dharma's temporary return and victory over adharma) and Kuningan (ten days later, marking their ascension back to heaven), when families set out yellow rice, penjor bamboo poles, and offerings to welcome and then send off ancestral spirits.*

Egungun (ancestors collectively) — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Masquerade embodiment of ancestral community. Ancestors made visible and physically present through sacred masquerade.
How to honor: *Ori is honored through the Ibori ("feeding the head") ceremony, performed at dawn: cool substances such as coconut water, efun (white chalk), and kola nut are poured or rubbed onto the crown of the head while praise chants are recited, and a white cloth is wrapped around the head afterward. This strengthens alignment with one's chosen destiny before major life undertakings or during crisis.*

Egungun (masked ancestor spirits) — *Ewe/Fon/Ogu*
Ancestors physically returning to community. Masked dancer understood as the literal embodied presence of an ancestor.
How to honor: *Egungun, the masked embodiment of returning ancestors, must never be touched or physically confronted by onlookers — especially women, for whom contact or unmasking is a severe taboo — and attendants carrying whips enforce distance from the crowd during processions. Devotees show reverence by bowing, making way, and offering small gifts of money or drink as the masquerade passes.*

Ereshkigal — *Mesopotamian*
Queen of the Underworld, Inanna's sister. Ruler of the Great Below who kills and later releases Inanna.
How to honor: *Ereshkigal is not approached with casual offerings but with formal, somber ritual — in Inanna's myth she is reached only by passing seven gated thresholds, surrendering a garment or ornament at each. Devotional acknowledgment mirrors this: dirges, lament, and stripped-down, unadorned approach rather than festive gifts; modern practitioners sometimes leave dark foods, pomegranate, myrrh, or black candles, always with a subdued, respectful tone rather than casual invocation.*

Erlig Khan — *Mongolian Shamanism*
Ruler of the Lower World/underworld. Underworld ruler governing ancestors and earth spirits.
How to honor: *Ruler of the Lower World governing the dead and ancestral/earth spirits; propitiated primarily around death and funerary ritual to ensure the safe passage of a departed soul, with offerings and rites conducted by a shaman rather than direct household devotion. Practices historically included careful funerary conduct (avoiding actions believed to anger underworld spirits, such as improper grave treatment) and offerings left at burial sites; living Tengerist/shamanic communities still incorporate invocations to underworld powers during death rites.*

Giltinė — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Goddess of death who extracts the soul at the moment of dying. Death goddess, sometimes Laima's sister, who closes the fate Laima opens.
How to honor: *Not demonized in either historical or revivalist framing — approached as necessary and completing rather than evil, the sister who closes what Laima opens. Folk custom personified her as a pale or skeletal woman with a long tongue or scythe-like implement who draws the soul from a dying person's mouth; households marked a death by covering mirrors, stopping clocks, and opening a window to let the soul pass — small courtesies extended to her passage rather than offerings to please her. There is no attested cult of propitiatory gifts; the appropriate honoring is respectful death ritual (wakes, funeral laments/raudos) rather than gifts to the goddess directly.*

Gwisin — *Korean Muism (Shamanism)*
Spirits of the improperly/violently dead who have not transitioned. Wandering troubled dead requiring ritual resolution.
How to honor: *Gwisin who died improperly or violently are addressed through ssitgim-gut, a "cleansing" ritual in which the mudang pulls a long cotton cloth through symbolic knots to represent untangling the spirit's grief (han) and easing its passage to the afterlife; food offerings including the deceased's favorite dishes are set out. Ordinary households appease wandering gwisin with small food offerings at thresholds, while omitting proper funeral/memorial rites is believed to leave them permanently earthbound and vengeful.*

Gwyn ap Nudd — *Welsh*
King of the dead/fairy realm; leads the Wild Hunt (Cwn Annwn). Leader of the Welsh Wild Hunt and ruler of the dead.
How to honor: *Gwyn ap Nudd is best honored by giving him wide berth and respect during his Wild Hunt (Cŵn Annwn) rather than seeking direct offerings — traditionally, hearing the hounds meant staying indoors and avoiding solitary travel at dusk. Where offerings are made, they are simple and left at hilltop or liminal sites (milk, bread, or mead at a crossroads or cairn); Glastonbury Tor, his mythic seat as king of the Tylwyth Teg and ruler of the dead, is the most fitting place of acknowledgment. He is addressed as a guardian/psychopomp figure to be respected, not feared outright, especially around Calan Gaeaf (Samhain) when the veil is thin.*

Hades — *Greek*
Ruler of the underworld and the dead. God of the realm of the dead.
How to honor: *Hades received sacrifices of black animals, especially black rams, with libations poured directly into pits in the earth (chthonic offerings, given downward rather than upward or outward like Olympian libations). Greeks avoided speaking his name directly, using euphemisms like Plouton ("the wealthy one," referencing earth's buried riches) instead, and the dead were buried with an obol coin in the mouth as payment for Charon's ferry — an indirect but essential offering within his domain.*

Hecate (Wicca) — *Wicca*
One aspect/name of the Wiccan Goddess. A name the Goddess is known by.
How to honor: *Hekate is honored via monthly Deipnon (dark-moon supper offerings left at a crossroads or outside the home — traditionally eggs, garlic, fish, and bread), with black candles, keys, torches, and dogs as symbols; incense favors garlic, myrrh, or mugwort. Hekate's Night/Hecate's Supper falls on the dark moon; some modern calendars also honor her August 13. Taboo: never eat or bring home the Deipnon offering once left, and don't look back after leaving it at the crossroads.*

Hel — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Ruler of Helheim, realm of the ordinary dead. Half-living, half-dead daughter of Loki ruling the dead.
How to honor: *Hel is honored with offerings of dark foods (black bread, dark ale, root vegetables), bones, black or half-black/half-white candles and imagery reflecting her split appearance, and items placed at graves or thresholds rather than a household shrine. She is not a punishing figure in the lore — Helheim is the resting place of the ordinary dead — so modern practice focuses on ancestor veneration, held at Samhain/dísablót-adjacent autumn dates or All Souls-tide, often at graveyards or liminal spaces. Avoid pity or fear-based framing; devotees stress she deserves the same respect as other deities.*

Hikule'o — *Polynesian (Tonga)*
Guardian of Pulotu (Tongan spirit world) and lord of the dead. Tongan god governing the relationship between living and dead.
How to honor: *Hikule'o, ruler of Pulotu (the Tongan spirit-world/afterlife), was traditionally approached only through trained ritual specialists (matāpule) and trance-mediumship, since*

Pulotu is a place of the dead beyond ordinary human contact. Proper honoring consists of correct funerary protocol and respect for ancestral spirits believed to reside under her governance.

Hine-nui-te-po — *Polynesian (Maori)*
Goddess of death. Sleeping goddess of death who ended Maui's quest for immortality.
How to honor: *Hine-nui-te-po is honored through tangihanga (Māori funeral rites) and karakia recited at death, at urupā (burial grounds), and during transitions from life to death. She is acknowledged with deep respect as guardian of the dead; proper honoring means observing correct tikanga around death and burial, approached only through appropriately trained kaumātua/tohunga.*

Hine-nui-te-po — *Maori*
Goddess of death who killed Maui when he sought immortality. Goddess of the underworld and death.
How to honor: *Papatuanuku is honored as the literal ground stood upon: karakia are recited before disturbing earth, and hongi (the pressing of noses) upon greeting is understood partly as breathing in connection with her. Kaitiakitanga (guardianship of land) is framed as an act of honoring her, and mist/rain is understood as her ongoing sighs of longing for Ranginui.*

Hine-nui-te-po (Maori master) — *Maori*
Goddess of death and the night. Guardian of the transition between life and death, crushed Maui.
How to honor: *Hine-nui-te-po is approached with deep respect and caution rather than propitiated with offerings — she governs the tapu-laden transition between life and death, and casual or boastful speech about her is avoided (Māui's fatal mistake was laughing while entering her body seeking immortality). Correct tangihanga (funeral) protocol is the living form of acknowledgment: appropriate karakia, weeping, and ceremony guide the dead safely into her realm (Rarohenga), and her domain is treated with solemnity, never mockery.*

Hun-Came (One Death) — *Maya (Xibalba)*
Primary lord of the Maya underworld Xibalba. Chief death lord of Xibalba.
How to honor: *Chief lord of Xibalba, ruling with Vucub-Came over the underworld's trial houses; not devotionally worshipped but ritually feared and appeased — caves and cenotes, treated as entrances to Xibalba, received copal incense and blood offerings meant to placate underworld powers generally. Owls, darkness, and the color black are his symbolic associations; the respectful modern approach is acknowledging him through Popol Vuh storytelling as a death-power figure, not petitioning him directly.*

Izanami — *Shinto*
Primordial creator goddess who died and became ruler of Yomi (underworld). Female creator who becomes goddess of death/underworld.
How to honor: *Izanami is honored primarily at Izanagi-jinja and sites tied to the Yomi myth (notably Hana no Iwaya cave shrine in Kumano, believed to be her burial place), with standard shinsen offerings of rice, sake, salt, and seasonal fruit, plus flowers left at the cave-rock shrine. As ruler of Yomi and death, she is also honored in ancestor-veneration contexts. A key taboo: her myth explicitly forbids looking upon her decayed form — approached with respect rather than fear.*

Jentilak — *Basque*
Ancient giants who built megalithic dolmens/cromlechs. Pre-human giant beings who preceded humanity.
How to honor: *Jentilak, the megalith-building giants, are acknowledged chiefly by leaving the dolmens and cromlechs attributed to them undisturbed and treating those sites with quiet respect, alongside continued oral storytelling of their legends. There is no attested ritual offering practice to them as such — their "honoring" is essentially heritage stewardship of the megalithic sites and the tales explaining them.*

Josang (Ancestral Spirits, Shamanism) — *Korean Muism (Shamanism)*
Spirits of deceased family members in active relationship with descendants. Family ancestor-spirits whose unresolved grief can cause misfortune if unhonored.
How to honor: *Josang ancestors are honored through jesa (memorial rites) held on death anniversaries and major holidays (Chuseok, Seollal), with a strict food-offering order — rice, soup, fish (whole, head facing east), meat, fruit, and rice wine — followed by ancestral bows (jeol) from eldest descendants first. Within a gut, the Josang-geori segment lets the ancestor speak through the mudang to voice unresolved grief (han); failing to hold jesa or ignoring an ancestor's grievance is believed to bring illness or misfortune to the family line.*

Josang Shin (Ancestor Spirits) — *Korean Muism*
Spirits of deceased family members remain close, interested in family affairs. Deceased family members treated as present, interactive sacred beings.
How to honor: *Josang Shin are honored through jesa, formal ancestor memorial rites held on the lunar anniversary of death and at major holidays (Chuseok, Seollal), with food arranged by strict rules (hongdongseo baekseo — red fruits east, white fruits west; jujube-chestnut-persimmon-pear order), rice, soup, and rice wine set before a spirit tablet, plus two deep bows from descendants. Between jesa, incense and a small bowl of water or rice are kept at a household shrine; strong-smelling foods like garlic and red pepper are traditionally excluded, and a josang gut is held specifically when ancestors are believed to be causing misfortune through neglect or grievance.*

Kali — *Hinduism*
Time, death, liberation, destruction of ego. Fierce dark goddess who destroys ego and illusion; most intense form of Durga.
How to honor: *Kali is especially venerated in Bengal and Assam, notably at the Kalighat and Dakshineswar temples in Kolkata, and honored through Kali Puja (coinciding with Diwali night in Bengal) with offerings of hibiscus flowers, red vermillion, and — at select traditional temples like Kalighat — animal sacrifice (historically goats), though this practice is now restricted or banned in many places. She is approached without fear as a compassionate mother-destroyer rather than purely a terror figure, and Tantric practitioners specifically use her fierce imagery in meditation to confront and dissolve ego attachment.*

Kali (Bhagavad Gita) — *Bhagavad Gita / Hinduism*
Referenced as "the Goddess Kali" alongside Vishnu, Krishna, and Siva. Fierce mother goddess associated with time/death/transformation.
How to honor: *Kali is honored on a dark or red-draped altar bearing her image, with red hibiscus flowers, red vermilion (sindoor), incense, and a ghee lamp; offerings of sweets and rice are standard, while meat or alcohol appear only within specific Tantric Shakta lineages. Her major festival, Kali Puja (Dipannita Kali Puja), falls on Amavasya of the Kartik month (coinciding with Diwali) and is marked by night worship after a day's fast, with symbolic or, in some Bengali/Tantric traditions, animal sacrifice; Kali Chaudas is a related observance the day before. Devotees are taught not to mistake her fierce imagery for evil but to approach her with reverence as destroyer of ego and time, following lineage-specific rules on any meat or alcohol offerings.*

Kalma — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Goddess of decay. Served by the guardian beast Surma at Tuonela's threshold.
How to honor: *Kalma, goddess of decay and graveyards (her name literally means "corpse-smell"), is respected through proper burial custom and graveyard etiquette rather than direct offerings — leaving graves undisturbed, speaking quietly near cemeteries, and honoring the dead were the practical devotions to her. Modern Suomenusko/heathen practitioners acknowledge her at Kekri with candles lit at gravesites and quiet remembrance. Taboo: disturbing graves or loud, disrespectful behavior near burial grounds.*

Lemures — *Roman Religion*

Restless/improperly-buried dead. Troubling wandering spirits requiring ritual propitiation.
How to honor: *The Lemures (restless dead) were ritually expelled at Lemuria (May 9, 11, 13), when the paterfamilias walked barefoot through his house at midnight, threw black beans over his shoulder nine times without looking back while reciting a formula, then banged bronze pots while repeating "Ghosts of my fathers, go forth!" nine times. Unlike the Manes, Lemures were feared rather than honored — the ritual is expulsion, not reverence.*

Loviatar — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Mother of plague and disease. Daughter of Tuonela associated with sickness.
How to honor: *Loviatar, the blind daughter of Tuoni who mothered nine diseases by the wind, is invoked in Finnish folk-healing charms (loitsut), where healers recited her genealogy and that of her disease-children as a counter-charm to name and thereby control or banish illness — common in Kalevala-tradition folk medicine. There is no positive offering cult to her; she is "honored" defensively, through wary acknowledgment in healing rites rather than festive worship. Taboo: casual invocation of her name outside proper healing-charm context, and exposure to cold wind while ill.*

Maman Brigitte — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Queen of the dead, guardian of blessed graves, healer. Irish-origin (St. Brigid) consort of Baron Samedi.
How to honor: *Devotees honor Tian not through temple ritual but through moral practice: living out jian ai (impartial, universal care/love) toward all people regardless of kinship or rank, since Mozi taught this mirrors Heaven's own non-discriminating will. Mozi described honoring Heaven through frugal living, opposing wasteful ritual/music, rejecting offensive warfare, and just governance — right action was the offering, not sacrifice. No attested cult, temple, or festival to Tian as a personal object of worship exists; correct conduct itself was the honoring act.*

Manes (Di Manes) — *Roman Religion*
Collective ancestral dead, "the good gods". Divine ancestral dead honored at family tombs.
How to honor: *The Manes (collective ancestral dead) were honored at Parentalia (February 13-21), when families visited ancestral tombs to pour libations of wine, milk, honey, and blood, scatter flowers, and share a graveside meal; public business and temples closed during this period. The phrase "Dis Manibus" was inscribed on virtually every Roman tombstone as standing acknowledgment.*

Marzanna — *Slavic Paganism*
Goddess of winter, death, disease. Goddess of winter drowned each spring in a living ceremony.
How to honor: *Marena (Morana) is honored through the annual drowning or burning of her straw effigy at the spring equinox (Maslenitsa's end/early spring), carried out of the village by the community and destroyed at a river or field edge; a strict taboo requires participants not to look back at the effigy or the water as they return, to avoid winter/death "following" them home. The rite is explicitly a communal expulsion, not a devotional offering — no food or object gifts are given to her, since the entire point is to drive her (and winter, disease, and death) away.*

Masauu (Maasaw) — *Hopi*
Guardian of the Fourth World, Spirit of Death, Earth God, Keeper of Fire. Skeletal but benevolent guardian who welcomed emerging people and gave fire and corn.
How to honor: *Spider Grandmother is approached with humility and cornmeal offerings, and honored by living out the skills she is said to have taught — weaving and careful, patient planting. Hopi teaching holds that one should "keep the door at the top of your head open" to her guidance, and disturbing spider webs unnecessarily is traditionally avoided.*

Mhondoro (territorial ancestor-spirits) — *Shona (Zimbabwe)*
Spirits of great chiefs/kings governing entire territories; can manifest as lions. Powerful territorial/national ancestor spirits linked to land and lion manifestations.

How to honor: *Unkulunkulu/uMvelinqangi (Shona/Ndebele context) receives no direct shrine, offering, or festival — devotion is structurally routed entirely through amadlozi (ancestor spirits), given beer, snuff, and animal sacrifice at family rites, while the creator himself is acknowledged only verbally as the distant original source. Honoring him concretely means maintaining the ancestor-veneration chain.*

Mictecacihuatl (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Lady of the dead, co-ruler of Mictlan. Underworld queen, "Lady of the Dead".
How to honor: *Mictecacihuatl, co-ruler of Mictlan, presided over funerary rites providing the dead with grave provisions for their journey, alongside Mictlantecuhtli. She is widely regarded as the deep indigenous root of the later syncretic (Catholic-fused) Día de los Muertos imagery — marigolds (cempasúchil), skull motifs, and ofrendas — though that specific festival form is colonial-era syncretism rather than direct Mexica cult practice, so the connection should be presented as ancestral influence, not identical continuity.*

Mictecacihuatl (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec*
Consort of Mictlantecuhtli, guardian of bones; source of La Catrina. Lady of the Dead, guardian of ancestral bones.
How to honor: *Central to the modern Día de los Muertos (Day of the Dead) — marigolds (cempasúchil), sugar skulls, pan de muerto, candles, and photographs of the deceased are placed on ofrendas (altars) in her honor as guardian of ancestral bones and Lady of Mictlan. Historically she was honored at the Aztec month-festivals Miccailhuitontli and Hueymiccaihuitl ("Little" and "Great" Feasts of the Dead), which after conquest merged with Catholic All Souls' Day observances to become today's tradition. Her modern folk-art descendant, La Calavera Catrina, keeps her image widely present in Mexican culture; disrespecting the dead or removing offerings from an ofrenda is considered a serious taboo.*

Mictlantecuhtli (Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Lord of the dead, ruler of Mictlan. Underworld ruler of the ninth level of Mictlan.
How to honor: *Mictlantecuhtli received grave goods meant to sustain the dead on their four-year journey through Mictlan's nine levels: a jade or greenstone bead placed in the mouth (representing the heart/life-breath), paper, and — critically — a small dog (xoloitzcuintle), sacrificed or symbolically provided to guide the soul across the underworld's river. His color was black, his creatures owls, spiders, and bats, and his temple/shrine associations lay toward the north.*

Mictlantecuhtli (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec*
Lord of Mictlan, the ninth underworld level. Skeletal lord of the Aztec underworld and the dead.
How to honor: *Honored through burial rites for the dead: a small dog (often a xoloitzcuintli) was buried or sacrificed alongside the deceased to guide their soul across Mictlan's river, a jade or greenstone bead was placed in the mouth as a toll, and offerings of paper, food, and goods were burned periodically over the four years believed necessary for the soul's journey through the underworld's nine levels. Owls, spiders, and other night creatures served as his symbolic emissaries and were treated with respectful caution rather than aversion. Direct shrine worship was minimal; honoring him meant properly provisioning the dead.*

Morana / Smrtka — *Czech (Slavic) folk tradition*
Personification of winter/death. Winter/death goddess figure expelled each spring.
How to honor: *Morana/Smrtka, personification of winter and death, is ritually expelled each spring (traditionally on Smrtná neděle, "Death Sunday," before Easter): a straw effigy dressed in rags is carried out of the village while children sing, then torn apart, drowned in a river, or burned, after which villagers return home without looking back to prevent winter's return.*

Mot — *Canaanite*
God of death itself, ruler of underworld. Devouring death-god, son of El.

How to honor: *Mot, devouring lord of the underworld, was not fed offerings like other gods but rather avoided and feared — he was acknowledged through mourning rites, ritual laments, and dry-season observances, with his name sometimes euphemized rather than invoked directly. The proper "honoring" of Mot is through funerary respect and acceptance of mortality, not propitiation or cultic feeding.*

Nephthys — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Goddess of liminal/threshold states, mourner at death. Goddess of thresholds, mother of Anubis.
How to honor: *Nephthys was honored primarily through funerary performance: professional mourners ritually played the roles of Isis and Nephthys at burials, reciting the "Lamentations of Isis and Nephthys," and she was invoked alongside Isis as protector of the canopic jars. Her devotion was overwhelmingly expressed through funerary ritual participation rather than separate temple offerings.*

Nergal — *Mesopotamian*
Male lord of the underworld (Kur/Irkalla), consort of Ereshkigal. God of death where destructive and life forces are one energy.
How to honor: *Inanna/Ishtar was honored through the Hieros Gamos (Sacred Marriage) rite reenacted between king and priestess at New Year, and through Enheduanna's hymns recited in her temples; historical offerings included dates, honey, wine, perfumes, and lapis lazuli jewelry, with the eight-pointed star and rosette as her symbols. Modern devotees build altars with red or gold cloth, wine, honey, and mirrors or Venus imagery, and invoke her for love, sexuality, ambition, and righteous conflict alike — she is honored as both erotic and martial, so offerings should not shy from either aspect.*

Nirriti — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Goddess of dissolution, presides over Mula nakshatra. Goddess governing dissolution and rebuilding.
How to honor: *Nirriti, goddess of dissolution presiding over Mula nakshatra, is propitiated apotropaically rather than devotionally: Vedic Nirriti-homa offerings use black sesame or broken/unwanted items carried away from the home and left at village boundaries to ward off misfortune. Because Mula births were historically considered inauspicious, a specific Mula Nakshatra Shanti pacification rite is performed for infants born under her; skipping it is believed to invite continued loss, not appeasement through pleasant offerings.*

Nsamanfo (the Ancestors, collectively) — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*
Active departed ancestors present in family/community life. Venerated ancestral spirits who bless or withhold blessing.
How to honor: *The Nsamanfo receive regular libation before meals and important decisions, poured with the ancestor's name spoken aloud and thanks given for guidance, and are honored collectively at the new moon and especially at Akwasidae, the recurring Akan festival (every 42 days on the Akan calendar) when stools representing royal and family ancestors are ritually fed with mashed yam, eggs, and drink. Black stools (used only after death, as opposed to the white stools of the living) serve as the physical seat/shrine for a departed elder's spirit and are kept, cleaned, and fed by descendants. Calling ancestors by name rather than generically is considered essential to a libation being effective.*

Omakisi (ancestors, collective) — *Muwila*
Deceased family members in active relationship with the living. The "living dead" — ancestors who died a "good death" and remain protectively engaged with descendants.
How to honor: *The Omakisi (ancestors) are honored at household ancestor shrines with regular libations poured out before family meals, attentiveness to dreams as messages, and divination consultations with a nganga to identify which ancestor needs acknowledgment. Cattle are sacrificed at major life events (illness, death, initiation), and the dead are formally incorporated into ancestorhood through burial with a nontombi (collar) and continued naming in daily prayer.*

Osiris — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
First divine king; ruler of the afterlife; dying/resurrecting god. Murdered-and-resurrected king who rules the afterlife.
How to honor: *Osiris was honored above all through the annual Mysteries of Osiris at Abydos (centered on the month of Khoiak), a public reenactment of his death, mourning, and resurrection involving the ritual "Osiris bed" — a mummy-shaped tray of soil sown with grain that sprouted as a living symbol of renewal. Devotees brought offerings of bread, beer, unguent, and natron, and sought burial as near Abydos as possible.*

Osiris (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Fertility, underworld, resurrection. First king of Egypt, murdered and resurrected as ruler of the afterlife.
How to honor: *Osiris was honored above all through the month-long Khoiak festival (Oct/Nov), when "Osiris beds" — soil-filled figures sown with grain that sprouted as a literal symbol of resurrection (many preserved examples survive archaeologically) — were prepared, and through the annual Passion/Mysteries of Osiris performed at Abydos, recorded on the Ikhernofret stela, where his death, search, and resurrection were reenacted before pilgrims. The djed pillar was ceremonially raised by the pharaoh as a rite of renewal, and offerings of bread and beer accompanied funerary rites patterned on his myth.*

Oya — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Wind, storms, change, threshold of death, cemetery guardian. Orisha of wind, storms, and transformative death/change.
How to honor: *Orunmila is consulted through a Babalawo priest using the ikin (sacred palm nuts) or opele divination chain; kola nut, gin, and water are typically presented before a reading, and the annual Odun Ifa festival honors him communally. His colors are green and yellow, his number 16 (matching the sixteen principal Odu), and honesty in reporting one's divination results is considered essential.*

Persephone — *Greek*
Queen of the underworld; cyclical descent/return myth. Goddess of seasonal death and rebirth.
How to honor: *Persephone was honored jointly with Demeter in the Eleusinian Mysteries, and separately through offerings of pomegranate seeds — symbolic of her binding to the underworld after eating them there — left at her shrines. She was also honored in the Thesmophoria alongside her mother, and seasonal transitions (planting in autumn, first sprouts in spring) were marked as moments of her descent and return, reflecting agricultural renewal.*

Pillanes — *Mapuche*
Beneficial ancestral spirits of great chiefs and machi dwelling in Wenu Mapu. Ancestor spirits of the upper world who guide and protect.
How to honor: *Pillanes are communicated with through the machi (shamanic healer) via trance, dreams, and ceremony, and are invoked particularly during weather crises, healing rites, and the Ngillatun cycle as protective ancestral spirits of great chiefs and machi. They are honored by maintaining right relationship with the machi tradition itself, since Pillanes are understood to work primarily through her mediation rather than direct individual approach.*

Pitris — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Ancestral forebears presiding over Magha nakshatra. Deified ancestors associated with lineage and royal authority.
How to honor: *The Pitris, presiding over Magha nakshatra, are honored through Shraddha rites and especially during Pitru Paksha (a dedicated fortnight, typically in September), when descendants offer black sesame seeds, water, and rice balls (pindas) at riverbanks or sacred sites like Gaya to nourish and appease ancestral spirits. Neglecting Shraddha is traditionally believed to cause "Pitru Dosha," bringing misfortune to the living family line.*

Pluto — *Western Astrology*

Modern ruler of Scorpio; death, rebirth, transformation, hidden power. Outer planetary archetype of destruction and regeneration.
How to honor: *Pluto, ruler of Scorpio, is associated with black and deep red, obsidian, black tourmaline, and smoky quartz, with incenses like patchouli, wormwood, and myrrh. Invoked for shadow work and transformation in dark, underground-feeling ritual spaces with offerings buried in earth; practitioners caution against forcing Plutonian transformation before its time or avoiding necessary endings out of fear.*

Pluto/Dis Pater — *Roman Religion*
The underworld, hidden wealth. Ruler of the underworld and hidden wealth.
How to honor: *Pluto/Dis Pater was honored through the mundus — a pit believed to connect to the underworld — ritually opened three times a year (August 24, October 5, November 8) to let spirits of the dead move among the living; these were inauspicious days when no public business could be conducted. Black animals were the standard sacrifice to chthonic deities like Pluto, offered at night, in contrast to white daytime offerings for sky gods.*

Preto Velho / Preta Velha — *Umbanda*
Spirit guides of enslaved African ancestors, wisdom through suffering. Beloved elder ancestor-spirit counselors.
How to honor: *Preto Velho/Preta Velha, ancestor-spirits of enslaved Africans, are honored in Umbanda gira sessions with unsweetened black coffee, pipe/cigar smoke, and simple offerings (beans, manioc) left at the base of large trees; their altar corner uses a white or brown candle and often a rustic chair or rosary. They are approached with patience and humility, consulted through slow, direct speech for wisdom and healing rooted in a lifetime of suffering, never mocked for their bent posture or accent.*

Rephaim — *Canaanite*
Deified shades of royal ancestors/heroes/kings. Ancestor-spirits capable of blessing the living.
How to honor: *The Rephaim, deified shades of royal ancestors and heroes, were summoned to marzeah ritual banquets with wine libations poured into the ground or at the tomb, invoked to bless and legitimize the living king through Ugaritic royal ancestor cult (the rpum texts). This was a royal/heroic practice, not a general ancestor cult for commoners.*

Resheph — *Canaanite*
Force of plague/pestilence, council member. Plague-associated deity.
How to honor: *Resheph, god of plague, war, and the underworld, had a genuine widespread cult — worshipped at Ugarit (a "gate of Resheph" shrine), adopted into Egyptian state religion at Memphis and Deir el-Medina, and honored across the Levant and Cyprus for over a millennium with weapons, votive stelae, and incense offered by soldiers seeking protection. Modern reconstructionists offer red items, bread, or wine, approaching him with caution and appeasement rather than casual devotion, since his "arrows" bring disease.*

Se (ancestors) — *Ewe/Vodun*
Moral order maintained by ancestors. Ancestral moral foundation; the dead remain active, venerated community members.
How to honor: *Se (the ancestors) are honored daily and at life-cycle events with libations of water, palm wine, or schnapps poured onto the ground while naming the deceased individually, oldest lineage member first. Family stools or small shrines kept in the household serve as their physical seat, and yam-harvest festivals in Ewe communities double as occasions of collective ancestor thanksgiving.*

Shiva — *Hinduism*
Destruction, transformation, yoga, meditation, liberation. The ascetic destroyer god whose cosmic dance clears the way for new creation.

How to honor: *Shiva is honored with the abhishekam ritual — pouring milk, water, honey, yogurt, and bilva (bael) leaves over the lingam — while chanting "Om Namah Shivaya," and Maha Shivaratri (his major festival, a night of fasting and all-night vigil) sees devotees stay awake performing four-phase worship through the night. He dislikes impure or disrespectful approach to the lingam and is never offered turmeric or kumkum in some regional traditions (considered feminine substances reserved for the goddess); ash (vibhuti) smeared on the forehead marks his ascetic devotees, and 108 circumambulations or japa mala recitations are common.*

Siwa (Shiva, Balinese) — *Balinese (Bali)*
Transformer aspect, most important in Balinese practice; governs cremation fire. Transformer god, central figure in Balinese cremation theology.
How to honor: *Siwa (Shiva), the most central deity in Balinese practice, is honored daily through the core white-flower offering in the canang sari and, most importantly, presides over the Ngaben cremation ceremony, where his fire aspect is invoked to purify and release the soul; cremation towers (bade) and sarcophagi are ritually burned under priestly mantra addressed to Siwa as the transformer who returns the body's elements to their sources. Disrespecting the cremation fire or interrupting Ngaben rites is considered a serious breach.*

Sluagh — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
The unforgiven dead / fallen spirits of the Unseelie Court, ride the night sky. Host of malevolent dead who sweep through the night sky seizing the living.
How to honor: *The Sluagh receive no offerings — devotion here is entirely protective avoidance: west-facing windows and doors are kept shut after dark, especially in winter, since the host is believed to travel from the west; salt or iron is laid across thresholds, and the dying or gravely ill were traditionally kept away from open windows so their departing soul could not be seized mid-flight.*

Surma — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Flesh-tearing guardian beast. Guards the thorn-thicket approach to Tuonela.
How to honor: *Surma, the fanged, flesh-tearing guardian beast of Tuonela's thorn-thicket boundary in the Lemminkäinen cycle, is a purely mythic monster with no attested cult or offering tradition, since encountering him meant death. The appropriate acknowledgment is storytelling of the Lemminkäinen death-and-resurrection episode, treating him as a symbolic personification of mortality's threshold rather than a devotional figure.*

Tiki — *Marquesas Islands*
First created human/divine ancestor figure. First human/ancestor deity, source of the "tiki" statue tradition.
How to honor: *Represented in carved stone and wood tiki figures placed at me'ae (sacred sites) and family compounds in the Marquesas, believed to hold ancestral/divine power (mana) and to protect the land and lineage. Genealogical chants (recitation of descent lines) were the living devotional practice, affirming continuity from Tiki as first ancestor. Modern Marquesan cultural revival (tattoo art, dance, wood carving) keeps his image and name alive as a symbol of identity rather than through active offerings.*

Tinoni Mate (Ancestor Spirits) — *Solomon Islands*
Deceased ancestors who remain active community members. Spirit-people whose cooperation must be actively maintained.
How to honor: *Honored through named mortuary and memorial feasts (varying by island/language group) involving pig sacrifice, shell-money and shell-valuable exchange, and communal feasting to keep ancestors satisfied as active participants in village affairs; neglecting these obligations, or offending an ancestor's memory, is believed to bring illness, poor harvests, or misfortune until amends are made through further offerings.*

Tuonetar — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*

Tuoni's wife, offers beer of forgetting to the dead. Erases memory of the newly dead crossing into Tuonela.
How to honor: *Tuonetar, Tuoni's queen, offers the newly dead a "beer of forgetting" (unohduksen olut) so they lose memory of the living; she is honored through funerary custom and Kekri observance, where pouring out beer or drink in remembrance of the dead symbolically echoes her role. Modern practitioners pour a beer libation at gravesites or ancestor rites in her name. Taboo: casual or disrespectful talk of the dead near burial sites, and neglecting proper remembrance of deceased kin.*

Tuoni — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
God of death, ruler of Tuonela. Rules the realm of the dead with no moral sorting.
How to honor: *Tuoni, grim ruler of the underworld river-realm Tuonela, is acknowledged not through festive worship but proper funerary rite and the Kekri autumn ancestor festival — correct burial, respect for the dead, and avoiding recklessness near graves or dark water served as his "offerings." Symbols include the ferry-crossing to Tuonela and dark coloring. Modern Suomenusko/heathen practitioners light candles for the dead and pour beer libations at Kekri; taboo is disrespecting the dead or boasting about death.*

Ujigami (general) — *Shinto*
Ancestral kami of a specific family or clan, deified ancestor. Category of ancestor-turned-guardian deity.
How to honor: *Ujigami are clan/family ancestral guardian kami honored through the ujiko (parishioner) system: descendants register with their local shrine and support it through its matsuri, typically including a mikoshi procession, standard shinsen food offerings, and seasonal purification rites. There is no single named ujigami cult — honoring practice consists of attending that specific shrine's annual matsuri and New Year (hatsumode) visit.*

Veles/Volos — *Slavic Paganism*
Underworld, cattle, wealth, magic, arts, trickery. Underworld deity locked in eternal conflict with Perun.
How to honor: *Veles historically had his idol stand at the base of the hill (opposite Perun's height), and merchants swore trade oaths "by Veles" as god of contracts and commerce; offerings of milk, grain, wool, and honey were left at cattle byres or crossroads. A distinctive harvest custom, "Volos's beard" (Volosnya borodka), left an uncut tuft of grain standing in the field after harvest, bound with ribbon, as an offering to him. As patron of volkhvy (seers) and skalds/gusli-players, poets and musicians honored him through composition and performance; he was propitiated to prevent cattle theft and household misfortune.*

Velnias — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Underworld deity, cattle god, lord of magic. Trickster/underworld god who steals from Perkūnas's domain, provoking the storm-chase.
How to honor: *Honored (unlike the Christianized "devil" caricature he became) in Romuva revivalism as an underworld/wealth and cattle deity linked to shapeshifting, magic, and the dead; offerings include milk, dark bread, and black animal figurines/wool left at forest edges, bogs, or crossroads, his liminal domains, often approached at night or twilight. He is associated with black/dark colors and cattle and invoked in folk magic and livestock protection. Taboo: conflating him with the Christian Devil in ritual, and disrespecting cattle, both considered offensive to him.*

Vucub-Came (Seven Death) — *Maya (Xibalba)*
Co-ruling lord of Xibalba. Co-ruling death lord of the Maya underworld.
How to honor: *Co-ruling lord of Xibalba alongside Hun-Came, presiding over the deadly trial houses the Hero Twins face; like his counterpart, feared and ritually appeased rather than worshipped, with cave/cenote offerings of copal and blood serving underworld powers broadly. He is best acknowledged today through respectful retelling of the Popol Vuh's underworld ordeals as a cautionary death-power figure rather than through any invented devotional rite.*

Xonaxi Quecuya — *Zapotec*

Goddess/Lord of the Dead, rules the underworld. Divine steward of the beloved dead.

How to honor: *Xonaxi Quecuya, ruler of the Zapotec underworld, was approached with respect and ongoing relationship rather than fear, consistent with Zapotec funerary practice that treated death as transition rather than annihilation — elaborate tomb offerings and funerary urns for the deceased functioned as gifts within her domain. She is honored today primarily through respectful historical study of Zapotec afterlife beliefs and tomb archaeology.*

Yama — *Hinduism*

God of death, judge of souls. God of death who reveals the secret of immortality to Nachiketa.

How to honor: *Yama is propitiated on Naraka Chaturdashi (the day before Diwali) and Dhanteras, when households light small oil lamps (Yamadeepdaan) facing south — normally a taboo direction — specifically to appease him and ward off untimely death. Bhai Dooj/Yama Dwitiya honors the myth of his sister Yamuna welcoming him, and brothers visit sisters for a tilak and meal on this day as a living observance across North India.*

Yama (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*

Lord of death and dharma, presides over Bharani nakshatra. God of death and moral law.

How to honor: *Yama, presiding over Bharani nakshatra, is honored less through celebratory worship and more through Yama Tarpana (ancestral water offerings) and rites performed on Yamadwitiya (part of Diwali) and during Pitru Paksha, using black sesame seeds and water poured with cupped hands. Devotees also light a "Yama Deepam" lamp facing south on certain observances to ward off untimely death, since he is approached with solemnity and moral seriousness rather than festive devotion.*

Healing & Medicine

Gods and spirits of medicine, healing plants, and the restoration of health.

Agwu — *Igbo Odinani (Nigeria)*
Deity of divination and healing; patron of the dibia. God of divination and sacred madness/insight associated with healers.
How to honor: *Dibia (diviner-healers) are traditionally "called" to their vocation by Agwu through illness, disturbing dreams, or episodes of sacred madness that only initiation resolves; refusing the call is believed to bring continued affliction. Agwu is invoked with kola nut and chalk (nzu) at the opening of afa (divination) sessions, and his unpredictable, trickster-like nature is acknowledged rather than tamed — he is honored through ritual respect for the ambiguity and risk inherent in divination and healing work.*

Ashwini Kumaras — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Twin divine healers presiding over Ashwini nakshatra. Divine physician twins associated with swift healing.
How to honor: *The Ashwini Kumaras, twin physician-gods of Ashwini nakshatra, are invoked primarily through healing-oriented Ayurvedic and Vedic ritual — their names appear in health-related mantras and the opening verses of some Ayurvedic texts, and nakshatra-specific shanti pujas for those born under Ashwini include their invocation with ghee and honey offerings. There is no major dedicated temple network; their devotional presence survives mainly within Vedic ritual formulas rather than independent worship.*

Avalokiteshvara (Chenrezig) — *Tibetan Vajrayana*
Bodhisattva of compassion. Bodhisattva of compassion incarnate in the Dalai Lama lineage.
How to honor: *Avalokiteshvara (Chenrezig) is honored continuously through recitation of Om Mani Padme Hum, spun on prayer wheels and printed on prayer flags that release the mantra on the wind. Mani stones carved with the mantra are placed along pilgrimage routes and passed on the left in circumambulation. The Dalai Lama, regarded as his living emanation, is venerated directly as a devotional focus, especially during Losar and his birthday observances.*

Bear (Mato) spirit — *Many nations*
Great healer spirit associated with the West, self-restoration knowledge. Animal spirit teacher of healing and inner-shadow work.
How to honor: *Bear medicine is invoked for healing and introspective "shadow work," often by medicine people (wapiya) who carry bear claws, bear grease, or bear-paw imagery as tools of their practice, and tobacco is the standard offering when calling on Bear's aid. Mato Paha (Bear Butte, South Dakota) is a major sacred site where Lakota and Cheyenne people still go for vision quests and prayer, tying colored cloth/tobacco prayer bundles (red, yellow, white, black, and often blue) to trees along the way. Because Bear is powerful and can be dangerous if disrespected, its ways (hibernation, self-healing) are imitated reverently rather than mocked or claimed lightly.*

Guanyin — *Chinese Folk Religion*
Bodhisattva of mercy, bestower of children. Goddess of boundless compassion who hears every cry.
How to honor: *Guanyin, bodhisattva of mercy, is honored with incense, calling her name ("Namo Guanyin Pusa") in times of distress, and offerings of lotus flowers and vegetarian food — meat and alcohol are avoided, reflecting her association with compassion and vegetarian vows. Her major feast day is the 19th of the second lunar month (with additional dates in the sixth and ninth months), when devotees often take temporary vegetarian vows and offer a vase of pure water or a willow branch, her iconographic emblem.*

Haurvatat — *Zoroastrianism*
Wholeness, health, perfection. Amesha Spenta of wholeness/health, corresponds to water.

How to honor: *Haurvatat is honored through the Khordadgan feast on her namesake day/month "Khordad," and through the broader Zoroastrian obligation to keep water ritually pure — pouring libations of clean water and milk at wells, springs, or the Aban Yasht rites. Taboo: defiling wells, rivers, or the sea with corpses, waste, or blood is one of Zoroastrianism's gravest prohibitions, directly tied to her domain.*

Idun — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Keeper of the golden apples of immortality. Guards the apples that keep the gods eternally young.
How to honor: *Idunn is honored with offerings of fresh apples (her defining symbol), other orchard fruit, and small wooden boxes or baskets representing her chest of apples; altars often feature apple-green and gold colors, apple blossoms, or feathers. She is invoked for youth, healing, vitality, and rejuvenation, especially in spring; no ancient festival is documented specifically for her, so modern devotees choose personally meaningful dates like the spring equinox. Avoid stale, rotten, or processed fruit as an offering — freshness symbolically matters to her.*

Isis (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Magic, healing, motherhood, wisdom. Greatest magical practitioner; reassembled and resurrected Osiris through devotion.
How to honor: *Isis was honored at her great temple of Philae (whose cult persisted into the 6th century CE, the last active ancient Egyptian temple) with offerings of milk, wine, and kyphi incense, and via the Isia festival reenacting her mourning and reassembly of Osiris. The Tyet (Isis knot), often carved in red jasper, was worn as a protective amulet invoking her magic; nursing-mother imagery of her suckling Horus made her a focus for maternal and healing prayer, a practice modern Kemetics continue with red-toned offerings and knot symbolism.*

Kannon (Avalokiteshvara) — *Shingon*
Bodhisattva of Compassion. Bodhisattva embodying compassion within the Womb World Mandala.
How to honor: *Fudo Myo-o is honored chiefly through the goma fire ritual — practitioners write petitions on gomagi sticks burned before his fierce image — and through misogi, cold-water austerity performed under waterfalls while facing his statue, since his sword (cutting delusion) and rope (binding evil) mark him as a protector to be approached with discipline.*

Kiputytto — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
"Pain girl," invoked in healing spells. Daughter of Tuonela personifying physical pain.
How to honor: *Kiputyttö ("Pain-girl"), who dwells with her sister on Kipuvuori ("Pain Mountain"), was invoked through the syntyloitsu (origin-charm) tradition of Finnish folk healing: a tietäjä (shaman-healer) recited the mythic origin/genealogy of the pain or illness, naming her and ritually commanding her to gather the pain into a vessel and carry it back to her mountain — naming an affliction's origin was believed to give the healer power over it. No positive offering cult accompanied this; it was a purely verbal ritual technique used only within a healing session, never festive worship.*

Mapacho (Tobacco Spirit) — *Shipibo-Conibo (Peruvian Amazon)*
Master protective plant spirit; blown as smoke over patients. The master protective plant teacher used to shield and cleanse in ceremony.
How to honor: *Ingested as a bitter brew during nighttime ceremonies led by an onaya/meraya, who sings icaros (këshan) directly over the cup before it is drunk to "dress" it with the healer's kene design-patterns; participants observe a pre-ceremony diet (no salt, sugar, pork, alcohol, or sex) and the space is closed with a final icaro and often mapacho smoke to seal participants' energy before sleep. Vomiting/purging is treated as part of the medicine's cleansing work, not something to suppress; leaving the maloca or interrupting mid-icaro before formal closing is considered dangerous and disrespectful.*

Mielikki — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Forest healing and nurturing aspect. Tapio's wife, forest's nurturing/healing power, shapeshifter.
How to honor: *Mielikki, the gentle mistress of the forest and game (Tapio's wife), is traditionally honored by hunters and berry/mushroom gatherers with small offerings of bread, butter, or coins left at a tree's base before entering the forest, with spoken requests for good hunting and safe passage. Honey was her especially favored offering (called "honey-pawed" in bear-charms); forest clearings or old-growth trees served as her shrine. Modern Suomenusko practitioners still leave forest-edge offerings of bread, honey, or berries; taboo is taking more from the forest than needed or failing to thank her.*

Oni (Ayahuasca Spirit) — *Shipibo-Conibo (Peruvian Amazon)*
Plant-teacher spirit accessed via ayahuasca brew; source of icaros (healing songs). The vine spirit whose songs and visions guide healing and diagnosis of the kene pattern.
How to honor: *Prepared and served by a trained curandero/onanya who sings icaros (medicine songs) both while cooking the vine and during ceremony to direct its power; the icaro itself is considered the primary offering and communication channel. Participants observe a strict dieta beforehand (avoiding salt, sugar, pork, alcohol, and sexual activity for days to weeks) as a sign of respect and to sharpen the spirit's visions; disrespecting the dieta or entering ceremony with impure intent is believed to bring difficult or punishing visions. The vine itself is harvested with a spoken prayer of permission and gratitude, never taken carelessly from the forest, and each ceremony is formally closed (often with tobacco smoke or additional icaros) so no spirit residue lingers.*

Osain — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Wild herbs, medicinal plants. Orisha of herbs and the healing power of the natural world.
How to honor: *Oya is offered eggplant (traditionally in sets of nine), plums, and red wine, with purple, maroon, or multicolored cloth marking her altar; offerings are placed at cemetery gates and marketplace entrances, reflecting her rule over both trade and the threshold of death. Her number is 9, and she is invoked during storms and at moments of major life transition — mutton is generally avoided in her rites.*

Ossain — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Lord of leaves and plant medicine. Orixá holding the secret knowledge of sacred leaves.
How to honor: *Ossain, keeper of the sacred leaves, is honored by gathering specific medicinal plants only after asking ritual permission of the plant itself, then leaving offerings of green foods and cachaça-free libations in forest gardens dedicated to him; his colors are green and white/brown, and no other orixá's rites can be properly performed without leaves consecrated through him via the amaci (herbal bath). Taking leaves without the proper prayer is considered a serious taboo.*

Saints Cosmas and Damian — *Byzantine*
Patron saints of medicine. Healing saints whose shrine practiced Christianized dream-incubation medicine.
How to honor: *Saints Cosmas and Damian were honored through dream incubation (enkoimesis) at their shrine (the Kosmidion) outside Constantinople, where the sick slept overnight hoping the saints would appear in dreams to diagnose or heal them, sometimes prescribing food remedies recorded in surviving miracle collections. As physician-saints who took no payment ("the Unmercenaries"), devotees historically avoided offering money and instead gave votive offerings, candles, and prayers of thanksgiving after healing. Their joint feast day (July 1 in the Byzantine calendar) is still kept in Orthodox practice with services for the sick.*

Sekhmet — *Kemet*
War, pestilence, and healing (fierce healer). Lioness goddess who is simultaneously bringer and curer of disease.
How to honor: *Sekhmet was honored through appeasement ritual above all: the "Festival of Drunkenness" reenacted the myth of her rampage being halted by red-dyed beer mistaken for*

blood, and Amenhotep III commissioned some 700 statues of her — one for each day of the year — specifically to placate her destructive aspect. Physicians served formally as her wab-priests, and dream incubation was practiced in her temples for healing.

Sinthgunt — *Germanic Heathenry (Continental)*
Sister of Sunna; sang healing charm. Minor healing goddess named in the Second Merseburg Charm.
How to honor: *Sinthgunt appears only in the Second Merseburg Charm, sung alongside Sunna, Frija, and Volla to heal the sprained leg of Balder's horse — no separate cult or offerings are attested beyond this single healing incantation. The most accurate honoring is reciting or adapting the Merseburg Charm itself in healing-focused ritual, rather than inventing further practice.*

Temazcalteci — *Aztec/Mexica*
Grandmother of the Sweat Bath, manifestation of earth goddess. Deity presiding over healing/purification steam baths.
How to honor: *Temazcalteci ("Grandmother of the Sweat Bath," also called Toci/Teteo Innan) was central to the Ochpaniztli ("Sweeping") festival, in which a woman ixiptla was sacrificed and flayed and a priest wore her skin in a ritual of cleansing and renewal; ceremonial sweeping symbolized purification of home and community. She was closely tied to midwives, healers, and the temazcal itself, with maize offerings and sweeping implements as her key ritual objects.*

Wisdom & Knowledge

Deities of wisdom, writing, learning, prophecy, and hidden knowledge.

Abraham — *New Age Channeling (Esther Hicks)*
Collective intelligence channeled since 1980s, source of Law of Attraction teaching. Most commercially successful contemporary channeled entity.
How to honor: *Abraham, channeled by Esther Hicks, is honored primarily by attending live Abraham-Hicks workshops and cruises, and by practicing the Law of Attraction techniques taught — vibrational alignment, deliberate creation, and maintaining a state of appreciation/positive emotion. There is no altar or ritual object tradition; devotion is expressed through daily practice of manifestation processes rather than ceremonial worship.*

Ae-oyna Kamuy / Okikurmi (Ainurakkur) — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Culture-hero kamuy who taught humans fire-making, weaving, carving, fishing, ceremony. Bridge figure between kamuy and human worlds, teacher of civilization.
How to honor: *Ae-oyna Kamuy (Okikurmi), the culture-hero teacher kamuy, is honored through the performance of oyna epic narratives — long sacred song-poems recounting how he taught the Ainu fire-making, weaving, woodcarving, and fishing — recited at ceremonial gatherings by trained reciters, with inau and sake offered before performances begin as a mark of respect for his teachings.*

Athena — *Greek*
Goddess of wisdom, craft, just war, practical intelligence. Goddess of applied wisdom, born from Zeus's head.
How to honor: *Athena was honored above all at the Panathenaea in Athens, where a new woven peplos robe was ceremonially presented to her cult statue, accompanied by processions, athletic and musical contests, and sacrifices of cattle. Olive oil and olive branches, owls, and displays of skilled craft or woven textiles were fitting offerings, since she was patron of both strategic wisdom and craftsmanship (weaving, pottery, shipbuilding).*

Brihaspati (Guru, Vishnu) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Vedic)*
Jupiter deity, teacher principle. Vedic Jupiter deity ruling Guruvar (Thursday).
How to honor: *Brihaspati (Guru, Vishnu): Thursday devotion centers on Guru/Brihaspati and Vishnu — wearing yellow clothing, offering bananas, chana dal (yellow lentils), turmeric, and yellow flowers, and feeding Brahmins, teachers, or the poor as a core act of the observance. Many devotees keep a partial fast and avoid cutting hair or nails on this day out of respect for the teacher principle. Donating books or educational materials is considered especially auspicious to him.*

Budha (Ganesha, Vishnu) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Vedic)*
Mercury deity; Ganesha and Vishnu also honored. Vedic Mercury deity ruling Budhvar (Wednesday).
How to honor: *Budha (Ganesha, Vishnu): Wednesday devotion favors Ganesha — offering durva grass (considered his favorite), modak sweets, red hibiscus flowers, and green clothing or cloth on the altar, invoked before starting new ventures or study as remover of obstacles. Green — Budha's color — extends to green vegetables or green gram (moong) offered in charity. Vishnu is also honored with tulsi leaves on this day in some regional traditions.*

Budha (Jyotish) — *Vedic Astrology*
Prince of planetary court; intellect, speech, commerce. Mercury deity of intellect and communication.
How to honor: *Budha is worshipped on Wednesdays with green items — green moong dal, green clothes, and emerald (or green tourmaline) — offered at his temple at Thiruvenkadu; Vishnu worship is paired with his rites since Budha is considered under Vishnu's patronage.*

Devotees favor donating green items or educational materials to students and scholars, reflecting his rulership of intellect and communication.

Cerridwen — *Wicca*
One aspect/name of the Wiccan Goddess. A name the Goddess is known by.
How to honor: *Cerridwen is honored with a cauldron centerpiece on the altar, offerings of grain, herbs, mead, or a simmered "awen" broth, and symbols of the white sow, corn, and the moon; sacred plants include vervain and foxglove. Rituals draw on the Tale of Taliesin, with modern Pagans holding a Litha-timed cauldron rite and workings for inspiration, transformation, and shadow-work. Taboo: her cauldron symbolism spans both death/dissolution and rebirth, so rushed or fear-avoidant workings are discouraged.*

Damballah Wedo — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Great white serpent; ancient wisdom, cosmic order, purity. Oldest, most revered Rada Lwa of cosmic order.
How to honor: *Damballah is served with white foods only — eggs (often set on a bed of white flour drawn as a veve), white rice, milk, and plain unsalted dishes — never rum, pepper, or blood sacrifice, which are considered incompatible with his purity. His altar uses white cloth, white candles, and a white basin; devotees possessed by him move and hiss serpent-like, sometimes climbing rafters. He is syncretized with St. Patrick; taboo is offering him alcohol, spice, or anything red.*

Djwhal Khul — *Theosophy/New Age (via Alice Bailey)*
Tibetan Master said to dictate 24 volumes of teaching to Alice Bailey. Ascended Master source of Bailey's New Age cosmology.
How to honor: *Djwhal Khul ("the Tibetan") is honored through study of the 24 volumes of esoteric teaching he is said to have telepathically dictated to Alice Bailey, used as core curriculum in the Arcane School and Lucis Trust. Practice centers on group meditation at the monthly full moon (esoteric Full Moon Meditation), triangle meditation work linking practitioners worldwide, and study/application of his teachings rather than any offering-based ritual.*

Enki / Ea — *Mesopotamian*
God of wisdom, freshwater deep, magic, sacred arts; patron of diviners/exorcists. Human-friendly god who saved the flood survivor and rescued Inanna.
How to honor: *Enki/Ea, centered at his temple/abzu shrine in Eridu, was patron of the ashipu (exorcist) and incantation priests, who invoked him by name in nearly every protective and purification spell; fish held special reverence in his cult — fish offerings and fish-cloaked priest figurines (apkallu) are attested — alongside libations of clean water and beer. He was petitioned for protection, wisdom, and craft skill rather than feared; modern devotees keep water and fish imagery on his altar and recite incantations for cleansing.*

Five Buddha Families (deities, unnamed individually) — *Tibetan Vajrayana*
Five expressions of awakened mind transforming the five poisons. Five-part mandala mapping anger, pride, desire, jealousy, ignorance to five wisdoms.
How to honor: *The Five Buddha Families are honored through mandala offerings arranged by the five associated colors (white, blue, yellow, red, green) and the five-nectar/five-meat symbolic substances placed on the shrine during tantric feast practice. Each family is engaged through recognizing its corresponding affliction (ignorance, anger, pride, desire, jealousy) arising in daily life and holding it in meditation as the seed of its matching wisdom, rather than through external offering alone. Practitioners visualize the mandala during deity yoga sadhanas tied to their yidam.*

Guru/Brihaspati — *Vedic Astrology*
Minister of planetary court; greatest benefic; wisdom, dharma. Jupiter deity, preceptor of the gods.

How to honor: *Guru (Brihaspati) is honored on Thursdays with yellow flowers, turmeric, chana dal (yellow split gram), bananas, and yellow sapphire (pukhraj), with the Vishnu Sahasranama commonly recited; his principal temple is Alangudi. Devotees often fast on Thursdays and donate yellow items, books, or money to teachers and priests, since he is regarded as the guru of the gods and patron of wisdom and dharma.*

Hermes Trismegistus — *Greco-Egyptian syncretic*
Synthesis of Hermes and Thoth; author of Hermetic wisdom texts. Supreme divine teacher of Hermetic philosophy.
How to honor: *Hermes Trismegistus, a late syncretic teacher-figure rather than a cultically worshipped god, is "honored" through contemplative study rather than offerings — reading and meditating on the Corpus Hermeticum and the Emerald Tablet, and reflecting on maxims like "as above, so below." Renaissance and modern Hermeticists practice this as a philosophical/alchemical discipline of inner transformation rather than through sacrifice, altar offerings, or festivals, since no ancient offering practice is attested for him specifically.*

Hermes Trismegistus (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Hermetic)*
Legendary/deified sage-god of Hermeticism. Attributed author of the Emerald Tablet, "as above so below".
How to honor: *Hermes Trismegistus (Planetary Days) is honored through study/recitation of the Corpus Hermeticum and Emerald Tablet, meditation on the seven Hermetic principles, invocation blending Hermes/Thoth imagery, ibis or caduceus symbols, a scribe's reed pen, frankincense/myrrh incense, and Mercury's gray/iridescent color. No continuous ancient cult existed under this specific syncretic name, so modern Hermetic Order rituals on Wednesday — study and philosophical dialogue as the primary "offering" — are the most historically honest form of devotion.*

Hermes Trismegistus (Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology / Hermeticism*
Syncretic Greek-Egyptian sage-god; author of Corpus Hermeticum. Legendary composite deity-sage credited as founder of Hermetic philosophy underlying astrology.
How to honor: *Hermes Trismegistus in modern Hermetic practice is honored through study and recitation of the Corpus Hermeticum and Emerald Tablet, meditation on the seven Hermetic principles, and ritual invocation blending Hermes (Greek) and Thoth (Egyptian) imagery — an ibis or caduceus, a scribe's reed pen, incense (frankincense/myrrh), and Mercury's gray/iridescent color. No continuous ancient cult of "Hermes Trismegistus" specifically exists, so devotion centers on Hermetic Order rituals held on Wednesdays (Mercury's day) with study and philosophical dialogue as the primary "offering."*

Holy Spirit (Catholicism) — *Roman Catholicism*
Third person of Trinity, sanctifying grace. The divine breath/grace that sanctifies and guides the Church.
How to honor: *Third Person of the Trinity, invoked at Confirmation (anointing with chrism), at Pentecost (marked with red vestments and, in some parishes, releasing doves or scattering rose petals through a church oculus), and at the epiclesis of the Mass when the priest calls the Spirit down upon the bread and wine. Personal devotion includes the "Come, Holy Spirit" prayer, novenas to the Holy Spirit before Pentecost, and seeking the traditional Seven Gifts through prayer and sacramental life.*

Isis — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Greatest magical practitioner; goddess of devoted love and magic. Magic goddess who restored Osiris and holds Ra's secret name.
How to honor: *Isis's major public rite was the Navigium Isidis (March 5), a springtime festival launching a ship in her honor, with priests in white linen and shaven heads leading elaborate street processions with rattling sistra. Devotees offered milk, wine, roses, and incense at her shrines, and her mystery cult required formal initiation with vigils and purification — she was also called on directly for personal protection and healing.*

Jupiter (Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology*
Rules Sagittarius/Pisces; expansion, abundance, philosophy. Greater benefic planetary archetype of growth and meaning.
How to honor: *Jupiter rules Thursday, colors royal blue/purple, tin as metal, and stones like amethyst, lapis lazuli, and turquoise; incenses are cedar, sage, nutmeg, or clove. Expansion, abundance, and luck rituals are timed to his planetary hour with offerings of wine or rich food; careless invocation is associated with overindulgence and overpromising, so restraint is paired with Jovial workings.*

Mahatmas / Masters — *Theosophy (via Spiritualism)*
Advanced spiritual beings claimed to transmit hidden wisdom to Blavatsky. Ascended-teacher beings said to guide Theosophical doctrine.
How to honor: *The Theosophical Mahatmas (principally Koot Hoomi and Morya) were honored historically through Blavatsky's claimed receipt of the Mahatma Letters and through the Theosophical Society's reverence for them as members of a hidden spiritual Hierarchy. Devotional practice consisted of study of the Letters and Theosophical doctrine, aspiration toward chelaship (discipleship), and ethical/meditative self-development; devotion today survives mainly among Theosophists as faith-based study rather than public ritual.*

Math — *Welsh (Mabinogion, Fourth Branch)*
Divine king with magical restrictions/powers. Magically powerful divine king central to the Fourth Branch.
How to honor: *Honored in reconstructionist ritual as a king-magician figure tied to sovereignty, law, and hidden magical knowledge; offerings include wine, wands or ash/hazel wood, and items symbolizing kingship (a staff or seat). His myth's requirement that his feet rest in a virgin's lap (except during war) makes him associated with themes of purity, boundaries, and the cost of power, framed by devotional practice as lessons on discipline rather than literal ritual requirements. General Druidic respect for oath-bound magical authority is the guidance given.*

Mimir — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Guardian of the well of wisdom. Keeper of the cosmic well of knowledge beneath Yggdrasil.
How to honor: *No ancient offerings to Mimir survive, but modern seiðr practitioners and Heathens pour clear water, mead, or silver coins into natural springs/wells paired with meditation or "well of wisdom" rites for insight and memory, ideally at an actual spring at dawn or midnight; polluting or disrespecting water sources is treated as a direct offense to him.*

Minerva — *Roman Religion*
Wisdom, craft, war strategy; Capitoline Triad. Goddess of wisdom, craft, and strategic war.
How to honor: *Minerva was honored especially by craftspeople, teachers, physicians, and artisans at her festival Quinquatrus (March 19-23), when schools closed, students gave gifts to teachers, and craft guilds held special observances at her temples. The owl was her sacred animal and olive branch her attribute, both commonly used as votive offerings at her shrines.*

Nabu — *Mesopotamian*
God of writing and scribal arts, son of Marduk. Patron of scribes and written knowledge.
How to honor: *Nabu was honored at his temple Ezida in Borsippa, with a major procession during the Babylonian Akitu (New Year) festival when his statue traveled to Babylon to "visit" his father Marduk. Devotees honored him with writing implements (styluses, clay tablets), offerings of dates, incense, and beer, and his symbols are the wedge/stylus and the mushussu dragon. Modern practitioners set an altar with a pen/tablet, dedicate written work to him, and avoid careless or dishonest writing in his honor since he is patron of truthful scribal record-keeping.*

Odin — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Allfather, god of wisdom, war, magic, death. Discovered the runes by hanging on Yggdrasil nine nights.

How to honor: *Odin (Norse, general) was historically honored with mead or ale offerings (often poured from a drinking horn), and self-sacrifice was the core devotional theme — his nine nights hanging on Yggdrasil to win the runes is echoed in modern practice as seeking wisdom through genuine personal ordeal rather than easy ritual. Runic inscription and galdr (chanted spell-verse) are used to invoke him, ravens are fed or honored as his messengers (Huginn and Muninn), and Wednesday (Odin's day) is kept as his observance day in modern Heathenry.*

Orunmila / Ifa — *Yoruba/Ifa*

Destiny, divination, witness of creation. Orisha of wisdom who witnessed every soul's chosen destiny; source of Ifa divination.

How to honor: *Obatala devotees avoid alcohol and red items entirely and wear or offer only white — coconut, white rice, shea butter, cascarilla (efun/chalk), and white cloth are placed on his altar, and land snails (igbin) are a traditional offering associated with his cool, non-violent nature. His color is white, his number 8, and moral restraint and calm speech are expected of those who serve him.*

Padmasambhava (Guru Rinpoche) — *Tibetan Vajrayana*

Lotus-born tantric master who subdued Tibet's spirits. Indian tantric master credited with establishing Vajrayana in Tibet, transforming spirits into protectors.

How to honor: *Padmasambhava (Guru Rinpoche) is honored via tsok (ganachakra) feast offerings of food and drink shared communally, especially on the 10th day of the lunar month (Guru Rinpoche Day) and the 25th (dakini day), and through recitation of the Seven-Line Prayer and Vajra Guru mantra (Om Ah Hum Vajra Guru Padma Siddhi Hum). Termas (hidden teachings he concealed) are still being revealed and studied as living devotion, and guru yoga practice — visualizing him above the crown and receiving blessings — is central to daily Nyingma practice.*

Quetzalcoatl (White Tezcatlipoca, West) — *Aztec/Mexica*

Feathered Serpent, wind, Venus, wisdom, calendar. God of wisdom, breath of life, and the sacred arts.

How to honor: *Quetzalcoatl was honored with maize, beans, tamales, sacred flowers, and copal incense on altars featuring quetzal feathers, serpent imagery, and turquoise/jade or white; his wind aspect Ehecatl was worshipped in distinctive round temples with priestly self-bloodletting. Today, Danza Azteca (Conchero) groups continue his veneration through ceremonial dance, drumming, and copal smoke at plazas and archaeological sites; disrespecting feather/serpent regalia or ignoring reciprocal ritual obligation is taboo.*

Saraswati — *Hinduism*

Knowledge, learning, music, arts, speech. Goddess of learning, music and creative intelligence, consort of Brahma.

How to honor: *Saraswati is honored on Vasant Panchami (her main festival, in spring) when students and musicians place books, pens, and instruments before her image the night before to be blessed, then begin new learning the next morning as a sacred first step; she is depicted with a veena and swan, and her mantra is "Om Aim Saraswatyai Namaha." White flowers, particularly white lotus, are her preferred offering, and unlike most Hindu deities she is traditionally not offered tulsi or given elaborate food offerings — knowledge and creative practice offered in her name are considered more valuable than material gifts.*

Seth — *New Age Channeling (Jane Roberts)*

"Energy personality essence no longer focused in physical reality". Channeled entity teaching that "you create your own reality".

How to honor: *Seth, channeled by Jane Roberts, is honored not through ritual or offering but through study and application of the Seth Material's core teaching that "you create your own reality" — followers hold study groups and read the Seth books. There is no altar, festival, or physical offering tradition; devotion is intellectual/practical engagement with the philosophy itself.*

Shakyamuni Buddha — *Shingon*
Historical Buddha. Historical founder of Buddhism, teacher of fearlessness.
How to honor: *Amida Nyorai is honored above all through recitation of the nembutsu ("Namu Amida Butsu"), an act of faith reflecting his Pure Land promise of salvation through other-power; funerary rites invoke him to guide the deceased's spirit to the Pure Land, and his image is commonly the focus of household Buddhist altars (butsudan).*

Siddhi — *Hinduism*
Spiritual attainment (consort of Ganesha). Goddess of spiritual attainment, one of Ganesha's two consorts.
How to honor: *Siddhi, like Riddhi, is honored only in tandem with Ganesha — present in his iconography and receiving the same puja offerings (modak, durva grass, red hibiscus) during Ganesh Chaturthi, with no separate shrine or ritual calendar of her own.*

Sophia — *Christianity Origins (Gnostic tradition)*
Divine feminine wisdom, cause and redemption of creation. Highest-order divine being in Gnostic cosmology, whose fall initiates the material world.
How to honor: *Sophia has no ancient offering cult — she is a theological/mythic figure of divine wisdom in Gnostic cosmology, not a folk-worshipped deity. Modern Gnostic churches (e.g., the Ecclesia Gnostica) hold a Sophia-centered liturgy drawing on texts like Pistis Sophia, and contemporary Sophian/feminist spirituality circles honor her through contemplative meditation, hymnody, and blue-candle devotionals symbolizing wisdom and the sea. Her deepest historical "survival" is indirect — through Marian devotion and Black Madonna veneration, which absorbed her wisdom-mother imagery rather than continuing a distinct Sophia cult.*

Sophia (Gnosticism/Kabbalah) — *Gnosticism (Valentinian and others)*
Youngest Aeon of the Pleroma whose fall produced the Demiurge and material world. Fallen divine Wisdom-Aeon whose restoration is a goal of the Gnostic path.
How to honor: *Youngest Aeon whose fall produced the Demiurge and material cosmos; Valentinian Gnostics honored her restoration through the sacrament of the bridal chamber (a ritual of spiritual reunification), and hymns addressed to her survive in Nag Hammadi texts such as "Thunder, Perfect Mind." Devotional practice centers on gnosis — contemplative recognition of one's divine spark as a fragment of her scattered light — rather than offerings; her restoration (apokatastasis) is treated as the goal of practice, not an event to be ritually induced.*

Tenjin — *Shinto*
Deified scholar Sugawara no Michizane. Exceptional human elevated to kami of learning.
How to honor: *Tenjin (deified Sugawara no Michizane) is honored overwhelmingly by students and scholars, especially before exams, at Tenmangu shrines such as Kitano Tenmangu and Dazaifu Tenmangu; devotees write wishes on ema plaques and buy omamori charms for academic success. Plum blossoms are his sacred flower, with plum-viewing festivals (Baika-sai, February 25) at his shrines; ox statues are found throughout Tenmangu shrines, and touching the ox's head is believed to bring wisdom. The Tenjin Matsuri in Osaka (July 24-25) is a major citywide celebration.*

The Mahatmas / Masters (Morya, Koot Hoomi, Djwhal Khul) — *Theosophy*
Perfected human adepts guiding humanity's spiritual evolution. Human beings perfected through many incarnations, claimed custodians of secret doctrine.
How to honor: *The Mahatmas are approached through disciplined study of the Mahatma Letters and Theosophical texts, meditation directed toward their thoughtform/image, and aspiration to the ethical and spiritual disciplines attributed to them (self-mastery, service, brotherhood). Devotees connected to Djwhal Khul's teachings recite the Great Invocation, still broadcast worldwide at Wesak and through the ongoing Triangles meditation network run by Lucis Trust; belief in their literal existence is not required for Theosophical Society membership.*

Thoth — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*

God of wisdom, persuasion. Wisdom god who mediates divine disputes.
How to honor: *Thoth was honored above all at Hermopolis, where devotees mummified millions of votive ibises and baboons (his sacred animals) as offerings, interred in vast catacombs at Tuna el-Gebel. Scribes customarily poured a small libation of water from their writing palettes before beginning work as an offering to him, invoking him for skill in writing and wisdom.*

Thoth (Djehuty) — *Kemet*
Wisdom, writing, moon, magic, measurement. God of wisdom and writing who recorded the Weighing of the Heart; became Hermes Trismegistus.
How to honor: *Thoth was honored at Hermopolis through the ibis and baboon, his sacred animals — millions of mummified ibises and baboons, offered as votive gifts, have been excavated at the Tuna el-Gebel catacombs. Scribes invoked him before beginning any writing, leaving offerings of ink, reed pens, or papyrus, and lunar festivals tied to the calendar he was believed to have devised marked his worship.*

Tonpa Shenrab Miwoche — *Tibetan Bon*
Pre-Buddhist enlightened teacher/founder of Bon. Bon's claimed original teacher of enlightenment, predating the Buddha.
How to honor: *Tonpa Shenrab Miwoche is honored through depiction in thangkas and monastery murals, recitation of the Zhang Zhung Nyan Gyu oral transmission, and an annual birth/enlightenment commemoration observed at Bon monasteries such as Menri and Triten Norbutse with prayer and teaching. Devotees circumambulate Bon shrines and Mount Kailash (Tise, sacred to Bon as his cosmic seat) counterclockwise — the reverse direction of Buddhist practice — as a mark of Bon identity. Pilgrimage to Kailash itself is considered the highest act of devotion to him.*

Vainamoinen — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Immortal shaman-singer, born of Ilmatar. Central hero whose voice/song reshapes physical reality.
How to honor: *Väinämöinen is honored primarily through performance itself: reciting or singing the Kalevala's runos (runolaulu) in the old Karelian oral tradition, accompanied by the kantele he is credited with inventing, is considered the devotional act. Finnish Kalevala Day (Feb 28) marks communal recitation and cultural celebration of him; historically, tietäjä (shaman-healers) invoked his name in origin-charms for wisdom, protective magic, and mastery of word-power, since his songs were believed to literally reshape reality. No separate offering cult is attested — the song is the offering.*

Vajrasattva — *Shingon*
Bodhisattva of purification; held the Tantric transmission in the Iron Stupa. Bodhisattva who received and preserved the complete Tantric transmission.
How to honor: *Dainichi Nyorai is honored through the Sanmitsu (Three Mysteries) — hand mudras, mantra recitation, and mandala visualization — and above all through the goma fire ritual, in which practitioners write personal wishes on wooden sticks (gomagi) that a priest burns before his image while chanting, symbolically consuming obstacles and delusions in sacred flame.*

Vajrasattva (Tibetan) — *Tibetan Vajrayana*
Purification deity. Deity invoked for purification of negative karma and broken vows.
How to honor: *Vajrasattva (Tibetan) is honored through the second of the four ngondro preliminary practices: visualizing him seated above the crown in white light while reciting his 100-syllable mantra 100,000 times to purify broken vows and negative karma. Practitioners visualize nectar flowing down through the body, washing out impurities as black liquid exiting through the lower orifices. The practice requires prior empowerment from a qualified lama and is typically done in retreat-style repeated sessions rather than as a one-time offering.*

Vohu Mana — *Zoroastrianism*

Good Mind/Purpose, divine intelligence. Amesha Spenta of good mind who led Zarathustra into Ahura Mazda's presence.
How to honor: *Vohu Mana ("Good Mind") is honored through cultivating right thinking and especially through kindness and protection toward cattle, with which he is closely associated in Zoroastrian symbolism — dairy offerings and prohibitions on cruelty to cattle reflect this link. He is invoked in prayers seeking clarity and righteous judgment, following the model of his guiding Zarathustra into Ahura Mazda's presence.*

White Buffalo Calf Woman (All My Relations) — *Lakota (Sioux)*
Sacred woman (wakan) who brought the Sacred Pipe and Seven Sacred Rites. Central sacred teacher of the Lakota, comparable to Christ/Buddha in significance.
How to honor: *White Buffalo Calf Woman is honored through the very rites she gave the Lakota: the Sacred Pipe ceremony she brought is smoked with reverence and never treated casually, and the Sun Dance and other of the Seven Sacred Rites are performed partly in her memory. She is approached only with pure intention and ritual purity (often preceded by inipi/sweat lodge purification), and disrespecting the pipe or the rites is considered a serious spiritual offense; the birth of a rare white buffalo calf is still treated by many Lakota today as a sign of her renewed presence.*

Woden/Odin (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Norse)*
God of wisdom, poetry, magic, the dead; gives Wednesday its name. Norse equivalent of Mercury, "Wodnesdaeg".
How to honor: *Woden/Odin (Planetary Days): Odin hung nine nights on Yggdrasil and sacrificed an eye at Mimir's well to gain wisdom, so historical and modern devotion centers on seeking knowledge at personal cost — study, writing, and divination (rune-casting) on Wednesday. Offerings historically included mead and, in extreme historical accounts, hanging sacrifices at groves like Uppsala; modern practitioners substitute mead or spirits poured out, ravens/wolves as symbolic animals, and a blindfolded or single-eye-covered meditation. Boastful oath-breaking and cowardice in battle were considered offensive to him.*

Craft & Smithing

Divine artisans — gods of the forge, the loom, and skilled making.

Annikki — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Weaving. Daughter of Tapio and Mielikki.
How to honor: *Kyllikki, a literary figure in the Kalevala (Lemminkäinen's sister, tied to weaving, spinning, and dawn imagery), has no attested independent cult, altar, or offering tradition of her own. The respectful way to honor her is through storytelling of her Kalevala role (aiding her brother, her "evening maiden"/dawn association) and, in modern craft-focused pagan circles, dedicating a handwoven or handspun item to her during needlework as symbolic tribute.*

Hephaestus — *Greek*
God of forge, craft, fire; divine craftsman, alchemist's patron. God of the forge and transformative craft.
How to honor: *Hephaestus was honored at the Hephaestia festival in Athens, which featured a distinctive torch relay race symbolizing forge-fire, along with sacrifices and offerings of well-crafted metal objects. His major cult center was the island of Lemnos, where volcanic activity was linked to his forge; smiths and craftspeople traditionally kept his favor by maintaining their fires and offering the first well-made piece from a new tool or forge.*

Ikenga — *Igbo Odinani (Nigeria)*
God of achievement, strength, and human endeavor. Personal deity of accomplishment tied to a man's Chi expression in his work.
How to honor: *Ikenga is kept as a carved wooden horned figure (topped with ram horns symbolizing achievement and the right hand of personal power) on a household or personal shrine, spoken to directly, and given kola nut and palm wine offerings before undertaking major endeavors. A man's ikenga could traditionally be ritually "killed" (broken) upon his death or in cases of dishonor, since it embodied his personal accomplishment.*

Ioireag — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Fairy woman believed present at waulking (cloth-fulling). Fairy woman whose invisible presence protects the cloth-working.
How to honor: *The Ioireag was honored during waulking (luadh), the communal fulling of woven tweed, when women pouring milk offerings and singing waulking songs believed her invisible presence blessed and protected the cloth being worked. Failing to sing properly or show the milk offering was thought to risk spoiling the cloth or displeasing her unseen hand in the work.*

Kothar-wa-Khasis — *Canaanite*
Divine craftsman and smith. Builder of Baal's weapons and palace.
How to honor: *Kothar-wa-Khasis, divine smith of Caphtor, forger of Baal's weapons and palace, was invoked by artisans, builders, and magicians for craft-magic and incantations. Modern reconstructionists honor him with finely made tools, small crafted objects, myrrh or frankincense incense, and wine/oil libations at a workbench or hearth-altar before metalwork, woodworking, or creative projects — honoring is task-based rather than tied to any attested festival calendar.*

Lleu (Lleu Llaw Gyffes) — *Welsh (Mabinogion)*
God of many skills, cognate to Irish Lugh; dies and resurrects as an eagle. Multi-skilled god who undergoes death and eagle-form resurrection.
How to honor: *As the Welsh cognate of Irish Lugh, some modern Celtic reconstructionists and ADF-style Druids honor him around Lughnasadh (August 1) with offerings of grain, bread, and first harvest fruits, plus craft tools (since he is skilled in every art) placed on the altar. Eagle feathers or imagery reference his transformation into an eagle after Blodeuwedd's betrayal, and*

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oak is his associated tree. Approach with respect for resilience and rightful sovereignty rather than treating him as a simple victim figure.

Lugh — *Irish*
Master of all skills, sun, harvest. Divine warrior-craftsman possessing every skill; patron of the harvest festival.
How to honor: *Lugh is honored at Lughnasadh (August 1) with first-cutting offerings of the new grain baked into bread, hilltop gatherings (Croagh Patrick was originally a Lughnasadh assembly site), berry-picking, and athletic competitions — the Tailteann Games he founded in Tailtiu's memory featured races, wrestling, and trial marriages. As master of every skill, craftspeople and athletes especially invoke him before contests or new undertakings.*

Ogum — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Orixá of iron, tools, labor, opening paths. God of iron and the opener of ways.
How to honor: *Ogum, Orixá of iron and the opener of paths, is honored with palm oil and iron objects left at crossroads or forest edges, traditionally on Tuesdays, with offerings sometimes including black beans and cachaça. His feast is often syncretized with St. George (April 23rd) in Brazil; devotees in dangerous or tool-based professions — drivers, mechanics, soldiers, surgeons — petition him especially for protection.*

Ogun — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Iron, tools, labor, war, blacksmiths, farmers, surgeons. Orisha of iron, technology, labor, and sacred justice.
How to honor: *Eshu-Elegba must be greeted and fed first before any other Orisha is approached, or rituals are believed to go wrong; offerings include dark rum, cigars/tobacco smoke, candies, coconut pieces, and palm oil, placed at doorways, crossroads, or behind the front door. His colors are black and red, Monday is his day, and the numbers 3 and 21 govern his rites; toys and small coins are also left to appease his mischievous, trickster nature.*

Ptah — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Memphite creator god, creation through thought and speech. Craftsman-creator god of Memphis theology.
How to honor: *Ptah was honored at his Memphis temple through the living Apis bull, kept and venerated in his temple precinct as his physical manifestation, and through his role as patron of craftsmen — artisans traditionally made offerings and invoked him before undertaking construction or artistic work. His priests performed the "Opening of the Mouth" ceremony, ritually animating cult statues and mummies.*

Ptah (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Creation through thought and speech. God who created the world by conceiving it in his heart and speaking it into being.
How to honor: *Ptah was honored at his cult center of Memphis, where craftsmen and artisans especially claimed him as patron, with offerings of bread, beer, and incense at his temple. His living cult incarnation, the Apis bull, was kept, revered, and given elaborate mummification and burial rites at death, making Apis worship the most visible expression of devotion to Ptah in ancient practice.*

Ptahil — *Mandaean*
Fourth emanation ("Fourth Life"); flawed shaper of the material world and of Adam's body. Lesser divine being who crafted the material world and the first human's body.
How to honor: *The Uthras (light-world helper beings) are invoked collectively in the Masiqta (death mass) and daily Mandaean prayers (Rushuma) as guides of the soul's ascent; priests recite their names while wearing the white ritual rasta (turban and robe) during baptism and death rites, since Uthras receive the soul at each of the seven Light-world way-stations. Honoring them is liturgical, through correct recitation and ritual purity, not gift-giving.*

Spider Grandmother (Kokyangwuti) — *Hopi*
Co-creator, guide between worlds, teacher of weaving/planting/ceremony. Divine helper who breathed life into first humans and guided people between worlds.
How to honor: *Sotuknang has no dedicated shrine or personal offering rite; he is honored indirectly through the broader Hopi ceremonial cycle (including Wuwuchim and Soyal) that reaffirms the cosmic order he structured, and through the respectful title "He Who Sits at the Center of the Universe" used in oral tradition.*

Spider Man — *Navajo/Dine*
Designed the weaving loom, husband of Spider Woman. Co-teacher of sacred weaving.
How to honor: *Corn pollen prayers accompany work at the loom he is credited with designing, paired with the same spirit-line taboo observed for Spider Woman, and respect for spiderwebs as his living symbol — they are left undisturbed, especially around dawn and dusk.*

Spider Woman (Na'ashjei'ii Asdzaa) — *Navajo/Dine*
Holy Person who taught weaving to the Dine. Teacher of the sacred, cosmologically-encoded weaving art.
How to honor: *Corn pollen prayers are offered before beginning work at the loom, and a "spirit line" — a small deliberate gap woven into the border — is left in every finished piece so the weaver's spirit is not trapped inside it; omitting the spirit line is a living taboo. Spiderwebs, especially near dawn or dusk, are treated with care and not disturbed out of respect.*

Tane (Eastern Polynesia) — *Society Islands*
God of forests, beauty, birds, skilled craft; creator of first man. God of forests, beauty, and skilled craftsmanship.
How to honor: *Tane was honored with marae offerings of first fruits and breadfruit, and specifically by canoe-builders and craftsmen, who performed ritual permission-asking rites before felling trees sacred to him for canoes or carvings. His images were wooden, wrapped in bark cloth (tapa) and adorned with red and yellow feathers, and pre-'Oro-cult communities honored him as a peaceable, non-warlike god.*

Tvashtar/Vishwakarma — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Divine architect, presides over Chitra nakshatra. Divine craftsman-architect deity.
How to honor: *Tvashtar/Vishwakarma, presiding over Chitra nakshatra, is honored above all on Vishwakarma Puja (September 17 in most regions), when craftsmen, engineers, factory workers, and artisans clean and ritually worship their tools and machinery, offering sweets, flowers, and incense to ensure safety and skill in their work. This remains one of the most actively practiced deity-specific festivals among the nakshatra deities, especially in industrial and artisan communities across eastern and northern India.*

Justice & Law

Gods of oaths, law, moral order, and the judgment of right conduct.

Aryaman — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
God of patronage, presides over Uttara Phalguni nakshatra. Deity of service, patronage, and healing support.
How to honor: *Aryaman, presiding over Uttara Phalguni nakshatra, is likewise invoked mainly within Vedic wedding rites and rituals of hospitality and social contract, since he governs patronage, kinship bonds, and honorable dealings between people; his name appears alongside Bhaga and other Adityas in marriage mantras. No independent temple cult survives for him; his devotional presence is preserved through ritual formula rather than shrine worship.*

Fudo Myo-o (Acala) — *Shingon*
The Immovable One, protector of Dainichi. Wrathful protector deity who destroys obstacles to awakening.
How to honor: *Vajrasattva is honored through recitation of his Hundred-Syllable Mantra, often completed in sets of 100,000 repetitions as a purification practice, while visualizing him as brilliant white light dissolving into the practitioner. Access to his full transmission requires formal initiation (kanjo) from a qualified teacher.*

Gui shen (spirits/ghosts, collective) — *Mohism (China)*
Moral enforcer-spirits who observe and reward/punish human conduct. Supernatural moral witnesses to human behavior in Mozi's theology.
How to honor: *Karai, god of flame and the sun's heat, is honored through petygua (sacred tobacco pipe) smoke offerings and invoked in jeroky ceremonial dance alongside the other companion gods; his name is also given to Guaraní prophet-leaders (karai) who lead migrations toward the "Land Without Evil." Fire-tending and hearth maintenance in the opy carries devotional weight as his domain.*

Khshathra Vairya — *Zoroastrianism*
Righteous power/dominion. Amesha Spenta of righteous power and sovereignty.
How to honor: *Khshathra Vairya has no independent cult but is honored through the Zoroastrian calendar day/month "Shahrivar," when the Shahrivargan feast (gahambar-adjacent) is kept with prayers from Yasna 51 and offerings of iron/metal objects laid near the sacred fire. Devotees honor him chiefly through conduct — exercising just, protective authority over the weak — rather than through offerings; metalworkers and warriors traditionally invoke him for right use of power.*

Ma'at — *Kemet*
Truth, balance, justice, cosmic order. Goddess/principle personifying truth and cosmic order; weighed against the heart after death.
How to honor: *Ma'at was honored not through temple offerings but through conduct: judges and viziers wore her feather pendant as a badge of office, pharaohs are shown in temple reliefs ritually "offering Ma'at" to the gods (presenting a small statuette of her as the highest possible gift, truth itself), and living by the 42 Declarations of Innocence — keeping the heart "light" — was the core, lifelong devotional practice expected of every Egyptian.*

Mithra — *Zoroastrianism*
Guardian of covenants and contracts. Yazata enforcing agreements and punishing oath-breaking; later spread to Rome as Mithraism.
How to honor: *Mithra is honored above all at Mehregan, the autumn harvest festival still celebrated by Zoroastrians and Iranians today, with feasting, purple/gold-toned decoration, and thanksgiving prayers facing the rising or setting sun. Oaths are sworn in his name with hand on*

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fire or bread, and oath-breaking (mithra-drug) is the single gravest taboo associated with him, believed to bring supernatural punishment.

Mitra — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
The cosmic friend, presides over Anuradha nakshatra. Deity of friendship, devotion, and covenant.
How to honor: *Mitra, the Rig Vedic god of covenant and friendship who presides over Anuradha nakshatra, was honored in Vedic yajnas with milk and ghee poured to the paired deities Mitra-Varuna while reciting the Mitra Sukta. Modern nakshatra practice is japa of "Om Mitraya Namah" and white-flower/sandalwood offerings on Anuradha days; devotees traditionally use this alignment to mend friendships and honor vows, since broken promises or lies are considered gravely offensive to him.*

Rama — *Hinduism*
Righteous kingship, duty, honor. Avatar of Vishnu and ideal king who upholds dharma at all costs.
How to honor: *Rama is honored by chanting "Rama Nama" (his name) especially at death and during funeral processions, since it is believed to grant liberation; Diwali marks his triumphant return to Ayodhya after defeating Ravana, while Dussehra/Vijayadashami burns effigies of Ravana to celebrate that victory, and Ram Navami (his birthday) involves recitation of the Ramcharitmanas and Ramayana in temples. Offerings of tulsi, sweets, and fruit are standard, and truthful, dutiful conduct is treated as itself a form of honoring him.*

Rashnu — *Zoroastrianism*
Divine justice, judge of souls. Yazata present at the Chinvat Bridge holding the scales of judgment.
How to honor: *Rashnu is honored primarily through funeral liturgy — Yasht 12 (the Rashn Yasht) is recited for the dead, and he is invoked alongside Mithra and Sraosha as one of the three judges weighing a soul's thoughts, words, and deeds at the Chinvat Bridge. There is no independent offering cult; devotion consists of living an honest life whose deeds will bear his scrutiny.*

Tano — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*
River god of justice, water, and storms; one of four primary Abosom. Obosom governing justice, water, and storms.
How to honor: *Tano, the river god of justice, storms, and water, is served by Okomfo mediums who undergo ritual spirit possession at his shrines, most notably the sacred grove at Tanoboase near Techiman, a major pilgrimage and oracular site. People swear binding oaths "by Tano" when settling disputes, since he is believed to punish false swearing with sickness or misfortune, and petitioners bring eggs, mashed yam (eto), white cloth, and schnapps as offerings when seeking judgment or healing. As one of the four great Abosom, he is also invoked collectively with Bia, Epo, and Bosomtwe during general household and stool libations.*

Tiw (Tyr/Ziu) — *Germanic Heathenry*
God of justice, sacred law, honorable combat. Ancient sky-father-descended god of law and honorable war.
How to honor: *Tiw/Tyr is honored through oaths sworn on a weapon or ring in his name — breaking such an oath is a serious taboo — and through invocation before duels or battles for fair, honorable combat, sometimes marked by carving the Tiwaz rune onto a blade for victory. He shares in the Sigrblót (victory sacrifice at the start of summer) alongside Odin, and Tuesday bears his name.*

Tyr/Tiwaz — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
God of justice, sacrificial courage, sacred law. Sacrificed his hand to bind the wolf Fenrir for justice's sake.

How to honor: *Tyr (Norse, general) is invoked specifically at oath-swearing — historically warriors placed hands on a blade or ring and swore by Tyr, since he sacrificed his own hand into Fenrir's mouth to keep a binding oath, making him the model of justice paid for at personal cost. His rune (Tiwaz, an upward arrow ↑) was carved onto sword blades before battle to invoke victory and fair judgment; Tuesday bears his name, and he continues to be invoked by those seeking fairness in legal disputes or courage in a righteous cause rather than through food offerings.*

Utu (Shamash) — *Mesopotamian*
Sun god of justice, law, oaths, exposes what is hidden. Solar god of justice and divine witness to human action.
How to honor: *Utu/Shamash was worshipped at temple Ebabbar in Sippar and Larsa, invoked above all as witness and enforcer of oaths — legal and personal vows were sworn in his name, and Hammurabi's law code was framed as his gift. Devotion centered on the two daily thresholds of sunrise and sunset (his mythic gates, guarded by scorpion-men), when hymns and offerings of bread, incense, and libations were presented; his symbol, the solar disc, and gold/yellow tones suit an altar. Approach him for justice, truth-telling, and exposing what is hidden — not for concealment or dishonest petitions.*

Xangô — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Orixá of thunder, lightning, justice. Deified king, thunder god and dispenser of justice.
How to honor: *Xangô, Orixá of thunder and justice, is honored with amalá (cornmeal cooked in palm oil), red wine, and okra dishes, his day of the week being Wednesday and his colors red and white; his symbol is the double-headed axe (oxê). He demands absolute honesty from devotees — lying in his presence is considered a grave offense — and is linked to thunderstones believed to fall from the sky during storms.*

Zangbeto — *Ogu/Egun (Ewe-related)*
Nocturnal policing, dispute resolution, purification, environmental protection. Spirit-guardian manifesting as a spinning haystack costume, enforcing sacred justice at night.
How to honor: *Zangbeto is honored during Benin/Togo's Zangbeto festival, when the spinning haystack-costumed guardian appears after dark; the dance's climax — lifting the costume to reveal nothing underneath — is treated as living proof of the spirit's power and must be witnessed with respect, not skepticism. When Zangbeto's gongs sound, a curfew is enforced and residents are expected to stay indoors; sanctified mangrove/lagoon sites tied to the society are strictly off-limits to cutting or fishing.*

Music, Art & Dance

Muses and patrons of music, poetry, dance, and the sacred arts.

Ame-no-Uzume — *Shinto*
Kami whose ecstatic dance lured Amaterasu from her cave. Goddess of dance/mirth who restored light to the world.
How to honor: *Ame-no-Uzume is honored through kagura sacred dance performed at shrines associated with her myth (Sarutahiko-jinja, Ama-no-Iwato Shrine), often reenacting the story of her ecstatic dance that lured Amaterasu out of hiding; kagura suzu bell-clusters, mirrors, sake, and rice are typical offerings. As patroness of dance and mirth, she is honored less through solemn ritual and more through actual laughter, music, and uninhibited performance.*

Bragi — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
God of poetry and eloquence. Norse god of poetic and musical craft.
How to honor: *Bragi, god of poetry and eloquence and husband of Idunn, is honored in modern Heathenry/Ásatrú chiefly through the sumbel/symbel ritual, where toasts, boasts, and oaths are spoken over a drinking horn — the "bragarfull" (Bragi's cup/toast) is the specifically named ceremonial toast associated with him. Offerings include mead or ale, and devotees honor him by composing or reciting poetry, skaldic verse, or eloquent speech in his name. The emphasis is on sincerity when oaths are sworn in his cup, since oath-breaking was considered deeply dishonorable in the sumbel context.*

Calliope — *Greek (Muse)*
Muse of epic poetry, "beautiful voice," mother of Orpheus. Chief Muse, patron of epic poetry.
How to honor: *Calliope, chief of the Muses and mother of Orpheus, was invoked at the opening ("proem") of epic poetry — poets formally called on her for eloquence and memory before reciting works like the Iliad or Odyssey. She was honored collectively with her sister Muses at Mount Helicon's sacred spring, Hippocrene, and at the Museia festival at Thespiae, with offerings of milk, honey, and garlands rather than blood sacrifice.*

Clio — *Greek (Muse)*
Muse of history. Muse who preserves the past.
How to honor: *Clio, Muse of history, was invoked by historians and chroniclers before recording events, asking for accuracy and preservation of memory — a convention followed by writers like Herodotus. Like her sister Muses she was honored communally at Helicon's springs and the Thespiae Museia festival, with garlands and libations of milk or honey as fitting, bloodless offerings.*

Euterpe — *Greek (Muse)*
Muse of music and lyric poetry, "giver of delight". Muse of musical joy.
How to honor: *Euterpe, "giver of delight," Muse of music and lyric poetry, was invoked by musicians and lyric poets seeking joyful, melodic inspiration, often credited with inventing the double-flute (aulos). She shared in the collective Muse cult at Helicon and Thespiae, honored with music performance itself as a form of offering alongside garlands and milk-honey libations.*

Melpomene — *Greek (Muse)*
Muse of tragedy. Muse of sorrow's sacred art.
How to honor: *Melpomene, Muse of tragedy, was invoked by playwrights before composing tragic drama, and later became closely tied to the mask of tragedy as her iconographic symbol. Honored collectively with the other Muses at Helicon and the Thespiae Museia festival, her truest "offering" in practice was the performance of tragic theater itself at festivals like the City Dionysia.*

Polyhymnia — *Greek (Muse)*
Muse of sacred hymns, sacred geometry, meditation. Muse most directly tied to devotional song.

How to honor: *Polyhymnia, Muse of sacred hymns and meditative stillness, was invoked before composing devotional hymns and sacred choral poetry, and was associated with pantomime and geometry in later antiquity. She received the same modest communal honors as her sister Muses — garlands, milk, and honey at Helicon's sacred springs — with hymn-singing itself serving as her primary living devotional act.*

Terpsichore — *Greek (Muse)*

Muse of dance. Muse of dance as sacred participation.

How to honor: *Terpsichore, Muse of dance, "she who delights in dance," was invoked before choral dance performances that combined movement with prayer, since Greek dance was often itself a ritual act rather than mere entertainment. She shared the collective Muse cult honors at Helicon and Thespiae, and sacred dance performance remains the most authentic way to "offer" to her, both then and in modern Hellenic reconstructionist practice.*

Thalia — *Greek (Muse)*

Muse of comedy and pastoral poetry, "the flourishing one". Muse of sacred laughter.

How to honor: *Thalia, Muse of comedy and pastoral poetry, "the flourishing one," was invoked before comic and pastoral compositions, seeking wit and abundance in expression. She received the standard collective Muse honors — garlands, milk, honey libations at Helicon and the Thespiae Museia — with comic theater performance itself functioning as her living tribute.*

Urania — *Greek (Muse)*

Muse of astronomy and sacred science/astrology. Muse of the heavens and mathematical order.

How to honor: *Urania, Muse of astronomy and astrology, was invoked by those studying the heavens or practicing celestial divination, reflecting the ancient link between poetic inspiration and mathematical/cosmic order. She shared the collective Muse honors at Helicon and Thespiae, and stargazing or astronomical study performed with reverent attention was considered a fitting act of devotion to her.*

Animal & Nature Spirits

Spirits bound to specific animals, forests, and wild places.

Afeno — *Ewe/Vodun*
Forest, hunters, wild animals, herbs. Forest family of Trowo governing wilderness and healing plants.
How to honor: *Afeno, the forest-family of Trowo, is honored by hunters and herbalists who pour a libation and request permission before entering the bush, hunting game, or harvesting medicinal plants — taking from the forest without this acknowledgment is believed to bring illness or bad luck. Offerings are typically left at the base of significant trees or forest shrines.*

Bama (Crocodile Spirit) — *Bamana/Bozo (Mali)*
Sacred ancestor-spirit for whom the Bamana people are named. Master of the river's transition zones, dangerous and revered.
How to honor: *Represented in Sogo bo by large articulated crocodile puppets carried/danced by hidden performers to drumming and praise-singing, marking Bama as the ancestral namesake of the Bamana people; children are given names invoking Bama, and elders retell his founding-ancestor stories at masquerade gatherings rather than through any private shrine cult.*

Basajaun — *Basque*
Wild hairy forest lord who taught agricultural/practical skills. Massive wild forest being, dangerous yet beneficial teacher of civilization.
How to honor: *Basajaun, the wild forest lord, is honored through careful, respectful conduct in the forest — not disturbing his domain, leaving small food offerings at the forest's edge, and heeding his whistled warnings, which traditionally protected flocks from storms or wolves in exchange for respect. He was credited with teaching humans agriculture, ironworking, and saw-milling secrets; mocking or attempting to steal his knowledge without proper respect was taboo in the folk tales.*

Basandere — *Basque*
Female counterpart of Basajaun, Lady of the Forest. Wild female forest spirit, equally ancient as Basajaun.
How to honor: *Basandere, Basajaun's female counterpart and Lady of the Forest, has no attested cultic worship; she is honored through storytelling, respectful forest walks, and small natural offerings (nuts, bread, milk) left at forest edges as symbolic remembrance rather than documented ancient ritual. Modern Basque neopagans link her to wildwood protection in nature-focused seasonal gatherings, but any offering practice should be presented as contemporary revival, not historical fact.*

Beydo — *Zapotec*
God of wind and breath, life force (pee). Deity of movement, communication, and the spirit-carrying wind.
How to honor: *Beydo, deity of wind, breath, and life-force (pee), has no continuous living devotional tradition — specific offering practices are not well documented in surviving colonial-era sources, since Zapotec religion was largely suppressed after conquest. A respectful modern acknowledgment is a simple breath-focused meditation or copal incense offered outdoors, paired with study of legitimate ethnohistorical sources rather than invented ritual specifics.*

Blodeuwedd — *Welsh (Mabinogion)*
Woman created from flowers as Lleu's wife; later transformed into an owl. Flower-born divine woman later transformed into an owl as punishment.
How to honor: *Modern devotional practice (largely revivalist/Druidic) honors her with offerings of the three flowers she was made from — oak blossom, broom, and meadowsweet — plus white or pale flowers, moonlit or dusk rituals, and owl feathers/imagery on the altar. She is invoked*

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around autumn/harvest-to-owl transitions (some link her to Mabon/autumn equinox) and honored for themes of authenticity, agency, and reclaiming one's story after betrayal. Taboo: reducing her to only "the unfaithful wife punished into an owl" is considered disrespectful to her fuller meaning as a sovereignty/nature goddess.

Boa Constrictor Spirit — *Shipibo-Conibo (Peruvian Amazon)*
Primary spirit-animal form the meraya (highest healer) can transform into. The boa is the principal spirit-animal of Shipibo healing cosmology, embodying transformative healing power.
How to honor: *Rolled black jungle tobacco (Nicotiana rustica) is smoked and blown (shupe) over the crown, back, and afflicted areas for protection and cleansing, while raw mapacho juice is also drunk in isolation during a strict dieta (bland unsalted food, no sugar, pork, alcohol, or sex, often in forest solitude) to "seat" the plant's spirit as a lifelong ally. Its smoke opens and closes ceremony and sweeps out intrusive energies; casual recreational smoking without the accompanying diet and respect is considered a waste of its protective power.*

Buffalo (Tatanka) spirit/Great Provider — *Lakota and Plains nations*
Sacred animal relative providing food, shelter, clothing, tools, ceremony. Sacred provider animal, covenant partner of the Plains peoples.
How to honor: *Tatanka is honored as a covenant relative: hunters traditionally offered tobacco and prayer before a hunt and gave thanks afterward, and every part of the animal (hide, bones, sinew, organs, meat) was used so nothing was wasted, in keeping with Pte Oyate teachings tied to White Buffalo Calf Woman, who brought the sacred Chanunpa (pipe). A painted or unpainted buffalo skull serves as a central altar object in the Sun Dance (Wiwanyang Wacipi) and in vision quests (hanbleceya), oriented and prayed to as a living presence, not decoration. Buffalo hide robes and skulls are still used ceremonially by Lakota and other Plains communities today, and buffalo meat is served at wacipi (powwow) feasts as an act of respect.*

Caboclo / Cabocla — *Umbanda*
Indigenous Brazilian spirit guides of forest wisdom. Indigenous nature-spirit guides with plant medicine knowledge.
How to honor: *Caboclo/Cabocla spirits are honored outdoors with green candles, forest incense, tobacco (charuto smoke), and offerings of fruit or herbal remedies left at trees or riverbanks; they speak forcefully and directly during gira, often performing spiritual plant-medicine healing. Devotees greet them with "Okê!" or "Saravá!" and value straightforward, unflinching counsel over flattery.*

Do (Leaf Masks) — *Bobo Bwa*
Most ancient mask type, raw undifferentiated Dwo. Sacred leaf-mask embodying nature's generative power.
How to honor: *Do, the leaf-mask embodying raw, undifferentiated Dwo, is prepared by binding fresh leaves into mask form and ritually activating it with chicken-blood sacrifice and libations at the community shrine; it is periodically "fed" with millet porridge or beer, danced during initiation and harvest rites, and its leaves are eventually allowed to decompose back into the earth rather than preserved, symbolizing the cyclical, ever-renewing nature of the sacred force it carries.*

Epona — *Pan-Celtic (referenced as Rhiannon's root)*
Widely worshipped Gaulish/Celtic horse goddess. Ancient Celtic horse goddess ancestral to Rhiannon.
How to honor: *Epona has the best-attested cult of any Celtic deity: hundreds of votive altars, reliefs, and inscriptions survive across Gaul, Britain, Germany, and Rome, including dedications by Roman cavalry units who adopted her as patroness of horses and mules — she even had an official festival date, December 18, on the Roman calendar. Offerings were horses adorned with flowers or ribbons, grain, apples, and roses left at stable shrines and roadside altars. Modern honor follows this directly: caring well for horses, leaving grain or apples at a stable shrine, and marking her festival with equine imagery.*

Fenrir — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Monstrous wolf bound by the gods. Great wolf destined to kill Odin at Ragnarok.
How to honor: *No attested historical cult exists for Fenrir; modern Heathen/Lokean practitioners occasionally leave raw meat or bones outdoors at dusk for him, avoid chain/iron imagery on the altar as disrespectful, and invoke him as protector of the wild and the oppressed rather than as a monster.*

Forest Spirits / Water Spirits (Asaro) — *Asaro (Eastern Highlands, PNG)*
Non-human presences associated with specific trees, bush areas, rivers, pools. General animist spirit population of the Eastern Highlands landscape.
How to honor: *Asaro forest and water spirits tied to specific trees, bush groves, rivers, and pools are honored through avoidance and etiquette rather than offerings: travelers acknowledge these locations verbally, avoid loud disruption, urination, or defecation near sacred pools and named trees, and elders pass down which specific sites are inhabited so they can be treated with appropriate caution when passed or used for resources.*

Glaistig — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Half-woman, half-goat spirit tied to mills, bridges, households. Ambiguous protective/dangerous female spirit of specific locations.
How to honor: *The Glaistig, tied to mills, bridges, and byres, was traditionally given a share of milk poured into a hollowed offering-stone (clach na Glaistig) near her haunt, especially by herders and dairy workers seeking her protection over cattle. Travelers passing "her" bridge or mill were expected to greet her politely and avoid mocking or ignoring her presence, since she could turn from guardian to dangerous depending on how she was treated.*

Iinnii (Buffalo spirit) — *Blackfoot*
Sacred being in covenant exchange with the Blackfoot people. Buffalo spirit who chose to give itself to sustain the people.
How to honor: *Iinnii (Buffalo spirit) is honored by using every part of the animal without waste, offering tobacco and prayers of gratitude before a hunt, and through Iniskim (buffalo-calling stone) ceremonies and buffalo jump rites that treat the buffalo's self-giving as a sacred covenant rather than mere resource use. Wasting meat or hide, or failing to offer thanks, is a serious breach of that reciprocal relationship.*

Iniskim (Buffalo Stone spirit) — *Blackfoot*
Fossil/stone gift from the Buffalo people, calls buffalo herds. Singing stone teaching buffalo-calling songs to a starving woman.
How to honor: *Iniskim, the singing buffalo-stone spirit, is kept as a sacred bundle object wrapped and cared for with the same protocol as other medicine bundles, and used ceremonially with the buffalo-calling songs originally taught to a starving woman in its origin story. It is brought out specifically to call buffalo herds toward jump sites or camps, never handled casually outside its ceremonial context.*

Jasy Jatere — *Guarani*
Forest spirit associated with yerba mate (ka'a). Forest spirit linked to the sacred yerba mate plant.
How to honor: *Wi, the sun and one of the four superior Wakan Tanka beings, is honored above all through the Wiwáŋyaŋg Wačípi (Sun Dance), a multi-day ceremony in which dancers fast, gaze at the sun, and in the traditional form pierce the flesh and pull against a sacred cottonwood tree as a sacrifice of flesh for the people's wellbeing. It remains an active, living ceremony; outsiders are generally not permitted to participate without invitation.*

Jinew (Nature Spirits of the Niger, collective) — *Bamana/Bozo (Mali)*
Spirits inhabiting specific places (crocodile pools, hippo deep-water, antelope territory). Place-specific nature spirits whose permission and cooperation are required for fishing, hunting, and agriculture.

How to honor: *Honored via the Sogo bo ceremony at fishing and planting season openings/closings, with offerings of grain, fish, palm wine, and kola nuts left at the pool or territory boundary; Bozo fishermen verbally greet and ask permission of the jinew before entering crocodile pools, hippo channels, or antelope grounds, since their cooperation — not just placation — determines the catch or hunt.*

Jormungandr — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Midgard Serpent encircling the world. Giant serpent biting its own tail in the outer ocean.
How to honor: *No historical worship of Jormungandr exists; modern Jotun-honoring Heathens leave saltwater, fish, or circular/coiled objects (rings, bracelets) at the ocean's edge, invoking him on themes of balance and inevitability rather than destruction, and reject the purely-evil framing as a Christianizing distortion.*

Kachinas (Katsinam, 400+ named) — *Hopi*
Spirit intermediaries embodying rain, healing, abundance, protection. Category of sacred beings who reside with the Hopi half the year, becoming clouds/rain the other half.
How to honor: *Masauu is invoked in Hopi funerary rites as guardian of the dead and the underworld, and honored through the Wuwuchim initiation ceremony, which involves sacred fire central to his identity as Keeper of Fire; corn offerings and a posture of humility, cooperation, and strict adherence to his original instructions are the concrete expectations placed on those who deal with him.*

Kami (Five Paths) — *Shinto (referenced)*
Spirits inhabiting mountains, rivers, trees, extraordinary rocks. Nature-spirit presences of Shinto animism (generic category, no individual kami named).
How to honor: *Kami are honored through everyday Shinto shrine practice: purification at the temizuya water basin before approaching, a bow-bow-two claps-bow sequence at the offering hall, and small monetary offerings (saisen) dropped in a box before ringing a bell to summon the kami's attention. Seasonal matsuri festivals, rice, sake, salt, and evergreen sakaki branches are standard offerings at any shrine, and cleanliness/purity (avoiding death, blood, and impurity near a shrine) is the central taboo across virtually all kami veneration.*

Kami (general) — *Shinto*
Sacred presence inhabiting all things of eminent/awe-inspiring quality. Pervasive category of divine/sacred beings, not fixed in number.
How to honor: *Kami in general are approached through a fixed etiquette: purification (temizu hand/mouth rinsing at the shrine's water basin, or full misogi) before entering sacred space, then at the altar two bows, two claps, a silent prayer, and a final bow. Tamagushi (sakaki branch with paper streamers) and shinsen (rice, sake, salt, water, and seasonal foods) are the standard offerings, always given with sincerity (makoto) rather than transactional intent. Kami dislike impurity (kegare) — death, blood, and illness traditionally required ritual cleansing before shrine approach.*

Kana'ti — *Cherokee*
The Lucky Hunter, husband of Selu, keeper of game animals. Mythic first hunter who taught right relationship with animals.
How to honor: *Kana'ti, the Lucky Hunter and keeper of game in Cherokee tradition, is honored through hunting protocol still taught today: hunters offer thanks before and after a kill, take only what is needed, and historically presented the first game of the season as a first-fruits offering. Boastful or wasteful killing is taboo, since myth holds Kana'ti kept game animals in a hidden storehouse/cave and released them only to hunters who respected that relationship.*

Kariba — *Shingon*
Hunting deity, son of Niutsuhime. Shinto hunting kami associated with Mount Koya.
How to honor: *Niutsuhime is honored at Niutsuhime Shrine at the base of Koyasan, where she is credited in Shingon founding legend with guiding Kukai to the mountain; shrine rites include*

rice and sake offerings, and she remains formally venerated as Koyasan's original protective kami alongside the Buddhist establishment built on her land.

Kim-un Kamuy (Bear Kamuy) — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Master of the mountains, visits human world in bear form bringing meat and fur. Most important land kamuy, divine visitor wearing a bear's body.
How to honor: *Kim-un Kamuy, the bear kamuy, is honored above all through the Iyomante (bear-sending) ceremony: a bear cub raised by the community as an honored guest is ritually killed and its spirit sent back to the kamuy realm with prayers, inau (whittled wood prayer sticks), sake libations, and a feast, so it will report the Ainu's hospitality and return again bearing more meat and fur. Disrespecting the bear's remains, wasting its meat, or performing the sending without proper inau and prayer is a serious offense.*

Kotan-kor-kamuy (Guardian Owl) — *Ainu (Hokkaido, Japan)*
Guardian kamuy of the village, embodied by Blakiston's fish owl. Guardian owl deity ensuring community wellbeing.
How to honor: *Kotan-kor-kamuy, the guardian owl (embodied by Blakiston's fish owl), is honored through opening placement in the yukar/oyna sacred song and epic cycles performed at ceremonies, and through inau offerings set up in his honor at the village nusasan; his presence as village guardian meant owls were treated with particular reverence and never casually harmed, since harming the owl kamuy's physical form was believed to bring misfortune on the community.*

Lesní panny / Divé ženy — *Czech folk tradition*
Forest maidens/wild women protecting springs/mushroom patches. Forest guardian spirits who can mislead travelers.
How to honor: *Lesní panny/Divé ženy, forest maidens guarding springs and mushroom groves, were propitiated with small offerings of bread, milk, or fruit left at forest edges and springs, and by observing quiet, respectful behavior in the woods — not overharvesting mushrooms or berries, not shouting. Spinning on certain forbidden days was believed to summon or anger them; modern folk-revival practice continues leaving flowers, milk, and bread at forest springs, with disturbing their springs considered a serious taboo.*

Manasa — *Bengali (referenced via Patua tradition)*
Snake goddess whose story is depicted on Patua sacred scrolls. Bengali folk snake goddess depicted in Patua storytelling.
How to honor: *Manasa is honored primarily through the Jhapan Yatra festival in Bengal, where devotees (often snake charmers) handle live venomous snakes in ecstatic ritual as proof of her protection, and through Manasa Puja performed especially during the monsoon month of Shravan when snakebite risk is highest. Offerings include milk poured at snake holes/anthills, banana leaves, and flowers at her shrine (often a simple clay pot or tree-based altar rather than an anthropomorphic image); the Manasamangal Kavya poems are recited or sung as part of her worship, and the Patua scroll-painting tradition depicts her myth as a devotional narrative performance.*

Medeina — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Ruler of forests, trees, and wild animals. Forest and wildlife goddess.
How to honor: *Medeina was invoked by hunters and foragers before entering the forest, with a portion of the kill or gathered food left behind as a return-offering to her domain; taking more than needed was taboo. Her sacred creature is the hare, and wolves also run in her retinue. In modern Romuva forest rites, small offerings of bread, grain, or drink are left at the base of old trees with a spoken request for safe passage and good hunting/foraging.*

Mmoatia — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*
Small dwarf-like forest spirits, servants/guardians of Asase Yaa's deep forest. Dangerous, wise forest dwarf-spirits and guardians.

How to honor: *Mmoatia, the small forest-dwelling spirit-dwarfs, are approached mainly by traditional herbalists and akomfo (priest-healers) seeking secret plant knowledge, since they are said to reveal herbal medicine and are the traditional source of Akan herbal lore when properly petitioned. Offerings of unsalted mashed plantain or palm-nut soup are left at forest edges, since mmoatia are said to dislike salt strongly — salted food is considered an insult or even repellent to them. Ordinary people show respect simply by entering deep forest quietly and courteously, avoiding boasting or loud talk, since mmoatia are held to be easily offended but capable of great favor to the humble.*

Nagas — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
Divine serpents presiding over Ashlesha nakshatra. Serpent deities symbolizing mystical power and cunning.
How to honor: *The Nagas, presiding over Ashlesha nakshatra, are honored above all through Naga Panchami (a major pan-Indian festival), when devotees offer milk to snake idols, anthills, or live snakes handled by snake charmers, along with turmeric, flowers, and rice; snake-stone (naga-kal) shrines under trees receive regular milk offerings from women seeking fertility or protection from snakebite. Ashlesha-nakshatra individuals often perform dedicated Naga dosha remedial pujas for the same reasons.*

Nahual — *Zapotec*
Personal animal-spirit counterpart connected to an individual from birth. Animal spirit double; powerful shamans could shapeshift into it.
How to honor: *One's nahual (animal-spirit double) is honored primarily by protecting and respecting the linked animal itself, since harm to the nahual is believed to cause corresponding harm to the person; some traditions link the nahual to one's birth day-sign, and powerful shamans were said to be able to shapeshift into theirs deliberately. Naming or acknowledging one's nahual and avoiding harm to its animal kind is the core practice rather than shrine-based offerings.*

Nandi — *Hinduism*
Shiva's bull vehicle; discipline. Patient bull mount of Shiva symbolizing the disciplined mind.
How to honor: *Nandi is honored by devotees who circle him and whisper wishes or prayers into his ear before addressing Shiva, since he is believed to relay messages to the god he faces. He receives offerings of milk poured over his statue, bael (bilva) leaves, and marigold garlands, and his image is always positioned facing the Shiva lingam in temple architecture.*

Nature spirits (unnamed) — *Hamar (Ethiopia)*
Inhabit rocks, trees, water sources, hills. Impersonal but powerful presences inhabiting specific landscape features.
How to honor: *Hamar nature spirits inhabiting rocks, trees, and springs are honored with small offerings of milk, coffee husks (buna), or honey beer (borde) left at the site, and specific trees, rocks, or hills are marked off-limits to cutting, farming, or disturbance without prior ritual acknowledgment. Approaching such sites loudly, urinating near them, or removing anything without permission is treated as a serious taboo likely to bring misfortune or illness.*

Ngen — *Mapuche*
Guardian spirit inhabiting every significant natural feature (rivers, mountains, trees). Nature-guardian spirits underpinning Ixofill Mogen.
How to honor: *Ngen spirits are honored through acknowledgment before use, not offerings alone: Mapuche traditionally speak a request aloud before drawing water, cutting a tree, or gathering medicinal plants from a ngen-inhabited river, mountain, or forest, and leave small gifts such as muday (fermented cereal drink), tobacco, or coins at the site. They are invoked collectively at the nguillatun, the great communal prayer/fertility ceremony, alongside Ngenechen. Angering a ngen through over-harvesting, pollution, or careless disturbance is believed to bring illness or misfortune to the offender.*

Ochossi — *Lucumí*
Orisha of the hunt, one of the Warriors; ensures aim/intentions reach target. Hunter Orisha received among the Warriors (syncretized with St. Norbert/St. Hubert).
How to honor: *Ochossi, received as one of the Guerreros (Warriors) alongside Elegguá and Ogún, has a small bow-and-arrow figure placed pointing toward the door or toward one's goals as a request for accurate aim in life. He is fed smoked bushmeat, honey, rum, and cigars, particularly by hunters and by anyone seeking justice, since he is also patron of law and the courtroom (syncretized with St. Norbert or St. Hubert); his color is blue and amber/gold and he dislikes deceit in pursuit of a goal.*

Ongons — *Evenki/Tungus Siberian Shamanism*
Physical spirit-images/dwelling places for helping spirits. Small figures housing a shaman's community of helping spirits.
How to honor: *Evenki/Tungus shamans keep ongon figures (carved wood, metal, or cloth-and-fur effigies) wrapped and hidden from outsiders' eyes in a special bag or corner of the tent; they are periodically "fed" by smearing their mouths with animal fat, blood, or vodka, especially before a hunt or healing session, and are inherited within shaman lineages rather than made anew casually. Neglecting to feed them or exposing them carelessly to non-initiates is considered dangerous and disrespectful.*

Oxóssi — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
King of the forest and the hunt. Hunter-king Orixá governing strategy and abundance.
How to honor: *Oxóssi receives forest fruits, honey, corn dishes (canjica, pamonha), and game or roasted meats left at the base of a tree or forest shrine; his colors are green and blue (sometimes gold), his day is Thursday, and his emblem is the ofá (bow and arrow) alongside a peacock feather fan. He is greeted with the shout "Okê Arô!" and syncretized with St. Sebastian, honored for bringing abundance, strategy, and provision through the hunt.*

Pan — *Greek*
Wild god of nature, panic, ecstasy; world-soul of the natural cosmos. Half-goat god of raw nature and instinctive fear.
How to honor: *Pan was honored with offerings left in caves and grottoes — his preferred sacred spaces — including milk, honey, and first-fruits of the harvest, along with occasional goat sacrifice reflecting his goat-legged form. Rural shepherds particularly venerated him to protect flocks and avert "panic" (a term derived from his name) in both animals and armies; he favored wild, untamed places over formal temples, and startling or mocking him in his sacred haunts was considered dangerous.*

Permoník — *Czech folk tradition (Bohemian mining)*
Dwarf-like mine spirits. Underground beings who help or hinder miners.
How to honor: *Permoník, dwarf-like spirits of Bohemian mines, were respected by miners who left small portions of bread in the tunnels and spoke to them courteously; their knocking sounds were heeded as warnings of impending cave-ins, and greed or disrespect toward them was believed to bring collapse or misfortune. Whistling or soft tapping was used to acknowledge and communicate with them underground.*

Rhiannon — *Welsh (Mabinogion)*
Otherworld horse goddess, Welsh descendant of Epona; wife of Pwyll. Divine horse-goddess of the Otherworld, descendant of Gaulish Epona.
How to honor: *Rhiannon is honored with offerings horses would take — oats, barley, apples — and with white horse figurines or imagery on the altar, reflecting her nature as an Otherworld horse goddess (kin to Epona). Her myth of enduring false accusation with patience and dignity (forced to carry visitors on her back and confess her "crime" like a beast of burden) makes her a figure invoked for justice against slander and unjust suffering. Her three magical birds, whose song heals grief, are honored by valuing birdsong; Calan Mai (May Day), tied to Welsh horse-procession customs like the Mari Lwyd tradition, is a fitting time for observance.*

Salimopiya — *Zuni (Pueblo)*
Guardian figures accompanying the Council of the Gods. Guardian spirit-beings protecting the sacred procession.
How to honor: *Salimopiya, the guardian figures accompanying the Council of the Gods, are honored through ceremonial entry from the sacred directions as protectors of the sacred procession during the Shalako cycle. As with Sayaykia, detailed devotional practice beyond this processional role is not well documented outside Zuni community knowledge.*

Sasabonsam — *Akan (Ghana/Ivory Coast)*
Terrifying forest giants representing the forest's dangerous, unpredictable dimension. Fearsome forest giant spirit.
How to honor: *Sasabonsam is overwhelmingly a feared, avoided figure rather than one devotionally worshipped: hunters avoid lingering beneath silk-cotton (onyina) and other tall trees at dusk, since he is said to dangle his legs from the branches to snatch passersby, and carrying iron or a blade is traditional protection because he reportedly fears iron. Rather than offerings, respect takes the form of cautionary storytelling and murmured protective invocations to Nyame or the ancestors before entering deep forest. Taboos include whistling, boasting, or traveling alone through dense forest at twilight.*

Sidhe (collective, incl. fairy folk/aos si) — *Irish*
Inhabitants of fairy mounds/hollow hills. Tuatha De Danann in their post-defeat aspect, inhabiting the Otherworld alongside humans.
How to honor: *The Sídhe are honored by leaving milk, cream, butter, or bread out overnight, especially at Bealtaine, and by never cutting a solitary hawthorn ("fairy") tree — a taboo still enforced in living memory, most famously when a 1999 Clare motorway was rerouted around a fairy bush rather than fell it. Building on or disturbing "fairy paths" between raths is avoided, and iron is traditionally used at doorways for protection from them rather than as an offering.*

Simargl — *Slavic Paganism*
Winged dog/griffin of fire, guardian of seeds/plants. Guardian spirit-creature of fire and crops.
How to honor: *Simargl, a winged dog/griffin guardian of seeds, sown fields, and the World Tree, is attested in the Primary Chronicle's list of Vladimir's pantheon; modern Rodnovery honors him with offerings of grain, seeds, and milk left at field edges or garden altars, especially at spring sowing time, and dog/griffin imagery as a symbol. Genuinely thin historical source material exists beyond the chronicle listing, so much modern practice is reconstructionist; the most respectful approach is a simple seed/grain offering at planting time.*

Tane — *Polynesian (Maori)*
God of forests; separated sky and earth; created first woman. Forest god who created light, life, and humanity.
How to honor: *Tāne is honored through karakia recited before felling trees or gathering forest resources, asking his permission and giving thanks to Tāne Mahuta, lord of the forest. The kauri tree is treated as his most sacred living form, with large named kauri themselves treated as objects of pilgrimage and reverence.*

Tane Mahuta — *Maori*
God of forests, birds, creator of humans. Separated Ranginui and Papatuanuku, created first human Hineahuone.
How to honor: *Tane Mahuta is honored through karakia recited before felling any tree or taking anything from the forest, asking his permission and explaining the need. Traditional practice required leaving the first tree of a stand untouched as a token to him, and rahui (temporary forest closures) are placed to let areas recover under his protection. Taking birds or timber wastefully, or beyond what karakia and need justify, is considered a direct offense against him.*

Tapio — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*

Forest king, master of the hunt. Forest god who grants successful hunts as a gift.
How to honor: *Tapio, "Metsän isäntä" (Master of the Forest), was addressed with spoken hunting prayers (Tapion virsi) asking him to release "Tapion kultaa" ("Tapio's gold," folk-speech for game) from his herds; hunters left bread, salt, or a coin at the forest edge or on a stone, removed their hats on entering deep forest as respect, and avoided loud talk or boasting, believed to anger him and doom the hunt. Taking more than needed, or failing to thank him afterward, was taboo and thought to end future hunting luck.*

The Wor / Wo (collective) — *Ga People (Ghana)*
Lesser divine forces tied to natural features and human concerns (fertility, fishing, health, rain). Active divine forces governing specific domains and communities.
How to honor: *The Wor are served through Wulomei (priests) and Woyei (priestesses) who lead kpele drumming, singing, and dance that induces possession trance, during which the deity is believed to speak through the medium. Offerings typically include schnapps or gin, eggs, white cloth, and fowl sacrifice at sacred groves or shrine houses, with taboos varying by which Wor is served; a pre-Homowo ban on drumming and noise is a recognized period of ritual quiet before the festival.*

Turtle (Turtle Island) — *Haudenosaunee*
Bears the earth on its back. Animal being on whose back the earth was formed.
How to honor: *Grandmother Moon (Haudenosaunee) is honored primarily through the Thanksgiving Address, thanked by name in her own passage for regulating tides, waters, and the planting calendar; women's ceremonies and full-moon gatherings also acknowledge her influence over fertility and cycles.*

Tuulikki — *Finnish/Karelian/Estonian*
Animal-calling. Daughter of Tapio and Mielikki.
How to honor: *Tuulikki, daughter of Tapio and Mielikki, associated with calling and herding forest animals for the hunt, is invoked by hunters through spoken charms asking her to "release" game from the forest's protection, sometimes with bread or tobacco left at a forest edge. Modern Suomenusko practitioners include her in forest-blessing rites before hunting or foraging trips; taking game wastefully or without gratitude was believed to close off the forest's future generosity.*

Vayu — *Hinduism*
Wind. Wind god and father of Hanuman.
How to honor: *Vayu is invoked in Vedic fire rituals with ghee offerings and is honored indirectly through Hanuman worship (as his son), where sindoor mixed with oil is smeared on Hanuman's image. Pranayama (controlled breathing) practice is sometimes framed as a living devotional acknowledgment of Vayu, though he has few dedicated temples or independent festivals today.*

Wolf (spirit patron) — *Tonkawa (Texas plains)*
Spiritual patron of the hunt; sacred compact partner with human hunters. Sacred animal spirit representing directed power and the hunting compact.
How to honor: *Wolf is honored via the Wolf Dance ceremony: fasting and purification precede the rite, dancers wear wolf-hide regalia, the wolf spirit is addressed directly as a partner in the sacred hunting compact, and farewell songs close the ceremony. This reflects a reciprocal relationship in which the hunter's success depends on maintaining right relationship with the wolf spirit, not domination over it.*

Wolf (Sunkmanitu Tanka) spirit — *Lakota and others*
Teacher of community, loyalty, cooperative strength. Animal spirit teacher of loyalty and collective strength.
How to honor: *Wolf medicine was traditionally called on by hunting parties and warrior/scout societies for cooperative strength, loyalty, and stealth; some warrior societies wore wolf skins,*

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tails, or headdresses as a mark of Wolf's protection and were literally called "wolf soldiers" in some accounts. Tobacco offerings and prayers invoking Wolf preceded group hunts, asking for the pack's coordinated success to be shared with the hunters. Wolf's example of pack loyalty is still cited today in teachings about tiyospaye (extended family/community) obligation.

Yunwi Tsunsdi (Little People) — *Cherokee*
Small supernatural mountain/underground beings. Little People who teach songs/medicines to the spiritually prepared.
How to honor: *The Yunwi Tsunsdi (Little People) are honored through quiet reciprocity: leaving a small food or tobacco offering if they've helped you (returned a lost child, taught a song or medicine), and strictly keeping any promise made to them. Speaking publicly about a song or cure they've taught you is taboo and believed to cause the gift to be withdrawn; staring at or spying on them is likewise avoided.*

Zaouli — *Guro (Côte d'Ivoire)*
Sacred mask-spirit of beauty, healing, and community protection; embodied by consecrated dancer. The Zle-derived mask spirit whose dance heals, protects, and blesses the Guro community.
How to honor: *Marian devotion centers on the Rosary (five decades of Hail Marys meditating on the Joyful/Sorrowful/Glorious/Luminous Mysteries), the Angelus prayer at set daily hours, and votive candles lit before her statue or icon; May and October are set aside as her devotional months, with flower-crowning ("May crowning") of her statue a widespread parish practice. Pilgrimage is central — Lourdes, Fatima, and Guadalupe draw millions who leave flowers, candles, and written petitions; the Miraculous Medal and blue/white color scheme are worn as continuing devotional objects.*

Zle (collective nature spirits) — *Guro (Côte d'Ivoire)*
Owners of the land — inhabit trees, rivers, hills, forest zones. Forest/nature spirits who predate and exist independent of human genealogy.
How to honor: *Zaouli is honored through strict ritual protocol rather than casual offering: the mask is ritually consecrated with sacrifice by designated ritual specialists, stored in a restricted men's sacred enclosure (never seen by uninitiated women), and must be greeted and "fed" symbolic offerings at set intervals to keep its spirit active. Performances only occur on divination-confirmed occasions; the identity of the dancer beneath it is a sacred secret — breaking these taboos is believed to bring misfortune.*

Messengers & Psychopomps

Divine messengers and guides who move between worlds, carrying words and souls.

Anubis (Anpu) — *Kemet*
Embalming, guardian of the threshold of death. Jackal-headed guide of souls through the Duat and supervisor of the Weighing of the Heart.
How to honor: *Anubis was honored through the embalming process itself: priests conducting mummification wore his jackal mask while performing the Opening of the Mouth ceremony, and offerings of natron, linen, and myrrh/frankincense accompanied funerary rites under his supervision. He remains invoked today at moments of death, grief, or major transition, with black-toned offerings and prayers for safe passage through the Duat.*

Bari Gongju — *Korean Muism*
Abandoned princess who traversed the underworld to bring healing water; guides souls through the spirit road. Mythic princess-psychopomp who guides the deceased's soul to the afterlife.
How to honor: *Bari Gongju is honored through Jinogi Gut (and related Ssitgim Gut) death rites, where the mudang performs her myth as a sung narrative (muga) recounting her journey through the underworld to retrieve the water of life. Offerings include clean water (echoing the life-water she brought back), white rice cakes, paper flowers, and chrysanthemums, all meant to guide the deceased's soul safely along the "flower road" to the afterlife; her story itself functions as the ritual technology for psychopomp work.*

Caboclo das Sete Encruzilhadas — *Umbanda*
Spirit who founded Umbanda in 1908. Founding spirit-guide of the Umbanda religion.
How to honor: *Caboclo das Sete Encruzilhadas, the founding spirit of Umbanda (manifested through medium Zélio de Moraes in 1908), is honored on the congá altar with a lit cigar or pipe, red wine or cachaça, fruit, and a white or green-and-gold candle. November 15 (Dia da Umbanda) is his major commemoration with gira, drumming, and communal food offerings; he is addressed with reverence as a guiding teacher-spirit, not propitiated as a dangerous entity.*

Eagle (Wanbli Gleska) spirit — *Many nations*
Messenger to the Creator, carries prayers upward, guardian of the East. Sacred messenger bird linking human and divine worlds.
How to honor: *Eagle feathers are the highest ceremonial gift and must be earned — through war deeds historically, and today through graduation, military service, or significant life achievement — never bought, sold, or casually given; under the federal Eagle Feather Law only enrolled tribal members may legally possess them, sourced through the National Eagle Repository. A feather is treated as a living relative: it must never touch the ground, and if one falls during a dance, only a designated veteran may retrieve it through a specific "fallen feather" ceremony before dancing resumes. Eagle feather fans are used to fan smoke from sage, sweetgrass, or cedar over people and the pipe during prayer, and single feathers are worn or presented at honoring ceremonies as tokens of respect and prayer carried to Wakan Tanka.*

Garuda — *Hinduism*
Vishnu's eagle vehicle, enemy of serpents. Mighty eagle-king who serves as Vishnu's mount.
How to honor: *Garuda is petitioned for protection from snakebite at Garuda Panchami (observed in Nepal and parts of India), when women pray to snake and Garuda imagery together and avoid frying/cutting foods that day as taboo. Garuda-stambha pillars stand before many Vishnu temples (notably Tirupati, where a special Garuda seva is performed), and his image or flag is venerated as Vishnu's vehicle rather than independently.*

Heimdall — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Guardian of Bifrost, divine watchman. Watchman god guarding the rainbow bridge to Asgard.

How to honor: *Heimdall is honored with offerings of clear/pure water, mead, gold or gold-colored objects, a drinking horn, or a ram (his sacred animal); altars often include a horn (recalling Gjallarhorn) and rainbow or bridge imagery. He is invoked for protection, vigilance, and boundary/threshold blessings — some modern Heathens light a candle at doorways or property lines in his honor. Avoid careless oaths or dishonesty near his altar, as he is associated with truth and guardianship.*

Hermes (Greek) — *Greek*
Messenger of gods, guide of souls, god of language/magic/boundaries. Boundary-crossing messenger god, prototype of Hermes Trismegistus.
How to honor: *Hermes was honored at herma — stone pillars topped with his head, placed at crossroads, doorways, and boundaries — where travelers left small stones or offerings for safe passage; adding a stone to a herma or cairn is a practice that persists informally in hiking culture. The Hermaea festivals, especially for youths and athletes, and first-fruit offerings from merchants honored his patronage of trade, travel, communication, and boundary-crossing.*

Jesus Christ (Michael the archangel) — *Jehovah's Witnesses*
Firstborn/greatest creation of Jehovah, heavenly king since 1914. Not God but God's first and greatest created Son, pre-existent as the archangel Michael.
How to honor: *Jesus Christ (identified by Witnesses as the resurrected Michael the archangel) is honored primarily through the annual Memorial service and through obedience taught as loyalty to Jehovah's Kingdom under Christ's heavenly rule since 1914. Crosses and other religious imagery are explicitly rejected as pagan and are not used in worship or on Kingdom Halls, distinguishing this practice sharply from mainstream Christianity.*

Jibril (Gabriel) — *Islam*
Angel who delivered Quranic revelation to Muhammad. Chief angel of revelation, created from light.
How to honor: *Angel who delivered the Quranic revelation to Muhammad; not propitiated with offerings, but honored through recitation and memorization of the Quran itself as the message he transmitted, and through special reverence for Laylat al-Qadr (the Night of Power) during Ramadan, traditionally associated with his descent. Muslims mention him respectfully with the phrase "peace be upon him" and affirm belief in him as one of Islam's six articles of faith.*

John Frum — *Vanuatu (Tanna Island)*
Cargo-cult deliverer figure who appeared to prophets in 1930s. Sacred deliverer promising cargo abundance if kastom is maintained and colonial religion rejected.
How to honor: *Honored annually on John Frum Day, February 15, at Sulphur Bay village with flag-raising, uniformed "John Frum Army" parades bearing carved bamboo rifles and "USA" painted on bare chests, string-band music, and all-night kava drinking; symbolic bamboo airstrips and a red cross (echoing WWII cargo planes and medical supplies) are maintained year-round as points of expectant contact, framed as fidelity to kastom against mission Christianity.*

Melek Taus — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Chief of the Seven Holy Beings; governor of the earth; intercessory being. The Peacock Angel, most beautiful of the seven angels, whose 7,000 years of weeping extinguished hell.
How to honor: *Because Khwedê is beyond all description, image, or direct address, there is no shrine, offering, or prayer aimed at Khwedê alone — devotion flows through the Seven Holy Beings who mediate divine will, through communal prayer facing the rising/setting sun, and through the great pilgrimage festivals at Lalish (notably Cejna Cemaiye in autumn). Taboo: Yazidis avoid uttering words resembling "Sheytan," and outsiders should not attempt to picture, name, or petition Khwedê directly, since that role is filled by the intercessory Seven.*

Mercury — *Roman Religion*
Commerce, communication, sacred messages, guide of the dead. Divine messenger and patron of merchants.

How to honor: *Mercury was honored especially by merchants at his festival Mercuralia (May 15), when Roman traders would sprinkle themselves and their goods with water drawn from his sacred well while praying for forgiveness of past dishonest dealing and future profit. As psychopomp and messenger he was also invoked before journeys; the caduceus and winged sandals were his standard votive imagery.*

Mercury (Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology*
Rules Gemini/Virgo; mind, communication, commerce. Messenger planetary archetype of intellect and language.
How to honor: *Mercury rules Wednesday, colors yellow/orange, quicksilver as metal, and stones like agate, citrine, and aventurine; incenses are lavender, storax, and mastic. Communication, travel, business, and study spells are timed to his day/hour using his caduceus/sigil and written petitions burned or buried; starting contracts or launching new communications during Mercury retrograde is widely avoided.*

Mercury/Hermes (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Roman/Greek)*
Governs communication, intellect, trade, travel. Roman/Greek messenger god, ruler of Wednesday.
How to honor: *Mercury/Hermes (Planetary Days): Rome's Mercuralia (May 15) had merchants sprinkle themselves and their goods with water drawn from his sacred spring near the Porta Capena, asking forgiveness for past dishonest dealing while seeking future profit. As patron of travelers, thieves, and boundaries, small offerings were left at crossroads herms (boundary markers topped with his image). Modern Wednesday practice favors precise, honest writing and speech, contract review, and short journeys begun under his hour.*

Met Kalfou — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Petwo master of the crossroads at night. Fierce nighttime counterpart to Papa Legba.
How to honor: *The gui shen (ghosts/spirits) were honored through traditional Chinese ancestral and state sacrifice practices that Mozi explicitly defended on the grounds that belief in watchful, reward-and-punish spirits deters wrongdoing and strengthens social order — he argued for maintaining ancestral offerings for this deterrent effect. His treatise "Ming Gui" lays out testimonial evidence for their reality and urges continued ritual observance.*

Nephthys (Kemet) — *Kemet*
Protection, liminal threshold guardian. Guardian of the threshold between worlds.
How to honor: *Nephthys was honored jointly with Isis in funerary ritual as chief mourners, invoked throughout the Pyramid Texts and Book of the Dead; offerings of black linen and myrrh accompanied her role as "Lady of the House" guarding thresholds. During Khoiak's Osiris rites, priestesses ritually enacted the "Two Kites" — reciting the Lamentations of Isis and Nephthys over the god's effigy — a practice modern Kemetics revive at twilight and liminal-time devotions.*

Ninshubur — *Mesopotamian*
Inanna's minister who appeals to the gods for her rescue. Divine minister/messenger securing Inanna's resurrection.
How to honor: *Ninshubur, Inanna's loyal sukkal (minister/vizier) who successfully petitioned the gods to rescue Inanna from the underworld, has no independent large temple cult but was honored as part of Inanna's retinue and invoked as patroness of loyal service and intercession. Modern devotees offer incense, small gifts, or written prayers of gratitude to her when asking for help through allies/advocates, echoing her role as the one who never gives up seeking aid.*

Papa Legba — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Guardian of all gateways, crossroads, and communication. Elderly gatekeeper Lwa who must open the way before other Lwa can come.
How to honor: *Invoked first in every ceremony before any other Lwa may be approached, and never last, since without him the gate stays shut; offerings include coffee, rum, cigars, candy, roasted corn, and small coins left at literal crossroads or doorways. His sacred day is Monday*

and his color purple (sometimes red-and-black); an old man's cane, straw hat, and pipe mark his altar, and he is syncretized with St. Peter/St. Lazarus. Taboo: skipping his opening salute is believed to close off the ceremony entirely.

Papa Legba (referenced) — *Hoodoo (via Vodou influence)*
Gatekeeper of the spirit world, sometimes identified with the crossroads spirit. Cross-referenced gatekeeper spirit associated with the Hoodoo crossroads.
How to honor: *Always saluted first in any Vodou-influenced ceremony before any other spirit is addressed; offerings include black coffee, rum, cigars or pipe tobacco, peppermint or coconut candy, corn, and coins, placed at a crossroads or doorway altar beneath his veve traced in cornmeal. His hours are Fridays and dawn/dusk, and he appears as an old man with a cane and straw hat, so disrespecting an elder or a poor person is taboo, as is skipping him in ritual order.*

Pushan — *Vedic Astrology (Nakshatra deity)*
The nourisher, guide of lost souls, presides over Revati nakshatra. Divine shepherd guiding travelers and souls.
How to honor: *Pushan, Vedic pastoral guide of travelers and lost souls presiding over Revati nakshatra, has one specific and well-attested devotional detail: because myth holds he lost his teeth when struck by Shiva at Daksha's sacrifice, he is offered karambha, a soft barley-and-curd gruel, rather than solid food. Devotees invoke him ("Om Pushne Namah") for safe travel and to recover lost livestock or possessions, with japa and gruel offerings performed on Revati nakshatra days.*

Shalako — *Zuni (Pueblo)*
Giant (10-ft) bird messengers of the rain gods. Annual messenger figures who bless newly built homes at winter ceremony.
How to honor: *Shalako is honored through a year-long preparation by host families for the newly built homes to be blessed, culminating in the winter ceremony: feasting, all-night dancing by the towering (10-ft) messenger figures, and a ceremonial foot race. Hosting a Shalako is considered a major honor and obligation involving substantial community investment.*

Sraosha — *Zoroastrianism*
Divine obedience, sacred hearing. Yazata who carries prayers to Ahura Mazda and grace back to humanity.
How to honor: *Sraosha is invoked nightly in the Aiwisruthrem (evening) prayers and the Srosh Baj recitation said before sleep for protection from evil spirits until dawn. Dogs are his sacred animal and are treated with formal respect in Zoroastrian practice, including the sagdid rite (a dog "viewing" the dead) performed at funerals under his auspices.*

Uthra (angelic beings, collective) — *Mandaean*
Angelic emanations of Hayyi Rabbi who assist soul descent/return. Beings of pure light who assist the soul's journey to and from the World of Light.
How to honor: *Hayyi Rabbi ("The Great Living One") is approached exclusively through Mandaean priesthood (tarmida, ganzibra) and living-water ritual, above all the masbuta — repeated full-immersion baptism in flowing river water performed by a priest throughout life, connecting Mandaeans to the World of Light. Daily prayer facing north and the masiqta (death-mass ritual guiding souls upward) are the other core devotional structures; because he is transcendent, no image, temple statue, or direct offering is made to him — right ritual performance by ordained priests is the honoring itself.*

Xolotl — *Aztec*
Lightning-dog god; twin of Quetzalcoatl; psychopomp guiding souls through Mictlan. Canine god who guides souls across the underworld's rivers.
How to honor: *Aztec lightning-dog god, twin of Quetzalcoatl, psychopomp — honor him through dog imagery (especially the Xoloitzcuintli, historically sacrificed or buried with the dead to guide souls across Mictlan's river) and axolotl imagery as his aquatic form, plus the twisted "wind*

jewel" ornament and ollin (movement) glyph. No single named public festival is documented specifically for him; modern practitioners honor him via Day of the Dead observances and offerings of water/food at crossroads or graves. Taboo: harming or disrespecting dogs, and treating death or the underworld journey lightly.

Trickster

Tricksters and boundary-crossers whose disruption is itself sacred and generative.

Angra Mainyu (Ahriman) — *Zurvanism (Persian)*
Evil spirit born of Zurvan's single moment of doubt; source of corruption, disease, death. Destructive twin god who seized dominion over the material world for 9,000-12,000 years.
How to honor: *Angra Mainyu (Ahriman) receives no offerings or shrine in Zoroastrian or Zurvanite practice — he is never worshipped, only ritually opposed. Devotees "honor" him only in the sense of actively resisting him: reciting the Ahunavar prayer, maintaining ritual purity, avoiding contact with corpses/decay (his domain), and performing the Nowruz and Sadeh fire festivals that symbolically reaffirm light's eventual victory over his darkness at the end of the 12,000-year cosmic cycle.*

Baba Yaga — *Slavic Paganism*
Forest witch, death/transformation, threshold guardian. Ambiguous crone who tests and either aids or devours seekers.
How to honor: *Baba Yaga is approached with strict hospitality protocol rather than offerings: tradition holds a visitor must address her hut correctly ("turn your back to the forest, your front to me") to make it turn and open, then accept her reversed hospitality — she feeds, warms, and baths the guest before asking why they've come, and answering her questions honestly and respectfully (never rudely) determines whether she helps or devours the seeker. She is not propitiated with a shrine; the "offering" is correct manners, courage, and truthful speech at her threshold.*

Black Man of the Crossroads — *Hoodoo (American South)*
Spirit governing the crossroads intersection between worlds. Spirit presiding over the most sacred site in Hoodoo, where exchanges between human and spirit worlds occur.
How to honor: *Petitioned at a literal crossroads (where two public roads cross, never a dead-end) at midnight or just before dawn, sometimes over nine consecutive visits (traditionally nine Sunday mornings before sunrise); offerings include liquor, a black or red rooster in older African-rooted variants, or a silver coin left as "payment" for the power requested. The petitioner must not show fear or flee, and afterward must walk home without looking back.*

Bolo (Fiber Masks) — *Bobo Bwa*
Wild, unpredictable bush-force masks. Comic wild masks carrying away communal disorder.
How to honor: *Bolo fiber masks of the Bobo Bwa are "fed" with chicken blood and millet porridge before appearing, and are deliberately allowed comic, disruptive behavior during masquerade to publicly air and carry off social tensions and disorder. They are stored in the sacred bush shed between performances and handled only by initiated men of the Do society; treating their transgressive antics as literal wrongdoing (rather than sanctioned ritual release) misunderstands their role.*

Coyote — *Tonkawa (Texas plains)*
Trickster-transformer whose disruptive cleverness inadvertently completes the world. Trickster spirit whose unpredictable actions create the world's necessary complexity.
How to honor: *No distinct, well-documented Tonkawa-specific devotional practice for Coyote survives — most published "Coyote" ritual material comes from other Southwest/Plains nations, not Tonkawa sources specifically, since Tonkawa oral tradition was heavily disrupted by 19th-century removal. Honor him by telling or reading his trickster stories aloud (traditionally a winter/night practice among Plains peoples generally); a small tobacco offering left outdoors with words of thanks is a widespread pan-tribal gesture, though not Tonkawa-attested specifically.*

Coyote (All My Relations) — *Plains/Southwest nations*

Trickster figure who creates through mischief/chaos. Trickster-creator figure of Plains and Southwest traditions.
How to honor: *Coyote, the Plains/Southwest trickster-creator, is honored not through offerings but through the careful, often seasonally-restricted telling of his stories — many Southwestern and Plains nations traditionally reserve Coyote tales for winter nights, believing that telling them out of season is disrespectful or even dangerous — with storytellers expected to relate his misadventures accurately as both entertainment and moral instruction.*

Elegguá — *Lucumí*
Guardian of crossroads, beginnings, all communication; first honored in every ceremony. Orisha of crossroads and open/closed paths (syncretized with Infant of Atocha/St. Anthony).
How to honor: *Elegguá is greeted first and last in any ceremony — before any other orisha receives attention, before leaving or entering a home. His concrete "head" sits behind or beside the front door, fed on Mondays (his day) and the 3rd of the month with candy, rum, cigars, smoked fish, jutía, palm oil, and toasted corn; coconut and cascarilla divination is used to ask him directly what he wants. He dislikes being ignored or placed at eye level — he's kept low, near the ground/threshold — and red, black, and white beads/cloth mark his color line.*

Eshu / Elegba — *Yoruba/Ifa*
Guardian of crossroads, thresholds, messenger between worlds. Orisha of the crossroads, communication, and messages between human and divine.
How to honor: *Olodumare is not approached with direct offerings, shrines, or priesthood in Yoruba practice — devotion is channeled entirely through the Orishas and Ifa divination, since Olodumare is considered too vast and remote for personal petition. The concrete way devotees honor Olodumare is ethical: living in alignment with Ase (life-force) and destiny, invoking the name only in opening blessings before ceremonies directed at the Orishas.*

Exu — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Lord of crossroads, communication, beginnings. First-honored Orixá who opens all paths between humans and Orixás.
How to honor: *Exu, lord of the crossroads in Candomblé/Umbanda, is always saluted and fed first in any ceremony — before any other Orixá — with offerings of red palm oil (dendê), rum or cachaça, cigars, and raw meat left at crossroads or thresholds, traditionally on Mondays. His colors are red and black; ignoring or disrespecting him is believed to block all other paths and invite chaos, which is why he opens every ritual.*

Flint (Bad Mind) — *Haudenosaunee*
Difficult, disruptive creative twin. Twin who created hardship features of the world; not eliminated, only banished.
How to honor: *The Thunderers (Hino/the Grandfathers) who bring lightning and rain are formally thanked at Step 12 of the Thanksgiving Address, recited communally at the opening of ceremonies; tobacco is the traditional offering burned in acknowledgment. Some traditions describe leaving tobacco outdoors during the first thunderstorm of spring as a direct greeting to their return.*

Gwydion — *Welsh (Mabinogion)*
Nephew of Math; trickster-magician of great power. Powerful trickster-magician who creates Blodeuwedd and shapes Lleu's fate.
How to honor: *Honored in modern Druidic/reconstructionist practice with offerings of wine or mead, storytelling aloud, and objects tied to magic and eloquence (a wand or staff, oak wood); associated with Gwynedd and the Milky Way (Caer Gwydion in Welsh folk-astronomy) so night-sky rituals are sometimes used. He's petitioned for skill in magic, wit, storytelling, and clever problem-solving. General respect for his trickster-magician nature — not invoking him for cruelty or deception of the innocent, echoing his own myth's consequences — is common-sense guidance.*

High John the Conqueror (spirit of the root) — *Hoodoo (American South)*
Spirit/folk-hero presence carried in the root for strength and victory over oppressors. Trickster folk hero (enslaved African king's son) whose spirit empowers the namesake root.
How to honor: *Carried in a mojo bag or pocket and treated as a living presence — "fed" periodically with drops of whiskey, Hoyt's cologne, or oil, and spoken to daily about specific goals to keep the root "working." The root should never be shown to others or handled by anyone but its owner; a piece is traditionally carried on the person for luck, protection, and victory over oppressors, echoing the folktale of the enslaved king's son whose trickster wit outsmarted his captors.*

Iktomi — *Lakota Sioux*
Spider trickster; gave humans speech. Trickster spider credited with giving humans speech.
How to honor: *The Wakinyan (Thunder Beings) are honored by those who receive a "thunder dream" — such dreamers are obligated to become heyoka, sacred clowns who behave backwards/contrarily as both a healing role and a humbling discipline. Thunder and lightning during storms are treated as their direct voice. Taboo: a person who receives the thunder dream and refuses the heyoka role is traditionally believed to risk being struck by lightning.*

Iktomi (All My Relations) — *Lakota (Sioux)*
Spider trickster figure. Lakota trickster spirit.
How to honor: *Iktomi is honored chiefly by keeping the storytelling tradition alive rather than through altars or offerings: traditional protocol holds that Iktomi/trickster tales are told only in winter, after first snowfall/frost, and never in summer — telling them out of season is considered disrespectful and can invite bad luck. Elders relate his stories at winter gatherings as moral teaching tools, since his foolishness and trickery illustrate what not to do. There is no shrine or feast for him; reverence takes the form of correct seasonal timing and faithful oral transmission.*

Koshare (Hano Clown) — *Hopi*
Sacred clown teaching values through transgression. Transgressive sacred clown considered father of the Kachinas in some accounts.
How to honor: *Koshare/Tewa clowns appear at kachina plaza dances (especially summer dances and Niman) painted in black-and-white or ochre horizontal stripes with corn-husk topknots, and are honored by tolerant participation rather than punishment: spectators feed them watermelon, peaches, and other treats they beg or steal, and let their gluttonous, boundary-crossing antics play out as pointed moral lessons rather than scolding them. Respect is shown by taking the mockery of bad behavior (greed, vanity, disrespect) seriously as instruction, not by treating the figure as comic relief only.*

Koyemsi (Mudhead) — *Hopi*
Sacred clown, also announcer/drummer. Rounded clay-masked clown figure who shepherds ceremonial proceedings.
How to honor: *Koyemsi (Mudheads) appear masked in rounded clay-colored heads at nearly every public kachina dance, acting as drummers, announcers, and guides who keep order and lead games between dances. Honoring them means active participation: children and adults join the races, guessing games, and gift exchanges the Mudheads organize, and accept the small gifts (piki bread, fruit, trinkets) they distribute as blessings rather than mere toys. Laughter and cooperative play during their antics is itself the correct form of respect.*

Loki — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Trickster, agent of disruption and change. Complex trickster who both helps and ultimately betrays the gods.
How to honor: *Loki is actively honored today by "Lokeans" with offerings of alcohol (whiskey/mead), spicy or fire-associated candy, shiny/reflective objects, matches or a lit candle, and items in green, black, or red/orange; altars often include fire symbolism, mirrors, and images of foxes or serpents. No ancient blót to Loki is documented, so modern devotional dates are self-chosen — some use April Fools' Day or a modern Loki's Day (August 1). Avoid closed-*

mindedness or rigid ritual — devotees say Loki dislikes stiff formality and responds better to humor, honesty, and creative offerings.

Maui — *Polynesian (Pan-Polynesian)*
Heroic demigod who fished up islands, snared the sun, brought fire. Trickster-hero who reshaped the physical and temporal world.
How to honor: *Maui has no attested shrine, altar, or offering tradition; he is honored entirely through oral performance — mele (chants), genealogical recitation, and storytelling crediting him with snaring the sun, fishing up islands, and bringing fire, plus place names commemorating his feats. Traditional tattoo motifs and navigational lore invoking his cleverness are the closest living practice.*

Maui (Hawaiian) — *Hawaiian*
Demigod (kupua) who fished up the Hawaiian islands, snared the sun, brought fire to humanity. Trickster demigod of transformative feats and cosmological mischief.
How to honor: *Maui is honored through oral performance — mele (chant) and hula recounting his exploits (snaring the sun atop Haleakalā, fishing up the islands, obtaining fire from the mudhen ʻalae) are the primary living devotional form, performed at hula schools (hālau) and cultural festivals rather than through altar offerings. Haleakalā ("House of the Sun") itself functions as a site of informal pilgrimage tied directly to his myth, and storytelling to children carries much of his continuing cultural transmission.*

Maui (Maori master) — *Maori*
Demigod trickster hero. Fished up North Island, snared the sun, stole fire, sought immortality.
How to honor: *Maui is honored primarily through oral transmission — waiata, whakapapa, and pūrākau recounting his feats (fishing up the North Island/Te Ika-a-Māui, snaring the sun at Tauwhare, retrieving fire from Mahuika, and his fatal quest for immortality against Hine-nui-te-po) are retold at hui, in schools, and on marae as both entertainment and moral instruction. No shrine or offering tradition is attested; place-names and landmarks linked to his exploits (e.g., the shape of the North Island as his "fish") function as ongoing living acknowledgment rather than ritual devotion.*

Nanabozho (Nanabush, Great Hare) — *Algonquian peoples*
Trickster/culture-bringer figure among Algonquian peoples. Algonquian trickster-culture hero.
How to honor: *Nanabozho is honored through oral storytelling and the Midewiwin tradition of the Ojibwe, where he is credited with helping bring the sacred Midewiwin medicine lodge teachings to the people; seasonal storytelling restrictions similar to Coyote's apply (many Algonquian traditions reserve Nanabozho stories for winter), and he is remains invoked as a culture-bringer figure whose trickster tales carry moral teaching for listeners.*

Napi (Old Man) — *Blackfoot*
Creator-trickster who shaped the physical world. Creator-trickster who made the world from mud, flawed and revisable.
How to honor: *Napi (Old Man) has no standalone offering cult; he is honored chiefly through accurate oral storytelling of the Blackfoot creation narrative, particularly during winter storytelling season when such tales are traditionally told. His presence is also marked in the landscape itself (e.g., places named for him, such as areas along the Oldman River), and respect is shown by not altering or embellishing his stories beyond what tradition-keepers relate.*

Pitao Xicala — *Zapotec*
Deity of dreams, vision, intoxication (pulque), night consciousness. Rules the threshold between ordinary and spirit world.
How to honor: *Pitao Xicala governed dreams, visionary states, and night consciousness, and was invoked by those seeking altered or prophetic states, with pulque (fermented maguey drink) serving as a ritual intoxicant central to threshold/vision rites in Zapotec and broader Mesoamerican practice. Documentation is thin compared to major agricultural deities; honoring*

him today is best done through accurate ethnohistorical study rather than reconstructed offerings.

Rahu — *Vedic Astrology*
North lunar node; obsession, illusion, karmic direction. Shadow planet representing the severed head of demon Svarbhanu.
How to honor: *Rahu is appeased with blue or black flowers, black sesame seeds, coconuts offered into flowing water, mustard oil, and hessonite garnet (gomedh) worn as a gemstone remedy; his temple is at Thiruvidan Maruthur (Rahu Sthala) in Tamil Nadu. Devotees often perform Rahu-specific homas (fire rituals) during eclipses or afflicted planetary periods, since he is associated with obsession, illusion, and sudden upheaval that ritual seeks to stabilize.*

Raven (All My Relations) — *Pacific Coast/Arctic nations*
Trickster who stole the sun from a box, bringing light to the world. Trickster-creator of Northwest Coast/Arctic traditions.
How to honor: *Raven, the Northwest Coast/Arctic trickster who stole the sun, is honored through the potlatch and clan crest system — Raven moiety clans among the Tlingit, Haida, and Tsimshian display his image on totem poles, masks, and regalia, and Raven story-cycles are performed at potlatches and winter ceremonial gatherings as both sacred history and clan identity, with careful protocol around who has the right to tell or depict specific Raven stories.*

Set — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Necessary disruption, chaos, change; defender of Ra against Apophis. God of chaos and creative destruction, murderer of Osiris.
How to honor: *Set was honored with red offerings (red being his color of desert/chaos) at his cult center of Ombos (Nubt) in Upper Egypt, and invoked in oaths and protective spells as Ra's essential defender against the serpent Apophis. His reputation shifted from respected/protective to increasingly demonized after later invasions were associated with him, so honoring him authentically means recognizing this dual character.*

Tezcatlipoca (Serpent and Star) — *Aztec*
Smoking Mirror; night, sorcery, destiny, testing of character. Shapeshifting god of night, fate, and testing, eternal rival of Quetzalcoatl.
How to honor: *Honored through obsidian mirror divination and scrying, black body paint, and offerings of tobacco, obsidian, and dark-colored items reflecting his night/fate domain. His central rite was Toxcatl: a flawless young man was chosen a year in advance to live as the god's living embodiment — given luxuries, four brides, and reverence — then sacrificed at the festival's climax, reenacting the god's inevitability and the fragility of fortune. Approached with wariness as capricious ruler of fate, sorcery, and testing of character; associated with north and the color black in five-direction offerings.*

Fate & Destiny

Weavers of fate, destiny, and the unfolding of a life or the cosmos.

Afa — *Ewe/Vodun*
Divination, destiny. Deity, practice, and body of knowledge governing personal destiny through the 256 Odus.
How to honor: *Afa (the Fa/Ifa divination system shared with Yoruba culture) is consulted through a bokono diviner using sixteen palm nuts or a divining chain to reveal one's personal Odu (destiny sign) out of 256 possible configurations. Each Odu prescribes specific vosa (sacrifices, often involving kola nuts, gin, or animals) and personal taboos the client must then follow for life, making Afa as much a lived ethical practice as a ritual one.*

Baba (Butterfly Mask) — *Bobo Bwa*
Mask spirit of metamorphosis/death-rebirth. Butterfly-form mask spirit symbolizing transformation.
How to honor: *Bobo Bwa butterfly-mask (Do cult) rites require the mask to be "fed" — sacrificial chicken blood and millet beer poured onto the fiber/wood, then stored hidden in a sacred bush shrine (not a house) when not in use. It is danced at initiations, funerals, and key agricultural turning points (start of rains, harvest) to enact death-rebirth transformation; disrespecting storage protocol or letting the uninitiated view it unmasked is taboo.*

Chi (individual divine spirit) — *Igbo Odinani (Nigeria)*
Individual portion of Chukwu assigned to each person before birth. Personal divine "other self" and guardian accompanying an individual through life.
How to honor: *Each person maintains a personal Chi shrine, often centered on an ikenga (carved wooden figure), where kola nut, palm wine, and libations are offered along with prayer. Living in alignment with what one's Chi "agreed to" before birth — hard work, moral conduct, right action — is itself considered an act of honoring it, since a well-fed, respected Chi is believed to bring good fortune.*

Dalia — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Fate-being governing distribution of material fortune/portion in life. Laima's close associate governing the specific "share" each person receives.
How to honor: *Modern Romuva practice honors Dalia with offerings of bread, grain, woven linen cloth (juosta/sash), and coins left at household altars or field boundaries, since she governs harvest fortune and one's material "share" in life; white and natural linen and spindle/weaving imagery represent her. She is invoked at harvest rites and life-passage rituals (birth, marriage) where portion or luck is at stake. Taboo: complaining about one's fate, considered an affront to her.*

Frigg — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Allmother, goddess of marriage and foresight. Odin's wife, seeress who tried to protect Baldr from death.
How to honor: *Frigg (Norse, general) is honored as patroness of marriage, motherhood, and the household hearth; she is said to spin clouds and foreknowledge at her wheel in the hall Fensalir, so distaff and spinning-wheel offerings parallel the Slavic Mokosh pattern — wool work dedicated or left undisturbed in her name. Her silence about foreknowledge she cannot change (famously about Baldr's death) is honored as a model of dignified restraint; she is invoked especially in matters of marriage, childbirth, and household protection, with hearth-blessing rites in modern Heathen practice.*

Israfil — *Islam*
Angel who will blow the trumpet at Judgment Day. Angel of the Day of Judgment's herald-trumpet.

How to honor: *Angel who will sound the trumpet (as-Sur) at the Day of Judgment; not propitiated, since Islamic practice directs worship to God alone, but honored through belief affirmation and through dua asking for a good outcome on the Day he will herald. His role is invoked mainly in eschatological teaching and Quranic recitation (e.g., Surah az-Zumar) rather than any dedicated ritual.*

Ketu — *Vedic Astrology*
South lunar node; detachment, past-life mastery, moksha. Shadow planet governing spiritual detachment.
How to honor: *Ketu is honored with multicolored flowers, blankets, flags donated to temples, and cat's eye gemstone (vaidurya) as a remedial stone; his temple is at Keezhaperumpallam (Ketu Sthala) in Tamil Nadu. Feeding dogs and donating multicolored or "off" items (mismatched cloth, mixed grains) is a traditional offering, reflecting his rulership over detachment, spiritual mastery, and severed material ties.*

Laima — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Goddess who pronounces each person's destiny at birth; protector of pregnant women/childbirth. Fate goddess (sometimes three sisters/aspects) determining a life's shape irrevocably.
How to honor: *Invoked at birth itself — folk custom held Laima appeared in the birthing room or bathhouse (pirtis) at the moment of delivery to pronounce the child's fate, so offerings of bread, cheese, wool, or a woven towel were left for her there. Expectant and new mothers prayed to her directly, sometimes giving birth in the sauna specifically because it was considered her domain, and a linden tree could be planted at a child's birth as her living token; she is also invoked at weddings as a second fate-turning point.*

Leontocephaline (lion-headed god) — *Zurvanism/Mithraism*
Lion-headed, serpent-wound, winged deity representing devouring/cyclical time (debated as Zurvan or Ahriman). Terrifying iconographic embodiment of time's destructive-consuming power.
How to honor: *The leontocephaline has no independent devotional record outside its physical placement in Mithraic sanctuaries (mithraea) — dozens of examples survive as statues wound in serpent coils, wings extended, holding keys and a scepter/thunderbolt, positioned at the rear of the cult chamber near or opposite the tauroctony. Scholars have found no separate liturgy addressed to it by name; it functioned as a silent icon of devouring time confronted by initiates during the mystery grades rather than a figure given food or drink offerings, so the most accurate acknowledgment is that it was venerated through proximity and gaze within the initiation rite itself, not through named ritual acts.*

Maitreya — *Shingon*
Future Buddha awaited by Kukai in eternal meditation. The future Buddha whose coming Kukai awaits in nyujo meditation.
How to honor: *Amaterasu is honored at Ise Grand Shrine's inner shrine (Naiku), where her sacred mirror (one of the Three Imperial Regalia) is enshrined and the entire shrine complex is ritually rebuilt every twenty years (Shikinen Sengu); rice, sake, and seasonal offerings are presented by Shinto priests, with public access restricted at the innermost sanctuary.*

Old Woman (Blackfoot) — *Blackfoot*
Co-creator who negotiated the world's nature with Napi (incl. death). Napi's negotiating partner who established mortality and balance.
How to honor: *Old Woman appears in Blackfoot origin narratives as Napi's negotiating counterpart who helped set the terms of human mortality (the floating buffalo-chip/stone test); she is honored through accurate oral storytelling, especially in winter, and through the broader ceremonial life — Sun Dance, sweat lodge, pipe ceremonies — that honors the created order she helped shape. No standalone cultic ritual to her alone is documented, so invented rites should be avoided; defer to Blackfoot tradition-keepers for authoritative retellings.*

Ori — *Yoruba/Ifa*

Personal divinity within the head; individual destiny. Most personal Orisha; the divine force governing one's individual chosen destiny.
How to honor: *Osain's leaves and roots are gathered before sunrise with a specific invocation and a small payment left at the base of the plant to compensate the forest spirit for what is taken; he is depicted as one-legged, one-eyed, and one-armed, and his ashe is stored in a sealed clay pot used by herbalists. Honoring him means never harvesting medicinal plants without the accompanying prayer and offering.*

Orula — *Lucumí*
Witness of every soul's destiny before birth; patron of Ifá divination. Orisha of destiny and divination knowledge (syncretized with St. Francis of Assisi).
How to honor: *Orula (Orunmila) is consulted exclusively through a Babalawo using the Ifá divination system (opele chain or ikin palm nuts), never approached directly by ordinary devotees. Receiving the Mano de Orula (Hand of Orula) bracelet is a formal initiatory ceremony that marks a person as under his protection and grants access to his guidance; he is offered smoked fish, jutía, toasted corn, and coconut, and is honored on the 4th and 16th of each month and October 4th (syncretized with St. Francis of Assisi).*

Oxumaré — *Candomblé/Umbanda*
Rainbow serpent, cyclical renewal, dual-gendered. Dual-gendered rainbow/serpent Orixá of transformation.
How to honor: *Oxumaré's altar is set in green and yellow with rainbow imagery, serpent figures, coins, and a double-headed axe, fed fruits, yams, and low-salt dishes plus small money gifts reflecting his domain of wealth and renewal. His day is Tuesday with a major festival August 24th; devotees greet him "Arroboboi Oxumaré!", he is syncretized with St. Bartholomew, and as a dual-gendered serpent deity (male six months, female six months) his rites emphasize transformation and balance rather than fixed identity.*

Rozhanitsy — *Slavic Paganism*
Fate-weaving beings present at every birth. Three female beings who weave a child's fate at birth.
How to honor: *The Rozhanitsy were honored alongside Rod at birth and household feasts with specifically bloodless offerings — kutia (grain porridge), bread, honey, and cheese, with meat or blood offerings avoided as inappropriate to them. Women held dedicated feasts after childbirth, and embroidered ritual cloths (rozhanitsa rushnyky) with birth-related motifs were made and dedicated in their honor; observance clustered around midwinter and post-harvest thanksgiving, framing them as ever-present guardians of a child's woven fate.*

Saoshyant — *Zoroastrianism*
Eschatological savior figure. Messianic savior figure who leads the final cosmic battle against evil.
How to honor: *Saoshyant has no ritual cult of his own since he is a future eschatological figure, but hope in his coming is expressed through prayers for Frashokereti (the final renovation of the world) recited in the Yasna, and through Nowruz (Persian New Year), which symbolically anticipates cosmic renewal. Living righteously (following Asha) is considered the way devotees personally hasten his arrival.*

Saturn — *Roman Religion*
Sacred time, the golden age, liberation. Ruler of the mythic Golden Age.
How to honor: *Saturn was honored at Saturnalia (December 17-23), marked by gift exchange, temporary suspension of social hierarchy, candle-lighting, and a public banquet where the god's statue had its feet unbound (normally bound with wool all year, symbolizing his liberation for the festival). The festival commemorated his mythic Golden Age reign of plenty and equality.*

Saturn (Western Astrology) — *Western Astrology*

Rules Capricorn/Aquarius; structure, limitation, discipline, karma. Greater malefic/teacher planetary archetype of time and mastery.
How to honor: *Saturn rules Saturday, colors black/dark brown/gray, lead as metal, and stones like onyx, jet, and hematite; incenses are myrrh, cypress, and patchouli. Binding, banishing, and discipline work is timed to his day/hour with offerings of dark bread or earth; the astrological "Saturn Return" (~ages 29, 58) is treated as a major life threshold, and impatience or rushing Saturnian work is considered counterproductive.*

Saturn/Kronos (Planetary Days) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Roman/Greek)*
Governs time, karma, discipline, thresholds. Roman/Greek god of time, ruler of Saturday.
How to honor: *Saturn/Kronos (Planetary Days): Saturn's festival Saturnalia (December 17–23) involved social role-reversal (masters served slaves), candlelit gift-giving of small clay figurines (sigillaria), and — uniquely among Roman sacrifices — his priest offered with head uncovered in the Greek rite rather than veiled. Modern Saturday observance keeps fasting, stillness, and ancestor/threshold work, treating the day as one for endings, discipline, and reckoning rather than initiating new projects. Rushed or careless action on his day is considered to invite setbacks.*

Shani — *Vedic Astrology*
Servant of planetary court; discipline, karma, longevity. Saturn deity, lord of karma.
How to honor: *Shani is worshipped on Saturdays with black sesame seeds, mustard oil lamps, black cloth, and iron offerings at temples like Thirunallar and Shani Shingnapur, alongside recitation of the Hanuman Chalisa (Hanuman being considered his ally and pacifier); fasting on Saturdays is common. Devotees traditionally avoid buying iron, oil, or black items on Saturdays and instead donate them to the poor, since Shani rewards humility and discipline but punishes arrogance or injustice severely.*

Shani Deva (Yama, Shiva) — *Sacred Planetary Days (Vedic)*
Saturn deity; associated with Yama (death) and Shiva. Vedic Saturn deity ruling Shanivar (Saturday).
How to honor: *Shani Deva (Yama, Shiva): Saturday devotion to Shani centers on offerings of black sesame (til) oil and seeds, iron objects, and black cloth, plus lighting a mustard-oil lamp beneath a peepal tree. Feeding crows (his vahana/vehicle) and giving charity — food, clothing, or money — to laborers and the poor is considered the most direct way to placate him and avoid his harsh judgments (sade sati). New ventures, purchases, or travel are traditionally avoided on Saturday out of respect for his association with delay and karmic reckoning.*

Tezcatlipoca (Black, North, Aztec/Mexica) — *Aztec/Mexica*
Smoking Mirror, night sky, sorcery, destiny. Trickster-fate deity of obsidian and hidden truth.
How to honor: *Tezcatlipoca's central rite, Toxcatl, involved a young captive chosen a year in advance to live as his living ixiptla (impersonator) in luxury — taught flute and fine speech, given four brides — before ascending the temple steps breaking a flute at each stair and being sacrificed at the top. He was invoked with obsidian mirrors, black paint/color, owls, and night; offended by broken promises and hidden deceit, since he was believed to see all secret wrongdoing.*

The Archons — *Gnosticism*
Servants of the Demiurge, often identified with planets, obstruct the soul's ascent. Planetary guardian-obstructors who block the soul's return to the Pleroma.
How to honor: *Planetary Archons who guard the boundaries of the cosmos and obstruct the soul's ascent; texts like the Books of Jeu and Pistis Sophia prescribe specific "seals," passwords, and divine names to be recited to pass each Archon's gate after death. Living Gnostic ritual (in groups like the Sethians) included baptismal rites — the "Five Seals" — meant to pre-arm the soul against Archontic interference; they are not propitiated with offerings but ritually outmaneuvered through esoteric knowledge.*

The Norns (Urdr/Wyrd, Verdandi, Skuld) — *Germanic Heathenry*
Weavers of fate at the Well of Urdr. Triple fate-weaving beings governing past, present, and future.
How to honor: *The Norns are honored less through offerings than through right conduct: words spoken at sumbel are believed recorded into the weave of fate, so oaths sworn there are treated as binding under their watch. Reconstructionist Heathens invoke them at rites of passage (naming, coming-of-age, marriage) and sometimes pour libations at a well or spring evoking the Well of Urdr, but lore prescribes no direct cult offerings — honest living and honored oaths are the devotion itself.*

Urd, Verdandi, Skuld (the Norns) — *Norse/Runes/Wiccan*
Weavers of fate for gods and humans. Three beings older than the gods who weave wyrd at Yggdrasil's base.
How to honor: *The Norns are honored collectively as a triad (rarely invoked individually) with offerings poured at a tree's base or into a well — water, milk, or mead — plus threads, yarn, or weaving tools left on the altar; best done near water or a tree at dawn, with requests framed as seeking clarity or acceptance of wyrd rather than asking them to alter fixed fate.*

Virgin Mary (Theotokos/Queen of Heaven, Catholicism) — *Roman Catholicism*
Mother of God; hyperdulia (elevated veneration, not worship). Mother of Jesus; greatest of the saints, intercessor between humanity and God.
How to honor: *Mother of Jesus, given hyperdulia (elevated veneration short of worship); honored through the Rosary (praying all mysteries on set weekdays), pilgrimage to major Marian shrines (Guadalupe in Mexico, Lourdes in France, Fátima in Portugal), the Angelus prayer at set daily hours, and Marian feast days (Assumption, Immaculate Conception). Devotees light votive candles before her images, wear the Miraculous Medal or brown scapular, and offer flowers — especially white ones — at her statues and shrines.*

Xquic — *Maya (Popol Vuh)*
Maiden impregnated by One Hunahpu's spitting skull; mother of Hero Twins. Underworld maiden miraculously mother of the Hero Twins.
How to honor: *Maiden of Xibalba impregnated by the spitting skull of One Hunahpu, mother of the Hero Twins and associated with blood, the moon, and motherhood; no independent cult or offering tradition is attested outside the Popol Vuh narrative. She is best honored through storytelling of her escape from Xibalba and her role as mother-ancestor, with symbolic moon or motherhood-themed acknowledgment rather than invented ritual offerings.*

Zurvan — *Zurvanism (Persian)*
Infinite/neutral god of time, fate, and space; father of Ahura Mazda and Ahriman. Neutral, uncreated god of infinite time from whom both good and evil are born.
How to honor: *Zurvan has essentially no independent cult, altar tradition, or named offerings recorded anywhere in the historical or archaeological record — Zurvanism was a Sasanian-era Zoroastrian theological school, not a separate devotional religion with its own priesthood or shrine practice; surviving evidence is confined to Middle Persian texts (e.g., Zatspram, Bundahishn) that debate his nature rather than describe worship of him. The most historically honest acknowledgment is that Zurvan was approached, if at all, only obliquely through the same Zoroastrian fire ritual and Gathic prayer addressed to Ahura Mazda, understood by Zurvanite priests as also honoring the totality of time from which Ahura Mazda emerged.*

Other Sacred Beings

Sacred beings, spirit-categories, and divine forces that do not fit neatly into a single domain above.

Amun (Amun-Ra) — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Hidden aspect of the divine merged with Ra. The "hidden" god merged theologically with the visible sun god.
How to honor: *Amun-Ra was honored at Karnak with elaborate daily offering rituals and above all through the annual Opet Festival, when his cult statue was carried by barque in grand procession from Karnak to Luxor Temple, accompanied by public feasting and music along the Nile. His sacred animals — rams and geese — were kept and offered at his temples.*

Angra Mainyu (Ahriman, Zoroastrianism) — *Zoroastrianism*
Evil, destruction, the Lie (Druj). The destructive spirit and source of all evil, opposed to Ahura Mazda.
How to honor: *Angra Mainyu (Ahriman) is never worshipped or offered anything — he is instead actively opposed through ritual purity, recitation of protective prayers like the Ahunavar, and strict avoidance of death-pollution (nasu), since contact with corpses or decay is believed to strengthen his destructive influence. Right living itself, in the Good Thoughts/Words/Deeds triad, is framed as the primary weapon against him.*

Anunnaki — *Mesopotamian*
The great gods, collective term. Collective designation for the major deities.
How to honor: *The Anunnaki (great gods collectively) were honored through daily temple cult where cult statues were ritually clothed, fed, and washed, with offerings of bread, beer, dates, meat, and cedar/juniper incense presented on offering tables. Major festivals included the Akitu (New Year) procession and enthronement rites; temples (ziggurats) were their houses on earth, tended by priests who performed libations and animal sacrifice on their behalf. Taboos centered on ritual purity for temple access and correct procedure in offerings.*

Apophis (Apep) — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Serpent of chaos, anti-creation force. Chaos serpent that threatens Ra's nightly voyage.
How to honor: *Apophis was "honored" only as ritual counter-magic: priests performed execration rites from the Book of Overthrowing Apep — modeling a wax or wood effigy of the serpent, spitting on it, trampling it, binding and mutilating it, then burning it, while his name was written on papyrus and destroyed. This apotropaic ritual (not veneration) treated him purely as a threat to be magically neutralized.*

Ayida Wedo — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Rainbow serpent; connection of sky and earth, abundance. Rainbow-serpent consort of Damballah.
How to honor: *Ayida Wedo, the rainbow serpent, is honored alongside her husband Damballah, sharing his white-food offerings plus symbols of the rainbow — multicolored ribbons, shimmering fabric, and mirrors added to their shared altar. She governs fertility, wealth, and marital harmony, so couples petition her for domestic prosperity. Pepper, rum, and dark or bloody offerings are taboo on her altar.*

Ayizan — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Guardian/patron of the Mambo; sacred palm frond, market/commerce. First Mambo and guardian of fair exchange.
How to honor: *Ayizan, first Mambo and guardian of the market and initiation itself, is honored chiefly through the kanzo initiation rite, where initiates are wrapped in palm fronds (her signature symbol) and veiled to symbolize purification and rebirth. Offerings include yams, unsalted foods, and items tied to fair trade/commerce; she is syncretized with St. Clare and*

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approached for honest dealing in the marketplace. Taboo: dishonesty in trade is believed to draw her displeasure, and her deepest rites are restricted to initiated clergy only.

Bacchus — *Roman Religion*
Wine, sacred ecstasy, mystery religion. God of wine and ecstatic mystery.
How to honor: *Bacchus was honored through ecstatic mystery-cult initiation rites (Bacchanalia) involving wine, music, and altered states — so socially disruptive the Roman Senate banned them outright in 186 BCE before later allowing a more controlled cult. Ivy, grapevines, and the thyrsus were his sacred symbols; wine libations poured out before drinking and theatrical performances were standard forms of honor.*

Barong — *Balinese (Bali)*
Lion-like creature representing dharma, cosmic order, protection. Protective guardian spirit embodying cosmic order.
How to honor: *Barong is honored through the same Barong-Rangda ceremonial drama, performed at temple anniversaries and during periods of perceived spiritual imbalance; the physical Barong costume/mask itself is treated as sacred (sesuunan) and stored in the temple, brought out and danced by trained performers who may enter protective trance, with offerings made directly to the Barong effigy before performances to activate its protective power for the village.*

Bennu — *Heliopolitan (Egypt)*
Sacred heron-like bird of renewal (proto-phoenix), tied to Ra and Osiris. Sacred bird symbolizing solar/soul renewal.
How to honor: *The Bennu, sacred heron-form bird tied to Ra and Osiris, was said to rest atop the benben stone in the temple sanctuary at Heliopolis, closely associated with the ba (soul) of Ra. Later Greek writers merged it with the phoenix myth, but native sources emphasize honoring it through solar/soul-renewal temple hymns and amulets.*

Bhuta Kala — *Balinese (Bali)*
Lower spirits of crossroads, cemeteries, waste ground causing illness/misfortune. Class of disturbing/chaotic spirits requiring practical management.
How to honor: *Bhuta Kala spirits are managed through caru offerings — food, meat, and sometimes small animals (such as a chicken for minor rites, larger animals for major purification ceremonies like Tawur Kesanga before Nyepi) — placed directly on the ground or at crossroads, since these lower spirits are appeased at earth-level rather than on raised shrines reserved for higher deities. The goal is pacification and balance (rwa bhineda), not elimination, and misplaced or upward offerings intended for gods are considered wasted on them.*

Cai Shen — *Chinese Folk Religion*
God of Wealth, righteous prosperity. God of Wealth invoked throughout Chinese daily life.
How to honor: *Cai Shen, god of righteous wealth, is welcomed on the 5th day of Chinese New Year ("Po Wu") with firecrackers and open doors at dawn, and honored with offerings of oranges/tangerines symbolizing gold and displayed red envelopes; his birthday is marked with further firecracker celebrations. Devotees stress honest dealing, since he is understood to bless only rightfully earned prosperity, not ill-gotten gain.*

Devas (the "shining ones," collective) — *Bhagavad Gita / Hinduism*
Highly evolved beings who control physical/astral forces and supervise the operations of the universe. Class of divine, luminous beings who co-sustain the cosmos with humanity.
How to honor: *The Devas are traditionally "fed" and honored through Vedic fire ritual (yajna/homa), in which ghee, grains, and other offerings are poured into consecrated fire while mantras invoke specific devas such as Agni, Indra, Surya, and Vayu, each with designated offerings. Householder Hindu practice includes deva-yajna as one of the five daily great sacrifices (pancha mahayajna) prescribed for maintaining cosmic and household order. The Gita itself (3.11–3.13) frames this as a reciprocal cycle — humans sustain the devas through yajna,*

and the devas in turn sustain humans through rain and natural order — so living in accordance with dharma and performing these rites is considered the proper way to honor them.

Dewata Nawa Sanga (Nine Directional Deities) — *Balinese (Bali)*
Nine deities governing the nine cardinal/intermediate/center directions. Nine-god mandala governing sacred directions of the cosmos.
How to honor: *The Dewata Nawa Sanga are honored through the nine-colored flower arrangement of the canang sari, each direction/deity receiving its designated color (white-east/Iswara, red-south/Brahma, yellow-west/Mahadewa, black-north/Wisnu, plus intermediate colors for the ordinal points and orange/multicolor center for Siwa), and through directional temple shrines (kahyangan jagat) positioned around Bali corresponding to each deity's cardinal point, most famously Besakih (northeast, associated with Siwa's supreme seat).*

Dionysus — *Greek*
God of wine, ecstasy, theater, transformation; death-rebirth deity. God of sacred frenzy and consciousness-dissolving ecstasy.
How to honor: *Dionysus was honored through major civic festivals — the City Dionysia and Rural Dionysia in Athens, which included the performance of tragedy and comedy as sacred theater — and the Anthesteria, a spring wine festival marking the opening of new wine. Ivy wreaths, the thyrsus wand, and wine libations were his core offerings, and ecstatic group rites (thiasoi) involving dance, music, and wine-induced enthousiasmos were central to his worship, especially among maenad devotees.*

Dwo — *Bobo Bwa*
Generative sacred force, animates masks/nature/fertility. Creative cosmic force manifesting through activated masks.
How to honor: *Dwo, the generative force animating masks, nature, and fertility, is cultivated through correctly performed mask rituals — danced at initiations, funerals, and agricultural rites — accompanied by specific drumming rhythms, with millet or sorghum offerings and millet beer poured onto mask shrines, and chickens sacrificed at mask consecration to properly "activate" the force.*

Ganesha — *Hinduism*
Removing obstacles, beginnings, wisdom. Elephant-headed remover of obstacles and patron of writers/scholars.
How to honor: *Ganesha is worshipped first before any new venture, ritual, or deity — his mantra "Om Gam Ganapataye Namaha" opens virtually all Hindu ceremonies — and modaka (a steamed sweet dumpling, reputedly his favorite food) is his signature offering, along with durva grass and red hibiscus flowers. Ganesh Chaturthi is his ten-day festival (especially massive in Maharashtra), where large clay idols are worshipped publicly then ceremonially immersed in water (visarjan); he dislikes being depicted or worshipped with the tulsi leaf, per a specific mythological curse against that plant touching him.*

Gaueko — *Basque*
Malevolent being of darkness kept away by the Eguzkilore. Being of darkness/night warded off by protective plant.
How to honor: *Gaueko, the malevolent being of darkness, is warded off primarily by hanging the eguzkilore (a dried thistle "sun-flower") above doorways, a protective custom still practiced in Basque households. Folk caution also held that one should not linger outdoors carelessly after dark or casually invoke his name, per the traditional saying warning that "Gaueko" should not "catch" a person out at night.*

Genius (personal) — *Roman Religion*
Male individual's generative/creative divine spirit. Personal divine double of a Roman man.
How to honor: *A Roman man's personal Genius was honored chiefly on his birthday, when he and his household offered wine, incense, and flowers (no blood sacrifice — bloodless offerings*

only) at a small altar or lararium; oaths sworn "by my Genius" were especially binding. The Genius of the reigning emperor became an important object of loyalty oaths under the Empire.

Hanuman — *Hinduism*
Devotion, strength, courage, protection. Monkey-god of perfect, selfless devotion to Rama.
How to honor: *Hanuman devotees recite the Hanuman Chalisa (a 40-verse hymn) daily, particularly on Tuesdays and Saturdays, his consecrated days, and offer sindoor (red vermillion) and til (sesame) oil applied directly to his image, along with laddoos as his preferred sweet. He is invoked specifically for protection from evil, courage before exams or hardship, and physical strength — wrestlers (pehalwans) in India traditionally maintain akhara gyms with a Hanuman shrine — and he is never offered alcohol or meat, as pure celibate devotion (brahmacharya) is central to his character.*

Heka — *Kemet*
Primordial magic, the creative force behind all ritual and speech. Deified fundamental creative/magical force of the universe.
How to honor: *Heka was honored by correct ritual speech: priests known as heka-priests opened spells and prayers by invoking his name as the animating force of magic, and sympathetic-magic practices (wax or clay figures, execration texts) relied on his power to make words effective. He was worshipped alongside Khnum and Menhit at Esna; his devotional practice, ancient and modern, centers on precise, intentional words rather than material offerings.*

Hineahuone — *Polynesian (Maori)*
First human woman, fashioned from red earth by Tane. First woman, ancestor of the Maori people.
How to honor: *The first woman, shaped by Tāne from red earth (oneone) at Kurawaka and given life through his breath into her nostrils — honor is expressed through karakia at childbirth and rites of new life rather than food offerings. Red ochre (kōkōwai), used in her creation myth, is a traditional symbolic color linked to her; she is invoked in whakapapa recitations and birth ceremonies.*

Holy Ghost — *LDS/Mormon*
Personage of Spirit (no physical body), third member of the Godhead. Spirit-member of the LDS Godhead.
How to honor: *The Holy Ghost is not prayed to directly but is formally "received" through the ordinance of confirmation — a priesthood holder lays hands on a newly baptized member's head and says "Receive the Holy Ghost." Ongoing devotion consists of living worthily to retain the Spirit's promptings, and testimonies are described as being confirmed "by the Holy Ghost" — members seek to feel warmth, peace, or a "burning in the bosom" as confirmation of truth.*

Holy Spirit (Byzantine) — *Byzantine*
Third person of Trinity. Divine person affirmed co-equal at Council of Constantinople 381 CE.
How to honor: *The Holy Spirit (Byzantine) is invoked directly at the epiclesis of the Divine Liturgy, the moment the priest calls the Spirit down to transform bread and wine into the Eucharist — this is the theological climax of Byzantine worship. Honored at Pentecost with kneeling prayers (the first kneeling permitted since Pascha) and church decorated with greenery symbolizing renewal. Chrismation (anointing with holy oil) immediately after baptism seals the recipient "with the gift of the Holy Spirit."*

Hretha (Hrēþe) — *Germanic Heathenry (Anglo-Saxon)*
Goddess of March, honored before Eostre. Anglo-Saxon goddess associated with glory/victory and early spring.
How to honor: *Hretha, like Eostre, is known only from Bede, who states sacrifices were offered to her during Hrēþmōnaþ (March) — virtually no further detail survives about her nature or rites. The most historically honest acknowledgment is that she remains genuinely obscure;*

modern Heathens who honor her typically do so with a simple toast or blót naming her during the March portion of the seasonal cycle rather than inventing elaborate ritual.

Huacas (sacred place-beings, collective) — *Inca/Tawantinsuyu (Andes)*
Sacred springs, rocks, tombs, and landscape features holding sacred power. Broad category of sacred places/objects/beings saturating the Andean landscape.
How to honor: *Required acknowledgment and small offerings (coca leaves, chicha, food) from anyone passing through their presence; organized along the ceque system — ritual sight-lines radiating from Coricancha in Cusco, each tended by specific kin groups responsible for its upkeep. Some huacas received Qhapaq hucha sacrifices (including chosen aqllakuna) at times of crisis or major imperial events, overseen by the Willaq Umu and noble panaqa families.*

Huanaki — *Niue*
Primary male protector deity of Niue. Protector god of the island of Niue.
How to honor: *Remembered in Niuean tradition as a protector/creator figure associated with raising up the island; Huanaki is also the name of an actual cave/site on Niue tied to the myth — but no documented ongoing offerings, altar setup, or festival calendar for him as a worshipped deity survives. The historically appropriate honor is storytelling remembrance of the island-raising myth and respectful acknowledgment of the Huanaki site itself as a place of cultural memory.*

Igigi — *Mesopotamian*
The lesser gods who labored before humans were created. Junior divine laborers of the pantheon.
How to honor: *The Igigi, the lesser laboring gods of Atrahasis/Enuma Elish, have no attested personal cult or offering list as individuals — the historically fitting way to honor them is through storytelling/remembrance of the Atrahasis myth (their strike against forced labor that led the gods to create humanity) and by symbolically honoring laborers or taking a day of rest in their name.*

Isis (Roman cult) — *Roman Religion*
Egyptian goddess of protection, magic, resurrection. Egyptian mystery goddess offering personal salvation.
How to honor: *Isis's Roman cult observed a twice-daily temple rite: a dawn ceremony unveiling the cult statue with hymns to the rising sun, and a formal evening closing rite; Nile water, kept in a sacred vessel, was venerated as a physical relic of her Egyptian origin. Her major public festival was the Navigium Isidis (March 5), "Isis's Ship," when a ceremonial boat was launched to mark the reopening of Mediterranean sailing season, with sistrum-rattling and priests carrying her sacred emblems through the streets.*

Jakaira — *Guarani*
Dominion over mist, springtime, and rising tobacco smoke. Companion god associated with mist and shamanic inspiration.
How to honor: *Kuarahy (Guaraci), the sun and sacred twin, is acknowledged at the opening of jeroky and opy ceremonies as part of the daily and seasonal cycle he governs; some Tupi-Guaraní descendant communities maintain sunrise-facing prayer as a mark of respect. He is honored through cosmological acknowledgment more than discrete offerings.*

Janus — *Roman Religion*
Beginnings, thresholds, doorways, time. Uniquely Roman two-faced god of thresholds and beginnings.
How to honor: *Janus was honored at every doorway and threshold in Rome; his temple's doors were kept open during wartime and closed only in times of full peace. January bears his name, and January 1 was his primary festival day, when Romans exchanged gifts and offered him the first prayers of any ceremony, since he was invoked before any other god as opener of ritual itself.*

Jeseok Shin (Heavenly Prince) — *Korean Muism*
Presides over blessing of living family members, abundance, fortune. Buddhist-derived spirit governing cosmic blessing of human fortune.
How to honor: *In Jeseok Gut, Jeseok Shin is honored with strictly vegetarian, Buddhist-influenced offerings — white rice, rice cakes (especially baekseolgi, white steamed rice cake), fresh fruit, and sometimes seven-grain rice tied to Chilseong (Seven Star) veneration; meat and alcohol are avoided because of his Buddhist purity association. The officiating mudang traditionally wears white or pale robes for this segment and offers prayers for family fortune, longevity, and childbirth, since Jeseok governs abundance and the wellbeing of living descendants.*

Jinns — *Hamar (Ethiopia)*
Shape-shifting spirit beings (human/animal form), unpredictable influence. Spirit beings capable of helping or harming humans, reflecting regional Islamic-influenced sacred imaginary.
How to honor: *Jinns among the Hamar and neighboring Horn-of-Africa communities are approached with caution rather than devotion — protective amulets, Islamic-influenced protective recitations, and avoidance of riverbanks or open ground at dusk (when jinns are believed most active) are common defensive practices. Whistling at night is a widely held taboo in the region, believed to attract their attention.*

Juno (personal) — *Roman Religion*
Female individual's divine counterpart. Personal divine double of a Roman woman.
How to honor: *A Roman woman's personal Juno was honored on her birthday with offerings of wine, flowers, and incense at the household shrine, invoked in oaths and blessings specific to her as an individual — distinct from public temple worship of the goddess Juno.*

Kachinas (All My Relations) — *Hopi*
Hundreds of named spirit beings serving as intermediaries between Creator and humans. Hopi spirit intermediaries governing specific life domains.
How to honor: *Kachinas are honored through the annual Hopi ceremonial calendar, embodied by masked and costumed dancers (katsinam) who bring rain, fertility, and blessings to the villages between roughly the winter solstice (Soyal) and Niman (Home Dance) in July, when the kachinas are ritually "sent home" to the San Francisco Peaks; carved Kachina dolls (tihu) are given to girls and infants as sacred teaching objects, never treated as mere toys, and secrecy around ceremonial specifics is strictly maintained by initiated members.*

Legba (Ewe) — *Ewe/Vodun*
Crossroads, doorways, communication between human/divine worlds. Trickster gatekeeper deity who must grant permission before any other spirit can be reached.
How to honor: *Legba must be greeted and fed before any other spirit in every Vodun ceremony — his shrine, typically a mound or phallic clay figure at the compound entrance, receives palm oil, palm wine, tobacco, cigars, peanuts, and (in stronger rites) a sacrificed rooster. Mondays are traditionally his day; withholding his opening offering is believed to block communication with every other spirit, making disrespect toward him the single greatest ritual taboo in the pantheon.*

Loko — *Vodou (Haiti)*
Guardian/patron of the Houngan (male priest); linked to the poteau mitan. First Houngan and Lwa of the sacred central post.
How to honor: *Papa Loko, first Houngan and Lwa of trees and the poteau-mitan (center post), is honored primarily through the priesthood itself — a Houngan's ason (sacred rattle) is consecrated in his name, and no major initiation (kanzo) can proceed without his blessing invoked over the sanctuary. Offerings include leaves, tree bark, herbal medicines, and libations poured at the base of significant trees, since illness and healing herbs are his domain. Taboo: performing initiation rites without properly honoring Loko is considered spiritually invalid.*

Mary (Theotokos/Marian devotion, Catholic & Orthodox) — *Christianity (Catholic/Orthodox)*
Venerated (not worshipped) intercessor; preserves a feminine divine presence. Mother of Jesus venerated as chief intercessor and quasi-divine feminine figure.
How to honor: *God the Father is honored through Mass/Divine Liturgy, the Eucharist, incense, icons, and the sign of the cross in Catholic/Orthodox practice; Protestants emphasize scripture reading, hymn-singing, and personal prayer, Pentecostals add glossolalia and expressive worship. Sunday communal worship, baptism, and grace before meals are common threads across all branches.*

Monster Slayer & Born for Water (All My Relations) — *Navajo (Diné)*
Holy People/Hero Twins central to Navajo spiritual life. Navajo Hero Twins, interactive spiritual protector beings.
How to honor: *Monster Slayer and Born for Water, the Navajo Hero Twins, are honored through their central role in the Enemyway and other protection-oriented chantways, where their defeat of the monsters that once threatened the Diné is retold to invoke their protective power, particularly for warriors, veterans, or anyone needing purification from dangerous or foreign contact; corn pollen and sandpainting imagery associated with their journey to the Sun's house are part of these healing ceremonies.*

Ninlil — *Mesopotamian*
Enlil's consort. Consort goddess of the storm god.
How to honor: *Ninlil, grain goddess and consort of Enlil, was worshipped alongside him at Nippur, with the Tummal festival marking her sanctuary's renewal/procession between Nippur and other cult cities. Traditional offerings were barley, grain, bread, and beer, reflecting her identity as a grain/harvest deity; modern reconstructionists honor her with baked bread, raw grain, and beer left on the altar, often paired with Enlil in household or seasonal harvest rites.*

Olentzero — *Basque*
Jentil who converted to Christianity, became winter solstice gift-bringer. Basque equivalent of Santa Claus, sole surviving Jentil.
How to honor: *Olentzero, the Jentil who became the Basque winter solstice gift-bringer, is honored each Christmas Eve with town processions carrying his straw effigy (often a coal-carrier figure) through the streets, accompanied by traditional songs (such as "Olentzero buruhandia"), bonfires, and offerings of cider and food; children write him letters requesting gifts. Treating him as identical to Santa Claus rather than his own distinct coal-miner/charcoal-burner figure with Basque-specific customs misses the point of the tradition.*

Prince Philip (deified) — *Vanuatu (Yaohnanen village, Tanna)*
Believed divine son of a mountain spirit, sacred ancestor figure. Real-world British royal venerated as a sacred/divine being since the 1950s-60s.
How to honor: *Honored at Yaohnanen village through framed photographs of Philip displayed as sacred objects on a small shrine, with pig killings and kava ceremonies marking key occasions; upon his April 2021 death, villagers held mourning rites (wailing, gathering, ceremonial exchange) and debated whether Charles or William should be recognized as the successor object of veneration.*

Ragana — *Lithuanian (Baltic)*
Powerful shapeshifting woman knowledgeable in herbs; boundary figure. Complex sacred-feminine figure demonized in Christian era, now being reclaimed.
How to honor: *Ragana is reclaimed in contemporary Romuva and Baltic revivalist practice as a wise "boundary woman" — a healer-herbalist and knowledge-keeper — rather than the witch/demoness she became under Christianization. Modern honoring centers on herb-gathering and folk-healing knowledge, storytelling that restores her pre-Christian dignity, and treating liminal places (forest edges, crossroads, old oaks) as her domain.*

Ruha (Ruha d-Qudsha) — *Mandaean*
Personified spirit bound up in Ptahil's creation, mother of planetary/zodiac spirits. Spirit drawn from the underworld before creation, governing material/astrological forces.
How to honor: *Abatur is invoked at Mandaean funerary rites (Masiqta) as the weigher of souls whose scales determine passage upward, and his gates are said to open during the Parwanaya/Dehwa Rabba (New Year) "Days of Creation." During this festival priests in white robes perform mass baptisms in flowing water, since ritual purity at this time eases the soul's eventual passage through his judgment.*

Saint Germain — *I AM Activity*
Guide/teacher associated with the Violet Flame, Seventh Ray. Ascended Master who reportedly appeared to Guy Ballard and inspired the I AM Activity.
How to honor: *Saint Germain is honored in the I AM Activity through spoken decrees, above all "I AM a Being of Violet Fire, I AM the purity God desires," repeated with visualized violet flame purifying the body and surroundings. Followers attend Saint Germain Foundation classes and pageants (historically at Mount Shasta and the Royal Teton Retreat), and strict adherents avoid meat, alcohol, and tobacco as part of maintaining ritual purity for his teaching to be received.*

Sapling (Good Mind) — *Haudenosaunee*
Gentle, constructive creative twin. Twin who shaped the earth's beauty and abundance.
How to honor: *Turtle, on whose back the earth (Turtle Island) was formed, is honored implicitly through the Thanksgiving Address's acknowledgment of earth and land, and through the widespread ceremonial use of "Turtle Island." Turtle shell rattles are used in Longhouse ceremonial singing, giving Turtle an active ceremonial role beyond origin-story reverence.*

Sheikh Hasan — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Second most important sheikh-figure in Yazidi sacred hierarchy. One of the Heft Sirr (Seven Holy Beings).
How to honor: *Honored through annual mass pilgrimage to his tomb-shrine at Lalish (peaking during Cejna Cemaiye), where pilgrims kiss the shrine's stone threshold and doorposts, tie colored cloth knots (silat) to pillars while making a wish, circle the sanctuary, and light rows of cotton-wick oil lamps fed with olive oil in the sanctuary's dark chambers. Pilgrims also bathe in and drink from the sacred White Spring (Zemzem) and receive blessed earth (berat) to carry home; stepping on the raised stone thresholds of the shrine is strictly taboo.*

Sheikh Nasir ad-Din — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Sacred being associated with specific sacred functions. One of the Heft Sirr (Seven Holy Beings), function not detailed in source.
How to honor: *Venerated as lunar counterpart to Sheikh Shams's solar role, invoked by name in qewls sung at Lalish and honored at a shrine within the sanctuary where pilgrims light cotton-wick oil lamps, especially during Cejna Cemaiye. Devotion is communal and pilgrimage-based rather than expressed through individual home altars or generic folk offerings; he should be named precisely as a sacred-hierarchy figure (khas), not treated as a standalone moon deity.*

Shishlam — *Mandaean*
Personification of the prototypical priest, honored at Dehwa d-Shishlam Rabba. Mandaean personification of the ideal/first priest.
How to honor: *Shilmai and Nidbai are honored by strict household withdrawal during Panja, the five intercalary "New Year" days: for a designated seclusion families stay indoors, abstain from work, killing, marriage, and travel, because these guardian spirits are believed to temporarily leave their posts, exposing people to danger. Quiet, restraint, and staying near hearth and water are the concrete acts of respect.*

Shiva (Bhagavad Gita) — *Bhagavad Gita / Hinduism*
Referenced as "Lord Siva," named alongside Vishnu, Krishna, and Kali. Destroyer/transformer deity of the Hindu Trimurti.

How to honor: *Shiva is honored via abhishekam — ritually bathing his lingam with water, milk, honey, ghee, and yogurt — while offering bilva/bel leaves (his favorite, given in sets of three), white flowers, sacred ash (vibhuti), and datura, while chanting "Om Namah Shivaya." His major festival is Maha Shivaratri, an all-night vigil with fasting and four-phase abhishekam, and Monday (Somvar) is his dedicated weekly fasting day. It is taboo to offer turmeric, kumkum, coconut water, or a husked coconut directly onto the lingam, and tulsi leaves (sacred to Vishnu) are never offered to him.*

Sita — *Hinduism*
Feminine strength, fidelity, dignity. Rama's devoted wife, avatar of Lakshmi and model of feminine virtue.
How to honor: *Sita is worshipped jointly with Rama, especially at Ram Navami and in Ramlila dramatic performances, and has her own festival, Sita Navami (her birth/appearance day), marked by fasting and recitation of the Ramayana. The Janaki Mandir in Janakpur, Nepal (her traditional birthplace) is a major pilgrimage site where devotees offer yellow flowers, turmeric, and bangles, reflecting her association with marital fidelity and dignity.*

Sìth (fairy folk, Seelie/Unseelie Courts) — *Scottish Highland Gaelic*
Parallel race inhabiting the Otherworld adjacent to the human world. The fairy folk, divided into a benevolent (Seelie) and malevolent (Unseelie) court.
How to honor: *The Sìth are propitiated with small daily courtesies rather than grand rites: milk poured onto doorsteps or fairy stones, bread or a portion of the meal left out at night, and their true name avoided in favor of euphemisms like "the good neighbours." Iron (a knife, horseshoe, or pin) is placed near cradles and doorways to bar them, and building on a known fairy path or disturbing a lone hawthorn tree is strictly avoided as inviting disaster.*

Soma — *Hinduism*
Sacred plant/drink, ritual intoxicant deity. Deified sacred plant and drink of Vedic ritual.
How to honor: *Soma is honored through the Vedic Somayajña, in which the juice of the soma plant is pressed with stones, filtered through wool, mixed with milk, poured into the sacred fire, and ritually drunk by officiating priests — the plant's exact botanical identity was lost by the classical era, so substitute plants (e.g., Sarcostemma) are used in the rare traditional Shrauta performances that still occur in India today. Outside these specialist Vedic ritual circles there is no ongoing popular devotional practice.*

The Peacemaker (Deganawida) — *Haudenosaunee*
Divine messenger who founded the Confederacy and Great Law. Sacred being of divine connection who brought the Great Law of Peace.
How to honor: *The Peacemaker (Deganawida) is honored through recitation and periodic public reenactment of the Condolence Ceremony, which follows the grief-healing pattern he used on Hiawatha, and through the annual retelling of the Great Law of Peace at Six Nations gatherings; wampum belts (notably the Hiawatha Belt) are handled and read aloud as sacred ceremonial objects tied directly to him. He is not petitioned with offerings — proper conduct of Confederacy law and Condolence protocol IS the honoring practice.*

Theotokos (Mary, Eastern Orthodoxy) — *Eastern Orthodoxy*
Mother of God, chief intercessor. Mother of Christ, most venerated human person in Orthodoxy though not considered divine.
How to honor: *The Theotokos (Mary) is venerated — a distinction from the worship (latria) reserved for God alone — through the Akathist Hymn, Paraklesis intercessory services (especially during the Dormition Fast, August 1–14), and the kissing of her icons, most famously the Vladimirskaya. Treating her veneration as equivalent to worship of God is itself considered a theological error to avoid within Orthodox practice.*

Tlazolteotl — *Aztec/Mexica*

Goddess of filth, sexuality, ritual confession. "She who eats filth," goddess of purification through confession.
How to honor: *Tlazolteotl, "Eater of Filth," was approached through a once-in-a-lifetime ritual confession to her priests (typically made late in life), who granted absolution for sexual and moral transgressions; her images were shown with a black rubber smear around the mouth signifying the filth she consumed. She was linked to cotton, spindles, and weaving, and to purification through sweeping; treating confession to her as repeatable or casual misrepresents its historically one-time, weighty nature.*

Tuatha De Danann (collective) — *Irish*
Divine race of pre-Milesian Ireland, tribes of the goddess Danu. Supernatural race that inhabited Ireland before humans, retreated into the sidhe.
How to honor: *The Tuatha Dé Danann are honored chiefly through care of the earthworks and mounds (Newgrange, Knowth, Dowth, and countless local raths/fairy forts) said to be their dwellings — never disturbing, farming over, or building on these sites, a taboo still observed in rural Ireland today (roads have been rerouted around "fairy" sites into the 20th–21st century). Offerings of milk, butter, or bread are left at thresholds and mounds especially at Bealtaine and Samhain, when the boundary between worlds is thin.*

Wekufu — *Mapuche*
Dangerous spiritual forces causing illness and misfortune. Malevolent forces operating "out of place" in the sacred order.
How to honor: *Wekufu are not propitiated with offerings but confronted and expelled: during the machitun healing rite the machi enters trance to the beat of the kultrung (drum), uses canelo (cinnamon tree) branches — considered sacred and protective — plus tobacco smoke and herbal remedies to diagnose and drive the wekufu out of the afflicted person. Canelo branches or leaves are also kept near homes as protective wards against them. The correct posture toward wekufu is defensive ritual and avoidance of "out of place" behavior, never invitation or offering.*

White Buffalo Calf Woman (Woope/Ptesan-Wi) — *Lakota Sioux*
Sacred female being who brought the Chanunpa and Seven Sacred Rites. Divine woman who gave the Lakota the Sacred Pipe and Seven Rites.
How to honor: *Unktehi, water monsters said to cause floods, are not petitioned but placated/avoided — their fossil bones are treated cautiously, and tobacco is offered before passage near waters they are said to inhabit. Taboo: swimming or camping in waters explicitly named as Unktehi lairs.*

Wiindigoo — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*
Cannibalistic winter spirit associated with starvation and consuming greed. Spirit embodying self-consuming greed and winter starvation.
How to honor: *Mishibizhii (the Underwater Panther) is treated with fear-tinged respect: certain lakes, rapids, and deep waters associated with him are approached carefully, sometimes with a tobacco offering placed at the shoreline before crossing or fishing, and stories of his danger are told to teach children caution around deep water. He is understood as a genuinely powerful, dangerous presence whose balance against the Thunderbirds must not be disturbed by disrespect.*

Wuloa — *Banna (Ethiopia, Ailama territory)*
Founding bitta (ritual chief-ancestor) of Ailama, led by bees to Mount Pinte. First bitta, sacred territorial founder guided by a red bull and bees.
How to honor: *Wuloa is a clan founder-ancestor from Banna oral tradition rather than a widely worshipped deity with an attested offering calendar; ethnographic accounts describe him leading livestock into Ailama territory and being drawn to Mount Pinte by a swarm of bees, where he placed a ritual spear and flag in a tree and performed a sheep sacrifice, its chyme and fat ritually spread to bless the land, cattle, and people. The culturally appropriate way to honor him today is oral retelling of this founding migration, symbolic association with Mount Pinte and bees, and*

respect for sheep and cattle as living emblems of his blessing — treated as clan-ancestral commemoration rather than deity worship.

Yei — *Navajo/Dine*
Holy People appearing in masked form during the Night Chant. Masked embodiments of specific Holy People.
How to honor: *The Yei are embodied by masked dancers in the Yeibichai, the culminating public dance of the nine-night Nightway (Ye'ii Bi Chei) ceremony, held in winter after the first hard frost and used for healing and restoring hózhǫ́. The masks themselves are treated as sacred objects — blessed with corn pollen, handled only by trained, ritually prepared men, and never treated casually. Attendance at the public dance portions is acceptable for outsiders, but sponsoring or requesting the full ceremony requires proper diagnosis by a hataali.*

Yezid ibn Muawiya — *Yazidism (Kurdish, Iraq/Syria)*
Historical Umayyad Caliph understood as divine manifestation. Historical caliph (680-683 CE) venerated by Yazidis despite being reviled in Shia Islam.
How to honor: *Second in the sheikh lineage descending from Sheikh Adi, he is venerated at his own shrine structure within the Lalish complex through oil-lamp lighting and recitation of qewls that place him in the sacred genealogy; devotion is communal and tied to pilgrimage (especially Cejna Cemaiye) rather than home worship. Taboo: because Yazidi religious authority is hereditary/caste-based, outsiders should not treat him as an independently invokable nature-spirit or make private personal offerings outside this communal, lineage-based framework.*

Yidam (category, tutelary deities) — *Tibetan Vajrayana*
Root of attainments; deity form used in sadhana. Personal meditational deity representing the practitioner's own awakened nature.
How to honor: *Yidam (category, tutelary deities) are engaged only after formal empowerment from a qualified lama, then generated through sadhana: visualizing oneself as the deity, reciting the specific mantra, and performing mudras while making mandala and torma offerings on the shrine. Devotees choose or are assigned a yidam matching their disposition (peaceful, wrathful, etc.) and maintain daily practice as a vow. There is no generic "offering" outside this structured practice — approaching a yidam without transmission is considered ineffective or even harmful.*

Yushamin — *Mandaean*
"Second Life," early emanation from Hayyi Rabbi. Divine emanation in the sequence from the First Life.
How to honor: *Ptahil receives no offerings or shrine; Mandaean practice treats him with deliberate theological caution as the flawed emanation who botched the material creation. He is acknowledged by name in Ginza Rabba recitations and by priests explaining why the physical world is imperfect, but devotees direct actual ritual energy (baptism, prayer) toward Hayyi Rabbi and the higher Uthras instead — the "honoring" is scholarly/liturgical inclusion, not veneration.*

Zar (spirit category, unnamed individuals) — *Ethiopian/Horn of Africa*
Powerful, morally ambiguous spirits who afflict (mainly women) until negotiated with. Category of capricious possessing spirits distinct from God/saints/angels.
How to honor: *Zar spirits are honored through possession-trance ceremonies led by a ritual specialist (often called a shaykhah or "zar doctor"), where the specific zar afflicting a person is identified by trial-and-error drumming — each named zar responds only to its own rhythm, song, and color of cloth. Offerings tailored to the individual zar's preference are given (specific incense like sandalwood or frankincense, particular foods, perfume, or a sacrificial chicken or goat whose blood is offered), after which ongoing token offerings (coffee, cloth, perfume) are maintained periodically to keep the zar appeased and prevent renewed affliction.*

Ziigwan — *Ojibwe/Anishinaabe*
Loosens maple sap at the start of sugaring season. Personified spirit of springtime thaw.

How to honor: *Grandmother Moon (Nokomis Dibiki-Giizis) is honored especially at the full moon, when some Anishinaabe women hold moon ceremonies tied to their sacred responsibility for water, sometimes including a water walk or water offering under moonlight; tobacco is offered in acknowledgment of her governance of tides and women's cycles.*

Closing Note

This compendium draws from the full library of research documents in the Research Check project — indigenous, ancient, folk, esoteric, and living traditions alike. Where a tradition names no separate pantheon (most forms of monotheism), it is not represented here, since the exercise is specifically about comparing gods across traditions that keep one. Entries are drawn directly from the source documents; where a document did not specify a rite of honor, that is noted rather than invented.